SHORT READS | APRIL 23, 2024

Most Americans say a free press is highly important to society

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BY KIRSTEN EDDY

A large majority of Americans see the freedom of the press as highly important to the well-being of society. But many express concerns about potential restrictions on press freedoms in the United States – and say that political and financial interests already have a lot of influence on news organizations. These findings come from a new Pew Research Center survey ahead of World Press Freedom Day on May 3.

How we did this

To examine Americans' perceptions of press freedom in the United States, Pew Research Center surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to 7, 2024.

Everyone who completed the survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

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Pew Research Center is a subsidiary of The Pew Charitable Trusts, its primary funder. This is the latest analysis in Pew Research Center's ongoing investigation of the state of news, information and journalism in the digital age, a research program funded by The Pew Charitable Trusts, with generous support from the John S. and James L. Knight Foundation.

Most Americans say press freedom is important to society

% of U.S. adults who say the freedom of the press is ___ important to the well-being of society

Note: Respondents who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Nearly three-quarters of U.S. adults (73%) say the freedom of the press – enshrined in the First Amendment to the U.S. Constitution – is extremely or very important to the well-being of society. An additional 18% say it is somewhat important, and 8% say it is a little or not at all important.

Some demographic groups are more likely to view press freedom as highly important to society. For instance, White and Asian Americans (78% each) are more likely than Hispanic (61%) and Black (60%) Americans to say it is extremely or very important. U.S. adults with more formal education and higher income levels also are significantly more likely than those with less formal education and lower incomes to say this.

There are no major differences by political party.

Views of press freedom and potential restrictions

Most U.S. adults (79%) believe the media are at least somewhat free to report the news in the country. However, only a third say they're *completely* free to do so. About one-in-five Americans

Topic: Freedom of the press

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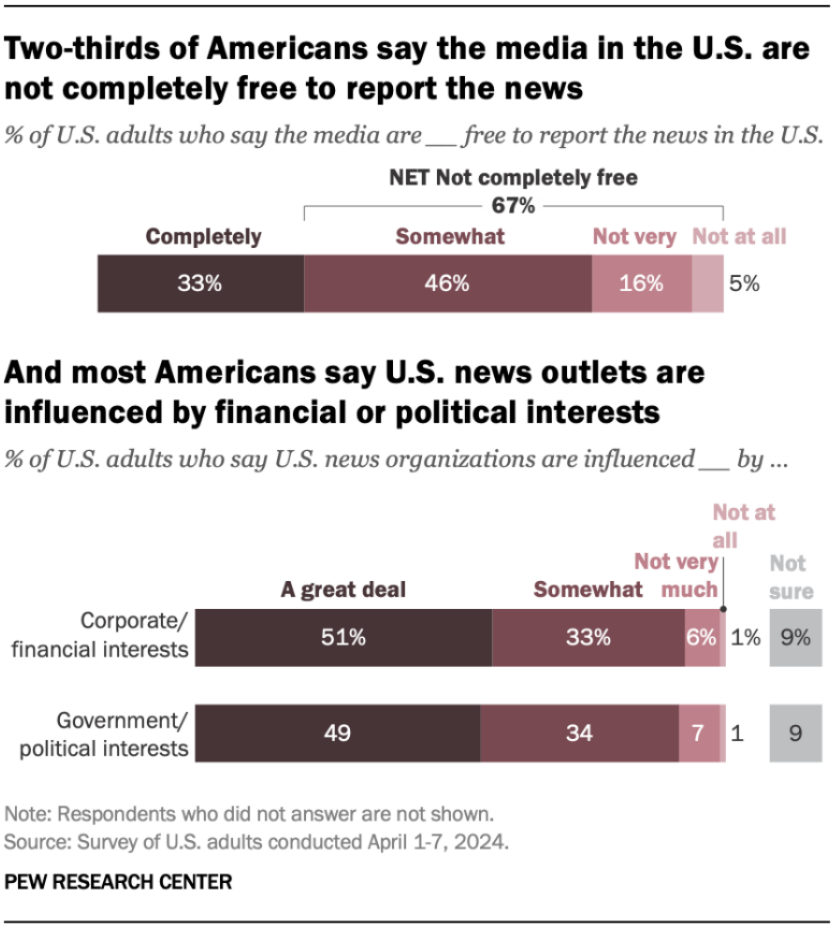
(21%) say the media are not very or not at all free to report the news in the U.S.



At the same time, large majorities of Americans believe that U.S. news organizations are at least somewhat influenced by corporations and financial interests (84%) or by the government and political interests (83%). This includes about half of Americans who say news organizations are influenced *a great deal* by financial interests (51%) or by political interests (49%).

Fewer than one-in-ten U.S. adults say news organizations are not influenced very much or at all by financial (6%) or political (8%) interests.

Recent high-profile incidents such as a police raid on a Kansas newsroom and a government seizure of a Florida journalist's materials have raised questions about press freedom in the U.S.

Regardless of how free they think the press currently is, 41% of Americans are extremely or very concerned about potential restrictions on press freedoms in the country. An additional 29% are somewhat concerned.

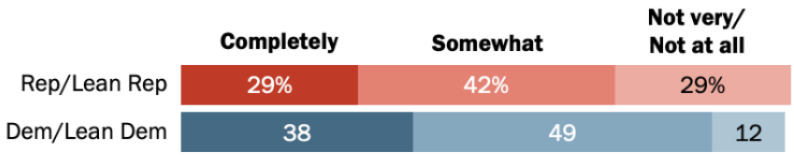
Journalists themselves are especially worried about possible restrictions on press freedom. In a 2022 survey of U.S. journalists, a majority of those surveyed (57%) said they were extremely or very concerned about this.

Partisan differences in views of press freedom

Some aspects of the debate over press freedom have been divided by political party in recent years. For example, former President Donald Trump has been adversarial toward journalists, and Republicans have long alleged that social media sites censor some political viewpoints.

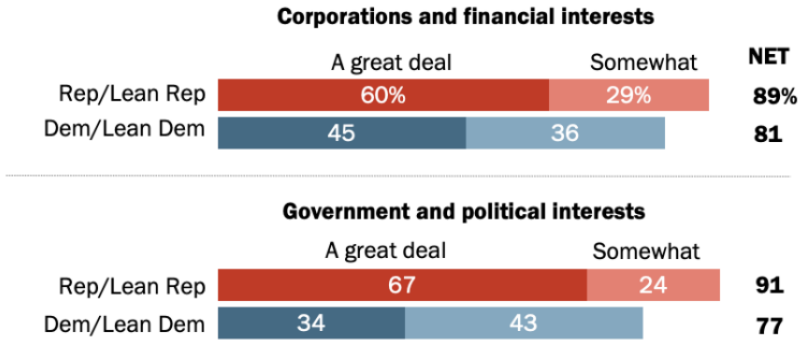
Republicans more likely than Democrats to say U.S. media are not very or not at all free to report news

% of U.S. adults who say the media are ___ free to report the news in the U.S.



And two-thirds of Republicans say news outlets are influenced a great deal by political interests

% of U.S. adults who say U.S. news organizations are influenced ___ by ...



Note: Respondents who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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In the new Center survey, Republicans and independents who lean toward the GOP are consistently more likely than Democrats and Democratic leaners to express concerns about press freedom.

For instance, Democrats are more likely than Republicans to say the media in the U.S. are completely free to report the news (38% vs. 29%), while Republicans are more likely than Democrats to say the media are not very or not at all free (29% vs. 12%). And 47% of Republicans say they are extremely or very concerned about potential restrictions on press freedoms, compared with 38% of Democrats.

Republicans are also about twice as likely as Democrats to believe political interests have *a great deal* of influence on U.S. news organizations. Two-thirds of Republicans say this about political interests, compared with 34% of Democrats. Six-in-ten

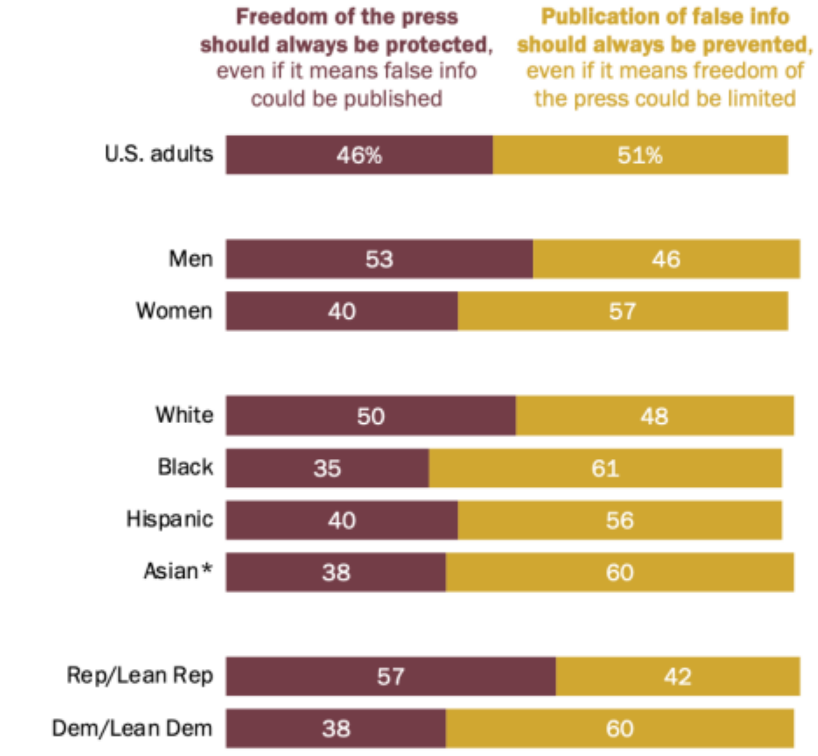
Republicans and 45% of Democrats say financial interests have a great deal of influence on U.S. news organizations.

Protecting press freedom versus preventing misinformation

While Americans largely value the concept of press freedom, they are more evenly divided when it comes to the tension between protecting a free press and preventing the spread of misinformation.

White Americans, Republicans are more likely to favor protecting press freedom over curbing misinformation

% of U.S. adults who say ...



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: Respondents who did not answer are not shown. White, Black, and Asian adults include those who report being only one race and are not Hispanic; Hispanic adults are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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About half of U.S. adults (51%) say that the publication of false information should always be prevented, even if it means press freedom could be limited. Meanwhile, 46% of Americans say

press freedom should always be protected, even if it means false information could be published.

The groups that are more likely to say press freedom should *always be protected* include:

- **Men:** 53% of men say this, compared with 40% of women.
- **White Americans:** Half of White adults say press freedom should always be protected; 35% of Black adults say the same.
- **College graduates:** U.S. adults with at least a bachelor's degree (53%) are more likely than those with a high school diploma or less (38%) to say press freedom should always be protected, even if it means false information can be published.
- **Republicans:** 57% of Republicans say this, compared with 38% of Democrats.

These partisan differences align with a previous Center study that found that Democrats are much more likely than Republicans to support interventions by the U.S. government or technology companies in moderating false information online.

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Research Analyst Naomi Forman-Katz and Research Assistant Christopher St. Aubin contributed to this analysis.

Topics Free Speech & Press, Freedom of the Press, Partisanship & Issues

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REPORT | APRIL 23, 2024

What Are Americans' Top Foreign Policy Priorities?

Protecting the U.S. from terrorism and reducing the flow of illegal drugs are top issues overall, but Democrats and Republicans have very different priorities

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BY JACOB POUSHTER AND LAURA CLANCY

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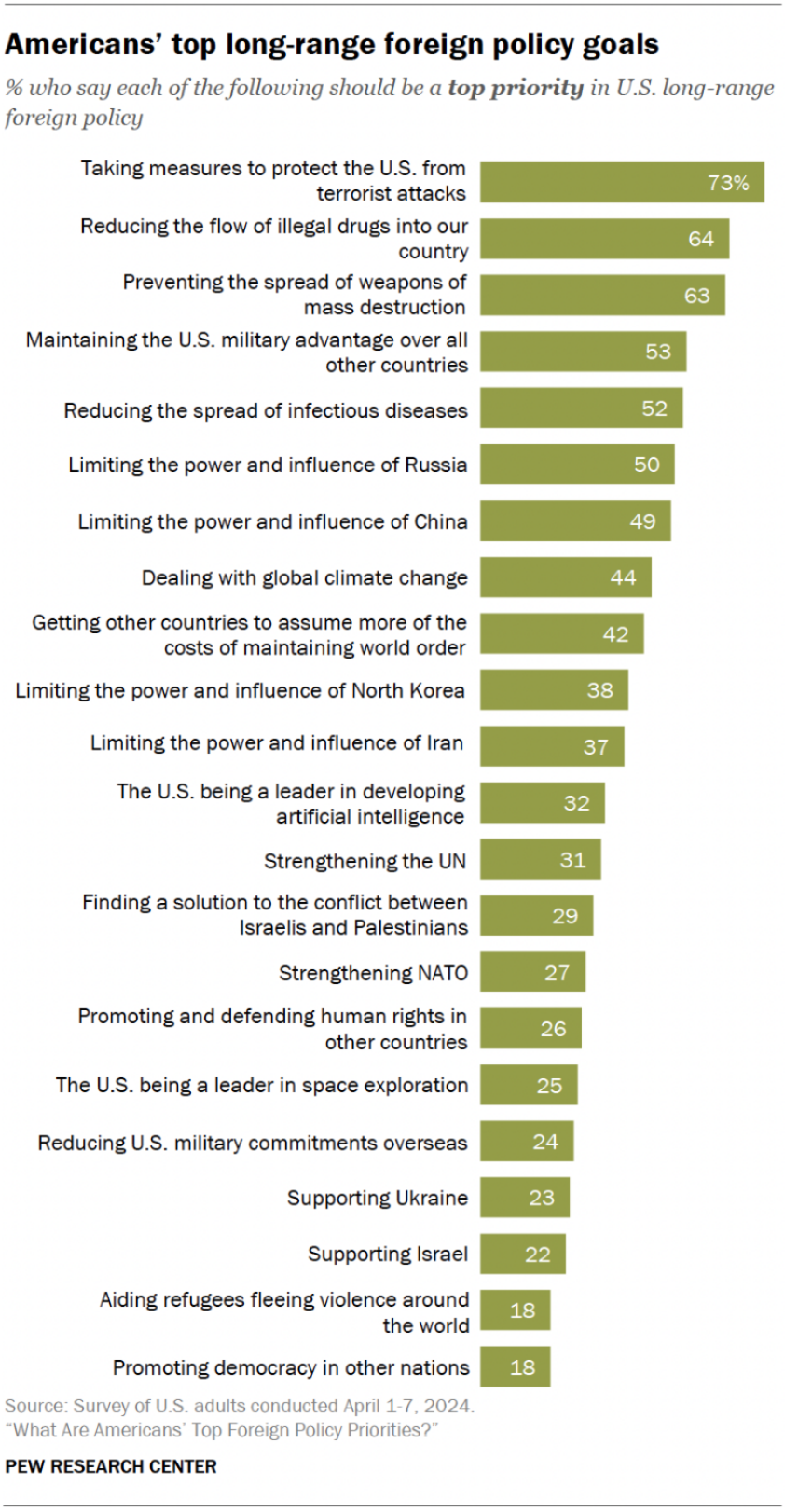
President Joe Biden arrives at the G20 Leaders' Summit on Oct. 30, 2021, in Rome. (Brendan Smialowski/AFP via Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to better understand Americans' long-range foreign policy priorities. For this analysis, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Americans have a lot on their plates in 2024, including an important election to determine who will remain or become again president. But the world does not stop for a U.S. election, and multiple conflicts around the world as well as other issues of global prominence continue to concern Americans.



When asked to prioritize the long-range foreign policy goals of the United States, the majority of Americans say preventing terrorist attacks (73%), keeping illegal drugs out of the country (64%) and preventing the spread of weapons of mass destruction (63%) are top priorities. Over half of Americans also see maintaining the

U.S. military advantage over other countries (53%) and preventing the spread of infectious diseases (52%) as primary foreign policy responsibilities.

About half of Americans say limiting the power and influence of Russia and China are top priorities. A recent annual threat assessment from the U.S. intelligence community focused heavily on those countries' strengthening military relationship and their ability to shape the global narrative against U.S. interests.

Fewer than half of Americans say dealing with global climate change (44%) and getting other countries to assume more of the costs of maintaining world order (42%) are top priorities. The partisan gaps on these two issues are quite large:

- 70% of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents say climate change should be a top priority, while 15% of Republicans and Republican leaners say this.
- 54% of Republicans say getting other countries to assume more of the costs of maintaining world order should be a top priority, compared with 33% of Democrats.

About four-in-ten Americans see limiting the power and influence of North Korea and Iran as top priorities. (The survey was conducted before Iran's large-scale missile attack on Israel on April 13.) And about a third say the same about the U.S. being a leader in artificial intelligence, a technology that governments around the world are increasingly concerned about.

When it comes to goals that focus on international engagement, like strengthening the United Nations and NATO or finding a solution to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, fewer than a third of Americans mark these as top foreign policy priorities.

Related: Fewer Americans view the United Nations favorably than in 2023

Only about a quarter of Americans prioritize promoting human rights in other countries, leading other countries in space

exploration and reducing military commitments overseas. And similar shares say supporting Ukraine (23%) and Israel (22%) are top issues.

At the bottom of this list of foreign policy priorities are promoting global democracy (a major policy push from the Biden administration) and aiding refugees fleeing violence around the world – about two-in-ten Americans describe these as top concerns. These assessments come amid a recent global surge in asylum claims. Still, in Center surveys, democracy promotion has typically been at the bottom of Americans' list of foreign policy priorities, even dating back to George W. Bush's and Barack Obama's administrations.

Overall, a majority of Americans say that all 22 long-range foreign policy goals we asked about should be given at least *some* priority. Still, about three-in-ten Americans say supporting Israel (31%), promoting democracy (28%) and supporting Ukraine (27%) should be given *no* priority.

How have American foreign policy priorities changed?

*% who say each of the following should be a **top priority** in U.S. long-range foreign policy*

	2018	2021	2024	'18-'24 change
Limiting the power and influence of China	32%	48%	49%	▲**17**
Finding a solution to the conflict between Israelis and Palestinians	18	-	29	▲**11**
Limiting the power and influence of Russia	42	42	50	▲**8**
Maintaining the U.S. military advantage over all other countries	49	48	53	▲4
Getting other countries to assume more of the costs of maintaining world order	40	42	42	▲2
Taking measures to protect the U.S. from terrorist attacks	72	71	73	▲1
Reducing the spread of infectious diseases	51	71	52	▲1
Promoting democracy in other nations	17	20	18	▲1
Dealing with global climate change	46	44	44	▼2
Limiting the power and influence of North Korea	40	40	38	▼2
Limiting the power and influence of Iran	39	38	37	▼2
Preventing the spread of weapons of mass destruction	66	64	63	▼3
Promoting and defending human rights in other countries	31	34	26	▼**5**
Reducing U.S. military commitments overseas	30	29	24	▼**6**
Strengthening the UN	39	30	31	▼**8**
Aiding refugees fleeing violence around the world	26	28	18	▼**8**

Note: Statistically significant changes are in **bold**.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.
"What Are Americans' Top Foreign Policy Priorities?"

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The long-range foreign policy priority questions were also asked in 2018 and 2021, and since then there have been some significant shifts in responses:

- Since 2018, the public has become significantly more likely to say limiting the power and influence of China (+17 percentage points) and finding a solution to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict (+11) are top foreign policy priorities.
- Americans have also increased the emphasis they place on limiting the power and influence of Russia, particularly in the wake of the Russian invasion of Ukraine (+8 points since 2021).
- On the decline since 2018 are strengthening the UN and aiding refugees (-8 points each), reducing foreign military

commitments (-6), and promoting and defending human rights in other countries (-5).

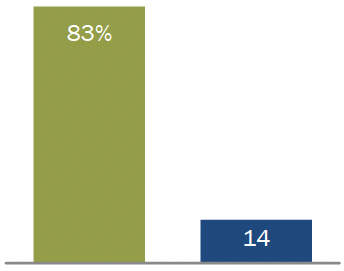
- Preventing the spread of infectious diseases is down 19 percentage points since 2021 – during the height of the COVID-19 pandemic – and about back to where it was in 2018.

These are among the findings from a Pew Research Center survey conducted April 1-7, 2024.

The survey of 3,600 U.S. adults shows that foreign policy remains a partisan issue. Republicans prioritize the prevention of terrorism, reducing the flow of illegal drugs into the country, and maintaining a military advantage over other nations. Meanwhile, Democrats prioritize dealing with climate change and preventing the spread of weapons of mass destruction (WMDs), but also preventing terrorist attacks.

Which should Biden focus on more?

% who say it is more important for President Joe Biden to focus on ...



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.
"What Are Americans' Top Foreign Policy Priorities?"

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There are also stark age differences on many of the policy goals mentioned, but for the most part, young adults are less likely than older Americans to say the issues we asked about are top priorities. The exceptions are dealing with climate change, reducing military commitments overseas, and promoting and

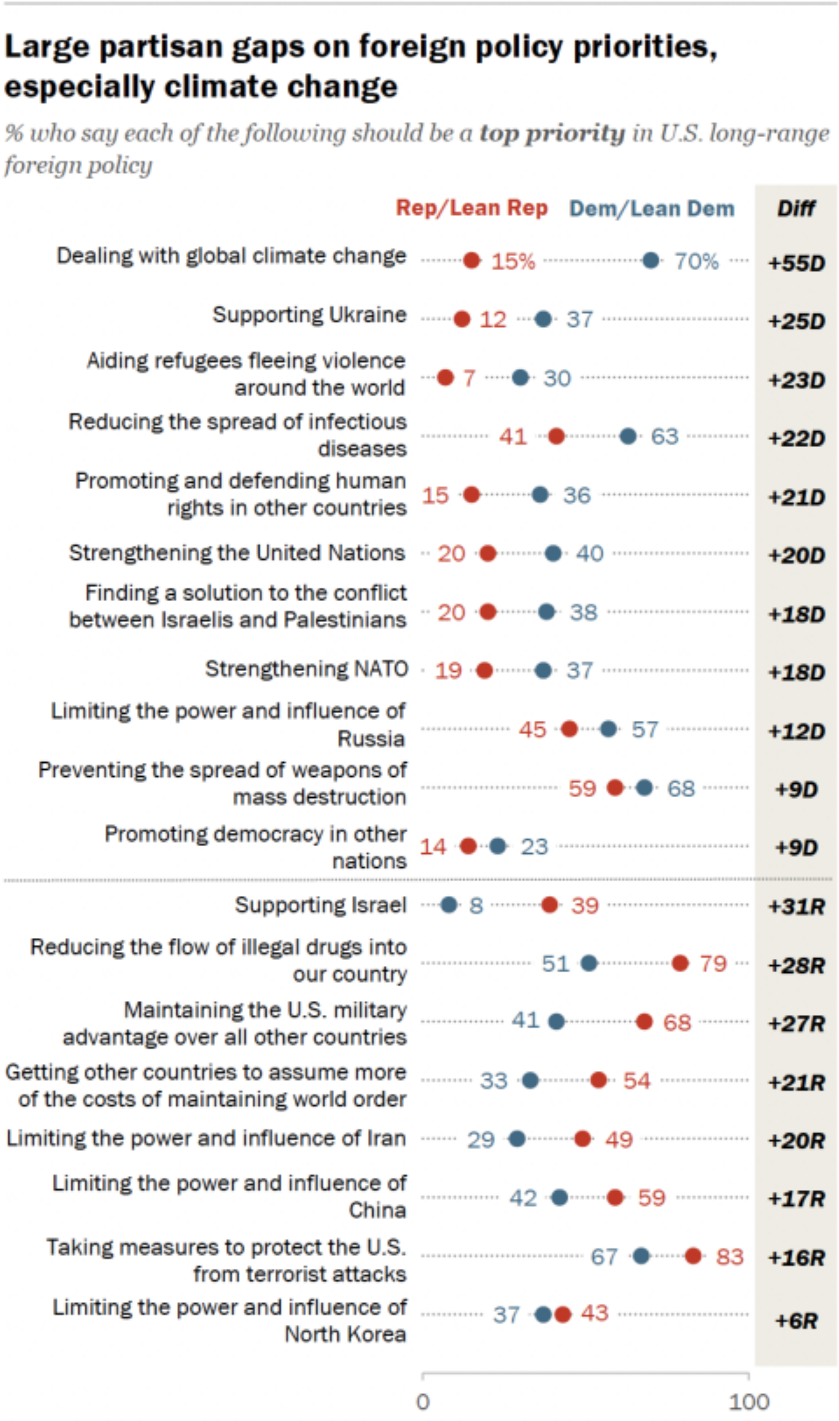
defending human rights abroad – on these issues, 18- to 29-year-olds are significantly more likely than older Americans to assign top priority.

Even with these priorities, foreign policy generally takes the backset to domestic policy for most Americans: 83% say it is more important for President Joe Biden to focus on domestic policy, compared with 14% who say he should focus on foreign policy.

Americans are even less likely to prioritize international affairs than they were in 2019, when 74% wanted then-President Donald Trump to focus on domestic policy and 23% said he should focus on foreign policy.

Differences by partisanship

Americans' foreign policy priorities differ greatly by party. The largest divide, by a significant margin, is the 55 percentage point gap between Democrats and Republicans on dealing with global climate change (70% vs. 15%, respectively, see it as a top priority).

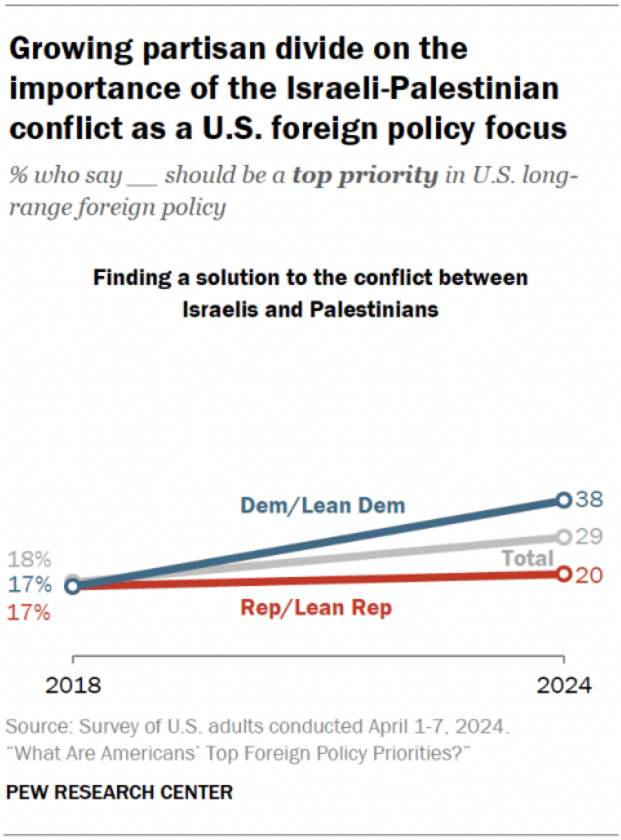


Supporting Ukraine, aiding refugees, reducing the spread of diseases, protecting human rights, and strengthening the UN are also issues on which Democrats are at least 20 points more likely than Republicans to prioritize. For example, 63% of Democrats say reducing the spread of infectious diseases is a top priority, compared with 41% of Republicans.

Republicans prioritize supporting Israel, reducing the flow of illegal drugs and maintaining a military advantage over other countries – among other security and hard power issues – significantly more than Democrats do. For example, more than half of Republicans (54%) say getting other countries to assume more of the costs of maintaining world order should be a top focus in foreign policy. Only a third of Democrats say the same.

The priority assigned to several issues is divided even further by ideology within parties. Take support for Israel and Ukraine as examples. Supporting Israel is generally a higher priority for Republicans than Democrats, but within the Republican Party, 48% of conservatives say it's a top concern, while 18% of moderates and liberals agree. Previous Center research shows that conservative Republicans are especially likely to favor military aid to Israel.

Supporting Ukraine, something Democrats emphasize more than Republicans, is a top priority particularly for liberal Democrats (47%), while about three-in-ten moderate and conservative Democrats agree (29%). Democrats have also shown more willingness than Republicans to provide aid to Ukraine in its conflict with Russia.

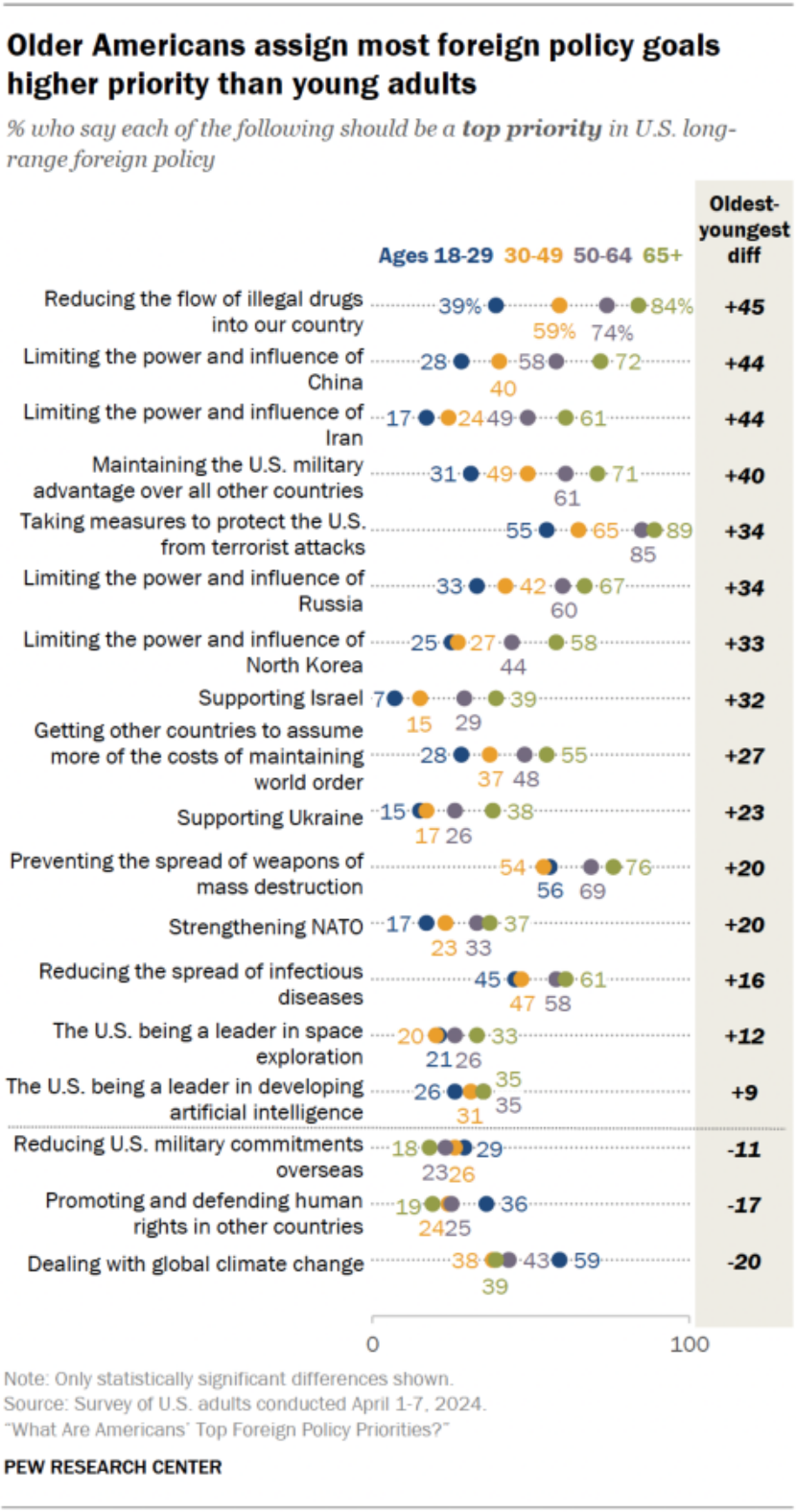


Generally, the **partisan differences on the importance of several foreign policy issues have gotten smaller since 2021**, when most of these questions were last fielded. This is especially true for items related to the relative power of major countries, like the U.S. maintaining a military advantage and limiting the power and influence of both Russia and China.

However, finding a solution to the conflict between Israelis and Palestinians – a priority that saw *no* partisan difference at all when it was last asked about in 2018 – has an emerging partisan gap today. The share of Democrats who call this a top priority has more than doubled, while the share of Republicans has changed little.

Differences by age

Age differences persist on foreign policy issues. Older Americans prioritize *most* of the issues we asked about at higher rates than those ages 18 to 29.



On four issues, there is at least a 40 percentage point gap between Americans ages 65 and older and young adults ages 18 to 29. The oldest Americans are more likely to prioritize reducing the flow of illegal drugs, limiting the power and influence of China and Iran, and maintaining a U.S. military advantage.

Those in the oldest age group are also more concerned than their younger counterparts on an additional 11 issues, ranging from support for Israel to U.S. leadership in space exploration.

For their part, young adults are more likely to say dealing with global climate change, reducing U.S. military commitments overseas, and promoting and defending human rights in other countries should be top foreign policy priorities.

Even starker patterns appear when looking at partisanship within two age groups – adults ages 18 to 49 and those 50 and older.

Among Democrats, older adults place particularly high priority on supporting Ukraine, strengthening NATO, and limiting the power and influence of Russia amid its war with Ukraine. Older Democrats are also more likely than younger ones to prioritize preventing the development of WMDs, curbing the spread of diseases, strengthening the UN and promoting democracy around the world, among other issues.

Among Republicans, those ages 50 and older are more likely than those ages 18 to 49 to prioritize supporting Israel, limiting the power and influence of Iran and China, getting other countries to assume more foreign policy costs, reducing the amount of illegal drugs entering the U.S., preventing terrorism, and maintaining a military advantage.

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SHORT READS | APRIL 23, 2024

Fewer Americans view the United Nations favorably than in 2023

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BY JANELL FETTEROLF

The United Nations headquarters building in New York City. (Daniel Slim/AFP via Getty Images)

Over the past year, Americans' views of the United Nations have become slightly more negative, according to a new Pew Research Center survey. Today, 52% of Americans view the organization favorably, down from 57% in 2023.

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to examine Americans' views of the United Nations. For this analysis, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults

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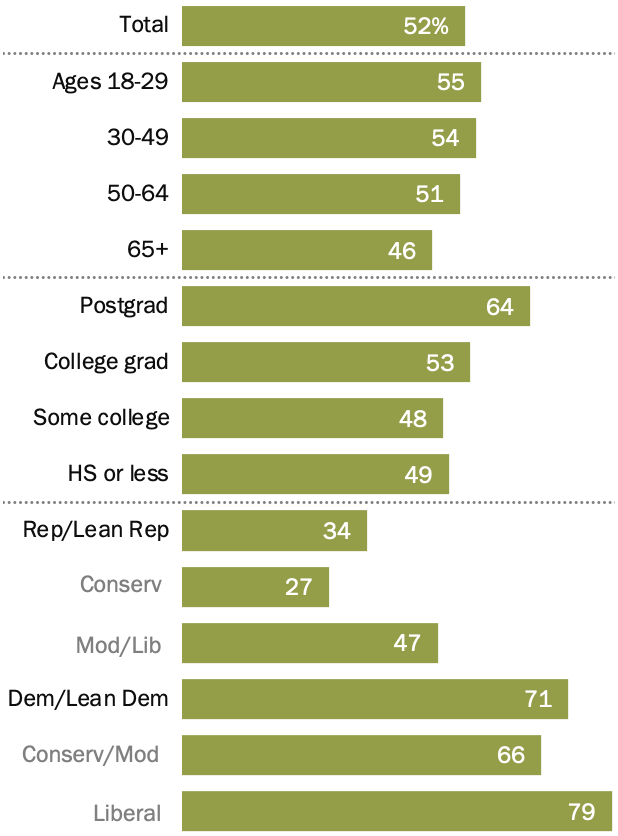
from April 1 to 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

In the United States, younger adults and Democrats are more likely to view the United Nations positively

*% who have a **favorable view** of the United Nations*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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U.S. adults under age 65 are more likely than those 65 and older to have a favorable opinion of the UN. And those with a postgraduate degree are more likely than those with less education to hold this view.

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Most people in 35 countries see the UN favorably in 2024, but views have dipped in some places

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Americans' views of the UN are most strongly divided along partisan and ideological lines. Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents are more than twice as likely as Republicans and Republican leaners to have a favorable view of the UN (71% vs. 34%).

Conservative Republicans are the least likely to see the UN favorably, while liberal Democrats are the most likely to favor it.

We also asked Americans about more specific aspects of the UN, including questions about the benefits of membership and the organization's influence in the world. On most questions, assessments are more positive than negative, though there are persistent differences by political party and age.

Benefits of U.S. membership in the UN

Americans generally see the country's role in the UN as beneficial for the United States. But this view has become somewhat less common since the last time we asked this question.

In 2022, 66% of Americans said the U.S. benefits from being a member of the UN, compared with 60% who hold this view today. And the share who say the U.S. benefits *a great deal* has dropped from 30% to 23%.

Over a third (37%) currently say the U.S. does *not* benefit from being a member of the UN.

The UN's influence in the world

When asked about the influence of the UN in the world, 48% of Americans say it is unchanged in recent years. Around a third (35%) say the UN's influence is getting weaker, while 13% say it is getting stronger.

A separate Center analysis finds that, when Americans are asked to rate different foreign policy goals for the U.S., only 31% say

strengthening the UN should be a top priority.

UN efforts in Gaza

Americans tend to rate the UN's impact in Gaza more negatively than they rate the organization overall.

For example, 29% of Americans say they have a great deal or fair amount of confidence in the UN to provide effective humanitarian aid to Gaza. Roughly half (51%) do not have confidence in the organization's ability and 19% are unsure. However, it's worth noting that multiple countries and organizations have been struggling with humanitarian aid for months.

In addition, only 15% of Americans say they have confidence in the UN to enforce a cease-fire between Israel and Hamas. Another 67% have no confidence and 17% are unsure.

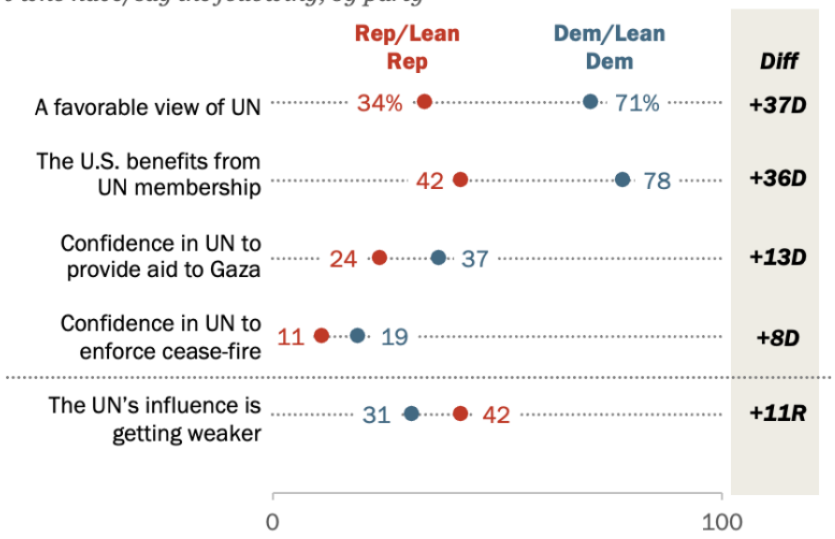
Notably, a recent Center survey found that only 12% of Americans believe that lasting peace between Israelis and Palestinians is at least somewhat likely. So Americans may not be optimistic about a cease-fire regardless of who attempts to enforce one. And, though the UN recently approved a resolution demanding a cease-fire between Israel and Hamas, negotiations between the two groups have been unsuccessful.

Partisan differences in views of the UN

Democrats are much more likely than Republicans to express positive views of the UN on every question asked.

In the U.S., Democrats have much more positive assessments of the United Nations than Republicans

% who have/say the following, by party



Note: All differences shown are statistically significant.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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For example, over three-quarters of Democrats believe UN membership benefits the U.S., compared with only 42% of Republicans. Liberal Democrats are the most likely – and conservative Republicans are the *least* likely – to say the U.S. benefits from its involvement in the UN.

Republicans are less likely now than in 2022 to say the U.S. benefits from participating in the UN, while Democrats are about as likely to say this now as they were in 2022.

In 2022, 49% of Republicans said the U.S. benefited from membership in the UN, compared with 42% now.

Democrats are also significantly more likely than Republicans to have confidence in the UN to provide humanitarian aid in Gaza and enforce a cease-fire between Israel and Hamas. Still, a minority of Democrats say this.

In addition, Democrats are much *less* likely than Republicans to say the UN's influence in the world is waning. Instead, they tend to see the UN's influence as stable.

Age differences in views of the UN

On most questions, U.S. adults under 30 have more positive views of the UN than those ages 65 and older. For instance, younger adults are more likely than older adults to see the benefits of the country's involvement in the UN. About two-thirds of those under 30 (66%) say the U.S. benefits at least a fair amount, while 57% of older adults share this view.

Adults under 30 are more likely than older adults to believe the UN's influence in the world is getting stronger or staying the same, and less likely to believe it's getting weaker.

However, younger adults do *not* have more positive assessments than older adults of the UN's efforts in Gaza. Instead, they are more likely than older adults to be uncertain of their confidence in the UN when it comes to providing humanitarian aid to Gaza or enforcing a cease-fire.

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Topics United Nations

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SHORT READS | APRIL 25, 2024

A growing share of Americans have little or no confidence in Netanyahu

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BY LAURA SILVER AND JORDAN LIPPERT

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu waits for the start of an Israeli war cabinet meeting also attended by U.S. President Joe Biden on Oct. 18, 2023, in Tel Aviv, Israel. (Brendan Smialowski/AFP via Getty Images)

A majority of Americans (53%) have little or no confidence in Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to do the right thing regarding world affairs, including 25% who have no confidence in him *at all*. Three-in-ten say they have at least some confidence in him, according to a Pew Research Center survey of 3,600 U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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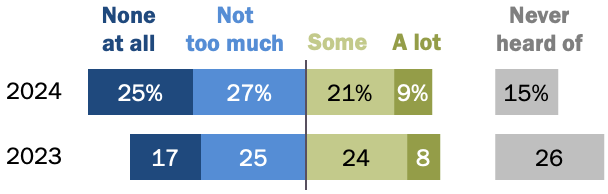
Share of Americans without confidence in Netanyahu has increased since 2023

% of U.S. adults who have ___ confidence in Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to do the right thing regarding world affairs



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

The share of Americans who have no confidence in Netanyahu has increased 11 percentage points since 2023. This includes an 8-point increase in the share who have no confidence in him at all.

This shift is related to a change in awareness of Netanyahu. In 2023, around a quarter of Americans (26%) said they had never heard of him, but that share has fallen to 15% this year.

How we did this

Pew Research Center analyzed Americans' attitudes toward Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu as part of our broader research about confidence in global leaders. Most of the data used in this analysis is from a survey of 3,600 U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024. Data on views of the Israeli government is from a survey of 12,693 U.S. adults conducted Feb. 13-25, 2024.

Everyone who took part in the April survey is a member of Pew Research Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way, nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Most of the respondents from the February survey (10,642) are members of Pew Research Center's American Trends Panel. The remaining 2,051 respondents are members of three other survey panels – Ipsos' KnowledgePanel, SSRS's Opinion Panel, and NORC at the University of Chicago's AmeriSpeak Panel – who were interviewed because they identify as Jewish or Muslim.

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The February survey "oversampled" (i.e., interviewed a disproportionately large number of) Jews and Muslims to provide more reliable estimate of their views on the topics covered in the survey. But these groups are *not* overrepresented in the national estimates reported as we adjusted for the oversampling in the weighting of the data.

Both surveys are weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education, religious affiliation and other categories.

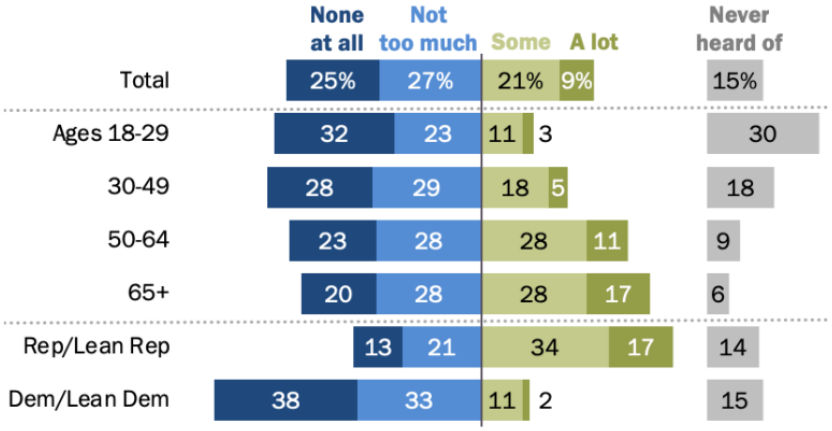
Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, as well as the February survey methodology and the April survey methodology.

Americans' views of Netanyahu differ by party and by certain demographic factors:

Partisanship

Democrats are much less confident in Netanyahu than Republicans are

% of U.S. adults who have ___ confidence in Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to do the right thing regarding world affairs



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Republicans and Republican-leaning independents have much more positive views of Netanyahu than Democrats and Democratic leaners do. Around half of Republicans (51%) say they have at least some confidence in him to do the right thing regarding world affairs, while only 13% of Democrats say the same. Among Democrats, many more say they have no confidence

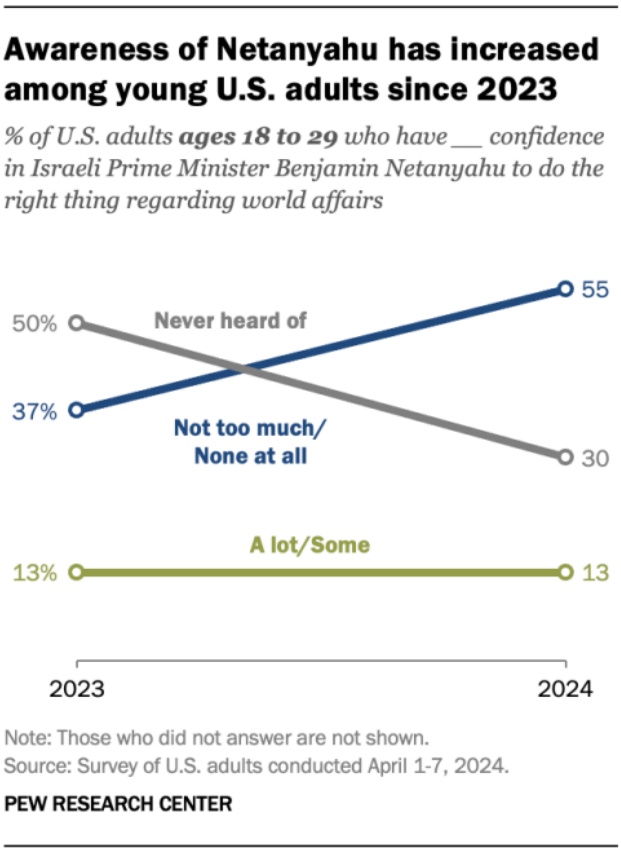
in him *at all* (38%) than report even having some confidence in him.

Conservative Republicans (62%) are twice as likely as moderate and liberal Republicans (31%) to say they have at least some confidence in Netanyahu. Conservative and moderate Democrats (17%) also express more confidence than liberals (7%).

There are also age differences among partisans. For example, Republicans ages 50 and older have much more confidence in Netanyahu than younger Republicans do (69% vs. 33% have at least some confidence). Age differences are more modest among Democrats: 16% of older Democrats have confidence in the Israeli prime minister, compared with 10% of younger Democrats.

Among both Republicans and Democrats, the share expressing *little or no confidence* in Netanyahu has increased since last year. However, the shift among Democrats (+15 points) has been three times as large as the shift among Republicans (+5 points).

Age



Older Americans are significantly more likely than younger ones to have positive views of Netanyahu. About four-in-ten Americans ages 50 and older (42%) have at least some confidence in him to do the right thing regarding world affairs. That compares with around a quarter of those ages 30 to 49 and only 13% of adults under 30.

The youngest U.S. adults have grown more negative toward Netanyahu since last year. The share of adults under 30 who have *little or no confidence* in Netanyahu has risen from 37% then to 55% today. This is related, in part, to the 20-point decrease in the share of young adults who say they have never heard of Netanyahu.

Views of the Israeli government

Americans' views of the Israeli government have also turned more negative since 2022, according to a Center survey conducted this February. About four-in-ten Americans (41%) have a favorable view of the Israeli government, down from 47% in 2022 and on par with the share who said this in 2019. Notably, the 2022 survey was the only one to take place when Netanyahu was not in office.

As with Netanyahu, when it comes to evaluations of the Israeli government, Republicans have much more favorable views than Democrats (63% vs. 24% favorable), and older Americans have more positive views than younger ones.

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, as well as the February survey methodology and the April survey methodology.

Topics

Israel Global Image, War & International Conflict, War & International Conflict

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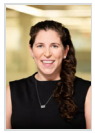

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REPORT | MAY 1, 2024

Americans Remain Critical of China

Many see China as increasingly influential and consider limiting its power a top priority

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BY CHRISTINE HUANG, LAURA SILVER AND LAURA CLANCY

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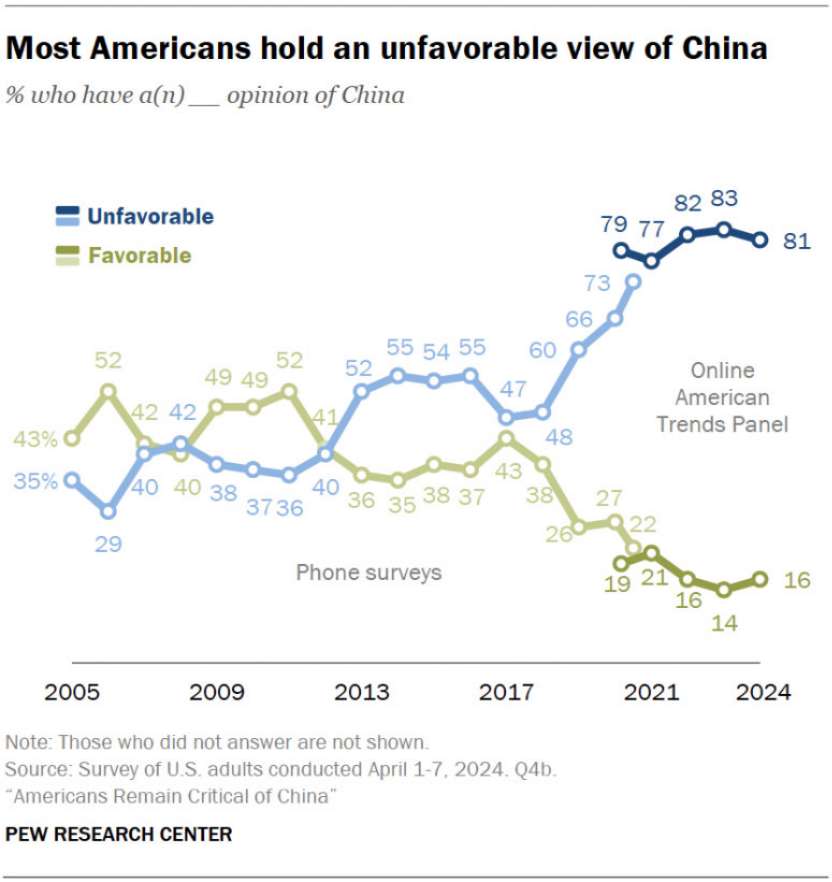
Supporters await Chinese President Xi Jinping's arrival near the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation summit headquarters in San Francisco on Nov. 14, 2023. (Andrew Caballero-Reynolds/AFP via Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand Americans' opinions of China, its role in the world and its impact on the U.S. economy. For this analysis, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

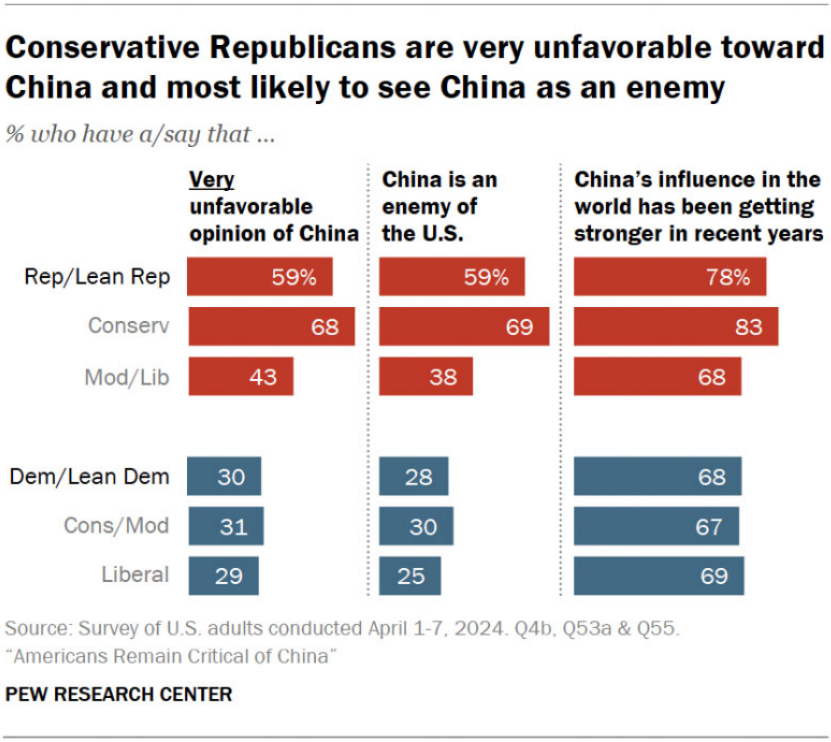
Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.



For the fifth year in a row, about eight-in-ten Americans report an unfavorable view of China, according to a new Pew Research Center survey. Today, 81% of U.S. adults see the country unfavorably, including 43% who hold a *very* unfavorable opinion. Chinese President Xi Jinping receives similarly negative ratings.

Still, many Americans agree that China's influence in the world has been getting stronger in recent years (71%). This sense is accompanied by concern about how China interacts with other nations: 61% of Americans are at least somewhat concerned about China's territorial disputes with neighboring countries. *(For more U.S. views of China's role in the world, go to Chapter 1.)*

When it comes to China's relationship with the United States, few see China as a partner (6%) and most Americans instead label it a competitor (50%) or an enemy (42%) of the U.S. They are likewise critical of China's impact on the U.S. economy, describing its influence as large and negative. Roughly half of Americans think limiting China's power and influence should be a top U.S. foreign policy priority, and another 42% think this should be given some priority. *(For more assessments of China's relationship with the U.S., go to Chapter 2.)*



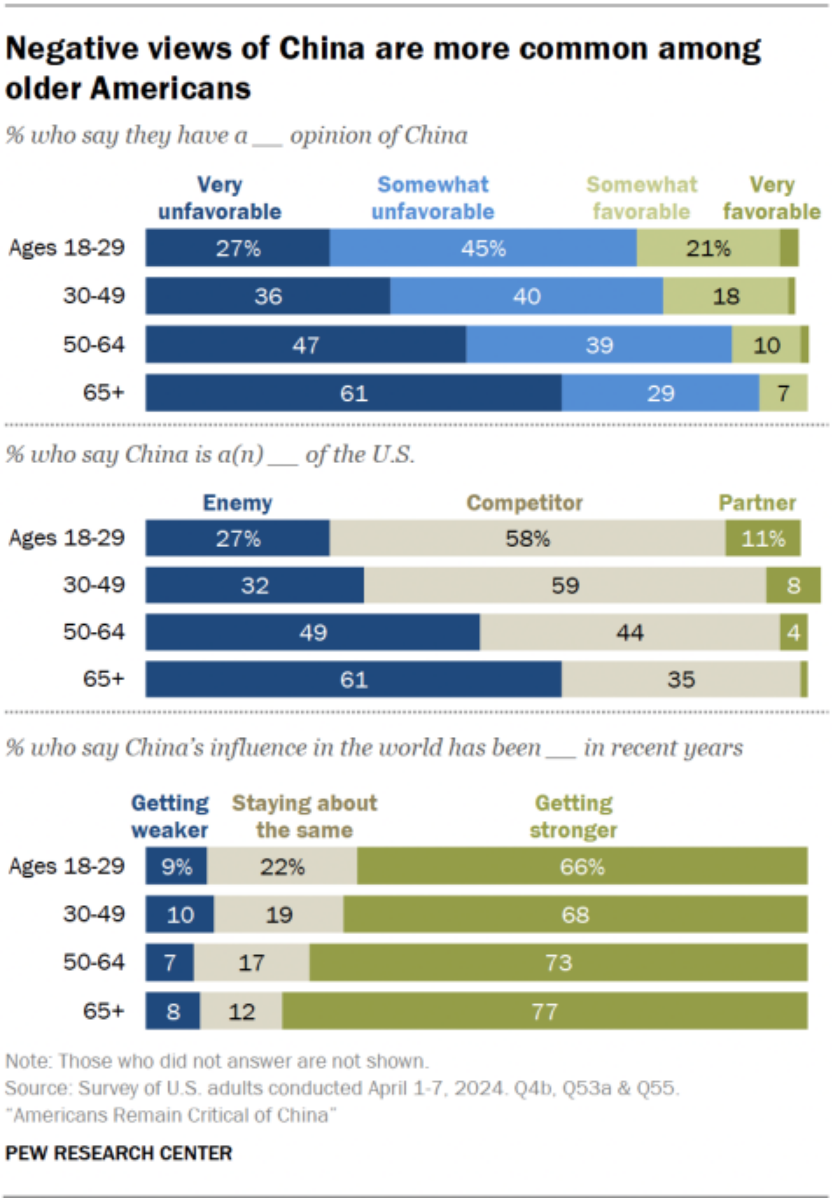
According to the Center survey, which was conducted April 1-7, 2024, among 3,600 U.S. adults, Republicans are more wary of China than Democrats are.

Republicans and Republican-leaning independents are about twice as likely as Democrats and Democratic leaners to hold a very

unfavorable view of China and to consider China an enemy of the U.S. They are also more likely to say that China has recently become more influential.

Republicans also have wider ideological differences within their party, and **conservative Republicans stand out on many measures**:

- Conservative Republicans are 25 percentage points more likely than moderate and liberal Republicans to express a *very* unfavorable view of China (68% vs. 43%). There is no difference between liberal Democrats and moderate and conservative Democrats on this question.
- Conservative Republicans are also 31 points more likely than moderate and liberal Republicans to see China as an enemy of the U.S. No ideological difference is present among Democrats.
- While 83% of conservative Republicans say China's influence in the world has been getting stronger in recent years, 68% of moderate and liberal Republicans say the same. The latter is similar to the shares of moderate and conservative Democrats (67%) and liberal Democrats (69%) who hold this view.



Older Americans are generally more critical of China. A 61% majority of adults ages 65 and older have a *very* unfavorable view of China, compared with 27% of adults under 30. Adults ages 65 and older are also more than twice as likely as those ages 18 to 29 to see China as an enemy of the U.S. For their part, younger adults are more likely than older ones to label China as a competitor and as a partner.

Older Americans also perceive more growth in China's international influence. Roughly three-quarters of adults ages 65 and older say China's influence has been getting stronger in recent years, while about two-thirds of adults under 30 say the same.

Americans with a sour view of the U.S. economy have more critical opinions of China. Those who say the current U.S. economic situation is bad are more likely to hold an unfavorable opinion of China and to say China has a great deal or fair amount of negative influence on the U.S. economy. They are also more likely to see China as an enemy when compared with those who see the economy positively.

Next: Assessments of China and its role in the world

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Americans' views of China have warmed in recent years

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Growing Partisan Divisions Over NATO and Ukraine

Many Americans say the influence of China, Russia and Iran is rising; increasing shares see U.S. and European nations as in decline

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BY RICHARD WIKE, MOIRA FAGAN, SNEHA GUBBALA AND SARAH AUSTIN

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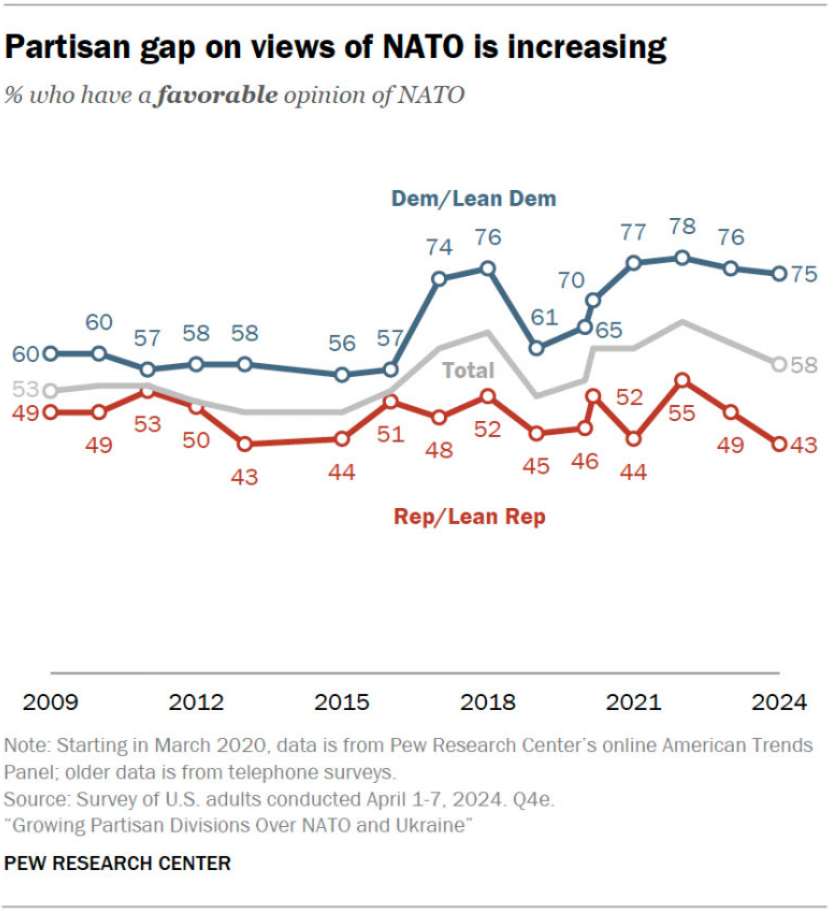
U.S. President Joe Biden shakes hands with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy following the G7 nations' joint declaration for support of Ukraine on July 12, 2023, in Vilnius, Lithuania. (Sean Gallup/Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this study to understand Americans' opinions of NATO, Russia and the war between Russia and Ukraine. For this analysis, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

As NATO approaches its 75th anniversary, Americans are increasingly divided in their views about the alliance. Most continue to believe the United States benefits from its membership, but partisan differences on ratings of NATO have widened in recent years.



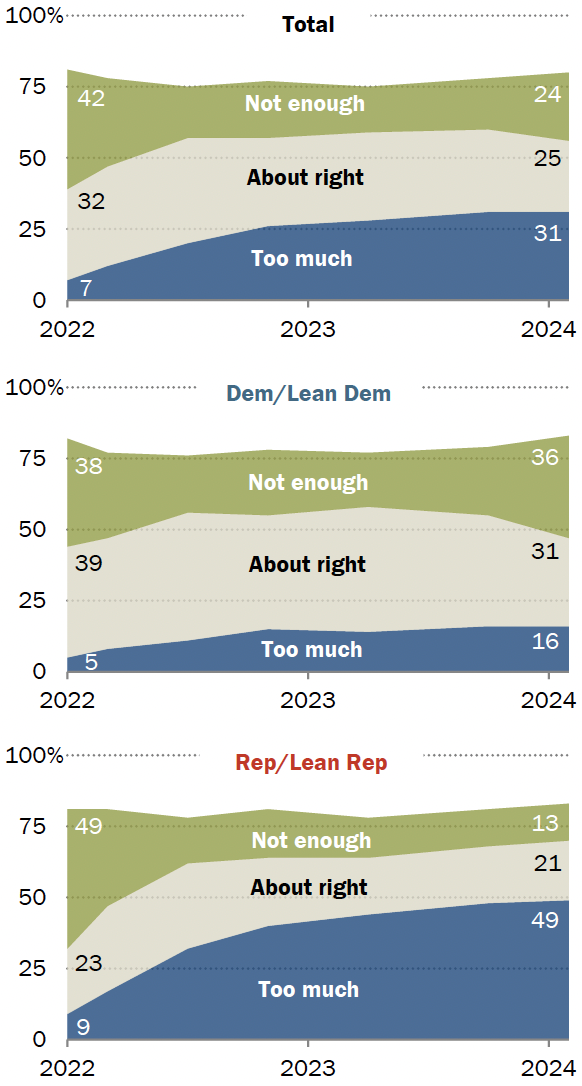
Three-quarters of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents rate the organization favorably, while only 43% of Republicans and Republican leaners agree – down from 55% in a 2022 survey conducted soon after Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

Attitudes toward the war in Ukraine have evolved to reflect the partisan polarization found across so many issues in U.S. politics. Democrats and Republicans differ sharply on views about aid to Ukraine, ratings of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, and whether supporting Ukraine helps or hurts U.S. interests.

The share of Americans who believe the U.S. is not providing enough support to Ukraine has risen slightly in recent months, following setbacks for Ukraine on the battlefield and prolonged congressional debate over sending aid. (The survey was conducted before President Joe Biden signed into law an aid package sending nearly $61 billion to the Ukrainian war effort.)

The partisan gap on aid to Ukraine has shifted significantly since start of war

% who say that, when it comes to Russia's invasion of Ukraine, the U.S. is providing ___ support to Ukraine



Note: Those who did not answer or who answered "Not sure" are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024. Q100. "Growing Partisan Divisions Over NATO and Ukraine"

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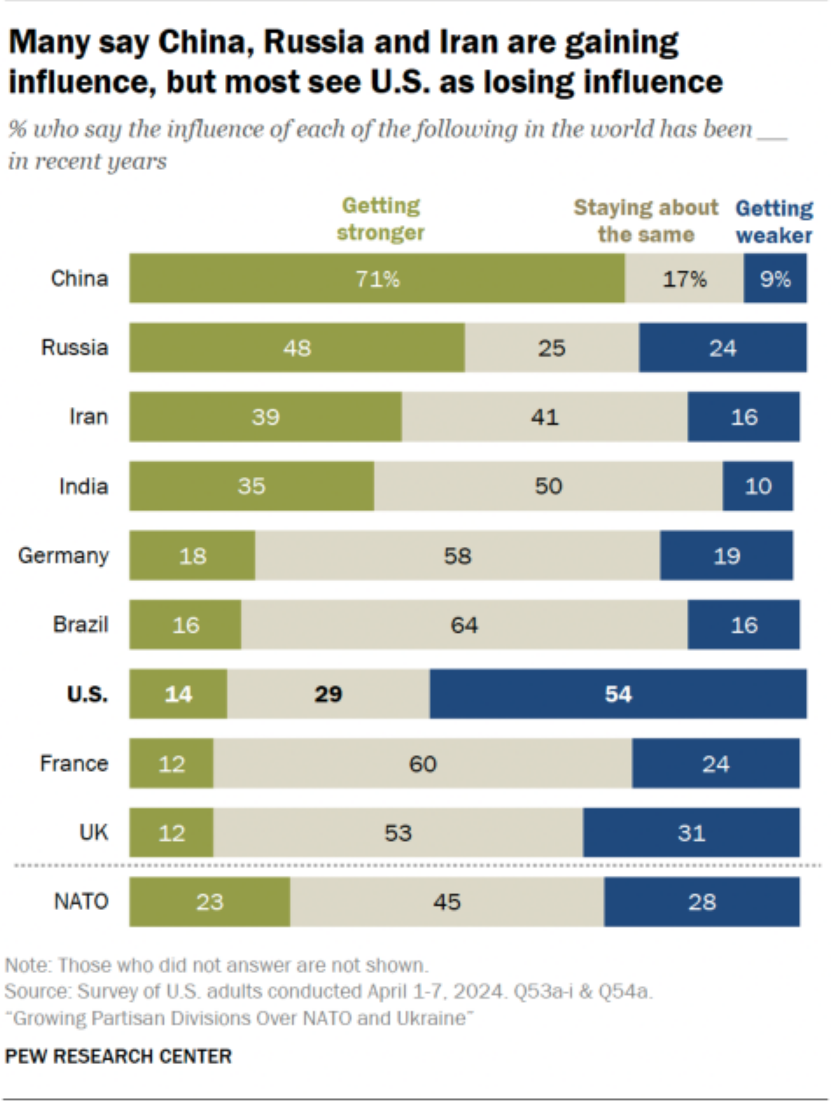
Roughly one-quarter of Americans (24%) now say the U.S. is not providing enough aid, up from 18% in November 2023, when we last asked this question. Still, more Americans (31%) think the U.S. is providing too much aid, and 25% believe it's giving the right amount.

However, views on this issue vary considerably by party. While the share of Democrats who believe the U.S. is not doing enough to

help Ukraine declined after the initial onset of the war, it has increased more recently. Currently, 36% of Democrats say the U.S. is not providing enough aid.

In contrast, just 13% of Republicans say the U.S. is not giving enough support to Ukraine, while 49% believe it is giving too much. At the beginning of the war, Republican attitudes were essentially the reverse: 49% said the U.S. was not providing enough aid and 9% said it was providing too much. Among Republicans, conservatives are more likely than moderates and liberals to say the U.S. is providing too much aid to Ukraine.

In addition to shifting views about NATO and Ukraine over the past few years, Americans have increasingly come to believe that U.S. power is declining on the global stage: 54% say the country's influence has been getting weaker recently, up from 47% two years ago. The shares saying the same about the United Kingdom, France and Germany – key U.S. allies in Europe – have also increased since 2022.



Meanwhile, about four-in-ten or more see China, Russia and Iran – nations often considered adversaries of the U.S. – as increasingly influential, including a 71% majority who say this of China. And about a third say India's influence is getting stronger.

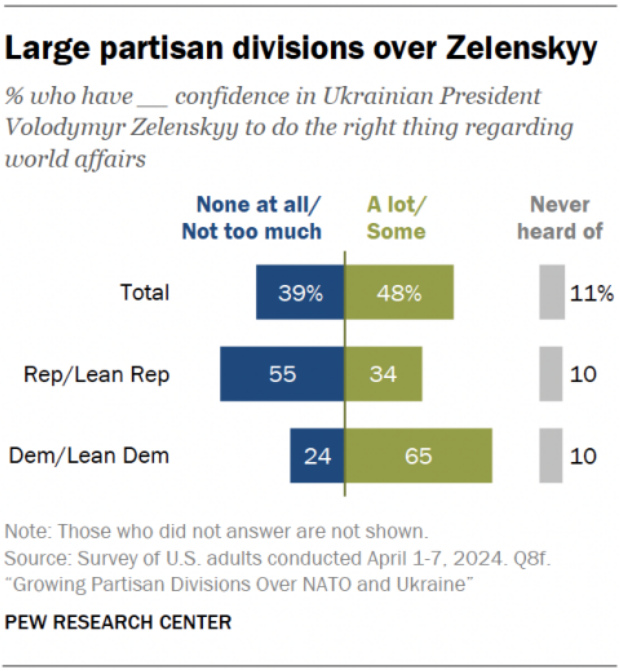
Republicans are more likely than Democrats to believe China, Russia and Iran are gaining strength. They are also more likely to believe the U.S., France and Germany are becoming weaker.

These are among the findings from a Pew Research Center survey conducted April 1-7, 2024, among 3,600 U.S. adults.

Below we describe some of the key findings from the survey, which explored attitudes toward NATO, Ukraine, trans-Atlantic relations, Russia and the shifting balance of power in global politics. For more in-depth analysis of these topics, read:

- Chapter 1: Views of Ukraine and U.S. involvement with the war
- Chapter 2: Americans' opinions of NATO
- Chapter 3: Views of trans-Atlantic allies and U.S.-Europe relations
- Chapter 4: Views of Russia and Putin

Ukraine



- There is no public consensus on whether supporting Ukraine is in America's national interests: 36% say it helps U.S. national security, 36% say it hurts and 24% believe it has no impact. Democrats are particularly likely to think it helps, while Republicans are especially likely to say it hurts.
- Concerns about Russia defeating Ukraine and Russia invading other countries in the region are higher today than in September 2022, the last time we asked this question. These concerns are more common among Democrats than Republicans.
- Opinions about Zelenskyy also divide sharply along partisan lines. A 55% majority of Republicans now *lack* confidence in Zelenskyy to do the right thing in world affairs, up from 48% a year ago. In contrast, 65% of Democrats say they *are* confident in the Ukrainian leader, although this is down from 71% in 2023.

NATO and trans-Atlantic relations

- In addition to partisan divisions over NATO, there are also substantial differences by education. For instance, 73% of Americans with a postgraduate degree have a favorable view of NATO, compared with just 51% of those with a high school degree or less education.

> **How much do Americans know about NATO?**
> Read the results of our NATO knowledge quiz.

- 66% of Americans believe the U.S. benefits a great deal or fair amount from being a NATO member; 51% of Republicans hold this view, compared with 81% of Democrats.
- Majorities of Americans have favorable views of the UK (70%), France (64%) and Germany (64%); Democrats are more likely than Republicans to see these key U.S. allies positively.
- Large majorities of both Democrats and Republicans believe economic and trade ties, security and defense ties, and shared democratic values are important for strong relations between the U.S. and Europe. However, while 45% of Democrats believe shared democratic values are *very* important, only about a third of Republicans (31%) say the same.
- Despite overall positive views of European allies and the nature of trans-Atlantic relations, roughly half of U.S. adults (47%) say European allies need to increase their defense spending. Older Americans and conservative Republicans are particularly likely to believe this.

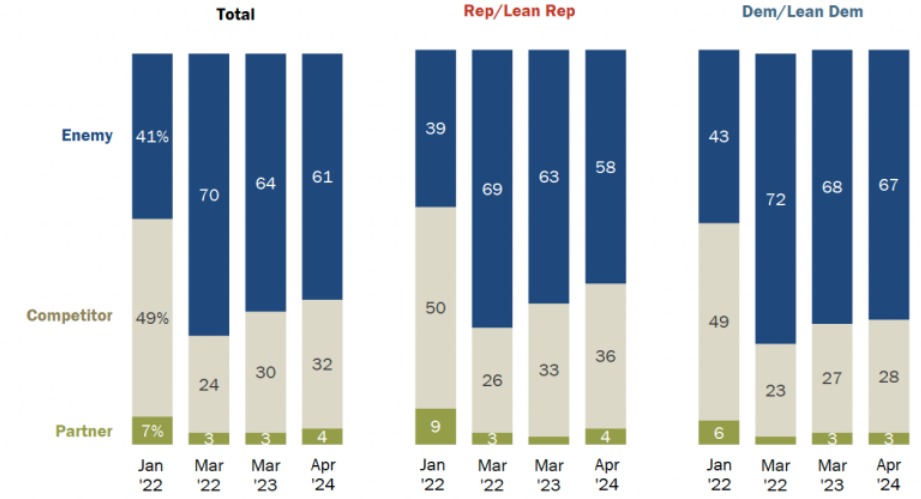
Russia

- Americans became significantly more likely to consider Russia an enemy after the February 2022 invasion of Ukraine. In January 2022, 41% considered Russia an enemy of the U.S.; two months later, 70% held this view. Today, roughly six-in-ten (61%) see Russia as an enemy.
- Compared with the other issues in this study, partisan divisions over Russia are relatively muted. Democrats (67%) are more likely to describe Russia as an enemy, but most Republicans

(58%) share this view. In 2022, these partisan differences were not as wide.

About 6 in 10 Americans see Russia as an enemy, including majorities of Democrats and Republicans

% who say Russia is a(n) __ of the U.S.



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024. Q56.
"Growing Partisan Divisions Over NATO and Ukraine"

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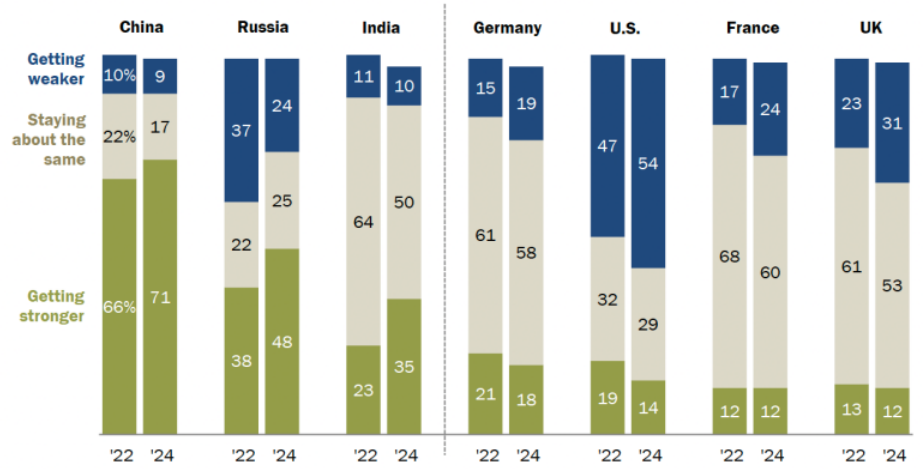
- Attitudes toward Russian President Vladimir Putin remain extremely negative among Americans: 88% say they do not have confidence in him to do the right thing in world affairs.

A shifting balance of global power

- Since 2022, Americans have become more likely to believe China, India and Russia are growing stronger in world affairs. In contrast, they have become more likely to say France, Germany, the UK and the U.S. are *losing* influence on the world stage.
- Two-thirds of Republicans think the U.S. is losing influence; 44% of Democrats agree. The share of each partisan group who say U.S. influence is declining has increased since 2022.
- Large majorities in both parties believe China's power is rising, although Republicans (78%) are somewhat more likely than Democrats (68%) to hold this view.

Americans increasingly say influences of China, Russia and India have been getting stronger, while U.S. and European influences have been getting weaker

% who say each country's influence in the world has been ___ in recent years



Note: Only countries with available trend data are listed. Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024. Q53a-f, i.
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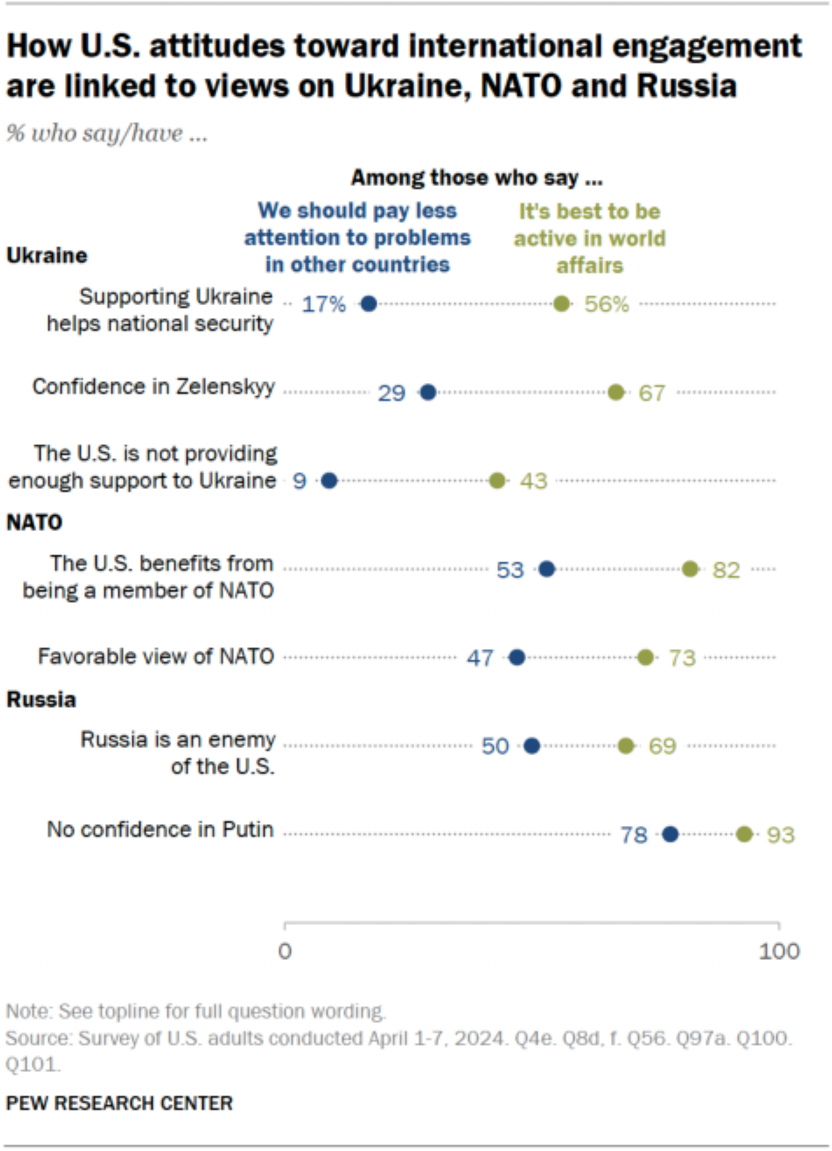
International engagement and foreign policy issues



- Many questions on the survey correlate with general views about international engagement. For example, 56% of those who think it's best for the U.S. to be active in world affairs say supporting Ukraine helps American national security. That share is just 17% among those who say the U.S. should pay less attention to problems in other countries and concentrate on domestic problems.

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How Americans and Israelis view one another and the U.S. role in the Israel-Hamas war

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BY LAURA SILVER

U.S. President Joe Biden and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu shake hands during a meeting at the 78th United Nations General Assembly in New York City on Sept. 20, 2023. (Jim Watson/AFP via Getty Images)

The United States continues to support Israel in its war against Hamas, but relations appear increasingly strained between the two countries and their leaders. The war also seems to have affected public opinion in both countries: Americans and Israelis now see one another's leaders more negatively than in the recent past, and other key views have shifted as well.

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Views on America's global role diverge widely by age and party

Below, we explore American and Israeli public opinion in detail. This analysis is based on two Pew Research Center surveys of U.S. adults – one conducted in February and one in early April – as well as a survey of Israeli adults conducted in March and early April.

How we did this

Pew Research Center analyzed Americans' and Israelis' attitudes on a variety of questions related to the Israel-Hamas war. The recent U.S. data is from two polls: a survey of 12,693 U.S. adults conducted Feb. 13-25, 2024, and a survey of 3,600 U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024. The data for Israel is from a survey of 1,001 Israeli adults conducted March 3-April 4, 2024.

Most of the respondents in the February survey of U.S. adults (10,642) are members of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP). The ATP is an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses, which gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

The remaining 2,051 respondents are members of three other survey panels – Ipsos' KnowledgePanel, SSRS's Opinion Panel, and NORC at the University of Chicago's AmeriSpeak Panel – who were interviewed because they identify as Jewish or Muslim.

The February survey "oversampled" (i.e., interviewed a disproportionately large number of) Jews and Muslims to provide more reliable estimates of their views. But these groups are *not* overrepresented in the national figures reported, because we adjusted for the oversampling in the weighting of the data.

Although the February survey included questions about where U.S. adults were born and whether they identify as Arab or of Arab origin, there was insufficient sample size to analyze Arab Americans or people of Palestinian descent separately. In that survey, only about a quarter of U.S. Muslims identified as Arab or of Arab ancestry. As a result, in our U.S. analysis, we describe differences between religious groups, rather than differences in opinion between Arab Americans and Jewish Americans. In contrast, our surveys in Israel have sufficient samples to allow comparisons between Israeli Arabs and Israeli Jews.

Both U.S. surveys are weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education,

REPORT | JUN 11, 2024

Globally, Biden Receives Higher Ratings Than Trump

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religious affiliation and other categories.

The survey of Israeli adults was conducted face-to-face. Interviews were conducted in Hebrew and Arabic, and the survey is representative of the adult population ages 18 and older, excluding those in East Jerusalem and non-sanctioned outposts. (The survey also does not include the West Bank or Gaza.) The survey included an oversample of Arabs in Israel. It was subsequently weighted to be representative of the Israeli adult population with the following variables: gender by ethnicity, age by ethnicity, education, region, urbanicity and probability of selection of respondent.

Here are the February and April questions and responses for the United States used for this analysis, and the questions and responses for Israel. Here are the February and April survey methodologies for the U.S., and the survey methodology for Israel.

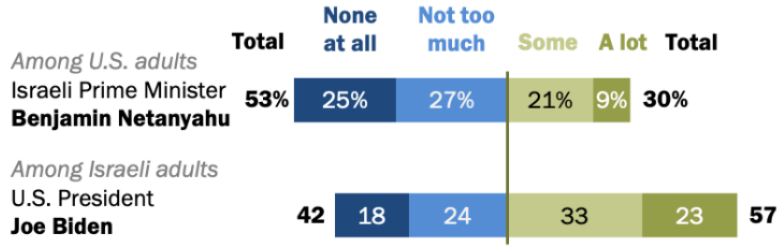
1 Americans have less confidence in Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu than Israelis have in U.S. President Joe Biden.

Only 30% of U.S. adults express some or a lot of confidence in Netanyahu, while around half (53%) have not too much or no confidence in him. An additional 15% say they have not heard of him.

By contrast, more than half of Israeli adults (57%) have some or a great deal of confidence in Biden to do the right thing regarding world affairs, whereas 42% have little or no confidence in him.

How Americans and Israelis view each other's leaders

% who have ___ (of) confidence in the following leaders to do the right thing regarding world affairs



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown. In the U.S., respondents could also say they had "Never heard of this person" and those responses are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024, and survey of Israeli adults conducted March 3-April 4, 2024.

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2 Americans' views of Netanyahu have turned more negative over the past year. The share of Americans with little or no confidence in Netanyahu to do the right thing regarding world affairs is up 11 percentage points since March 2023 (42% then, 53% today).

Democrats are more likely than Republicans to have a negative view of Netanyahu. Approximately seven-in-ten Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents (71%) have little or no confidence in him, up from 56% in 2023. Around a third of Republicans and GOP leaners (34%) now take this view – up from 29% in 2023.

Related: *A growing share of Americans have little or no confidence in Netanyahu*

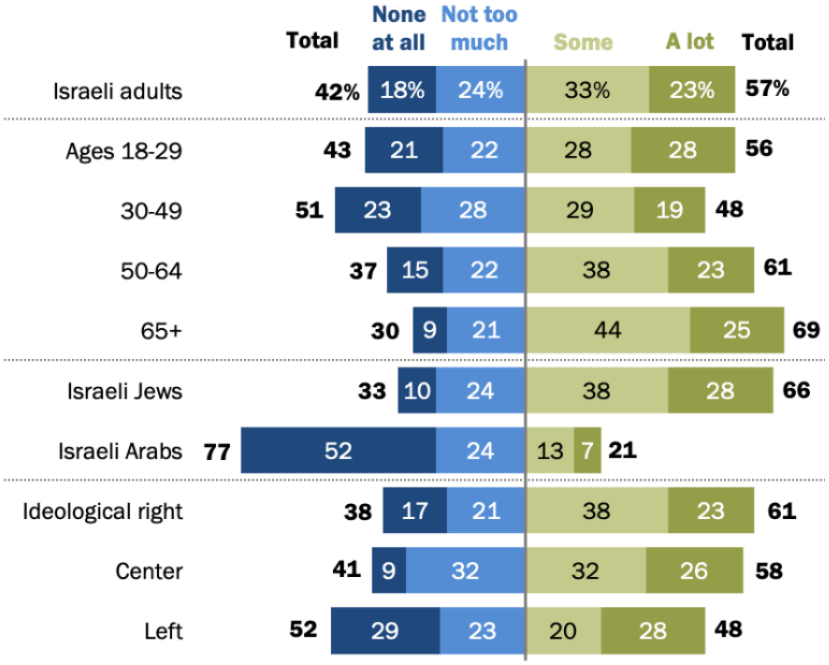
3 Israelis' opinions of Biden have also turned more negative. While 57% of Israelis express a lot or some confidence in Biden, that's down from 68% last year. The share of Israelis who have *no confidence at all* in Biden has doubled, from 9% to 18%.

Israeli Jews and Arabs differ widely in their views of the U.S. president: 66% of Jews have confidence in Biden, but only 21% of Arabs agree. Among both groups, overall confidence in Biden has decreased by 10 points since last year.

Older Israelis, as well as those in the ideological center or on the right, have more confidence in Biden than younger and left-leaning Israelis do.

Israeli Jews, Arabs sharply divided in views of Biden

*% of **Israeli adults** who have ___ (of) confidence in U.S. President Joe Biden to do the right thing regarding world affairs*



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of Israeli adults conducted March 3-April 4, 2024.

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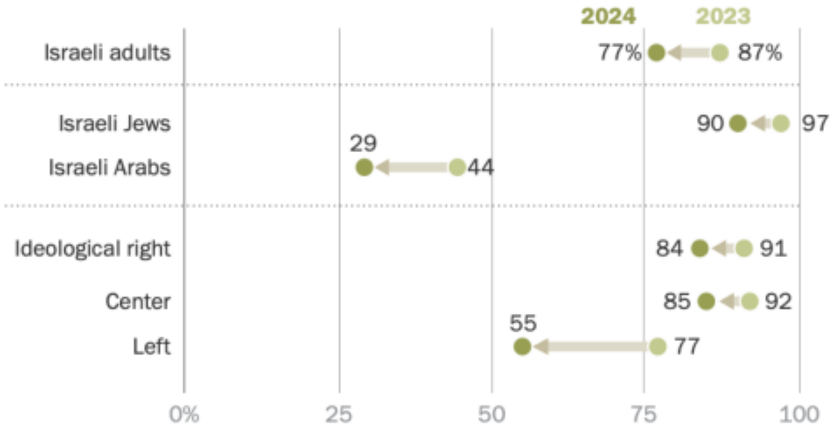
4 The share of Israelis with a favorable opinion of the U.S. has declined. While a broad majority of Israelis (77%) continue to see the U.S. favorably, this is down 10 points since last year. This marks the lowest overall rating of the U.S. in Israeli public opinion since 2011, based on our nearly two-decade trend.

Israeli views of U.S. have turned less positive over the past year – especially among Arabs, those on the left

*% of **Israeli adults** who have a **favorable** view of the U.S.*



Source: Survey of Israeli adults conducted March 3-April 4, 2024.

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Views of the U.S. are significantly more positive among Jewish Israelis (90%) than Arab Israelis (29%). They are also much more positive among Israelis who place themselves on the ideological right (85%) or in the center (84%) than on the left (55%).

Since last year, views of the U.S. have soured among most demographic groups in Israel, but particularly among Arab Israelis and people on the ideological left.

5 Americans' views of the Israeli *people* are broadly positive, but far fewer express favorable views of the Israeli *government*.

In our recent U.S. polling, we have asked separately about views of the Israeli government and the Israeli people, rather than ask a single question about views of Israel. (Past research suggests that views of the country tend to fall somewhere between views of its people and its government.)

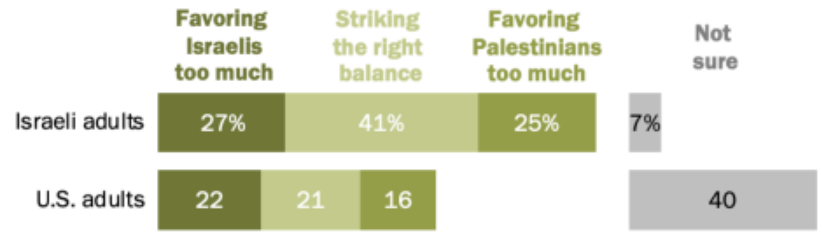
In our survey this past February, 64% of Americans had a favorable view of the Israeli people, while 41% voiced a favorable view of the Israeli government. Both of these figures were down modestly from 2022. Views of the Israeli people have ticked

downward more among younger Americans than among older ones.

6 Americans and Israelis alike are divided over whether Biden is favoring one side too much in the Israel-Hamas war. In our February survey, Americans were about evenly split as to whether Biden was favoring the Israelis too much (22%), favoring the Palestinians too much (16%) or striking the right balance (21%). However, the largest share of all – 40% – was not sure.

In the U.S. and Israel alike, the public is divided over Biden's approach to the Israel-Hamas war

% who say Joe Biden is ...



Note: In the U.S., the question read "Striking the right balance," and in Israel, "Favoring each group the right amount." In the U.S., the "Not sure" option was explicit, while in Israel it was volunteered.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Feb. 13-25, 2024, and survey of Israeli adults conducted March 3-April 4, 2024.

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In Israel, 41% of adults say Biden is striking the right balance, but nearly equal shares say the U.S. president favors the Israelis too much (27%) or favors Palestinians too much (25%). Just 7% of Israelis aren't sure or did not answer the question. (It's important to note that U.S. respondents took the survey online and were given an explicit "Don't know" option. Israeli respondents, interviewed in person, were not. Previous research shows that offering an explicit "Don't know" option in online surveys is a better comparison with face-to-face survey data.)

In both the U.S. and Israel, people on the ideological left are more likely than those on the right to say Biden is favoring Israelis too

much (in the U.S., ideology was measured as liberal, moderate and conservative).

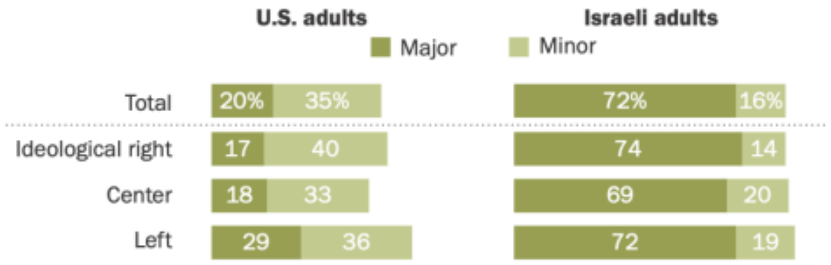
In the U.S., Muslim Americans are far more likely than Jewish Americans to say Biden favors the Israelis too much (60% vs. 13%). In Israel, Arabs (86%) are much more likely than Jews to say the same (86% vs. 11%). (In the U.S., we "oversampled" Muslim and Jewish Americans but did not have sufficient sample size to analyze Arab Americans. For more details on the sampling, read the "How we did this" box.)

7 Around seven-in-ten Israelis (72%) want to see the U.S. play a major diplomatic role in resolving the Israel-Hamas war, but Americans are more divided.

In the U.S., a majority of Americans (55%) also say the U.S. should play a role in ending the war, but more favor a minor role than a major one (35% vs. 20%). Another 27% want the U.S. to play no role at all – a view shared by only 10% of Israelis.

Americans are less likely than Israelis to want the U.S. to play a major role in resolving the Israel-Hamas war

% who say the U.S. should play a ___ role in diplomatically resolving the Israel-Hamas war



Note: In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left).
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted Feb. 13-25, 2024, and survey of Israeli adults conducted March 3-April 4, 2024.

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Americans on the ideological left are more supportive of the U.S. playing a major role than are those in the center or on the right. In Israel, U.S. involvement is broadly popular across the ideological spectrum.

In the U.S., 45% of Jews think the U.S. should play a major role in resolving the war, compared with 27% of Muslims. In Israel, Jews and Arabs are both generally supportive of the U.S. playing a major role (74% and 62%, respectively).

Note: Here are the February and April questions and responses for the United States used for this analysis, and the questions and responses for Israel. Here are the February and April survey methodologies for the U.S., and the survey methodology for Israel.

Topics

Israel Global Image, Joe Biden, U.S. Global Image, War & International Conflict, War & International Conflict, World Leaders

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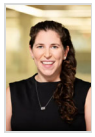

Laura Silver is an associate director focusing on global attitudes at Pew Research Center.

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SHORT READS | JUNE 3, 2024

Ratings of the EU remain broadly positive in member countries, but have gone down slightly since 2022

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BY SNEHA GUBBALA

The European Parliament building in Brussels is covered in a promotional banner for elections scheduled for June 6-9, 2024. (Kenzo Tribouillard/AFP via Getty Images)

Voters across Europe will head to the polls this week to choose their representatives in the European Parliament, the only directly elected institution of the European Union. A new Pew Research Center survey finds that a median of 63% of adults in nine member countries have a favorable view of the EU.

How we did this

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Despite recent political clashes, most people in Poland and Hungary see the EU favorably

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on public opinion of the European Union in nine surveyed EU member countries, as well as in the United Kingdom, the United States and Turkey.

For non-U.S. data, this report draws on nationally representative surveys of 11,294 adults conducted from Jan. 11 to May 15, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in France, Germany, Greece, Italy, the Netherlands, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. We conducted face-to-face surveys in Hungary, Poland and Turkey.

In the U.S., we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for the analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

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How exactly do countries join the EU?

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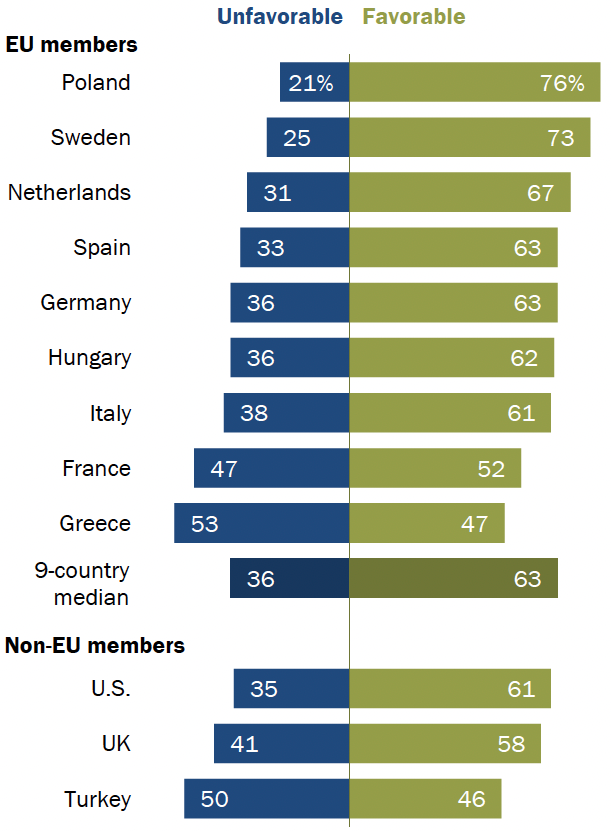
Views of the EU are generally favorable in surveyed member countries

% who say they have a(n) ___ opinion of the European Union



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Q4c.

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In two surveyed countries that are *not* EU members – the United States and the United Kingdom – majorities also have a favorable view of the organization. But in the third surveyed nonmember country, Turkey, attitudes are divided (46% favorable, 50% unfavorable).

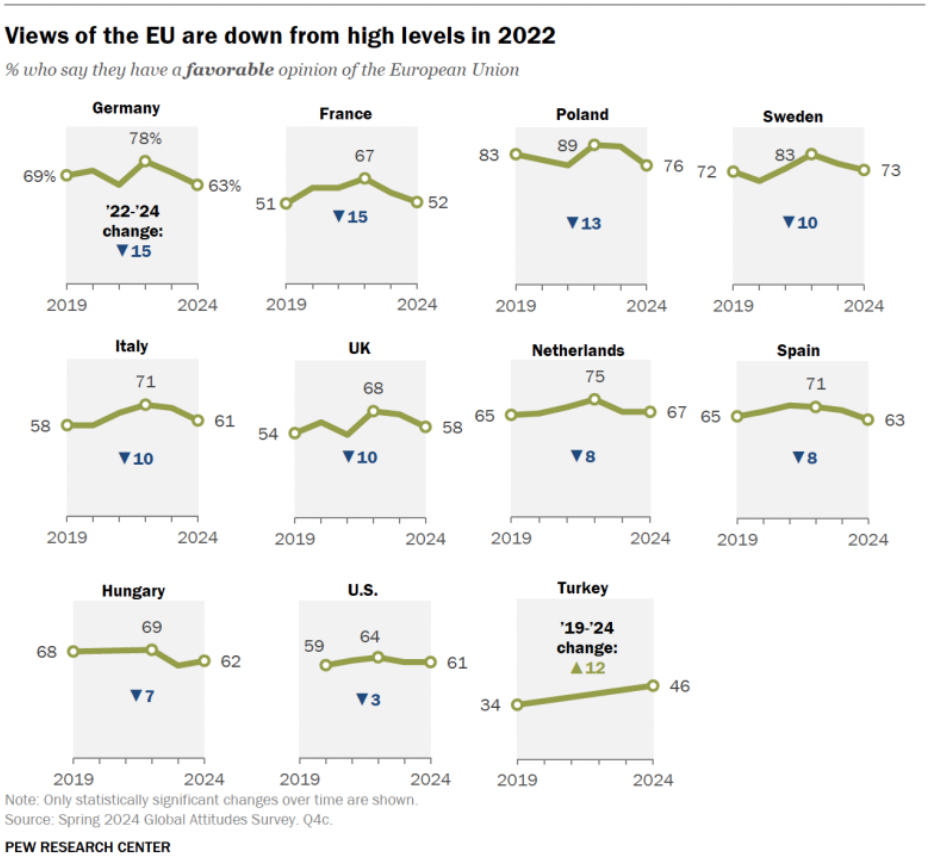
Among the member countries surveyed, views of the EU are most positive in Poland and Sweden, where roughly three-quarters hold a favorable view. In Germany, Hungary, Italy, the Netherlands and Spain, at least six-in-ten adults evaluate the EU positively. Views are more tempered in France and Greece. For example, 53% of adults in Greece hold a negative opinion of the EU.

How views of the EU have changed over time

Opinions of the EU reached record highs in many member countries in 2022, following Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

Favorability slipped somewhat in 2023, and this year, the downward trajectory has continued in most countries. In 2021, for example, 63% of Germans had a favorable view of the EU. A year later, a record high 78% of Germans expressed a positive opinion, but that fell to 71% in 2023 and 63% in the new survey.

Poland has seen the greatest decrease in favorable views of the EU since 2023, though views there remain broadly positive. The vast majority of Poles (88%) expressed a favorable view of the EU in 2023, but that percentage slipped to 76% this year. The drop in favorability has come amid protests by Polish farmers against EU climate policies and Ukrainian imports.



How people in Turkey view the EU

In Turkey – which has been working toward EU membership since 1987 – ratings are the highest they've been since 2004, the year the Center began asking this question. Today, 46% of Turkish adults say they have a favorable view of the EU. In 2019, when we last asked, only 34% said this.

Related: *How exactly do countries join the EU?*

While views of the EU remain divided in Turkey – and accession talks have been on hold since 2018 – 56% of Turkish adults still at least somewhat favor their country becoming a member of the organization. This is up 16 percentage points from the last time we asked this question in 2017. Perhaps not surprisingly, Turks with a positive view of the EU are more likely than those who have a negative opinion of it to favor their country joining the organization (77% vs. 38%).

Turkish adults on the ideological left are especially likely to favor their country becoming an EU member, with 73% saying this. By comparison, fewer than half of Turkish adults who place themselves on the ideological right (45%) share this sentiment.

Younger Turks are also more likely than their older counterparts to favor EU membership for their country. Two-thirds of adults under 35 say this, compared with half of adults ages 50 and older.

Opinions also vary by education. Turkish adults with higher levels of educational attainment are more likely than those with less education to favor EU membership (69% vs. 52%), though adults with lower levels of education are also less likely to offer an opinion.

How people in the United Kingdom view the EU

As was the case in several other European countries surveyed, views of the EU reached a record high in the UK in 2022, following Russia's invasion of Ukraine. At the time, 68% of Britons held a favorable view of the organization, and this share

remained relatively unchanged at 66% in 2023. Today, a smaller majority of British adults (58%) have a positive opinion of the EU.

The UK formally withdrew from the EU in 2020.

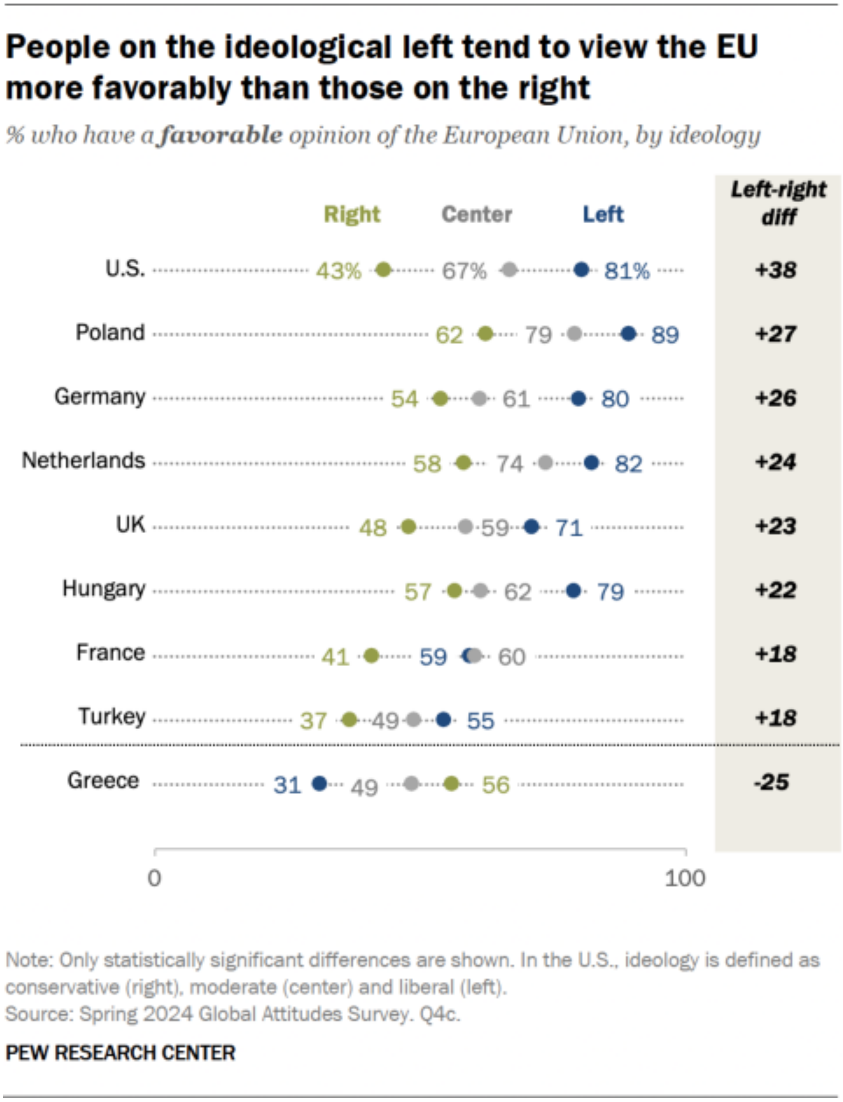
How people in the United States view the EU

In the U.S., views of the EU have remained somewhat stable since 2020, with about six-in-ten Americans or more expressing a positive view of the organization each year. Prior to 2020, U.S. surveys were conducted by phone, so results are not directly comparable. However, Americans' views of the EU have remained broadly favorable over time.

In our new survey, we also asked Americans about the global influence of the EU in recent years. Half of U.S. adults say its influence in the world has stayed about the same, while 28% say it is getting weaker and 17% say it is getting stronger.

Americans' views on this vary by party. Republicans and Republican-leaning independents are more likely than Democrats and Democratic leaners to say that the EU's global influence is weakening (33% vs. 25%).

How views of the EU vary within countries



In many surveyed countries – both within and outside the EU – people who place themselves on the ideological left are significantly more likely than their counterparts on the right to have a favorable opinion of the organization. These ideological differences are often on the order of 20 points or more.

Greece is a notable exception to this pattern. In Greece, a 56% majority of people on the ideological right have a positive opinion of the EU, compared with 31% of those on the left.

As in previous surveys, supporters of right-wing populist parties in many European countries are less likely to have a favorable opinion of the EU. In Germany, for instance, those who support Alternative for Germany (AfD) are 42 points less likely than other Germans to view the EU favorably. There's a similar pattern in France, Hungary, the Netherlands, Poland, Sweden and the UK

when it comes to right-wing populist parties in those countries. (For more information on how we classify populist parties, read the Appendix.)

Views of the EU also vary by age and education in some countries. Younger adults and people with higher levels of educational attainment tend to view the organization more favorably than older adults and those with less education.

Note: Here are the questions used for the analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Topics European Union, World Elections

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Sneha Gubbala is a research analyst focusing on global attitudes research at Pew Research Center.

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SHORT READS | JUNE 18, 2024

Satisfaction with democracy has declined in recent years in high-income nations

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BY RICHARD WIKE AND JANELL FETTEROLF

People around the world generally believe representative democracy is a good way to govern their countries. But as a new Pew Research Center survey highlights, many are dissatisfied with the way it is working. And in several high-income democracies, dissatisfaction has been on the rise.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on views of democracy in 31 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East, North America and sub-Saharan Africa.

This analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 36,412 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 15, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka and Thailand. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 adults from April 1 to 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's

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In advanced and emerging economies, similar views on how social media affects democracy and society

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Hungarians differ in their evaluations of

American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

The survey was conducted right after the 2024 legislative elections in South Korea. In India, Mexico and South Africa, the survey was completed before the most recent elections.

To compare views of those who support the governing party or parties with those who do not, we grouped respondents based on their answers to a question asking them which political party, if any, they identified with in their country. For more, including country specific classifications, read our Political Categorization Appendix.

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardized education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education.

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all reports beginning in 2024, totals will be based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here is the question used for this analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

democracy under Orban's leadership

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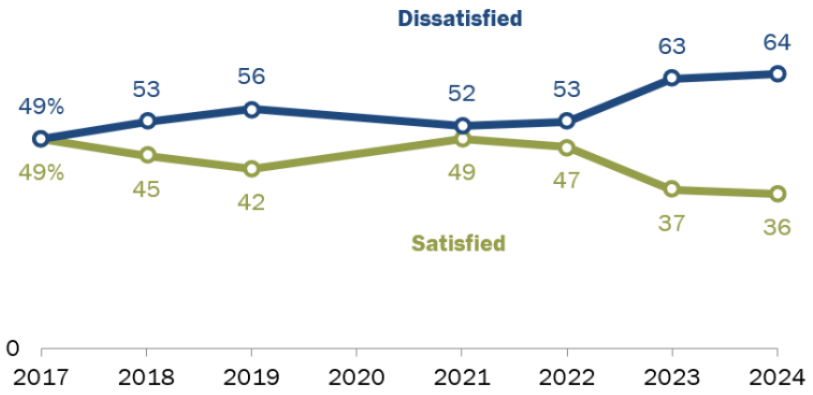
Satisfaction with democracy across 12 high-income, democratic countries is down in recent years

Median % who are __ with the way democracy is working in their country



Note: Percentages are medians across 12 advanced economies: Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, the Netherlands, South Korea, Spain, Sweden, the United Kingdom and the United States. Starting in 2021, U.S. data is from Pew Research Center's online American Trends Panel; older data is from telephone surveys.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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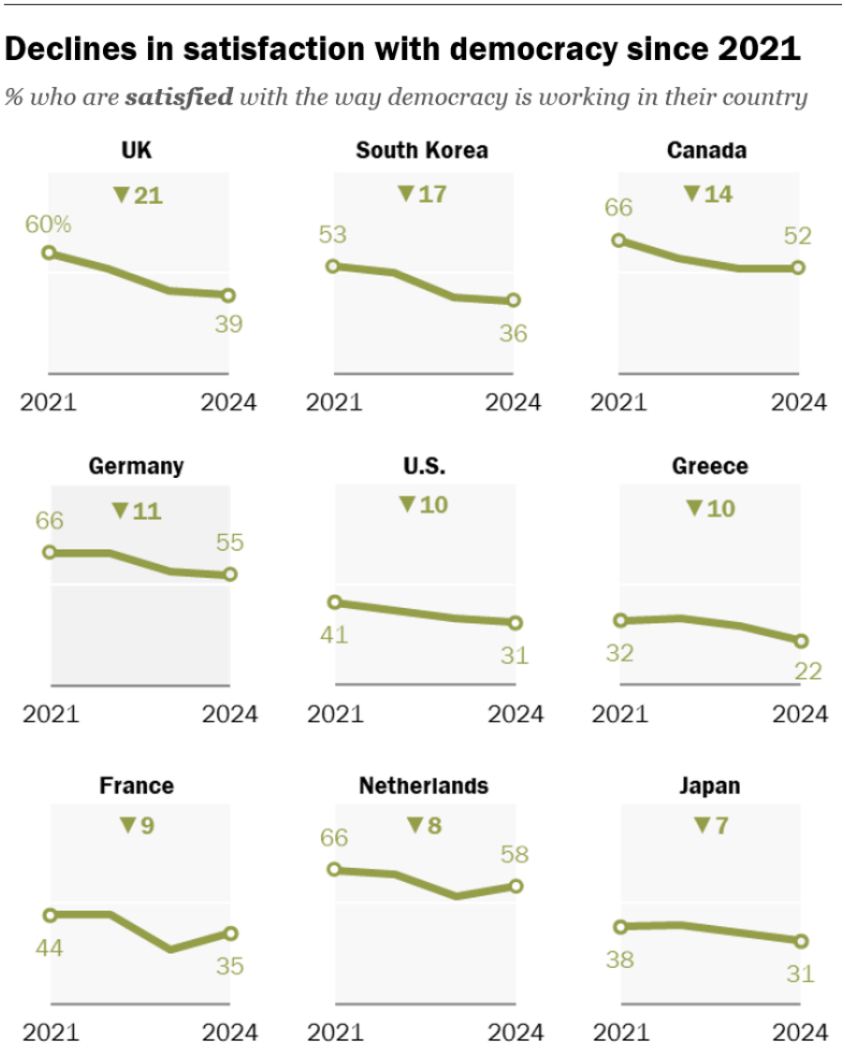
Since 2017, we've regularly asked people in 12 economically advanced democracies how satisfied they are with the state of their democracy. Overall, satisfaction declined in these countries between 2017 and 2019 before bouncing back in 2021, during the COVID-19 pandemic.

Since 2021, however, people in these nations have become more frustrated with their democracies. A median of 49% across these 12 nations were satisfied with the way their democracy was working in 2021; today, just 36% hold this view. (The 2024 survey was conducted before the European Parliament elections in June.)

Related: *Representative Democracy Remains a Popular Ideal, but People Around the World Are Critical of How It's Working*



Satisfaction is lower today than it was in 2021 in nine of the 12 nations where we have asked the question consistently. This includes six countries where satisfaction has dropped by double digits: Canada, Germany, Greece, South Korea, the United Kingdom and the United States.

Satisfaction has not increased in any of the 12 countries surveyed.

How does satisfaction with democracy vary today?

In addition to the 12 countries where the Center has consistently asked about satisfaction with democracy over time, we asked the same question this year in 19 other countries. Across 31 nations

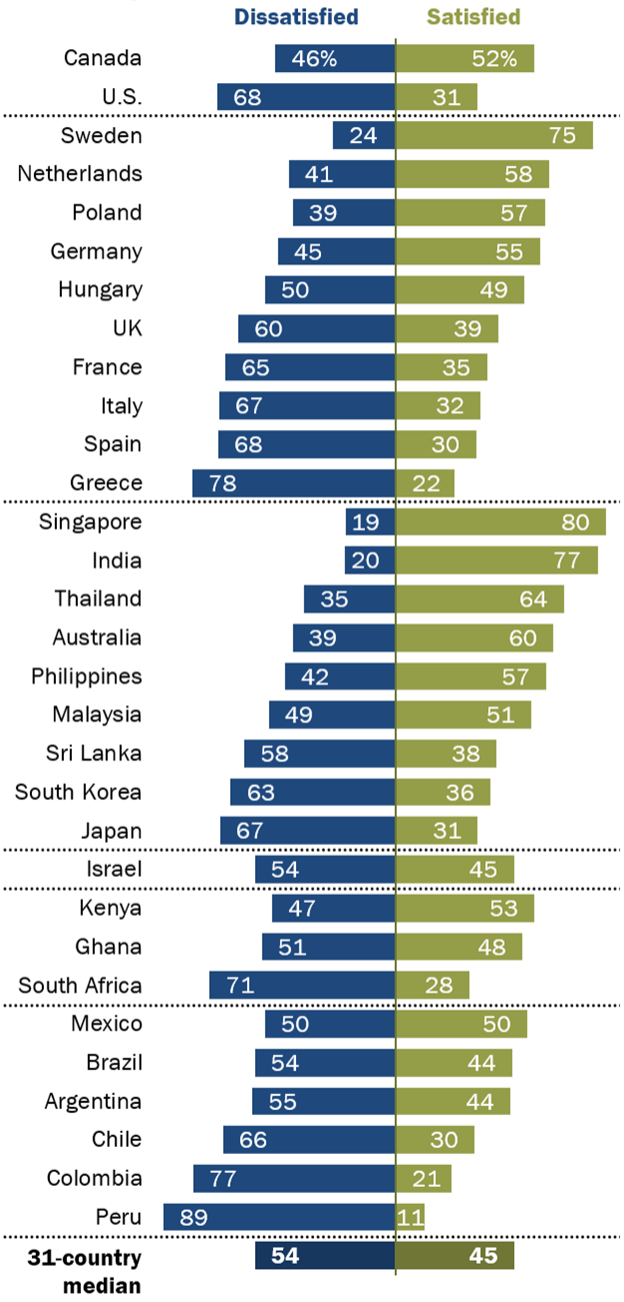
polled in spring 2024, a median of 54% say they are dissatisfied with their democracy, while 45% are satisfied.

Countries in this analysis

The countries included in this analysis receive moderate to positive ratings from research organizations that rate the health of democracy, such as the Economist Intelligence Unit, Freedom House and the Varieties of Democracy Project. Countries in our 2024 survey that are classified as autocratic or a hybrid regime by more than one expert source were excluded from this analysis.

Many people worldwide are dissatisfied with the way democracy is working

% who are ___ with the way democracy is working in their country



Notes: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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Looking across regions, opinions in Europe vary widely: 75% of Swedes are satisfied with their democracy, compared with just 22% in Greece. The same is true in the Asia-Pacific region, where more than three-quarters of Indians and Singaporeans – but only

31% of Japanese – are satisfied with the way their democracy is working. (Our survey took place before recent elections in India.)

In sub-Saharan Africa and Latin America, about two-thirds or more of South Africans, Chileans, Colombians and Peruvians express negative views about their democracies. (Fieldwork in South Africa also took place prior to the country's recent elections.)

Related: *In Their Own Words: What Can Improve Democracy?*

How people feel about the way democracy is working is strongly related to how they believe their economy is working. In all 31 nations polled, people who rate the national economy negatively are more likely than those who rate it positively to be dissatisfied with their democracy.

Similarly, how people feel about the governing party in their country is linked to their assessments of democracy. In 27 countries, supporters of the governing party or coalition are particularly likely to say they are satisfied with the way their democracy is working. (Refer to the Appendix for country-specific governing party classifications.)

In eight countries – Argentina, Chile, France, Germany, the Netherlands, Poland, Spain and the U.S. – people with less education are less satisfied than those with more education with the way democracy is working in their country. And in seven countries – Argentina, Chile, Colombia, Germany, Peru, Singapore and South Korea – adults under 35 are more satisfied with democracy compared with those ages 50 and older. In other countries surveyed, there are few differences by education level or age.

Note: Here is the question used for this analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Topics Democracy, International Affairs, International Political Values

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REPORT | JULY 2, 2024

NATO Seen Favorably in Member States; Confidence in Zelenskyy Down in Europe, U.S.

Views of Russia and Putin remain broadly negative

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BY MOIRA FAGAN, SNEHA GUBBALA AND JACOB POUSHTER

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A staff member carries a Swedish flag on March 11, 2024, at NATO's headquarters in Brussels, ahead of a ceremony marking Sweden's joining of the military alliance. (Omar Havana/Getty Images)

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on public opinion of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), Russia, Russian President Vladimir Putin and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy. The study includes publics in 35 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East, North America and sub-Saharan Africa.

For non-U.S. data, this analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 40,566 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face to face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
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In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Throughout the report, we analyze respondents' attitudes based on where they place themselves on an ideological scale. We asked about political ideology using several slightly different scales and categorized people as being on the ideological left, center or right.

- In most countries, we asked people to place themselves on a scale ranging from “Extreme left” to “Extreme right.” The question was asked this way in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Canada, Chile, Colombia, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Israel, Italy, Mexico, the Netherlands, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Turkey and the United Kingdom.
- In Australia, the scale ranged from “Left” to “Right”.
- In Japan, Singapore, South Korea and Thailand, ideology was measured on a scale from “Extremely progressive” to “Extremely conservative.”
- Ideology was not asked about in Ghana, India, Kenya, Malaysia, Sri Lanka or Tunisia.

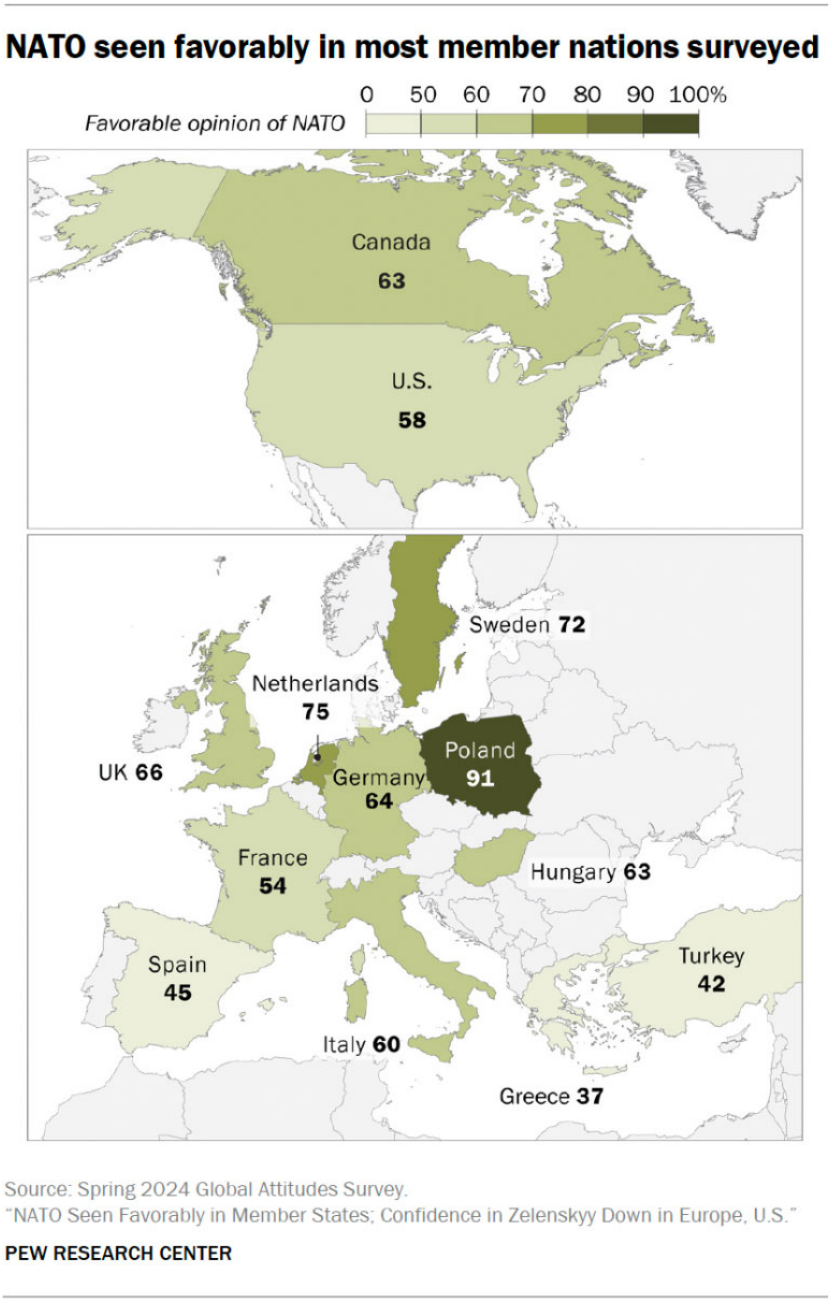
To compare educational groups across countries, we standardize education levels based on the UN’s International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

To compare views of those who support the governing party or parties with those who do not, we grouped respondents based on their answers to a question asking them which political party, if any, they identified with in their country. For more, including country specific classifications, read our Political Categorization Appendix.

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all reports beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years’ data.

Here are the questions used for the report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Ahead of a July 2024 summit marking the 75th anniversary of NATO’s founding, the trans-Atlantic alliance continues to be seen largely favorably in select member nations. A median of 63% of adults across 13 member countries surveyed have a positive opinion of NATO, while 33% have a negative opinion.



Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"NATO Seen Favorably in Member States; Confidence in Zelenskyy Down in Europe, U.S."

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More than two years since Russia's invasion of Ukraine, ratings for Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy are mixed in a broader set of 35 NATO and non-NATO countries we surveyed. A median of 40% of adults across these countries have confidence in Zelenskyy to do the right thing regarding world affairs, while 46% do not. Majorities in just seven countries have confidence in his ability to navigate international affairs. And confidence in him has dropped significantly across several countries in Europe and North America.

Global views of Russia and its leader, President Vladimir Putin, have remained very negative since the conflict began in 2022,

though opinions have warmed slightly in several countries since we last surveyed there.

For this report, we surveyed 44,166 adults in 35 countries from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024. In addition to this overview, the report includes chapters on:

- Views of NATO
- Confidence in Zelenskyy and support for Ukraine
- Views of Russia and Putin

Read some of the report's key findings below.

Views of NATO have changed in several countries

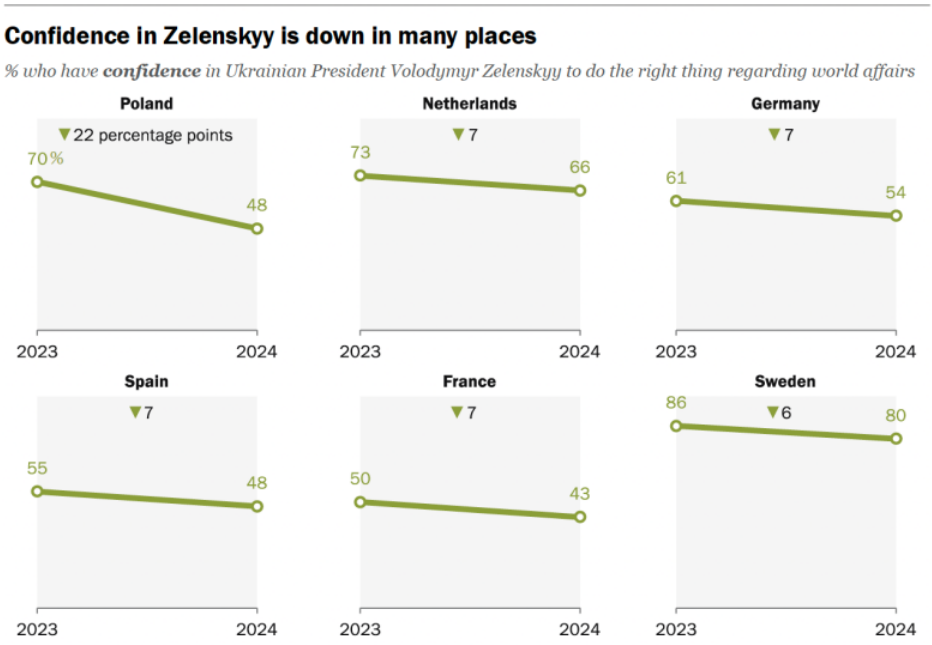
Favorable views of NATO are up significantly in Turkey since our last survey there in 2019. And Hungarians have also grown more favorable toward the alliance in the past year. However, in a handful of places – including Spain, Sweden, the United Kingdom and the United States – positive views of NATO have ticked down slightly since 2023. *(For more on views of NATO over time, read Appendix A.)*

In Hungary, Poland and Turkey, we asked respondents whether NATO membership is important for their country's security. More than eight-in-ten adults in Hungary and Poland say it is important, and roughly six-in-ten share this belief in Turkey.

Confidence in Zelenskyy varies across Europe – and has declined in some places

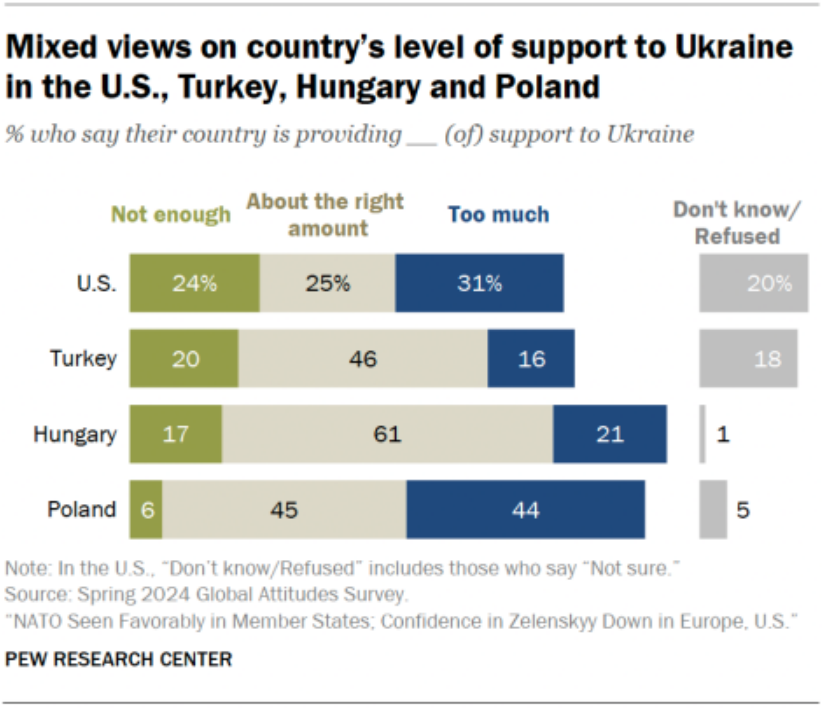
In Europe, confidence in the Ukrainian president varies significantly by country. Eight-in-ten adults in Sweden have confidence in Zelenskyy; a roughly equal share in Hungary do not.

Confidence in Zelenskyy has decreased significantly in many countries since 2023. The drop is largest in Poland, where confidence in him has dropped 22 percentage points since last year.



Little consensus on support for Ukraine

Publics in four countries – the U.S., Turkey, Hungary and Poland – differ widely on whether their country is providing enough support to Ukraine.



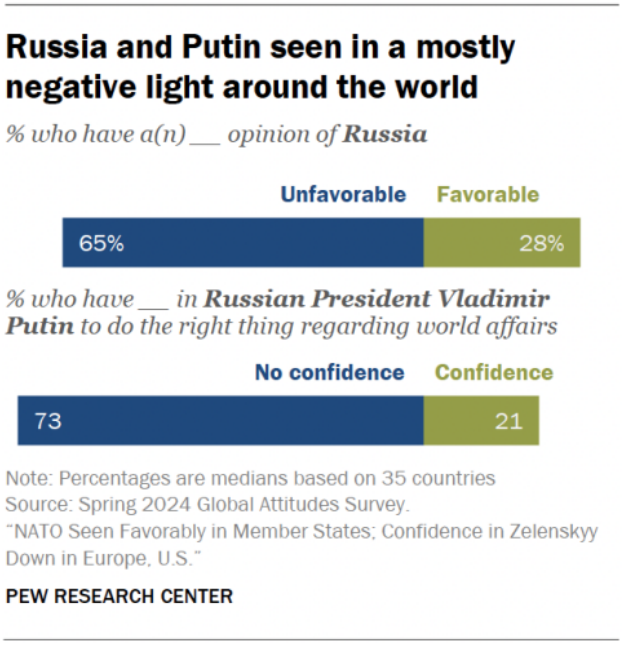
Roughly a quarter of Americans (24%) now say the U.S. is not providing enough aid to Ukraine, up from 18% in November 2023,

when we last asked this question. Still, more Americans (31%) think the U.S. is providing *too much* aid, and 25% believe it's giving the *right amount*.

A majority of Hungarians (61%) and a plurality of Turks (46%) say their country is giving about the right amount of aid to Ukraine. Poles are more divided: While 45% say their country is giving the right amount of support, a nearly identical share (44%) say it is providing too much.

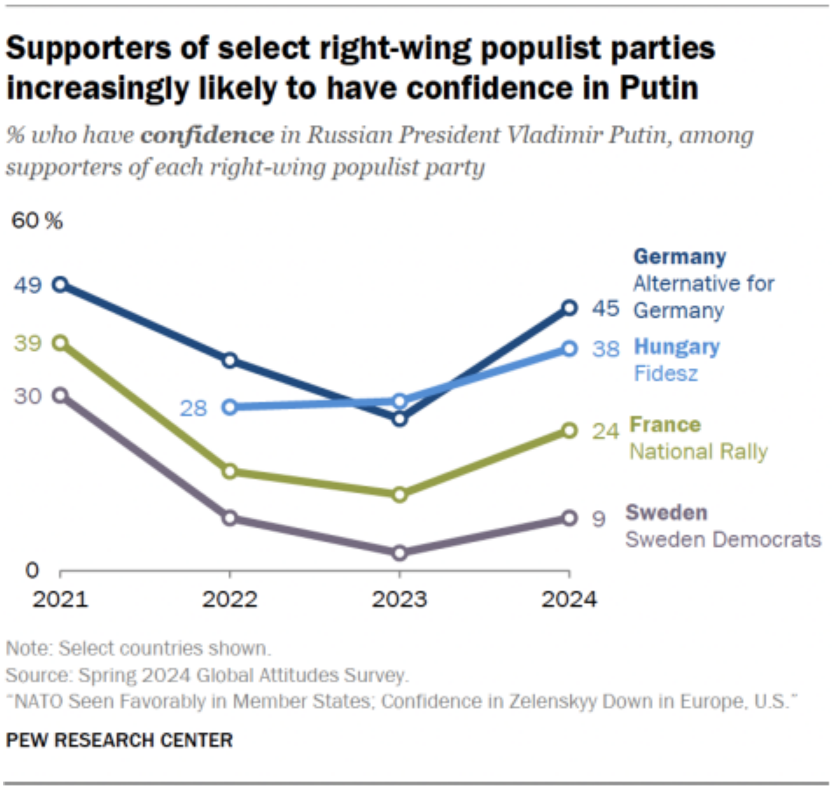
Related: *Growing Partisan Divisions Over NATO and Ukraine*

Views of Russia, Putin have warmed in some places



Views of Russia and Putin remain largely negative across 35 countries polled: A median of 65% have an unfavorable view of Russia and 73% lack confidence in the Russian leader to do the right thing regarding world affairs.

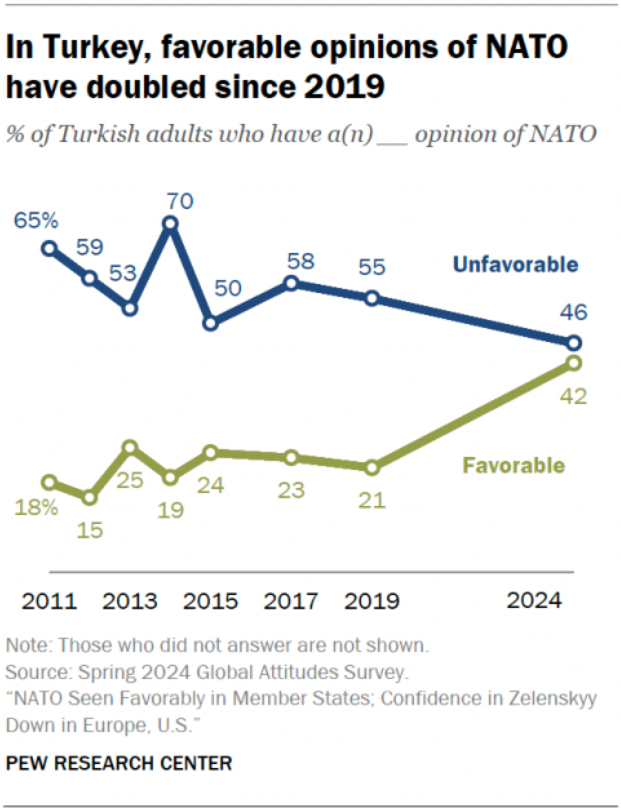
But in a handful of countries, opinions of Russian and Putin have warmed since we last surveyed there. Argentines, for example, have grown 11 percentage points more favorable toward Russia and 9 points more confident in Putin over the past year. *(For more on views of Russia and Putin over time, read Appendix A.)*



In several European countries, people who have a favorable view of a right-wing populist party in their country see Russia and Putin more positively than do people with unfavorable views of those parties. While ratings for Russia and Putin among some right-wing populists dropped sharply in 2022 and 2023 (our 2022 fieldwork largely took place during the early weeks of Russia's invasion of Ukraine) favorability and confidence are creeping back up in a few countries.

In Germany, for example, about a quarter (26%) of supporters of Alternative for Germany (AfD) had confidence in Putin in 2023. Now, 45% do, an increase of 19 points and close to preinvasion levels of confidence. The same pattern appears elsewhere, too. *(For more information on how we categorize populist party support, read Appendix C.)*

Country spotlight: Turkey



Favorable views of NATO historically have been much lower in Turkey than in other NATO members states, according to our previous surveys. Before this year, no more than a quarter of adults in Turkey had a positive view of the long-standing treaty organization, which Turkey joined in 1952.

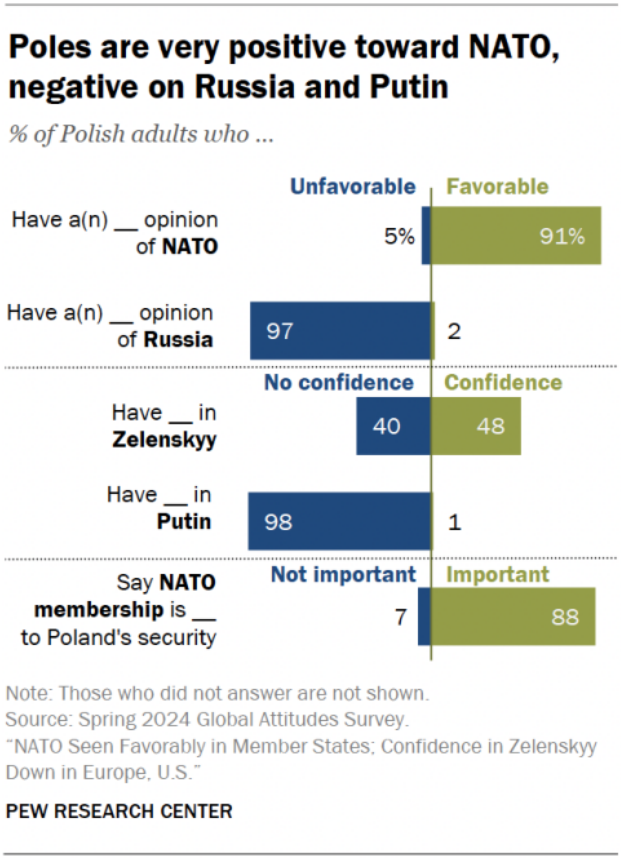
However, the share of Turks with a positive view of NATO has nearly doubled since 2019, when we last surveyed in the country. Today, 42% have a favorable opinion of the alliance, up from 21% in 2019. Fewer Turks now hold unfavorable opinions or have no opinion of it. A majority (61%) also say membership in NATO is very or somewhat important to their country's security. Still, favorability of NATO in is lower in Turkey than in many of the other member states we polled.

Turks are quite negative toward Russia and Putin: More than six-in-ten express an unfavorable view of Russia or have no confidence in its leader. Those on the ideological left are more likely than those on the right to have a negative opinion of Russia and to lack confidence in Putin. And those who have a favorable opinion of Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdoğan are about

twice as likely to express a positive view of Russia as those who have an unfavorable view of Erdoğan.

Turks' views of Zelenskyy are similar to their views of Putin. Only 31% of Turks have confidence the Ukrainian president, while 60% have no confidence. A plurality (46%) say their country is providing about the right amount of support to Ukraine, while 20% say it is not providing enough support and 16% it is providing too much; another 18% did not answer.

Country spotlight: Poland



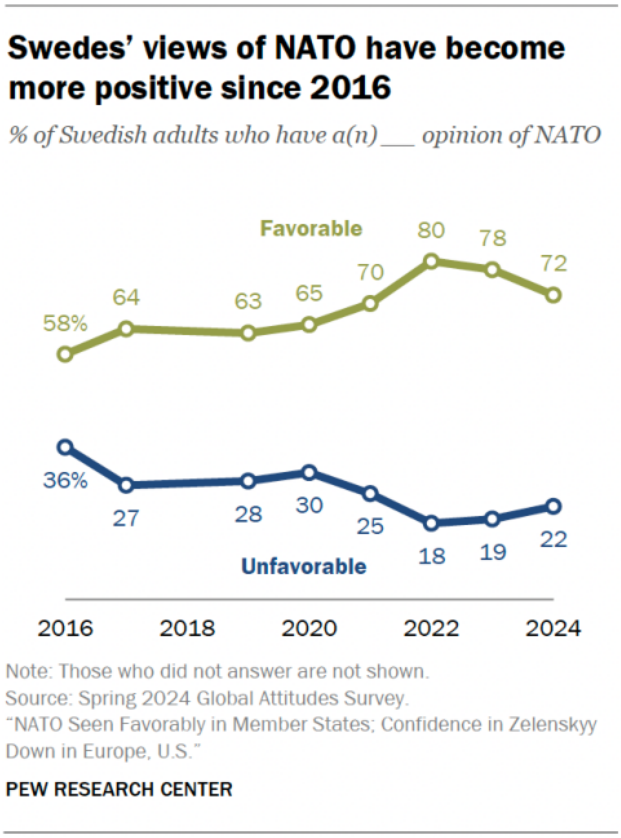
Poles stand out among the publics we surveyed for their very positive opinions of NATO and very negative views of Russia and Putin.

Roughly nine-in-ten adults in Poland have a favorable view of NATO, the highest share among the member states polled. And 88% consider their country's membership in NATO important to national security, including a 55% majority who say it is *very* important.

Poles are nearly united in their negative sentiments toward Russia and its leader: 97% have an unfavorable view of Russia and 98% have no confidence in Putin on the world stage.

However, they are more divided on Ukraine's leader: 48% are confident in Zelenskyy to do the right thing regarding world affairs, while 40% have no confidence in him. During the fieldwork period for this survey, a farmer-led blockade in Poland over the low price of imported grain from neighboring Ukraine caused friction between the two countries.

Country spotlight: Sweden



NATO is popular in Sweden, which formally became a member of the alliance in March 2024, just before our fieldwork for this survey began there. About seven-in-ten Swedes have a positive view of NATO, while 22% have a negative opinion.

The share of Swedes with a positive view of NATO is down slightly from 80% in 2022. That year, our fieldwork in Sweden began the same day as Russia's invasion of Ukraine – and Swedes grew increasingly positive about NATO as our fieldwork went on.

People in Sweden express strongly unfavorable views of Russia and Putin, though they rank just below Poland in the strength of these sentiments. And 80% of Swedes have confidence in Zelenskyy, the highest share across all 35 surveyed countries.

Next: Views of NATO

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Most People in 35 Countries Say China Has a Large Impact on Their National Economy

People in middle-income countries are more likely than those in high-income countries to view China's economic influence positively

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BY LAURA SILVER, CHRISTINE HUANG, LAURA CLANCY AND ANDREW PROZOROVSKY

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Chinese tourists take a photo with a China Aid plaque in Vientiane, Laos, on April 8, 2024. A high-speed railway between China and Laos is a key project of China's Belt and Road Initiative. (Lauren DeCicca/Getty Images)

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on public opinion of China in 35 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East-North Africa region, North America and sub-Saharan Africa. Views of China are examined in the context of long-term trend data.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Most People in 35 Countries Say China Has a Large Impact on Their National Economy"
PEW RESEARCH CENTER

For non-U.S. data, this analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 40,566 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

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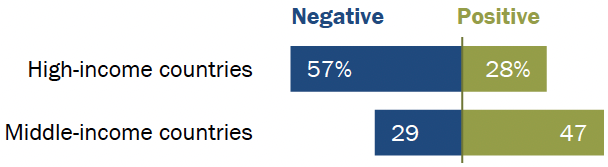
- In Australia, the scale ranged from "Left" to "Right."
- In Japan, Singapore, South Korea and Thailand, ideology was measured on a scale from "Extremely progressive" to "Extremely conservative."
- In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left).
- Ideology was not asked about in Ghana, India, Kenya, Malaysia, Sri Lanka or Tunisia.

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all reports beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here are the questions used for the report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

More in middle-income countries than high-income countries see China's economic influence as positive

Median % who say China is having a __ impact on economic conditions in their country



Note: Percentages are medians based on 18 high-income countries and 17 middle-income countries. Reflects responses to two questions: one asking about how much influence China has on economic conditions and another on whether that influence is positive or negative. Those who said China is having no influence at all were not asked the second question. Those who said China is having no influence at all, who volunteered another answer like "Both" or "Neither," or who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Most People in 35 Countries Say China Has a Large Impact on Their National Economy"

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People around the world feel China's economic influence where they live, according to a new Pew Research Center survey of 35 countries.

Large majorities in nearly all the nations we polled – spanning six continents and ranging in income level – say China has a great deal or a fair amount of influence on their country's economic conditions.

And China's economic influence is now felt more widely than it was when we last asked this question in 2019. **In 10 of the 13 countries where trend data is available, a larger share say China has a great deal of impact on their country's economy than said so five years ago.**

But whether people see this influence as positive or negative varies widely. **In most of the middle-income countries included in the survey, people tend to view China's economic influence as a good thing. But in the high-income countries, people tend to see it as a bad thing.**

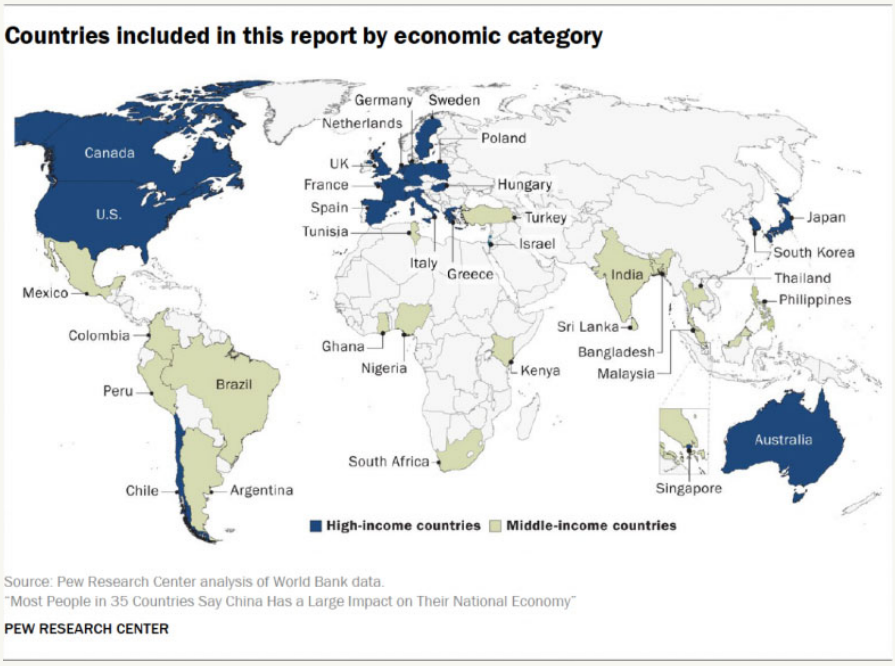
- In the 17 middle-income countries surveyed, a median of 47% of adults say China has a *positive* influence on their country's

economy, while 29% say it has a negative impact.

- In the 18 high-income countries surveyed, a median of 57% of adults say China's economic influence is *negative*, while 28% say it's positive.

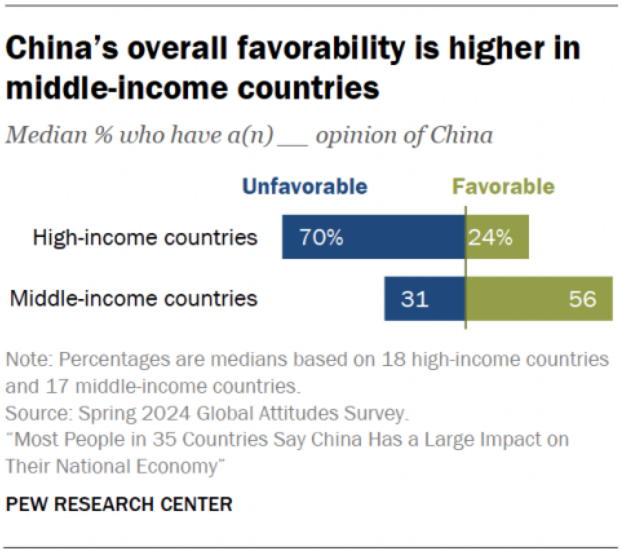
Economic categorization

For this report, we grouped countries into high-income and middle-income categories based on definitions from the World Bank.



Americans are the most likely to have negative views of China's economic impact. About three-quarters say China's influence on the U.S. economy is negative. *(Read more about Americans' views of China in our May report.)*

Where views on China's economic influence have changed, they have generally become more negative. In Argentina, Brazil, Israel, Japan, South Korea and Tunisia, more say China has a *negative* economic influence on their country than said so in 2019. *(Read more about perceptions of China's economic impact in Chapter 2.)*



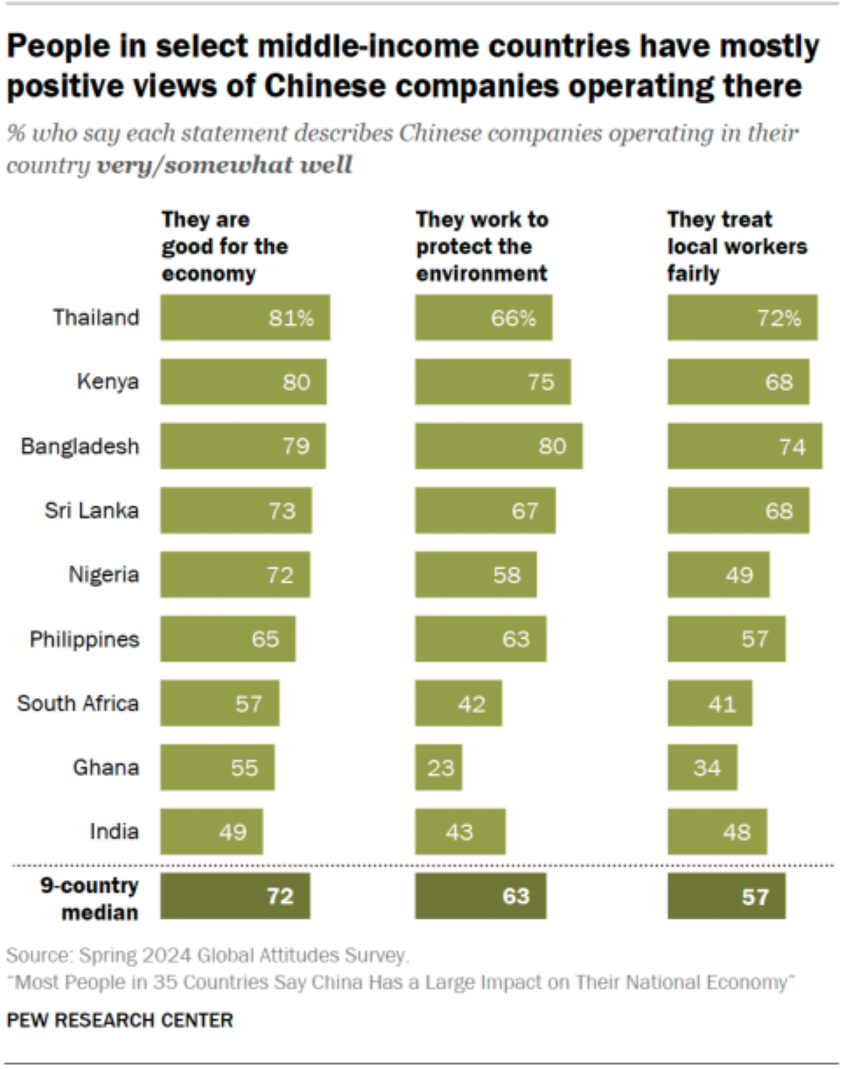
Overall favorability of China follows a similar pattern to views of its economic influence:

- Across the high-income countries surveyed, a median of 70% view China *unfavorably*.
- Across the middle-income countries surveyed, a median of 56% view China *favorably*. *(Read more about favorability in Chapter 1.)*

These are among the key findings of a new survey of 44,166 people in 35 countries conducted from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024.

The report also includes some questions only asked in the Asia-Pacific region or in specific middle-income countries.

Views of Chinese firms are mixed



China launched its Belt and Road Initiative in 2013. Today, more than 10 years into the initiative, the country's global outward foreign direct investment is close to $3 trillion. And according to a Bloomberg analysis of data from China's Ministry of Commerce, its investments overseas are at their highest point in the last eight years.

At the same time, controversies have arisen about the environmental impact of Chinese firms operating abroad, how their workers are treated, and even whether Chinese investments benefit local economies or act as harmful competition.

Still, people in a number of middle-income nations have a positive impression of Chinese companies operating there. **Across the nine nations where we asked about this, a 72% median say Chinese companies are good for their country's economy.** Views are most positive in Thailand (81%), Kenya

(80%) and Bangladesh (79%), though a majority or plurality hold this view in each of the nine surveyed countries.

When it comes to whether Chinese companies work to protect the environment in these countries, opinion is a bit cooler. **A median of 63% say Chinese companies *do* work to protect the environment. But in Ghana and South Africa, large shares say they do not.**

Opinion is even more mixed on whether Chinese companies in each country treat local workers fairly. **In Ghana, Nigeria, the Philippines and South Africa, around four-in-ten or more *do not* think Chinese companies operating in their country treat local workers fairly.** *(Read more about views of Chinese firms in Chapter 2.)*

China's territorial disputes concern many in Asia-Pacific countries

Publics in Asia-Pacific countries are concerned about territorial disputes between China and its neighbors

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Most People in 35 Countries Say China Has a Large Impact on Their National Economy"

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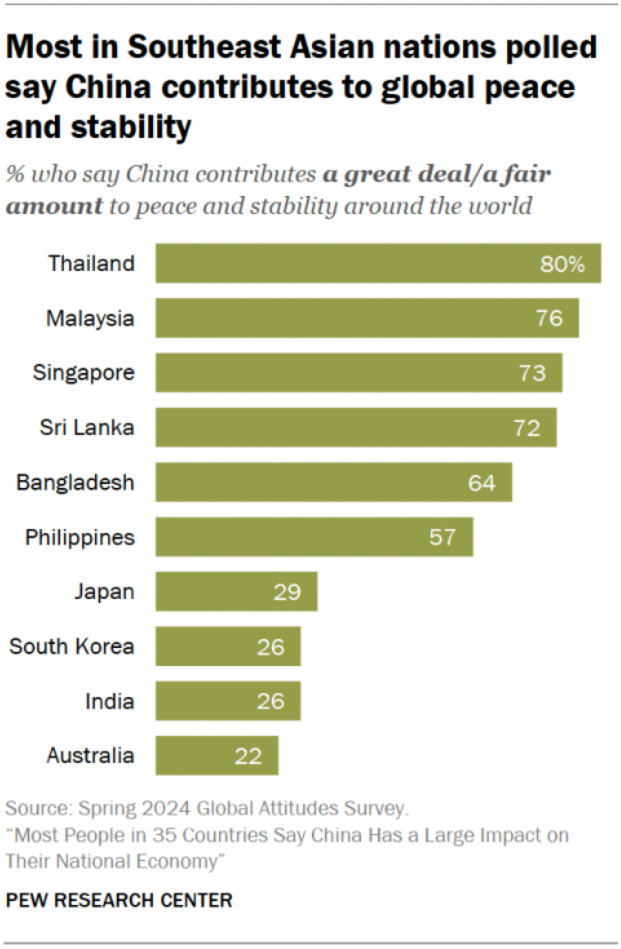
China is party to multiple territorial disputes in the Asia-Pacific region, whether related to the South China Sea, the East China Sea or even specific borders such as those between China and India. **Of the 10 Asia-Pacific countries we surveyed, majorities or pluralities in all but Thailand are at least somewhat concerned about these territorial disputes.**

In the Philippines, for example, where border tensions with China largely center on the Second Thomas Shoal of the Spratly Islands, 91% say they are concerned about territorial disputes between China and its neighbors, including 65% who are *very* concerned. (Since fielding, the conflict has flared up over a collision in the area between Chinese and Philippine ships.)

Around three-quarters or more in Australia, Japan, Malaysia and South Korea also express concern. *(Read more about views of China's territorial disputes in Chapter 3.)*

In the Asia-Pacific, views differ on whether China contributes to global peace and stability



Across the Asia-Pacific region, we also asked people whether China contributes to peace and stability around the world. Opinion is divided: In Malaysia and Thailand, around two-thirds or more see it playing this role. About three-in-ten or fewer say the same in Australia, India, Japan and South Korea.

When we asked this question in 24 countries in 2023, Australians, Japanese and South Koreans were some of the least likely to say China contributes to global peace and stability. They remain some of the most critical, but to a lesser extent than last year. Still, these three publics are generally less likely to say China plays this

stabilizing role than to say the same about other regional powers we asked about (Australia, India and Japan).

(Read more about views of China's role on the world stage in Chapter 3.)

Next: Views of China and Xi Jinping

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BY LAURA SILVER

More people around the world have a positive view of the United States than China, according to a Pew Research Center survey of 35 countries. A median of 54% of adults in these nations have a favorable view of the U.S., while a median of 35% see China favorably.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis explores public opinion of the U.S. and China in 35 countries in North America, Europe, the Asia-Pacific region, the Middle East-North Africa region, sub-Saharan Africa and Latin America. Data on public confidence in U.S. President Joe Biden is limited to 34 countries because we did not ask this question in the United States.

This analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 40,566 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face to face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

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Americans' views of China have grown somewhat more positive in recent years

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Views of the U.S. have worsened while opinions of China have improved in many surveyed countries

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

We base our classifications of high- and middle-income countries on the World Bank's designations.

TOPICS

China Global Image

Joe Biden

U.S. Global Image

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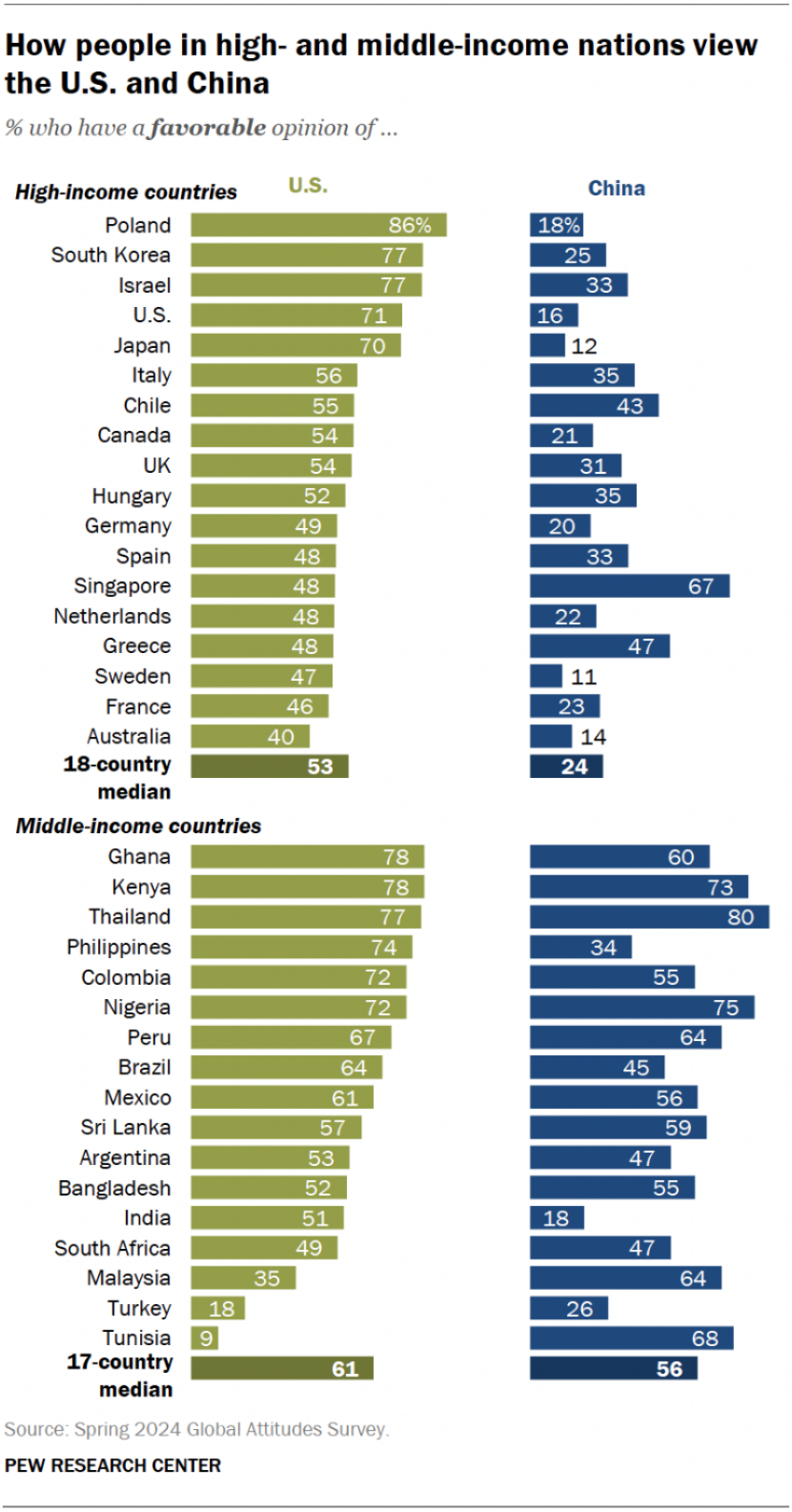


Views of the U.S. are broadly positive across the high- and middle-income countries we surveyed between January and May:

- A median of 53% in 18 high-income countries have a favorable view of the U.S.

- A median of 61% in 17 middle-income countries also see the U.S. favorably.

Favorability ratings of the U.S. range from a high of 86% in Poland to a low of 9% in Tunisia. And 71% of Americans themselves have a positive view of their country.

When it comes to China, people in high- and middle-income countries have markedly different opinions:

- In the high-income countries surveyed, a median of just 24% have a favorable view of China.
- Far more in middle-income nations (a median of 56%) see China positively.

Indeed, there's only one high-income country where a majority of adults have a favorable opinion of China – Singapore, where 67% hold this view. By comparison, majorities are favorable in more than half of the middle-income countries surveyed.

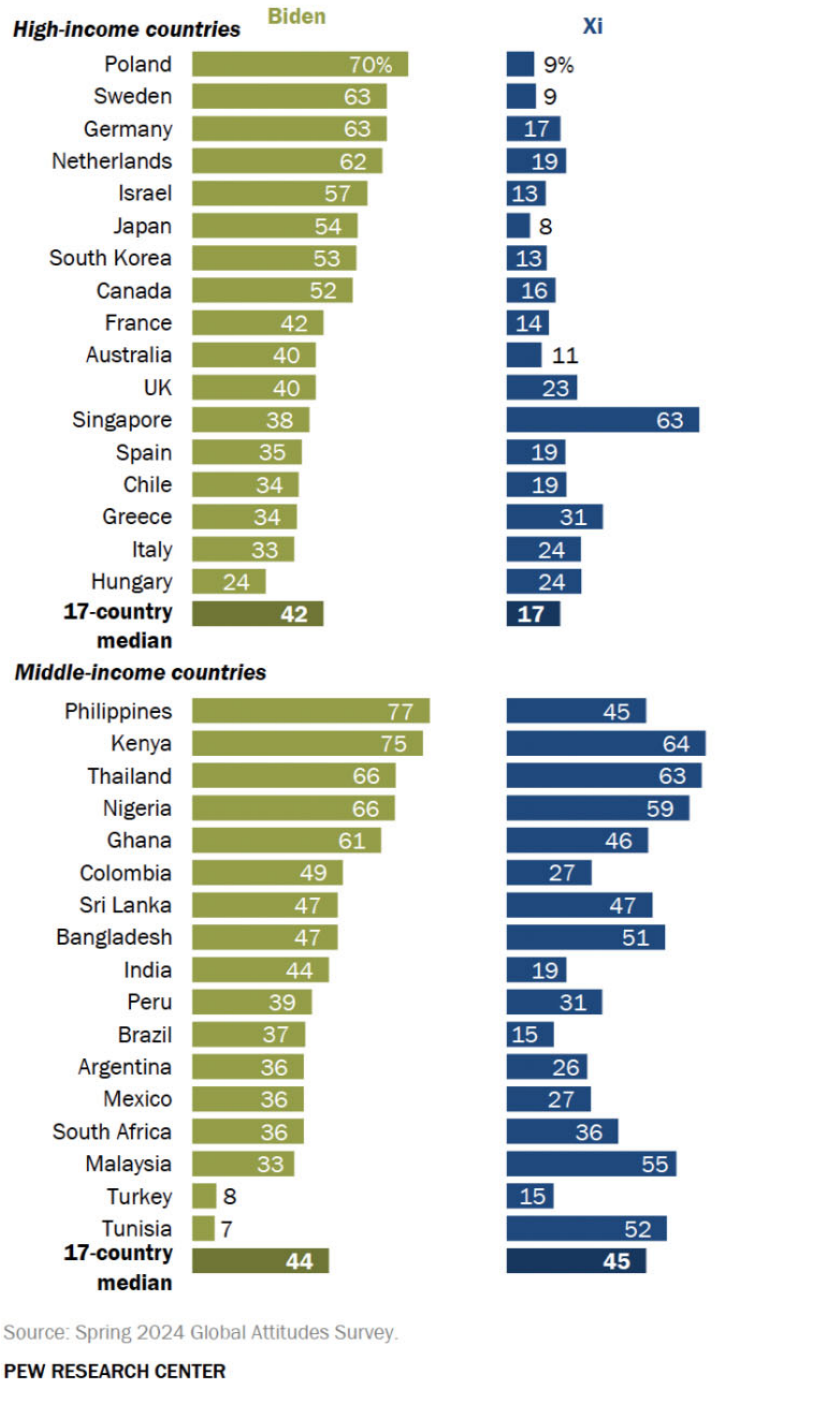
When it comes to *differences* in views of the U.S. and China, a few countries stand out:

- More people have a favorable opinion of China than the U.S. in Malaysia, Singapore, Tunisia and Turkey.
- Views of the U.S. and China are broadly similar (and mostly favorable) in Bangladesh, Greece, Nigeria, Peru, South Africa, Sri Lanka and Thailand.
- More people have a positive view of the U.S. than China in the remaining 24 countries we surveyed. In some of these places, such as Kenya and Mexico, people are only slightly more likely to favor the U.S. over China. In other places, such as Japan and South Korea, far more people view the U.S. favorably than hold the same view about China.

Opinions of the U.S. and China have fluctuated somewhat since last year in the 22 countries where 2023 trend data is available. But there is only one – Spain – where views of the U.S. have

become more negative while views of China have become more positive. Elsewhere, views of only one country have shifted significantly. And in Israel, views of *both* the U.S. and China have become more negative.

Confidence in Biden and Xi



People in the surveyed countries also tend to have more confidence in U.S. President Joe Biden than Chinese President Xi Jinping to do the right thing regarding world affairs. A median of 43% of adults across 34 countries (excluding the U.S.) have confidence in Biden, compared with a median of 24% who have confidence Xi.

Again, there are major differences in views between high- and middle-income countries:

- In the high-income countries surveyed, a median of 42% of adults have confidence in Biden, while 17% have confidence in Xi.
- In middle-income countries, nearly identical shares have confidence in Biden and Xi (44% vs. 45% at the median).

Malaysia, Singapore, Tunisia and Turkey are the only surveyed countries where more people have confidence in Xi than Biden.

In most other countries, more people have confidence in Biden than Xi. In fact, in several of these countries – including Germany, Japan and South Korea – people are at least 40 percentage points more likely to have confidence in the American president than in his Chinese counterpart.

Topics China Global Image, Joe Biden, U.S. Global Image

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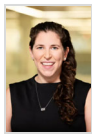

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SHORT READS | JULY 10, 2024

72% of Americans say the U.S. used to be a good example of democracy, but isn't anymore

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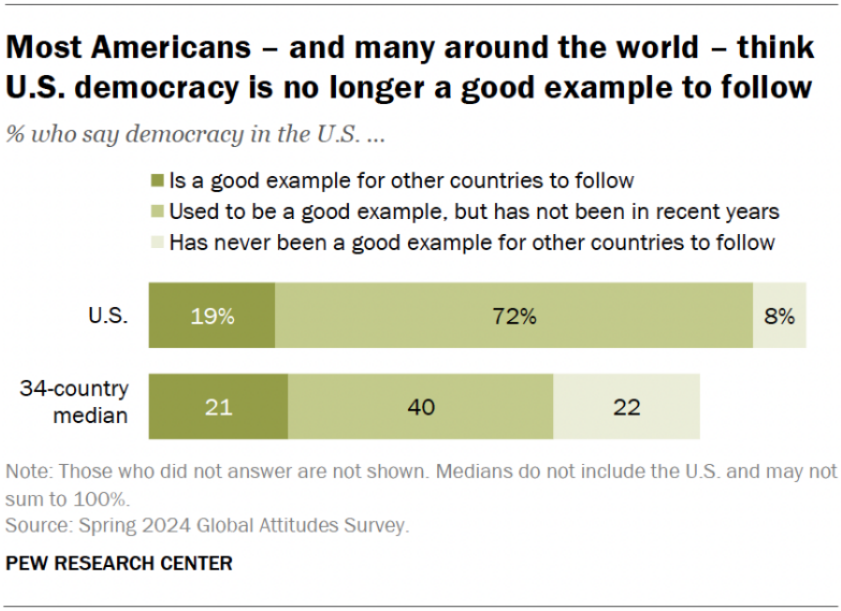
BY JANELL FETTEROLF

Ahead of the November presidential election, just 19% of Americans say democracy in the United States is a good example for other countries to follow, according to a Pew Research Center survey conducted in April.



The most common view – held by 72% of Americans – is that democracy in the U.S. *used to be* a good example, but has not

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Americans are more dissatisfied with how their democracy is working than people in other high-income countries

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A majority of Americans say the

been in recent years. Another 8% of Americans say U.S. democracy *has never been* a good example for other countries to follow.

Americans are much more likely than people in other countries to say U.S. democracy *used to be* a good example. A median of 40% of adults across 34 other countries surveyed in 2024 take this view.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis examines views of American democracy among people in the United States and in 34 other countries we surveyed this year.

For non-U.S. data, this analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 40,566 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

Countries included in this analysis

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
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In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through

country's best years are behind us

TOPICS

U.S. Democracy

U.S. Global Image

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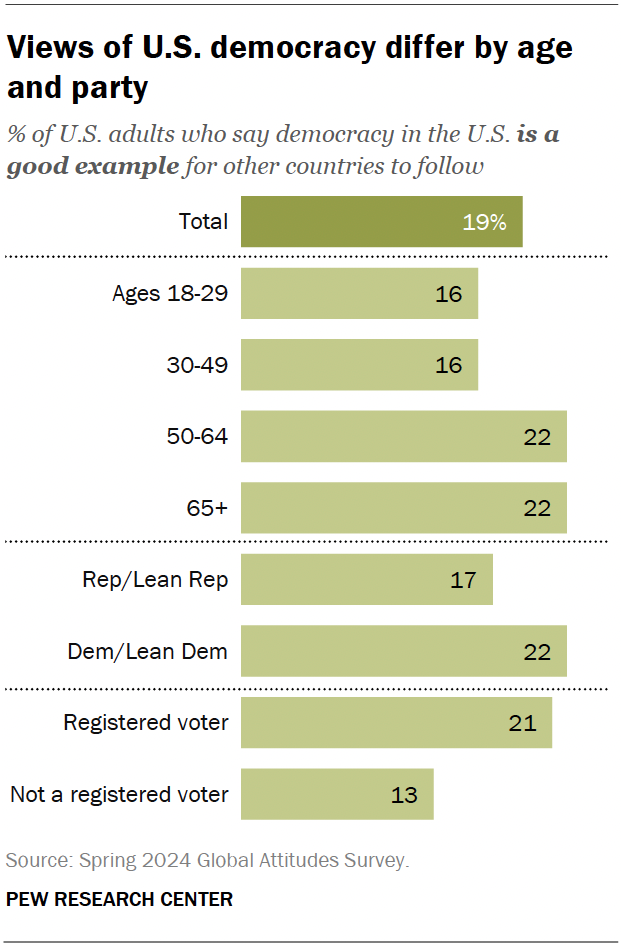
national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

For more information on how people in 34 other countries view democracy in the United States, refer to our June report: "Globally, Biden Receives Higher Ratings Than Trump."

Here is the question used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Americans' views differ by age, party and voter status



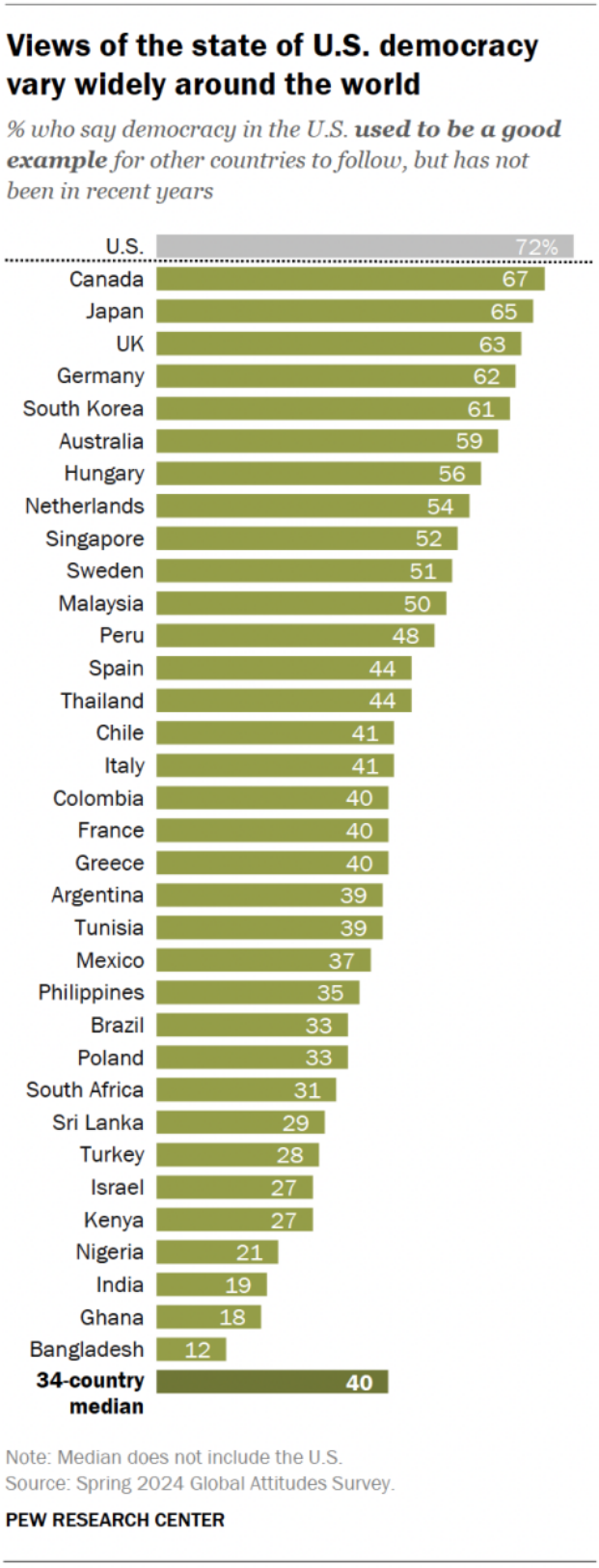
Relatively few Americans overall see the nation's democracy as a good example for other countries to follow. But adults ages 50 and older are more likely than those under 50 to hold this view. Younger adults, on the other hand, are more likely than older

adults to say American democracy *has never been* a good example (11% vs. 4%).

Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents are somewhat more likely than Republicans and Republican leaners to see U.S. democracy as a good example (22% vs. 17%). This is nearly the reverse of where things stood in February 2021, when 24% of Republicans and 16% of Democrats saw democracy in the U.S. as a good example.

Opinions also differ by voter status. Among Americans who are registered to vote, 21% see U.S. democracy as a good example, compared with 13% of those who are not registered to vote. Registered voters are also somewhat more likely to answer this question.

Globally, views of American democracy differ by country



As in the U.S., the most common view across the other countries we surveyed this year is that American democracy *used to be* a good example for other nations to follow, but has not been in recent years. However there are big differences by country.

Around two-thirds of adults in Canada (67%) and Japan (65%) say democracy in the U.S. used to be a good example. By contrast, only 12% in Bangladesh, 18% in Ghana and 19% in India hold this view, though sizable shares in Bangladesh and India do not offer an opinion.

Elsewhere, large shares of the public take the view that U.S. democracy *has never been* a good example for other countries to follow. Around half of adults in Turkey (52%) say this, as do 45% in Tunisia.

And like in the U.S., younger people in other countries are often more likely than their elders to say American democracy *has never been* a good example. In Greece, for instance, 54% of adults under 35 say this, compared with 34% of those 50 and older. There are also notable age gaps in Australia, Canada, Germany, Italy, the Netherlands and Sweden.

This pattern is reversed in several other countries. Older adults in Argentina, Brazil, Colombia, Peru, Singapore and Turkey are *more* likely than younger people to say American democracy has never been a good example.

(Read more about global views of U.S. democracy in our June report.)

Note: Here is the question used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Topics U.S. Democracy, U.S. Global Image

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SHORT READS | JULY 19, 2024

U.S. adults under 30 have different foreign policy priorities than older adults

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BY JENN HATFIELD AND LAURA SILVER

From left: A law enforcement officer with a bomb-sniffing dog patrols outside Geneva Presbyterian Church in Laguna Woods, California, on May 15, 2022, shortly after a shooting took place there. Climate activists gather at the March to End Fossil Fuels on Sept. 17, 2023, in New York City ahead of the Climate Ambition Summit there. Antinuclear activists protest outside the United States Mission to the United Nations. (Allen J. Schaben/Los Angeles Times via Getty Images; middle and right images both Erik McGregor/LightRocket via Getty Images)

Majorities of U.S. adults under 30 say dealing with global climate change (59%), preventing the spread of weapons of mass destruction (56%) and taking measures to protect the United States from terrorist attacks (55%) should each be a top foreign policy priority for the country.

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People in Middle-Income Countries Say Climate Change Is Affecting Their Community

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Americans' views of key foreign policy goals depend on their attitudes toward international cooperation

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Scientists more worried than public about world's growing population

These three issues stand out as the *only* ones that majorities of young adults see as top priorities, according to a recent Pew Research Center survey that asked about 22 long-term foreign policy goals.

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to understand how Americans' long-term foreign policy priorities differ by age. We surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to 7, 2024.

Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way, nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Around a third or more of young adults also prioritize:

REPORT | MAR 18, 2009

Most Like It Hot

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Majorities of young adults only see 3 of 22 foreign policy goals as top priorities for the U.S.

% of U.S. adults ages 18-29 who say the following long-range foreign policy goals should be given ...

Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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- Reducing the spread of infectious diseases (45% say this should be given top priority)
- Reducing the flow of illegal drugs into our country (39%)
- Promoting and defending human rights in other countries (36%)

The April survey specifically asked about Americans' foreign policy goals. When it comes to the public's *domestic* priorities, young adults place less emphasis on climate change than on other issues, including strengthening the economy, improving education and reducing health care costs, according to a separate Center survey conducted in January.

Young adults' views on supporting other countries

In our April survey about foreign policy goals, we find that many young adults do *not* prioritize several ways of supporting other countries.

This is particularly true when it comes to Israel: 48% of 18- to 29-year-olds say supporting Israel should be given *no priority* – the highest share of young adults who say this about any foreign policy goal we asked about. Around a quarter (26%) also say finding a solution to the conflict between Israelis and Palestinians should be given no priority.

In a separate February survey, we found that young adults are more than twice as likely to say the U.S. should play *no* role in diplomatically resolving the Israel-Hamas war as they are to say it should play a *major* role (29% vs. 13%). However, another 25% said they weren't sure.

When it comes to other foreign policy goals, the April survey finds 34% of young adults say that supporting Ukraine should not be a priority, and an identical share say this about promoting democracy in other nations.

Young adults also do not especially prioritize two technological goals included in the April survey: being a leader in developing artificial intelligence and being a leader in space exploration. For example, just 26% of U.S. adults under 30 say that leading the way on AI should be given top priority. A similar share (28%) says this should be given *no* priority.

How do young adults' foreign policy goals compare with those of older adults?

While dealing with global climate change is a top foreign policy priority for about six-in-ten young adults, it is a lower priority for older adults. Some 38% of adults ages 30 to 49 say it should be a top priority, as do 43% of those 50 to 64 and 39% of those 65 and older.

In fact, global climate change ranks 11th out of the 22 policy goals among adults 65 and older, based on the share who say it should be a top priority. It ranks 11th among those ages 50 to 64 and eighth among those 30 to 49.

While the youngest U.S. adults prioritize climate change, older adults prioritize preventing terrorism

% of U.S. adults who say the following long-range foreign policy goals should be given ***top priority***

	Ages 18-29	30-49	50-64	65+
Dealing with global climate change	**59**	38	43	39
Preventing the spread of weapons of mass destruction	56	54	69	76
Taking measures to protect the U.S. from terrorist attacks	55	**65**	**85**	**89**
Reducing the spread of infectious diseases	45	47	58	61
Reducing the flow of illegal drugs into our country	39	59	74	84
Promoting and defending human rights in other countries	36	24	25	19
Limiting the power and influence of Russia	33	42	60	67
Finding a solution to the conflict between Israelis and Palestinians	31	23	29	35
Maintaining the U.S. military advantage over all other countries	31	49	61	71
Reducing U.S. military commitments overseas	29	26	23	18
Strengthening the United Nations	29	22	36	38
Getting other countries to assume more of the costs of maintaining world order	28	37	48	55
Limiting the power and influence of China	28	40	58	72
Aiding refugees fleeing violence around the world	27	14	17	18
The U.S. being a leader in developing artificial intelligence	26	31	35	35
Limiting the power and influence of North Korea	25	27	44	58
The U.S. being a leader in space exploration	21	20	26	33
Promoting democracy in other nations	18	13	20	25
Limiting the power and influence of Iran	17	24	49	61
Strengthening NATO	17	23	33	37
Supporting Ukraine	15	17	26	38
Supporting Israel	7	15	29	39

Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Among young adults

Climate change is one of only two policy goals we asked about where the youngest adults prioritize it more than all older age groups. The other is promoting and defending human rights in other countries. On this issue, 36% of adults under 30 – but no more than a quarter of adults in older age groups – say it should be a top priority.

Among adults ages 30 and older

For adults ages 30 and older, the top priority is protecting the U.S. from terrorist attacks. These adults were alive for, and are likely to remember, the terrorist attacks of Sept. 11, 2001, unlike many 18- to 29-year-olds.

The other top priorities for those ages 30 and older are reducing the flow of illegal drugs into the U.S. and preventing the spread of weapons of mass destruction (WMD). Both of these issues are most important to the oldest Americans: 84% of those 65 and older say reducing the flow of illegal drugs should be given top priority, and 76% say the same about WMD.

Sizable shares of adults ages 30 and older, and especially those 65 and older, also prioritize:

- Limiting the power and influence of China
- Maintaining the United States' military advantage over all other countries
- Limiting the power and influence of Russia

About two-thirds or more of adults 65 and older say each of these goals should be given top priority, as do about four-in-ten or more among those ages 30 to 49 and 50 to 64. In contrast, only about a third or fewer of adults under 30 say these should be top priorities.

This is consistent with past Center research showing that older Americans are more likely than younger adults to perceive global conflicts – including those between China and Taiwan and between Russia and Ukraine – as important to U.S. national interests. Older Americans are also much more concerned than younger ones about Ukraine being defeated and taken over by Russia.

Similarities across age groups

One policy goal where younger and older adults don't differ much is finding a solution to the conflict between Israelis and Palestinians. In each age group surveyed, about a third or fewer say the Israel-Palestine conflict should be given top priority, while the largest shares say it should be given some priority.

Topics

Climate, Energy & Environment, Environment & Climate,

Generations, Age & Politics, Political Issues, Science Issues, Younger Adults

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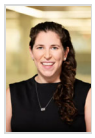
Jenn Hatfield is a writer/editor at Pew Research Center.



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SHORT READS | AUGUST 12, 2024

How Mexicans and Americans view each other and their governments' handling of the border

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BY JACOB POUSHTER, JORDAN LIPPERT AND SARAH AUSTIN

Mexicans hold generally positive views of the United States, while Americans hold generally negative views of Mexico – a reversal from 2017 – according to Pew Research Center surveys conducted in both countries earlier this year.

In this analysis, we'll take a closer look at how Mexicans and Americans view the other country, as well as their attitudes about how each government is handling the large number of migrants seeking to cross the border from Mexico in the U.S.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on how Mexicans and Americans view each other and how they rate their governments' handling of the situation at the U.S.-Mexico border. The analysis also explores Mexicans' opinions of U.S. presidents and other world leaders.

For Mexico data, this analysis draws on a nationally representative survey of 1,042 adults conducted from Feb. 23 to April 27, 2024. The survey was conducted face-to-face.

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's

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About half of Americans continue to say Trump administration is doing 'too much' on deportations

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Americans Have Mixed to Negative Views of Trump Administration Immigration Actions

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Most Americans say undocumented immigrants should be able to stay legally under certain conditions

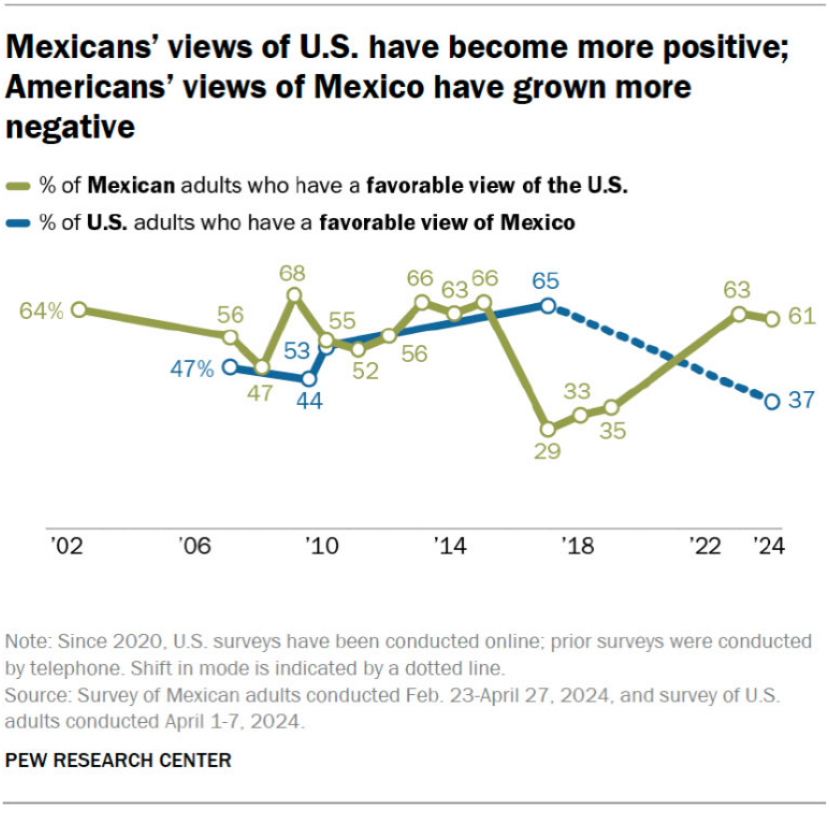
American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardize education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all analyses beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

How Mexicans view the U.S., and how Americans view Mexico



Mexicans and Americans view the other country in opposite ways:

REPORT | SEP 27, 2024

Trump and Harris Supporters Differ on Mass Deportations but Favor Border Security, High-Skilled Immigration

SHORT READS | JUN 17, 2020

Americans broadly support legal status for immigrants brought to the U.S. illegally as children

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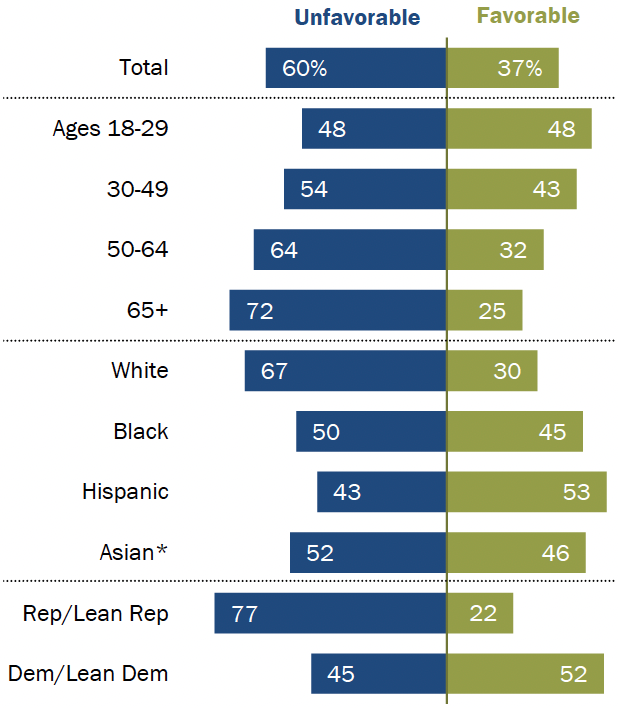
- Most Mexicans (61%) have a favorable view of the U.S., compared with 33% who hold an unfavorable view.
- By contrast, 60% of Americans have an unfavorable view of Mexico, while 37% have a favorable view of their southern neighbor.

These attitudes have changed markedly over time. As recently as 2017 – when Donald Trump was the president of the U.S. – only 29% of Mexicans had a favorable opinion of their northern neighbor. And 65% of Americans had a favorable opinion of Mexico.

Related: *Globally, Biden Receives Higher Ratings Than Trump*

Americans' views of Mexico

% of U.S. adults who have a(n) ___ opinion of Mexico



* Estimates for Asian adults are representative of English speakers only.
Note: Those who did not answer are not shown. White, Black and Asian adults include only those who report being one race and are not Hispanic. Hispanic adults are of any race.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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(It's important to note that our U.S. surveys are now conducted online. Prior to 2020, we conducted U.S. surveys by phone, which

4 Many Americans Are Struggling to Afford Basic Necessities

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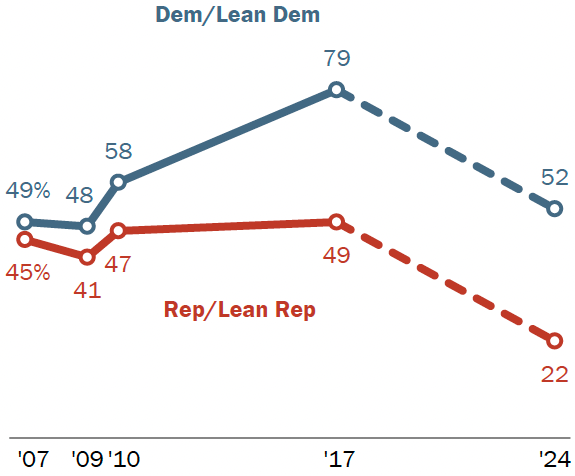
means that findings before and after the change in survey mode may not be directly comparable.)

Differences by age, race and ethnicity, and party

In Mexico and the U.S. alike, views of the other country differ by age and other factors. For example, 71% of Mexican adults under 30 have a positive view of the U.S., compared with only half of Mexicans ages 65 and older.

In both parties, Americans' views of Mexico have become less positive

*% of U.S. adults who have a **favorable** opinion of Mexico, by party*



Note: Since 2020, U.S. surveys have been conducted online; prior surveys were conducted by telephone. Shift in mode is indicated by a dotted line.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Similarly, younger Americans are more positive toward Mexico than older Americans are. Around half of U.S. adults under 30 (48%) have a favorable view of Mexico, compared with just 25% of those ages 65 and older.

Americans' attitudes toward Mexico also differ by race and ethnicity. Around half of Hispanic Americans (53%) see Mexico positively, compared with only 30% of White, non-Hispanic Americans. Other racial and ethnic groups are more evenly divided in their sentiments.

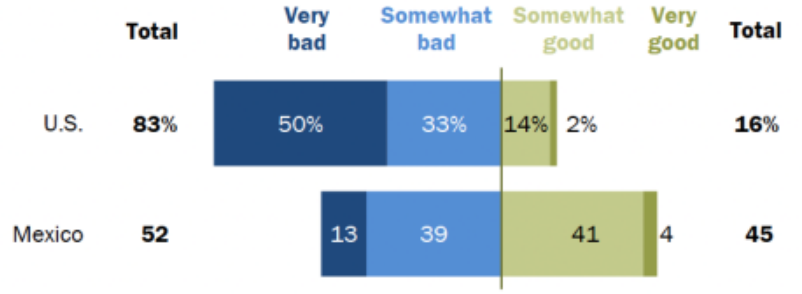
There are also large partisan differences in the U.S.: 52% of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents have a favorable view of Mexico, compared with only 22% of Republicans and Republican leaners.

When we first asked this question in 2007, Democrats and Republicans were about equally favorable toward the country (49% and 45%, respectively). Notably, views of Mexico have become more negative among Americans in *both* parties since 2017.

Views of the U.S. government's handling of the border

Americans are more critical than Mexicans of the way U.S. government is handling migrants at the border

*% who say the **U.S. government** is doing a ___ job dealing with the large number of people seeking asylum at the U.S. border with Mexico*



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of Mexican adults conducted Feb. 23-April 27, 2024, and survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Americans are much more critical than Mexicans of the way the U.S. government is dealing with the large number of migrants seeking asylum at the U.S. border with Mexico. (The survey was conducted before a recent decline in migrant encounters at the border due to asylum policy changes in the U.S. and Mexico.)

More than eight-in-ten Americans (83%) say the U.S. government is doing a bad job dealing with migrants at the border, including half who say the government is doing a *very* bad job. By comparison, a much smaller share of Mexicans (52%) say the U.S. government is doing a bad job, including just 13% who say it's doing a *very* bad job.

Differences by education, income and party

In both countries, higher levels of education and income are associated with more negative views of the U.S. government's handling of the border situation. For example, Mexicans with higher levels of education are 13 percentage points more likely than Mexicans with less education to rate the U.S. government's handling of the situation poorly.

When it comes to party, however, Republicans are more likely than Democrats to say the U.S. government is doing a bad job managing the border (92% vs. 76%). In Mexico, those who support the governing political parties and those who do not have similar views on this question.

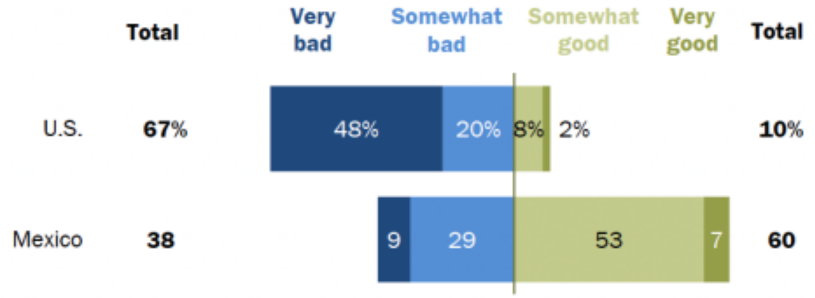
Related: *Latinos' Views on the Migrant Situation at the U.S.-Mexico Border*

Views of the Mexican government's handling of the border

We also asked people in both countries to rate the Mexican government's handling of the large number of people seeking asylum at the border.

Two-thirds of Americans, but far fewer Mexicans, say Mexican government is doing a bad job at the border

*% who say the **Mexican government** is doing a __ job dealing with the large number of people seeking asylum at the U.S. border with Mexico*



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown. In the U.S., "Not sure" was also a response option; 22% said this.
Source: Survey of Mexican adults conducted Feb. 23-April 27, 2024, and survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Again, Americans express much more negative views than Mexicans. Two-thirds of U.S. adults say the Mexican government is doing a bad job, including 48% who say it is doing a *very* bad job. A much smaller share of Mexicans (38%) say their government is doing a bad job, and only 9% say it is doing a *very* bad job.

Differences by education, income, age and party

In both countries, those with higher levels of education tend to have more negative views of the Mexican government's handling of the border situation. For instance, Mexicans with more education are 17 percentage points more likely than Mexicans with less education to rate the government's border response poorly.

When it comes to income, views differ in the U.S., but not in Mexico. Americans with higher incomes are more likely than those with lower incomes to say Mexico is doing a bad job handling the border.

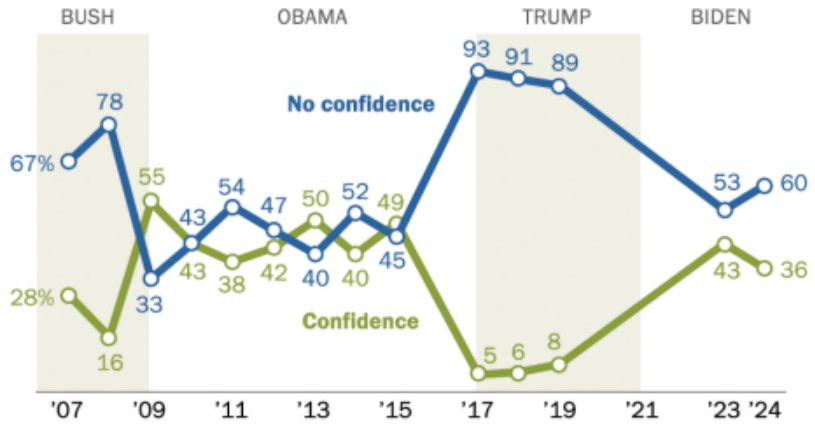
Americans ages 65 and older are much more likely than U.S. adults under 30 to say the Mexican government is doing a bad job at the border (80% vs. 50%).

While U.S. partisans generally rate the Mexican government poorly when it comes to the border, Republicans are much more likely than Democrats to hold a negative view (80% vs. 58%). And in Mexico, those who do not support the governing parties are more likely than those who do support them to say their government is doing a bad job (48% vs. 29%).

How Mexicans view Biden and Trump

6 in 10 Mexicans lack confidence in Joe Biden

% of Mexican adults who have ___ in the U.S. president to do the right thing regarding world affairs



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of Mexican adults conducted Feb. 23-April 27, 2024.

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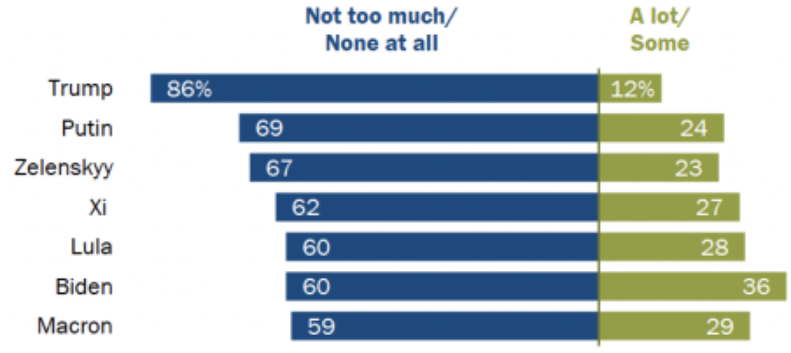
Mexicans' confidence in the U.S. president has shifted dramatically depending on who is in office.

Trump was very unpopular with the Mexican public in 2017, as was his call for the building of a wall on the Mexico-U.S. border. More than nine-in-ten Mexicans opposed the construction of a border wall, and 93% had no confidence in Trump's ability to lead in 2017.

Mexicans have little confidence in many world leaders

% of Mexican adults who have ___ confidence in the following leaders to do the right thing regarding world affairs



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of Mexican adults conducted Feb. 23-April 27, 2024.

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Mexicans' views rebounded somewhat when Joe Biden took office in 2021. But today, six-in-ten Mexicans have little or no confidence in Biden. This remains below the 86% of Mexicans who today lack confidence in Trump. (This survey was conducted when Biden was still actively seeking reelection.)

More broadly, Mexicans have little to no confidence in *all* the world leaders we asked about in our survey, including French President Emmanuel Macron, Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, Chinese President Xi Jinping and others.

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Topics

Border Security & Enforcement, Immigration Attitudes, International Issues, Unauthorized Immigration

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SHORT READS | AUGUST 28, 2024

Many around the globe say it's important their leader stands up for people's religious beliefs

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BY JONATHAN EVANS, MARIA SMERKOVICH, MANOLO CORICHI AND WILLIAM MINER

Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi carries holy water from the Ganges River to offer prayers as he arrives to inaugurate the Kashi Vishwanath Dham Corridor in Varanasi on Dec. 13, 2021. (Sanjay Kanojia/AFP via Getty Images)

When asked about the leader of their country, people around the world are generally much more likely to say it is important to have someone who stands up for people with their religious beliefs than to say the leader needs to have strong religious beliefs of their own or to have the same beliefs as they do.

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Turks Lean Negative on Erdoğan, Give National Government Mixed Ratings

SHORT READS | MAY 1, 2024

As Biden and Trump seek reelection, who are the oldest – and youngest – current world leaders?

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis explores public attitudes about the religious qualities of national leaders in 35 countries in North America, Europe, the Asia-Pacific region, the Middle East-North Africa region, sub-Saharan Africa and Latin America.

This analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 40,494 adults conducted in 34 countries from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

In the United States, we surveyed 12,693 respondents from Feb. 13 to 25, 2024. Most of the respondents (10,642) are members of Pew Research Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel recruited through national random sampling of residential addresses, which gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection.

The remaining U.S. respondents (2,051) are members of three other panels: the Ipsos KnowledgePanel, the NORC Amerispeak Panel and the SSRS Opinion Panel. All three are national survey panels recruited through random sampling (not "opt-in" polls). We used these additional panels to ensure that the survey would have enough Jewish and Muslim respondents to be able to report on their views.

The U.S. data is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education, religious affiliation and other categories.

For more about the U.S. data, refer to the ATP's methodology and the methodology for our previous report that looked at these questions only in the U.S.

Here are the questions and responses for all 35 countries surveyed, as well as the survey methodology for data collected outside the U.S.

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardize education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

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4 Many Americans Are Struggling to Afford Basic Necessities

In each country surveyed, only religious groups with large enough sample sizes for analysis are included.

This analysis was produced by Pew Research Center as part of the Pew-Templeton Global Religious Futures project, which analyzes religious change and its impact on societies around the world. Funding for the Global Religious Futures project comes from The Pew Charitable Trusts and the John Templeton Foundation (grant 63095). This publication does not necessarily reflect the views of the John Templeton Foundation.

5 Online Community and Connection in America

Leaders standing up for others' religious beliefs typically seen as more important than having their own strong religious beliefs

*% of adults who say it is **very/somewhat important** to have a leader of their country who ...*

● Highest rating

	Stands up for people with your religious beliefs	Has strong religious beliefs, even if they are different from your own	Has religious beliefs that are the same as your own
Indonesia	●90%	86%	●90%
Bangladesh	89	64	●91
Philippines	●88	86	86
Malaysia	●82	77	81
India	●81	79	●81
Kenya	●80	●80	76
Sri Lanka	79	75	●80
Nigeria	●76	70	72
South Africa	●76	73	67
Ghana	●75	●75	63
Poland	●73	41	52
Turkey	●72	47	69
Thailand	●69	58	67
Israel	●68	29	55
Peru	●67	56	59
Brazil	●66	55	41
U.S.	●64	48	37
Colombia	●63	58	56
Hungary	●62	46	40
Mexico	●54	44	43
Canada	●50	32	23
Singapore	●50	45	36
UK	●50	27	22
Chile	●49	40	35
Australia	●47	23	18
Argentina	●46	40	38
Greece	●46	34	42
Germany	●42	22	23
Italy	●41	34	30
Netherlands	●38	24	15
Sweden	●36	6	12
Spain	●33	20	18
Japan	●27	18	22
South Korea	●27	●27	21
France	●25	18	17
35-country median	**63**	**45**	**42**

Note: The specific title of the national leader asked about (president, prime minister or chancellor) differs by country. Read the topline for more information.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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In the United States, for instance, 64% of adults say it is important to have a president who stands up for people who share the respondent's religious beliefs. Fewer (48%) say it's important that a president has their *own* strong religious beliefs, even if the beliefs differ from those of the respondent. And even fewer Americans (37%) say it is important for a president to have religious beliefs that are the same as the respondent's.

In countries where religion is perceived as very important, people are generally more likely to value each of these qualities in a leader. For example, 94% of adults in Indonesia say religion is very important in their lives, and 86% there say it's important for their president to have strong religious beliefs. This is among the highest levels found in the 35 places surveyed.

These findings are from a 35-country Pew Research Center survey conducted from January to May 2024 among more than 53,000 respondents.

Leaders who stand up for people with your religious beliefs

Adults in Indonesia, Bangladesh and the Philippines are the most likely to say it is important to have a leader who stands up for people with their religious beliefs: Roughly nine-in-ten in each country hold this view. Around half or more in 22 additional countries say the same.

However, in several European and East Asian countries, adults are less likely to say it's important for a national leader to stand up for people with their religious beliefs. France, Japan and South Korea stand out as some of the places where the smallest shares say this is important. In each country, around a quarter of adults say this.

Leaders who have strong religious beliefs, even if they are different from your own

Indonesia and the Philippines again top the list when considering the share of adults who say it's important that their leader has strong religious beliefs, even if they are different from their own (86% each say this). In all four African countries we surveyed – Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria and South Africa – 70% or more say this, too.

Swedish adults are the least likely to say it is important to have a prime minister who has strong religious beliefs. Just 6% of Swedes say this.

Leaders who have religious beliefs that are the same as your own

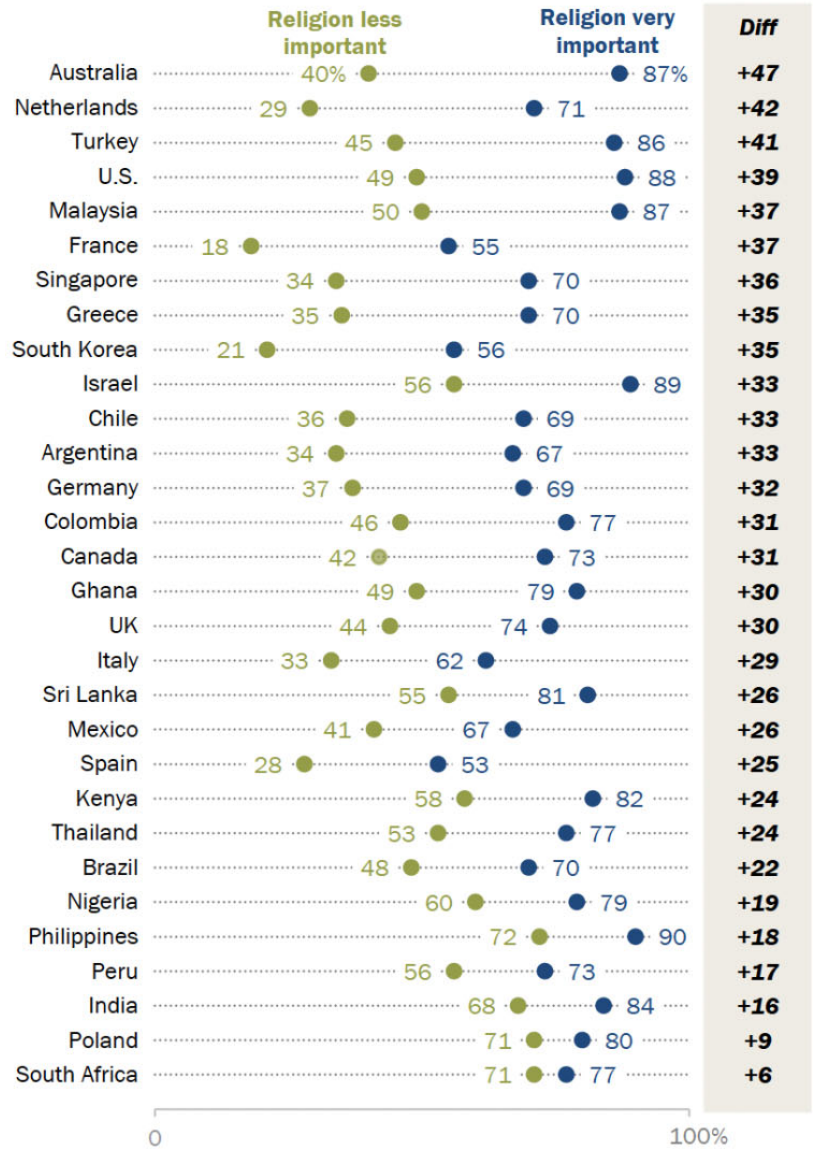
About nine-in-ten Indonesian and Bangladeshi adults say it's important for their leader to have the same religious beliefs as they do. Many people in neighboring South and Southeast Asian countries also feel this way, including 81% of adults in India.

This view is much less common in some countries. In Singapore, a far smaller share (36%) say it is important for a prime minister to share their religious beliefs. And Sweden again has the smallest share of adults who say this is important (12%).

Opinions on these questions among the highly religious

People who say religion is very important more likely to value leaders who stand up for religious beliefs

*% who say it is **very/somewhat important** to have a leader who stands up for people with their religious beliefs, by religious salience*



Note: All differences shown are statistically significant. The specific title of the national leader asked about (president, prime minister or chancellor) differs by country. Read the topline for more information.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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People who say religion is very important in their lives are far more likely than other adults to say it's important for their country's leader to stand up for people with their religious beliefs.

For example, 86% of Turkish adults for whom religion is very important say it is important that the president stands up for

people with their religious beliefs, compared with 45% among Turks for whom religion is less important.

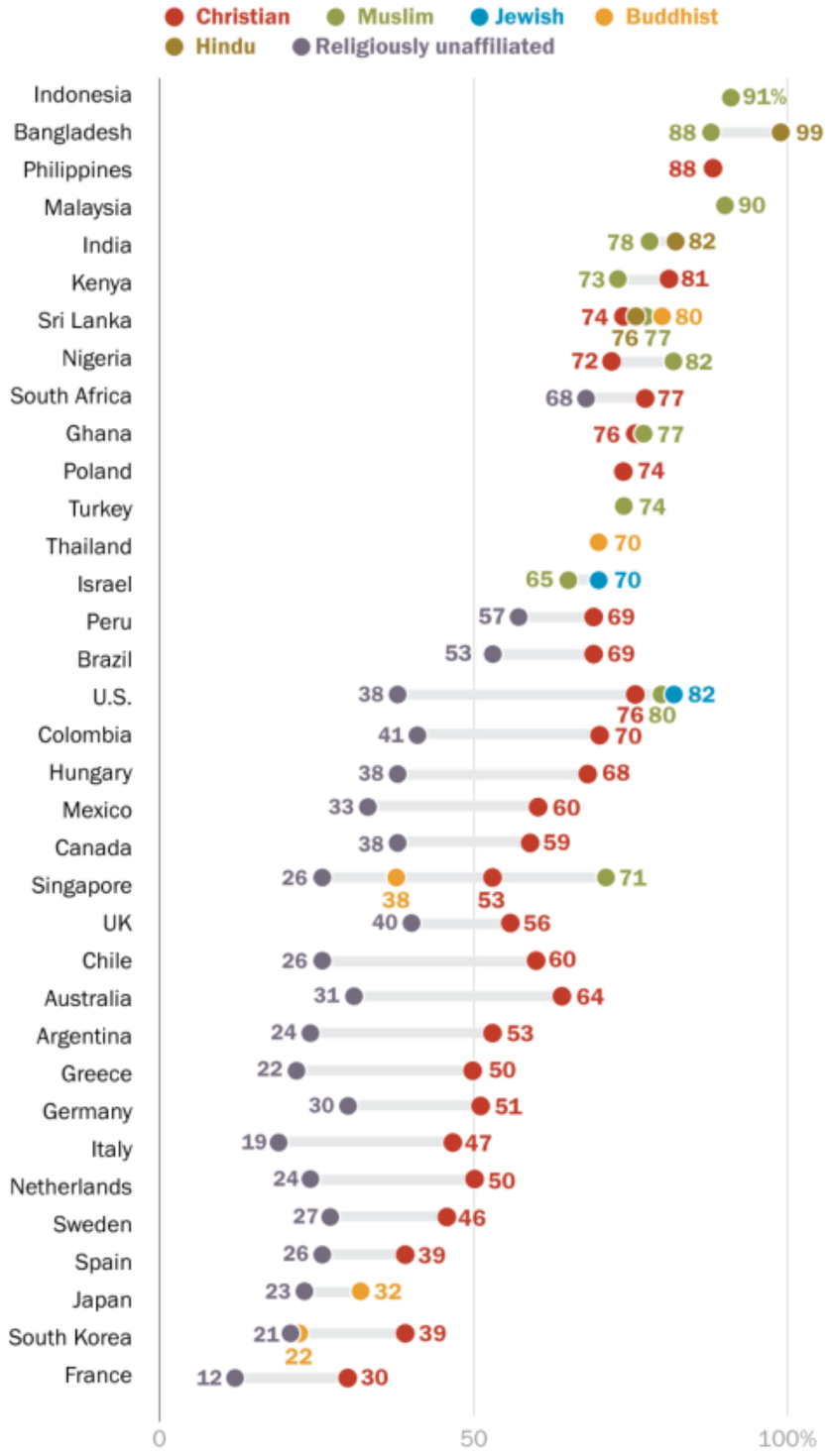
Similar patterns are evident when it comes to both of the other measures asked about in this survey.

Looking again at Turkey, 55% of adults who consider religion very important say it is important for the country’s president to have strong religious beliefs, even if these beliefs are different from their own. Among less religious Turkish adults, 33% think this is important.

How do people with different religious identities feel?

Religiously unaffiliated least likely to say leaders should stand up for people with their religious beliefs

*% who say it is **very/somewhat important** to have a leader who stands up for people with their religious beliefs, by religious identity*



Note: The specific title of the national leader asked about (president, prime minister or chancellor) differs by country. Read the topline for more information. Only religious groups with large enough sample sizes for analysis are included.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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Differences on these questions also emerge by respondents' religion.

Among **Hindus**, majorities say that all three measures of leaders' religion-related qualities are important. For example, nearly all Hindus in Bangladesh – 99% – say it is important for their prime minister to stand up for people with their religious beliefs. (The survey took place before Bangladesh's prime minister resigned.)

Likewise, most **Buddhists** in both of the Buddhist-majority countries we surveyed – Sri Lanka and Thailand – say all three religious aspects we asked about are important in their leaders. But for Buddhists elsewhere, far smaller shares voice these opinions. For example, while 70% of Thai Buddhists feel it is important for their prime minister to stand up for people with their religious beliefs, only 32% of Japanese Buddhists say the same.

In general, most **Muslims** also say the various religious measures we asked about are important when it comes to their leaders. But Muslims in Israel are a notable exception. Only 30% of Israeli Muslims say it's important for the Israeli prime minister to have strong religious beliefs, even if they differ from respondents' own beliefs.

Attitudes among **Jews** are mixed in Israel and the U.S. (the only two places surveyed with large enough sample sizes of Jews to analyze). Most Jewish adults in both countries say it is important for their prime minister or president, respectively, to stand up for people with their religious beliefs. But only about three-in-ten Jewish adults in either place say it is important for the leader to have strong religious beliefs.

And in the U.S., where only about 2% of the population is Jewish, just 13% of Jewish adults say it is important for the president to have religious beliefs that are the same as theirs. In Israel, where a large majority of the population is Jewish, 59% of Jews see this as important.

The opinions of **Christians** vary widely by country for all three measures. For example, the share of Christians who say it's important for their country's leader to stand up for people with their religious beliefs ranges from 88% in the Philippines to 30% in France.

The **religiously unaffiliated** are consistently the *least* likely group to say each of these measures is important. For instance, three-in-ten unaffiliated German adults say it is important for their chancellor to stand up for people with their religious beliefs. Roughly half of German Christians say the same.

Differences by education, ideology and age

Adults with more education tend to be *less* likely than others to perceive the religion-related qualities of their country's leader as important. In Greece, for instance, 38% of adults with at least a postsecondary education say it is important to have a prime minister who stands up for people with their religious beliefs. But among Greeks with less education, 49% say this.

Views also vary by ideology. In many countries, those on the ideological right are more likely than those on the left or in the center to say their leader's religious beliefs are important. For example, in Turkey, those on the right are twice as likely as those on the left to say it is important to have a leader who shares their religious beliefs (92% vs. 46%).

Across many countries surveyed, younger and older adults largely agree on the importance of the three measures asked about when it comes to their country's leader. However, in Latin America, adults under 40 are consistently less likely than those ages 40 and older to say each is important. For example, in Chile, 42% of adults under 40 say it is important to have a president who stands up for people with their religious beliefs. That share rises to 54% among older Chileans.

CORRECTION (June 5, 2025): The topline for this report has been updated. The changes do not substantively affect the findings of this analysis. Refer to the errata for more information.

Note: Here are the questions and responses for all 35 countries surveyed, as well as the survey methodology for data collected outside the U.S.

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Topics

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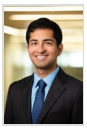

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SHORT READS | SEPTEMBER 5, 2024

Most people in 35 countries see the UN favorably in 2024, but views have dipped in some places

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BY MOIRA FAGAN

The United Nations headquarters in New York City. (Angela Weiss/AFP via Getty Images)

Note: *For 2025 international survey data on views of the UN, read "United Nations seen favorably by many across 25 countries."*

As the 79th United Nations General Assembly opens on Sept. 10, people around the world generally see the UN in a positive light. A median of 58% across 35 countries have a favorable view of the

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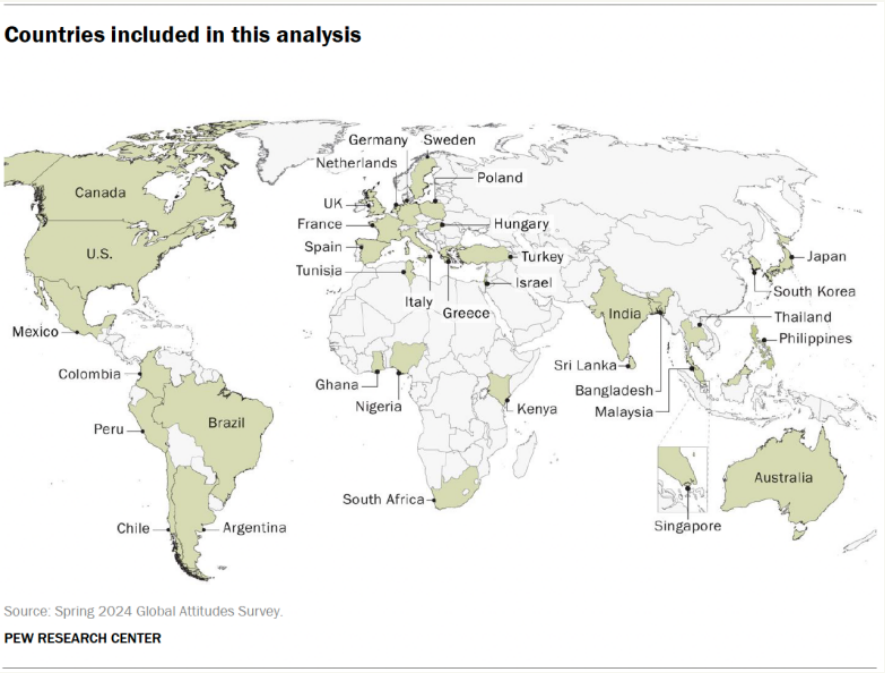
organization, while 31% have a negative view, according to a Pew Research Center survey conducted this spring.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis explores public opinion of the United Nations. We surveyed people in 35 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East, North America and sub-Saharan Africa.

For non-U.S. data, we conducted nationally representative surveys of 40,566 adults from Jan. 5 to May 21, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.



Organizations, Alliances & Treaties

United Nations

MOST POPULAR

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Throughout this analysis, we look at respondents' attitudes based on where they place themselves on an ideological scale. We asked about political ideology using several slightly different scales and categorized people as being on the ideological left, center or right.

- In most countries, we asked people to place themselves on a scale ranging from "Extreme left" to "Extreme right." The question was asked this way in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Canada, Chile, Colombia, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Israel, Italy, Mexico, the Netherlands, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Turkey and the United Kingdom.
- In Australia, the scale ranged from "Left" to "Right."
- In Japan, Singapore, South Korea and Thailand, we used a scale from "Extremely progressive" to "Extremely conservative."
- In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left).
- We did not ask about ideology in Ghana, India, Kenya, Malaysia, Sri Lanka or Tunisia.

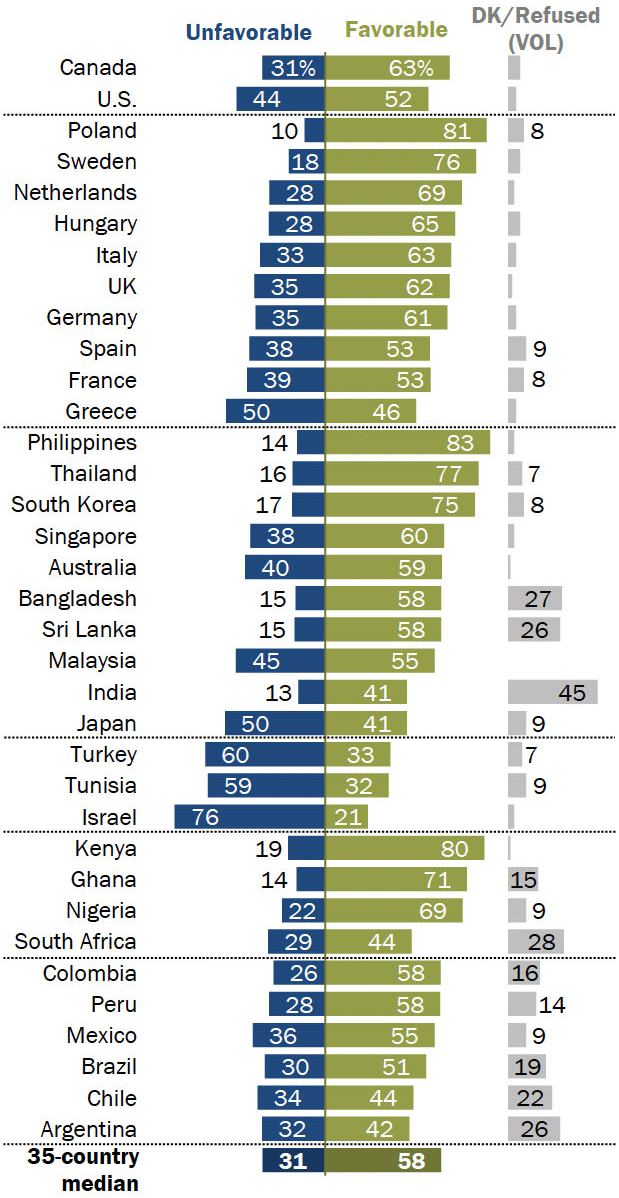
To compare educational groups across countries, we standardized education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. Beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to find our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here are the questions and responses used for the analysis, the survey methodology for non-U.S. surveys, and the survey methodology for the U.S. survey.

People around the world generally see the UN more favorably than not

% who have a(n) ___ opinion of the United Nations



Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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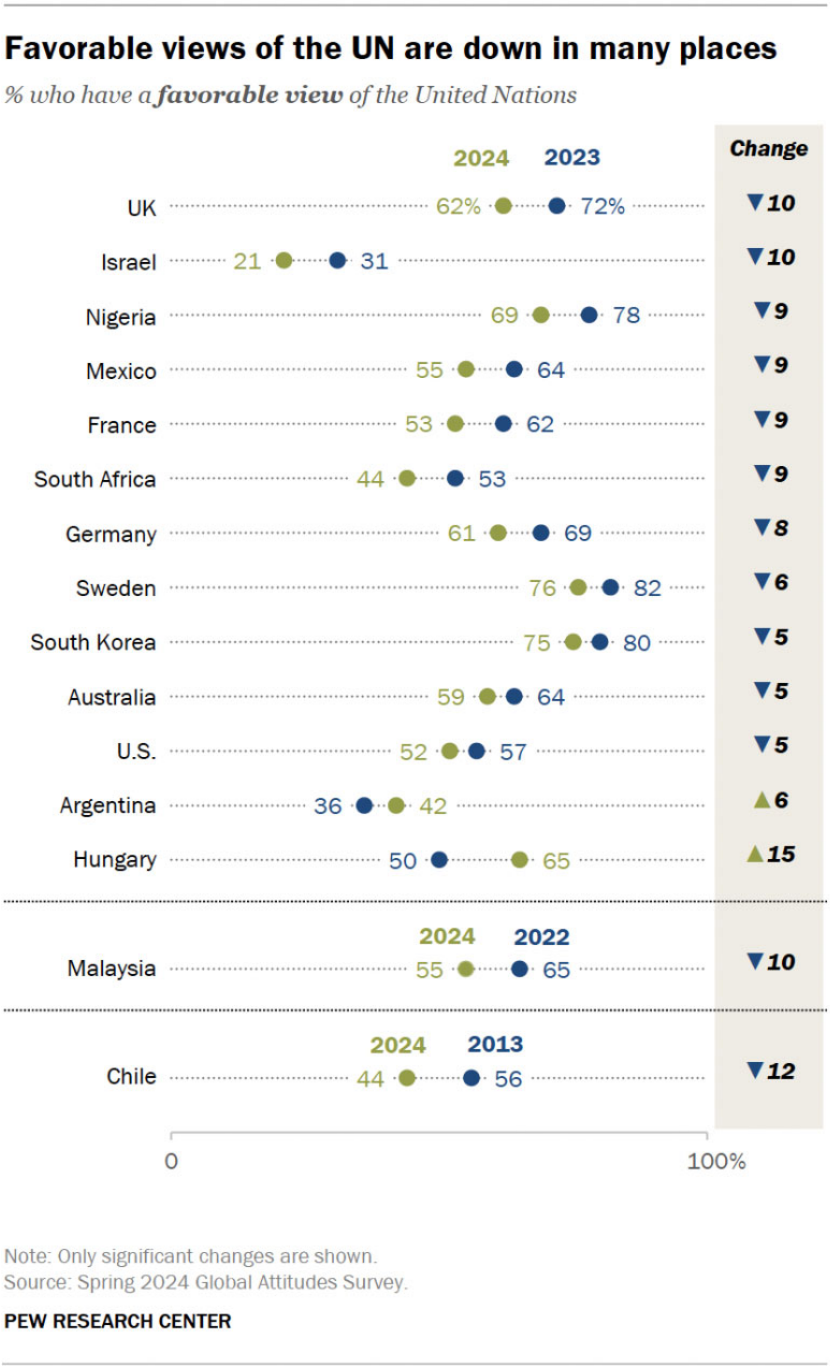
In 22 of the 35 countries surveyed, majorities see the UN positively. This includes three-quarters or more in Kenya, the Philippines, Poland, South Korea, Sweden and Thailand.

Views of the UN are less positive in some places. Half or more in Greece, Israel, Japan, Tunisia and Turkey express a negative opinion.

Israelis have long had more negative than positive views of the UN. This year, their views are the most negative of the countries polled: 76% there view the organization unfavorably. Jewish Israelis (82%) have more negative views of the UN than do Arab Israelis (53%).

How opinions of the UN have changed over time

Favorable views of the UN have dipped in many places over the past year. In Israel, favorable views fell from 31% – which was already relatively low – to 21% over the past year.



Similarly, 62% of Britons now see the UN favorably, down from 72% last year. Positive ratings of the UN are also down in Australia, France, Germany, Mexico, Nigeria, South Africa, South Korea and Sweden.

Americans' views of the UN have turned more negative over the past year as well. Today, 52% of U.S. adults see the UN in a positive light, down 5 percentage points from 2023. Additionally, only 31% see strengthening the UN as a top foreign policy priority.

Related: *Fewer Americans view the United Nations favorably than in 2023*

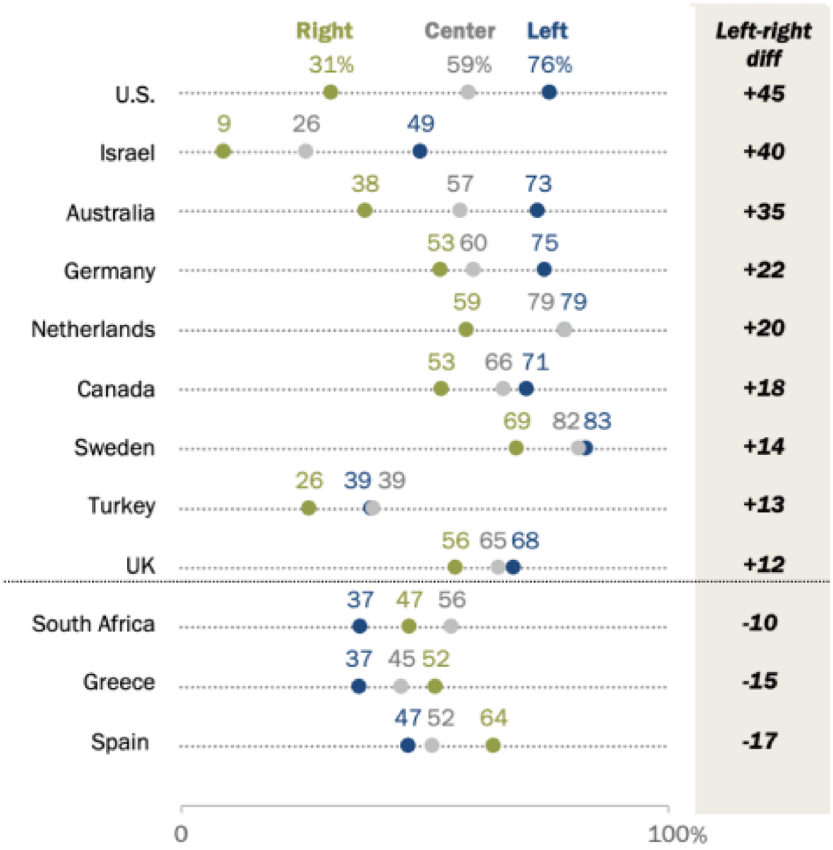
In other countries, opinions of the UN have declined over a longer period. For example, the share of people in Malaysia who have a favorable opinion of the UN has decreased 10 points since 2022, and the share in Chile is down 12 points since 2013.

Only in Argentina and Hungary have views become more positive since last year (up 6 points and 15 points, respectively).

How opinions of the UN vary within countries

People on the ideological left see the UN more positively than those on the right in some countries

*% who have a **favorable opinion** of the United Nations, by ideology*



Note: Only statistically significant differences are shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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As has been the case in a handful of countries in past years, people on the ideological left are more likely than those on the

right to express a positive opinion of the UN.

The ideological divide is largest in the U.S. and Israel, where those on the left are at least 40 points more favorable toward the UN than those on the right. Adults on the ideological left also have more favorable views than those on the right in Australia, Canada, Germany, Netherlands, Sweden, Turkey and the UK.

However, people on the ideological *right* are more likely to express a favorable opinion in South Africa, Greece and Spain. Notably, Greeks on the right are also more favorable than those on the left toward NATO and the EU.

In some countries, ideological views of the UN have shifted over time. For example, French adults on the ideological right have grown much less positive toward the UN since 2023 (down 18 points) than those on the left (-5) or in the center (-4) have. Among Swedes, too, those on the right have grown significantly less favorable toward the UN (-10) than others on the ideological spectrum have. Meanwhile, Hungarians on the right (+20) and in the center (+16) have grown *more* favorable of the UN, compared with those on the left.

In 24 of the 35 countries surveyed, younger adults are more likely than older adults to have a positive opinion of the UN. The age divide is largest in Malaysia: 66% of adults ages 18 to 34 see the UN favorably there, compared with 43% of those 50 and older.

Education also relates to views of the UN in some countries. For example, Germans with higher levels of education are more likely than their counterparts with less education to hold a favorable opinion of the UN (75% vs. 56%). In many of these countries, however, those with less education are also less likely to provide a response.

Note: This is an update of a post first published Sept. 17, 2021. Here are the questions and responses used for the analysis, the

survey methodology for non-U.S. surveys, and the *survey methodology for the U.S. survey*.

Topics Organizations, Alliances & Treaties, United Nations

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SHORT READS | SEPTEMBER 23, 2024

How people in the Americas see Brazil ahead of the G20 summit

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BY SOFIA HERNANDEZ RAMONES, MOIRA FAGAN AND CHRISTINE HUANG

In November, Brazil will host political leaders from around the world for the annual G20 summit – its first time presiding over the event. Ahead of the meeting, people in six countries across the Americas express generally favorable views of Brazil but lack confidence in its president, Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva.

Here are key findings about views of Brazil and Lula, based on Pew Research Center surveys conducted this spring in Argentina, Chile, Colombia, Mexico, Peru and the United States.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis examines public opinion of Brazil and President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva in six countries ahead of the G20 summit in November. We looked at opinions in Argentina, Chile, Colombia, Mexico, Peru and the United States.

For non-U.S. data, this analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 5,180 adults conducted from Jan. 22 to April 27, 2024. The surveys were conducted face-to-face.

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way

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nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Throughout the analysis, we look at respondents' attitudes based on where they place themselves on an ideological scale. We asked about political ideology using several slightly different scales and categorized people as being on the ideological left, center or right.

- In Argentina, Chile, Colombia, Mexico and Peru, we asked people to place themselves on a scale ranging from "Extreme left" to "Extreme right."
- In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left).

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardized education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED). Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all reports beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here are the questions and responses used for the analysis, the survey methodology for non-U.S. surveys, and the survey methodology for the U.S. survey.

Views of Brazil across the Americas

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1 Majority of Americans Expect Democrats to Win Control of House; Public Is Split on Senate

2 Why Don't Some People Use Chatbots?

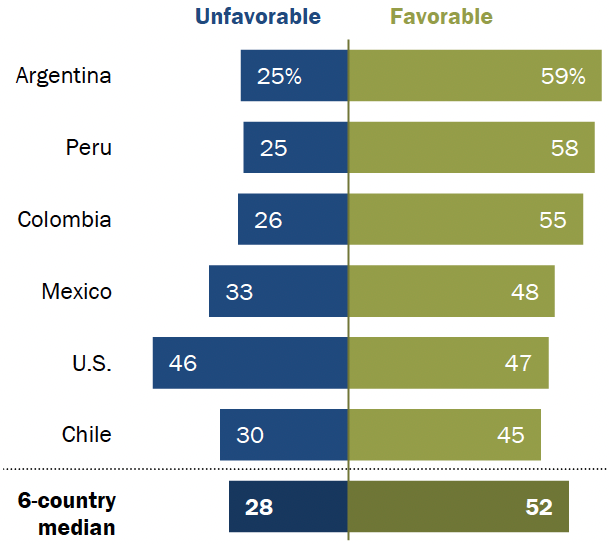
3 Americans' Use of Social Media in 2026

4 Many Americans Are Struggling to Afford Basic Necessities

5 Online Community and Connection in America

Views of Brazil across 6 countries are generally favorable

% who have a(n) ___ opinion of Brazil



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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Attitudes toward Brazil – the most populous country in South America and the seventh-most populous country in the world – are relatively positive. A median of 52% of adults across the six surveyed countries have a favorable opinion of Brazil, while 28% have an unfavorable opinion.

Argentines and Peruvians have the most positive views of Brazil, with about six-in-ten in each country holding a favorable opinion.

U.S. adults are the most likely to have a negative view of Brazil: 46% view it unfavorably, compared with no more than 33% in any of the other countries surveyed. Americans are also the most likely to provide an opinion.

In Chile, Colombia and Peru, we can analyze how views of Brazil have changed over time. In Chile and Peru, positive views of Brazil have decreased significantly since we last asked this question there in 2015. Favorability dropped from 78% to 45% among Chileans and from 68% to 58% among Peruvians. In

contrast, Colombians' opinions of Brazil have not changed significantly since 2014.

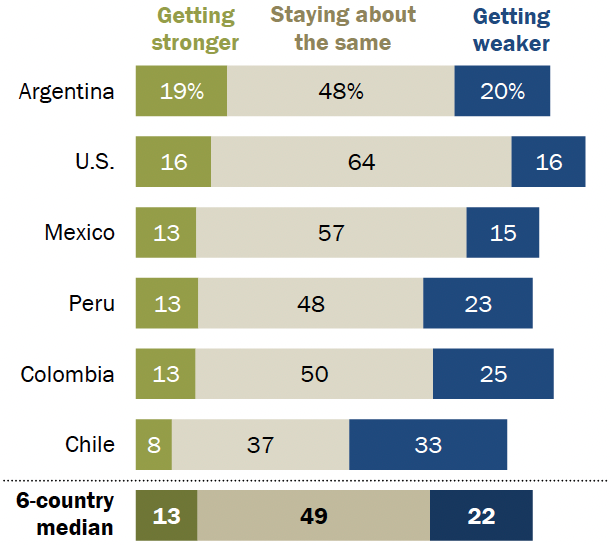
Opinions of Brazil are more favorable among younger adults in Chile, Colombia, Mexico, Peru and the U.S. For example, 68% of Colombians ages 18 to 34 hold a favorable view of Brazil, compared with 43% of adults ages 50 and older. Younger adults are also more likely to answer the question in these countries, except in the U.S.

In the U.S., Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents see Brazil more favorably than Republicans and Republican leaners do. Among Democrats, 54% hold a favorable view of Brazil, compared with 42% of Republicans.

Brazil's international standing

Many people in 6 countries say Brazil's global influence has stayed the same

% who say Brazil's influence in the world has been ___ in recent years



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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When asked about Brazil's influence in the world in recent years, many people in the U.S. and Latin America say it has stayed about

the same. A median of 49% of adults across the six countries surveyed say this, but shares range from 64% in the U.S. to 37% in Chile.

A median of 22% say Brazil's influence has weakened in recent years. A third in Chile say this, the highest share across the countries surveyed.

Few people overall (a median of 13%) say Brazil's power is on the rise. No more than about one-in-five in any of the six countries surveyed say Brazil's influence has strengthened in recent years.

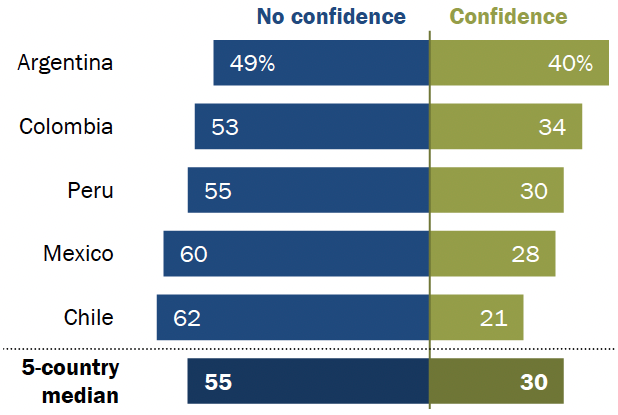
In Argentina, Colombia and Mexico, people who have confidence in Lula are more likely than those with no confidence to say Brazil's influence is getting stronger. Mexicans who lack confidence in Lula are less likely to express an opinion about Brazil's influence in the world.

***Related**: Brazilians Mostly Optimistic About Country's Global Standing Ahead of G20 Summit*

Confidence in Lula across Latin America

Many people in Latin America lack confidence in Brazil's president

% who have ___ in Brazilian President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva to do the right thing regarding world affairs



Notes: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.

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Confidence in Lula to do the right thing regarding world affairs is relatively low across the Latin American countries surveyed. A median of 30% in these five countries express confidence in him, while a median of 55% do not. Confidence is lowest in Chile, where only 21% have confidence in Lula's decision-making.

We asked this question for the first time in 2007, during Lula's second term as president. Confidence in Lula was higher in Chile and Peru than it is now. In 2007, 49% of Chileans expressed confidence in Lula, but only 21% do so today. In Peru, confidence has dropped from 53% to 30% over the same period.

In some countries, confidence in Lula varies by certain demographic factors.

In Colombia, Mexico and Peru, people with more education express greater confidence in the Brazilian president than those with less education. For example, Colombian adults with more education are 15 percentage points more likely than their counterparts with less to express confidence in Lula. Colombians with more education are also more likely to answer the question.

Mexican and Peruvian adults who have incomes above the national median are more likely than those with lower incomes to have confidence in Lula. And in Argentina, those on the ideological left are more likely than those on the right to trust Lula.

Note: Here are the questions and responses used for the analysis, the survey methodology for non-U.S. surveys, and the survey methodology for the U.S. survey.

Topics Global Image of Countries, Leaders, Organizations, Alliances & Treaties

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REPORT | SEPTEMBER 26, 2024

Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests

Most view Pope Francis favorably, though his ratings have dropped

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BY JONATHAN EVANS AND KELSEY JO STARR

Table of Contents

Pope Francis waves to the crowd as he arrives in the popemobile to celebrate an open-air Mass in Villavicencio, Colombia, on Sept. 8, 2017. (Alberto Pizzoli/AFP via Getty Images)

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis explores views on the Catholic Church and Pope Francis among Catholics in Latin America and the United States.

All seven countries in the survey have Catholic populations that rank among the world's 25 largest – notably including Brazil (largest), Mexico (second-largest) and the U.S. (fourth-largest) – according to the Vatican's 2021 Statistical Yearbook of the Church. And the six Latin American countries surveyed account for roughly three-quarters of the region's Catholics.

For non-U.S. data, this analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 6,234 adults – including 3,655 Catholics – conducted from Jan. 22 to April 27, 2024. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Mexico and Peru.

In the U.S., we surveyed 12,693 respondents from Feb. 13 to 25, 2024, including 2,021 Catholics. Most of the survey's respondents (10,642) – including all of the survey's Catholic respondents – are members of the American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel recruited through national random sampling of residential addresses, which gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

The remaining respondents (2,051) are members of three other panels: the Ipsos KnowledgePanel, the NORC Amerispeak Panel and the SSRS Opinion Panel. All three are national survey panels recruited through random sampling (not "opt-in" polls). We used these additional panels to ensure that the survey would have enough Jewish and Muslim respondents to be able to report on their views. (While Jewish and Muslim respondents are not discussed in this particular report that focuses on Catholic topics, they are discussed in other reports based on this survey.)

The U.S. data is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education, religious affiliation and other categories.

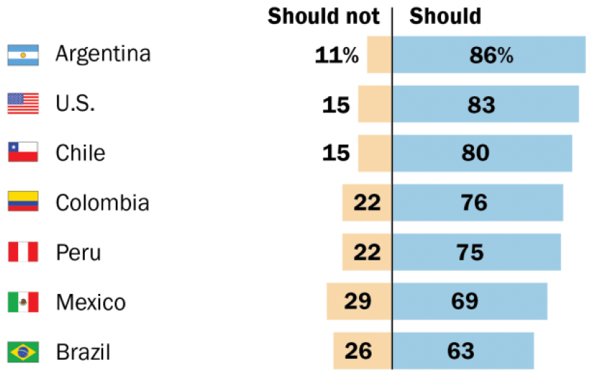
Here are the questions used for the report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

This analysis was produced by Pew Research Center as part of the Pew-Templeton Global Religious Futures project, which analyzes religious change and its impact on societies around the world. Funding for the Global Religious Futures project comes from The Pew Charitable Trusts and the John Templeton Foundation (grant 63095). This publication does not necessarily reflect the views of the John Templeton Foundation.

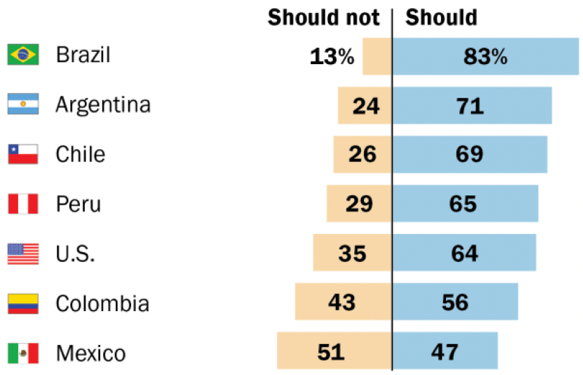
A new survey by Pew Research Center asked Catholics in six Latin American countries and the United States how they think the church should handle a variety of matters related to contraception, the priesthood and sexuality. Among the main findings:

Majorities of Catholics say the church should allow use of birth control, ordain women priests

% of Catholics who say the Catholic Church ___ allow Catholics to use birth control



% of Catholics who say the Catholic Church ___ allow women to become priests



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests"

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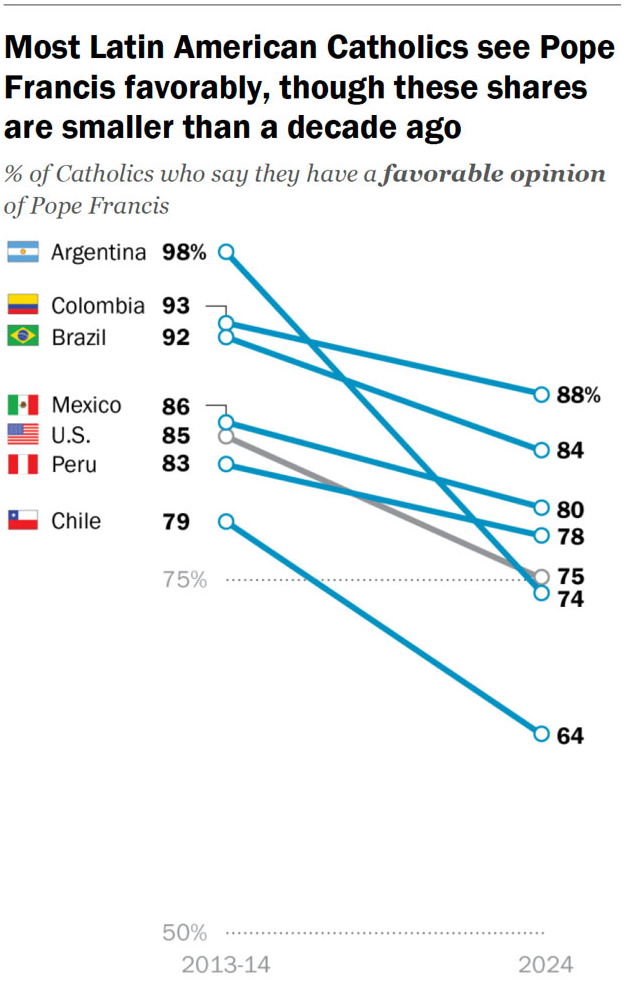
Most Catholics in all seven countries want the church to allow Catholics to use birth control. The shares saying this range from 86% in Argentina to 63% in Brazil.

In most of the countries surveyed, **majorities of Catholics also say the church should allow women to become priests.**

Opinion is more divided on whether the church should allow priests to get married. Roughly two-thirds of Catholics in Argentina, Chile and the U.S. are in favor, but majorities in Mexico and Peru say the church should *not* allow priests to marry.

Views on whether the church should recognize the marriages of gay and lesbian couples vary among Catholics in the countries surveyed. Majorities of Catholics in Argentina and Chile say the church should recognize the marriages of gay and lesbian couples, and just over half of U.S. Catholics agree. In the other four countries, fewer than half take this stance.

The survey also finds that Pope Francis, the first Latin American pope, remains broadly popular among Catholics across the region – though his favorability ratings are lower now than they were a decade ago, shortly after his papacy began in March 2013.



The decrease in favorability has been sharpest among Catholics in Argentina, his country of birth. Ten years ago, nearly all Catholics surveyed there (98%) expressed a favorable opinion of Francis, compared with 74% today.

And in the U.S., where a February 2014 survey found that 85% of Catholics viewed the pope favorably, 75% now take that view.

Most Catholics surveyed also say Francis represents a change in the Catholic Church's direction, with more of them calling it a *major* change than a minor one.

These are among the key findings of a survey of 5,676 Catholics, conducted in English, Spanish and Portuguese from January through April 2024 in seven countries: Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Mexico, Peru and the U.S.

The rest of this report explores these findings in more detail.

More than a dozen of our surveys have measured U.S. Catholics' favorability toward Pope Francis since the start of his papacy. Find this more detailed U.S. trend in our recent report, "Majority of U.S. Catholics Express Favorable View of Pope Francis."

How we worded these questions

We used simple, common phrases in the survey questions about some steps that Catholics would – or would not – like to see the church take. Our goal was to make the questions easy to understand for as many respondents as possible. In some cases, the wording of the questions involved a trade-off between broad understandability and theological nuance.

For example, one question asks whether the church should "allow priests to get married." This would not, strictly speaking, be a change in doctrine. The Catholic Church already allows married priests under certain circumstances, such as if a man was married before being ordained in an Eastern Catholic Church. Technically, the church considers the rule of celibacy for priests to be a "discipline" rather than a doctrine. Nonetheless, allowing parish priests to get married and continue in their duties would represent a big change in the everyday life of the church in the United States and Latin America.

Similarly, another question asks whether the church should allow unmarried Catholics who "are living with a romantic partner" to receive Communion. Actually, Catholicism has no rule against unmarried people living together. The church's teaching is that *sexual activity outside of marriage* is a grave sin, and that anyone "conscious of a grave sin" should not take Communion unless they have been to confession.

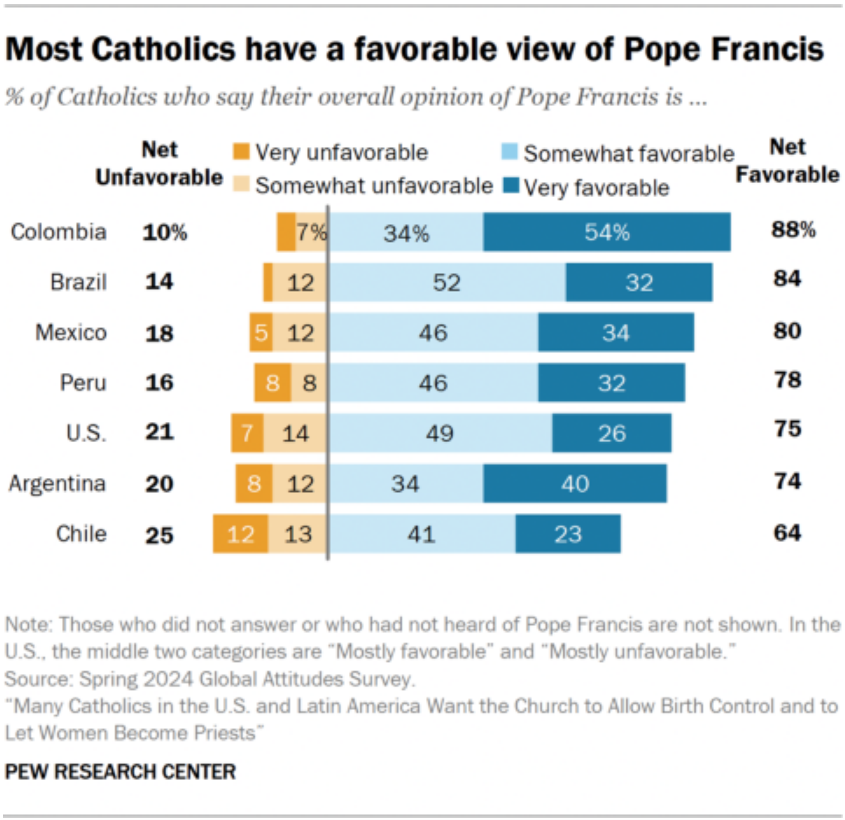
Yet another example concerns contraception. The survey asks whether the church should allow Catholics to "use birth control." But the church does not object to married couples using natural methods (i.e., abstaining from sex during fertile periods) to "space the births of their children." Rather, the objection is to using methods that prevent the sexual act from resulting in

conception, including "condoms, hormonal birth control pills and sterilization."

Views of Pope Francis

In every Latin American country surveyed, as well as the United States, approximately two-thirds or more Catholics express a favorable view of Pope Francis, including 88% in Colombia and 84% in Brazil.

Related: How people in Latin America and the U.S. view Pope Francis



Colombia is the only country surveyed where at least half of Catholics express a *very* favorable view of Francis. In the other countries, these shares range from 40% in Argentina to 23% in Chile.

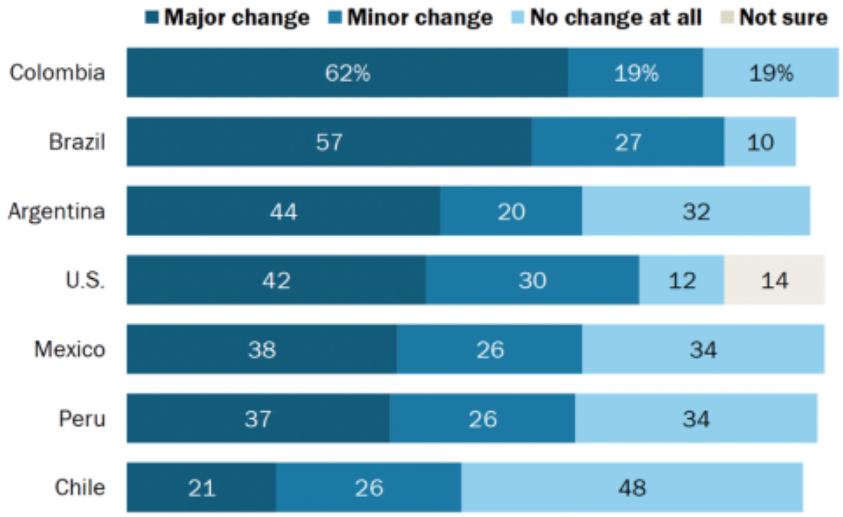
Catholics who pray daily generally are more likely than those who pray less frequently to hold a very favorable view of Francis. For example, 40% of Mexican Catholics who pray daily say they view the pope very favorably, compared with 29% of other Catholics.

Pope Francis as a source of change in the church

Most Catholics surveyed say Pope Francis represents a change in the Catholic Church's direction. And they are more likely to say this is a *major* change than a *minor* change.

Most Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America say the pope is bringing change to the Catholic Church

% of Catholics who say Pope Francis represents (a) ___ in the direction of the Catholic Church



Note: "Not sure" was only given as an explicit answer option to U.S. respondents. Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests"

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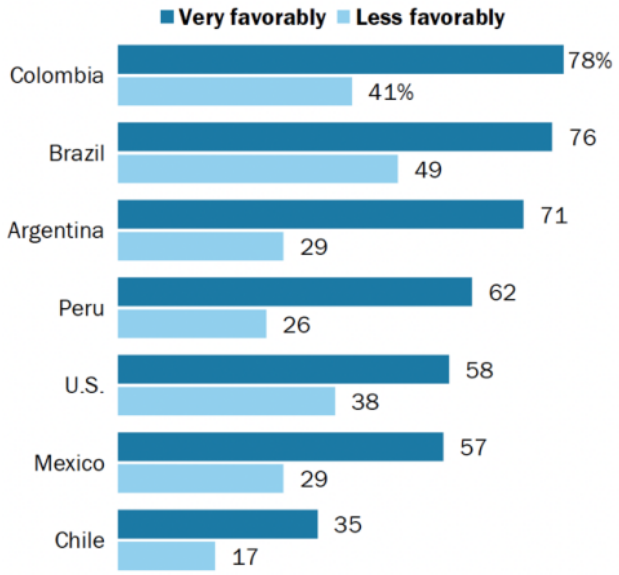
For example, in Colombia, 62% of Catholics say that he represents a major change in the church's direction, while just 19% say he is a *minor* change. Another 19% of Colombian Catholics say he represents no change at all for the church.

Most Catholics who see Francis very favorably also say he represents major change for the church

*% of Catholics who say that Pope Francis represents a **major change** in the Catholic Church, among those who view him ...*



Note: In Latin America, "Less favorably" includes those who say they have a "Somewhat favorable," "Somewhat unfavorable" or "Very unfavorable" view of the pope. In the U.S., "Less favorably" includes those who say they have a "Mostly favorable," "Mostly unfavorable" or "Very unfavorable" view of the pope.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests"

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Chilean Catholics, who tend to be less favorable toward Francis than Catholics in other surveyed countries, also stand out on this question. Nearly half say that Francis has not changed the church's direction, and the rest are divided on whether he has been a major (21%) or minor (26%) change for the church.

The view that Pope Francis represents a major change is especially strong among Catholics who say they have a very favorable view of him.

For example, 62% of Peruvian Catholics with a very favorable view of the pope also say he represents a major change in direction for the church, while 26% of Peruvian Catholics who view Francis less favorably say this.

Views on the priesthood, contraception and sexuality

On balance, most Catholics in Latin America and the U.S. say the Catholic Church should allow Catholics to use birth control, allow women to become priests and allow cohabiting couples to receive Communion.

Peruvian Catholics least likely to say the church should recognize same-sex marriages

% of Catholics who say the Catholic Church ***should*** *...*

	Allow Catholics to use birth control	Allow women to become priests	Allow Catholics to take Communion even if they are unmarried and living with a romantic partner	Allow priests to get married	Recognize the marriages of gay and lesbian couples
Argentina	86%	71%	77%	64%	70%
U.S.	83	64	75	69	54
Chile	80	69	73	65	64
Colombia	76	56	52	52	40
Peru	75	65	56	32	32
Mexico	69	47	45	38	46
Brazil	63	83	59	50	43

Note: Darker shades represent higher values.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests"

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Catholic opinion in the countries surveyed is more divided on whether the church should let priests marry and whether it should recognize the marriages of same-sex couples. Catholic majorities in Argentina, Chile and the U.S. want the church to take both of these steps, while a majority of Peruvian Catholics do *not* want the church to take these steps.

Similarly, most Catholics in Mexico do not want the church to allow priests to get married, and a majority of Catholics in Colombia do not think the church should recognize marriages of same-sex couples.

Views by measures of religiousness

In general, Catholics who pray daily are *less* likely than other Catholics to say the church should take these steps. For example, 55% of Brazilian Catholics who pray daily say the church should allow Catholics to take Communion even if they are unmarried and living with a romantic partner. Meanwhile, among Catholics in Brazil who pray less often, 75% say this.

Due to small sample sizes of Catholics who say they attend church weekly or more often, we are unable to show the differences in opinions on these survey questions between frequent Mass attenders and other Catholics in all the surveyed countries.

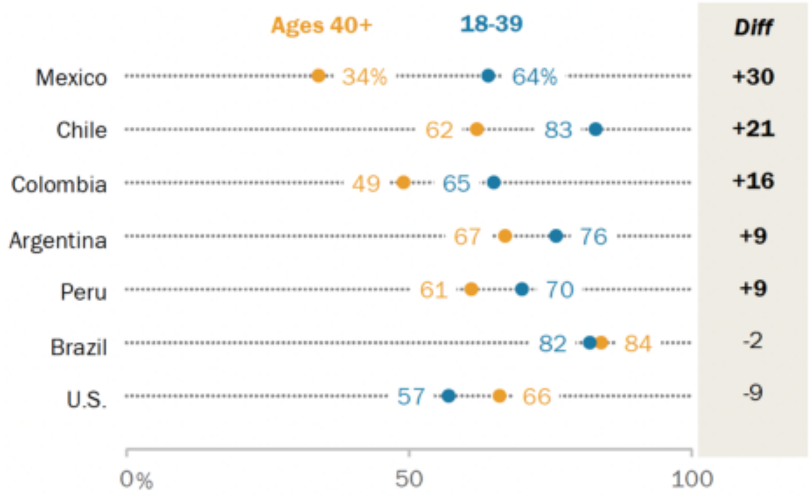
However, in countries where the samples are large enough to allow reliable analysis, the broad pattern is similar to daily prayer: More traditionally observant Catholics are less likely to favor these ideas. In Mexico, for instance, 38% of Catholics who attend church at least weekly think the church should recognize gay and lesbian marriages, but among other Catholics, 52% say this.

Views by age

Across Latin America, younger Catholics are more likely than others to say the church should take these steps.

In Latin America, younger Catholics are more likely to support women becoming priests

*% of Catholics who say the Catholic Church **should** allow women to become priests, by age*



Note: Statistically significant differences indicated in **bold**.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests"

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In Colombia, for instance, 65% of 18- to 39-year-old Catholics think the church should allow women to become priests. Among older Colombian Catholics, 49% take this position.

Views over time

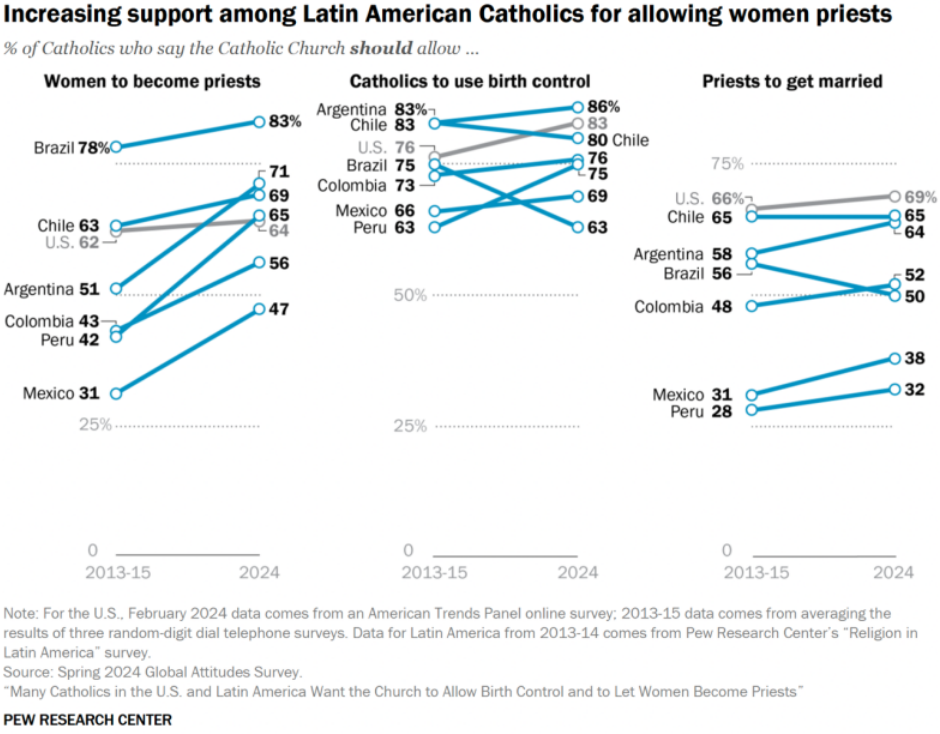
We also asked several of these questions in our survey of religion in Latin America a decade ago, and in surveys of U.S. Catholics conducted around the same time.

The shares of Latin American Catholics who say the church should allow women to become priests have risen. In Argentina, these shares increased from 51% in 2013-14 to 71% in 2024, while in Mexico they increased from 31% to 47% over the same period. In the U.S., however, attitudes on this question among Catholics are in the same ballpark as they were a decade ago.

Views about the church allowing Catholics to use birth control have held fairly steady over the decade in most of the countries surveyed. The largest swings recorded in either direction were

among Catholics in Peru (a 12 percentage point increase in wanting the church to take this step) and in Brazil (a 12-point *decrease*).

Meanwhile, the shares of Catholics who say the church should allow priests to get married have remained relatively stable in the surveyed countries.



Note: For the U.S., February 2024 data comes from an American Trends Panel online survey; 2013-15 data comes from averaging the results of three random-digit dial telephone surveys. Data for Latin America from 2013-14 comes from Pew Research Center's "Religion in Latin America" survey.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Many Catholics in the U.S. and Latin America Want the Church to Allow Birth Control and to Let Women Become Priests"

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For more information on how attitudes on these issues have changed over time among U.S. Catholics – including the individual data points for all three surveys from 2013-15 that asked some of these questions – refer to our recent report, "Majority of U.S. Catholics Express Favorable View of Pope Francis."

Next: Acknowledgments

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RECOMMENDED CITATION:

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Report PDF

Topline

Spanish: Muchos católicos en Latinoamérica y los EE. UU. quieren que la Iglesia permita el uso de métodos anticonceptivos y que permita que las mujeres puedan ser sacerdotes

Report errata

American Trends Panel Wave 143

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Topics

Catholicism, Gender & Leadership, Gender Equality & Discrimination, Pew-Templeton Global Religious Futures Project, Pope Francis, Religion & Bioethics, Religion & LGBTQ Acceptance, Religious Leaders & Institutions

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Economic Inequality Seen as Major Challenge Around the World

Most say rich people's political influence is a big contributing factor

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BY RICHARD WIKE, MOIRA FAGAN, CHRISTINE HUANG, LAURA CLANCY AND JORDAN LIPPERT

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How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on public opinion of inequality and its contributing factors in 36 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East-North Africa region, North America and sub-Saharan Africa. The report also explores views of children's financial futures and the economic system reform in each country.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Economic Inequality Seen as Major Challenge Around the World"

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For non-U.S. data, this report draws on nationally representative surveys of 41,503 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Throughout the report, we analyze respondents' attitudes based on where they place themselves on an ideological scale. We asked about political ideology using several slightly different scales and categorized people as being on the ideological left, center or right.

- In most countries, we asked people to place themselves on a scale ranging from "Extreme left" to "Extreme right." The question was asked this way in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Canada, Chile, Colombia, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Israel, Italy, Mexico, the

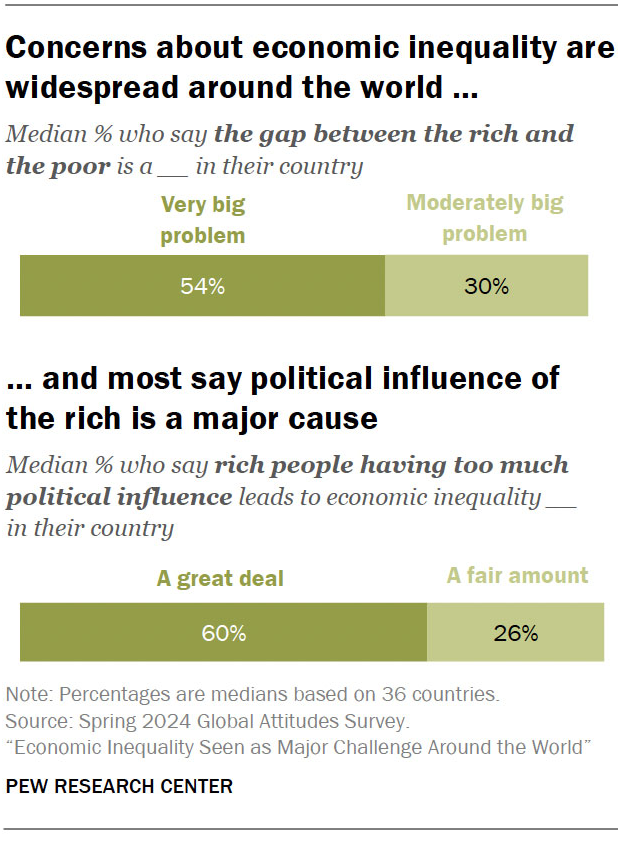
Netherlands, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Turkey and the United Kingdom.

- In Australia, the scale ranged from "Left" to "Right."
- In Japan, Singapore, South Korea and Thailand, ideology was measured on a scale from "Extremely progressive" to "Extremely conservative."
- In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left).
- Ideology was not asked about in Ghana, India, Indonesia, Kenya, Malaysia, Sri Lanka or Tunisia.

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardize education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all reports beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here are the questions used for the report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.



A new Pew Research Center survey of 36 nations finds widespread public concern about economic inequality. And when asked what leads to this inequality, most people across the countries surveyed point to the intersection of wealth and politics.

The key findings of the survey include:

- A median of **54% of adults across the nations surveyed say the gap between the rich and the poor is a very big problem** in their country. Another 30% say it is a moderately big problem.
- A median of **60% believe that rich people having too much political influence** contributes a great deal toward economic inequality.
- These views are **especially common among people on the ideological left,** though many on the right agree. Ideological divisions are particularly large in the United States.

What is a median?

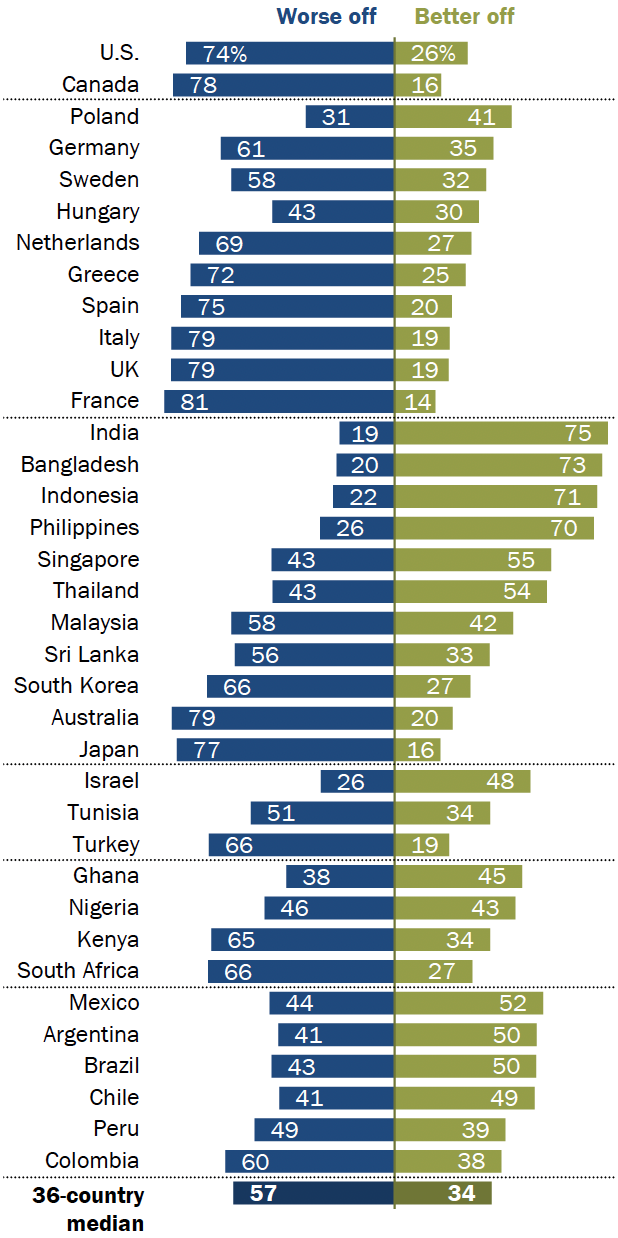
Throughout this report, median scores are used to help readers see overall patterns in the data. The median percentage is the middle number in a list of all percentages sorted from highest to lowest.

The survey, conducted in spring 2024, also finds deep global anxieties about the economic future and a strong desire for economic reform.

A median of **57% of adults across the nations polled expect children in their country to be worse off financially than their parents** when they grow up.

Globally, most think children will be worse off financially than their parents

% who say that when children in their country grow up, they will be ___ financially than their parents



Note: Those who did not answer, or who volunteered "Same," are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Economic Inequality Seen as Major Challenge Around the World"

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This view is particularly widespread in several high-income nations, including Australia, Canada, France, Italy, Japan, Spain, the United Kingdom and the U.S.

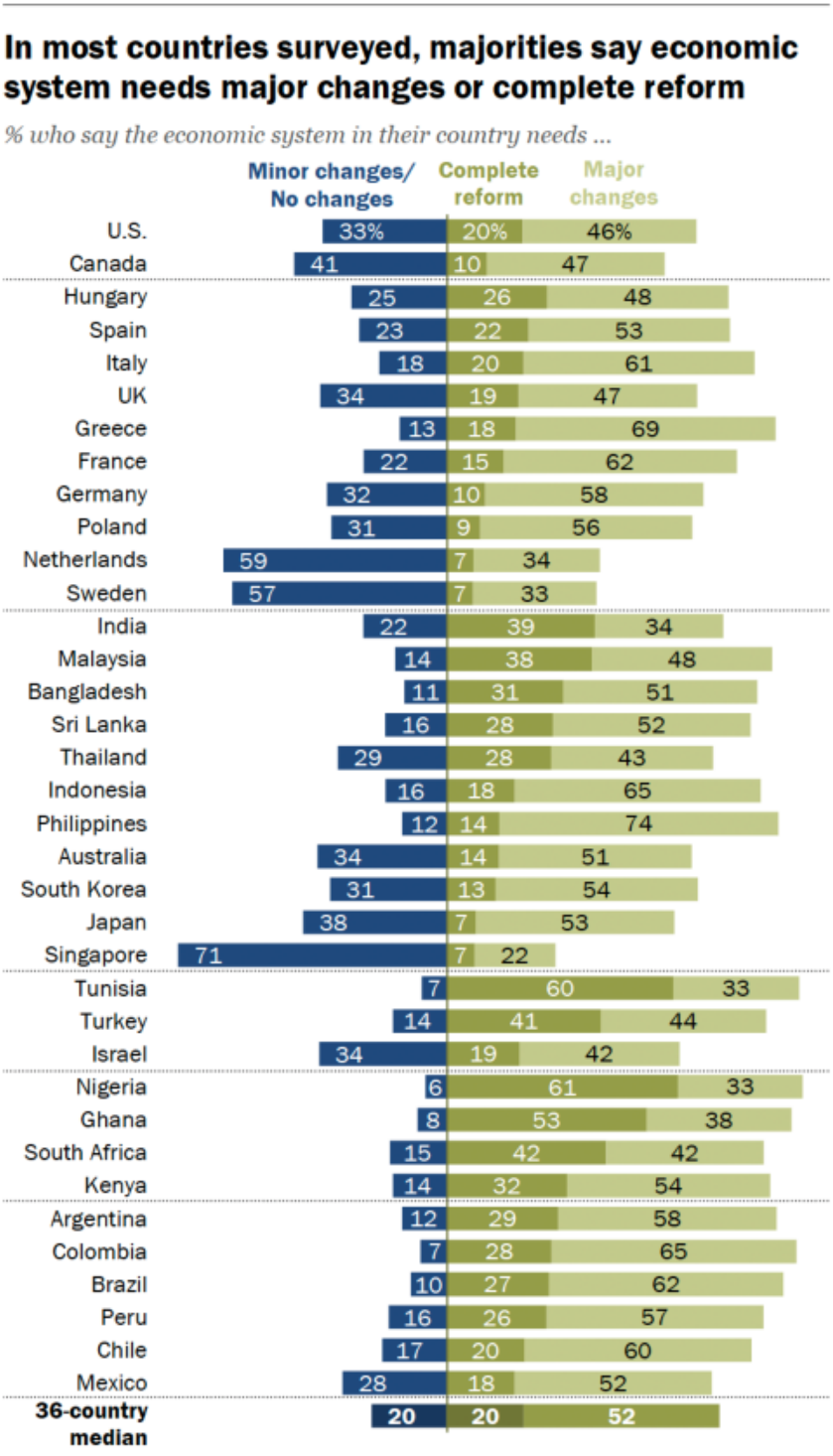
For the most part, this pessimistic view about the economic future is shared by younger and older adults alike, as well as by people with higher and lower incomes.

However, in several countries, the public is more optimistic than pessimistic about the financial prospects of the next generation. These include a few South Asian and Southeast Asian nations: Bangladesh, India, Indonesia, the Philippines, Singapore and Thailand.

And there is modest optimism in some Latin American nations, too. About half of those surveyed in Argentina, Brazil, Chile and Mexico think today's children will be better off than their parents, while around four-in-ten or more say they will be worse off.

In many countries, there is more economic pessimism today than before the COVID-19 pandemic – which hurt many people economically. In 15 of 31 countries where trends are available, the share of the public who thinks children will be worse off financially than their parents is higher today than in pre-pandemic surveys.

Read more: The next generation's financial future



Majorities in 33 of 36 nations also think their country's economic system needs major changes or complete reform. People in middle-income nations in the Asia-Pacific region, Latin America, sub-Saharan Africa and the Middle East-

North Africa region are especially likely to want this degree of change.

Still, people in many wealthier countries want change, too. At least six-in-ten adults in most of the European nations surveyed want major economic changes or complete reform; 66% share this view in the U.S.

In almost every country polled, people who see economic inequality as a very big problem are significantly more likely than others to want major changes or complete economic reform.

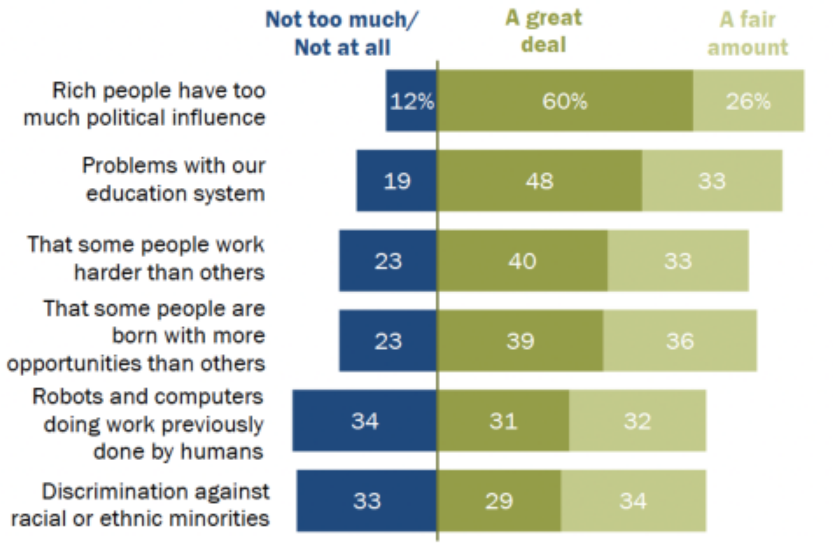
Read more: Changing the current economic system

Perceived causes of economic inequality

What causes economic inequality? In our list of six potential factors, **the strong connection between money and politics** resonates most with respondents, topping the list in 31 of 36 countries.

Political influence of the rich seen as top contributor to economic inequality

Median % who say each of the following leads to economic inequality ___ in their country



Note: Percentages are medians based on 36 countries. Those who did not answer are not shown. Refer to topline for country-specific wording used on the race and ethnicity item.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Economic Inequality Seen as Major Challenge Around the World"

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Overall, more than eight-in-ten adults say that rich people having too much influence over politics contributes to economic inequality either a great deal (60% at the median) or a fair amount (26%).

But respondents see other factors as important, too. Majorities across the countries surveyed believe problems with the education system add to inequality in their nation.

Many also attribute inequality to some people working harder than others or some being born with more opportunities. Smaller but still notable shares cite other factors, including robots and computers doing work previously done by humans, and discrimination against racial or ethnic minorities.

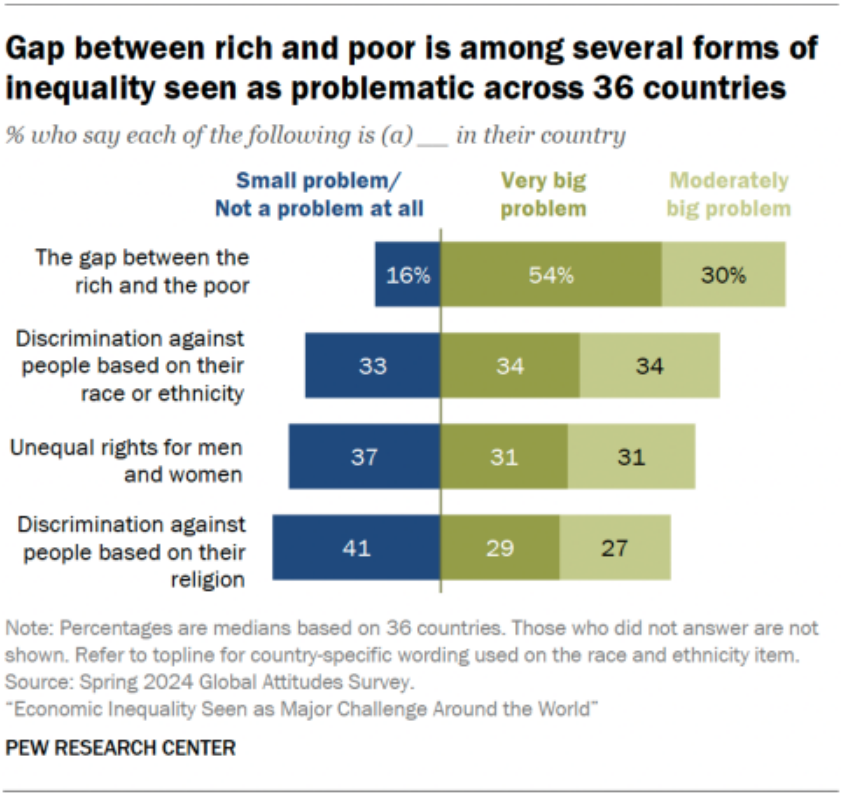
Economic anxiety during a global election year

Voters in more than 60 countries went to the polls in 2024. In many of these countries – including France, Japan, South Africa, the UK and the U.S. – incumbents lost or suffered major electoral setbacks. Economic concerns played a key role in these elections. For more, read our data essay: "Global Elections in 2024: What We Learned in a Year of Political Disruption."

Read more: Factors seen as contributing to economic inequality

Views of other forms of inequality

Nearly a decade and a half after the Occupy Wall Street protests in the U.S. – which coincided with similar movements in other countries – economic inequality remains the reality in many nations.



And as our survey highlights, this is a matter of strong public concern. More than eight-in-ten adults across the surveyed countries see the gap between rich and poor as a very or moderately big problem in their country.

But there's concern about other forms of inequality as well. Roughly two-thirds say discrimination against people based on their race or ethnicity is a very or moderately big problem where they live, while about six-in-ten say this about gender inequality. And more than half describe discrimination against people based on their religion as a big problem.

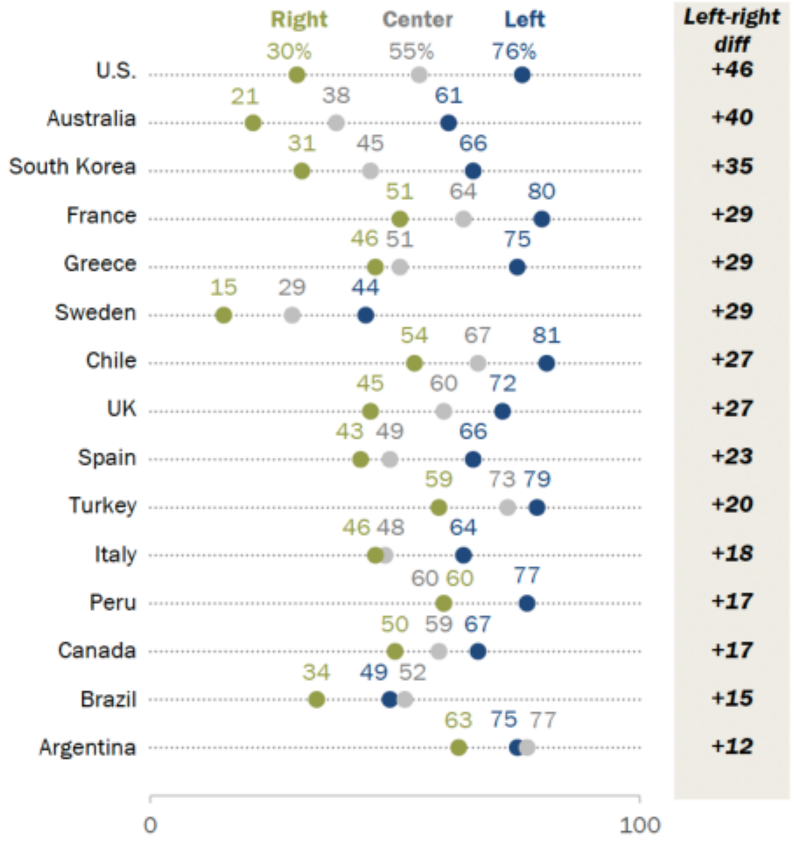
Concerns about these issues are often tied to respondents' demographic characteristics, background and experiences. For example, in some nations, people with lower incomes are especially worried about economic inequality; racial and ethnic minorities are more concerned about racial and ethnic discrimination; women are more concerned about gender inequality; and people who prioritize religion are more likely to see religious discrimination as a very big problem.

Read more: Global perceptions of different types of inequality

Ideological differences in views of economic inequality

People on the ideological left more likely than those on the right to see economic inequality as a problem

*% who say the gap between the rich and the poor is a **very big problem** in their country, by ideology*



Note: Only statistically significant differences are shown. In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left).
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Economic Inequality Seen as Major Challenge Around the World"

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On several questions in this survey, opinions vary significantly by political ideology.

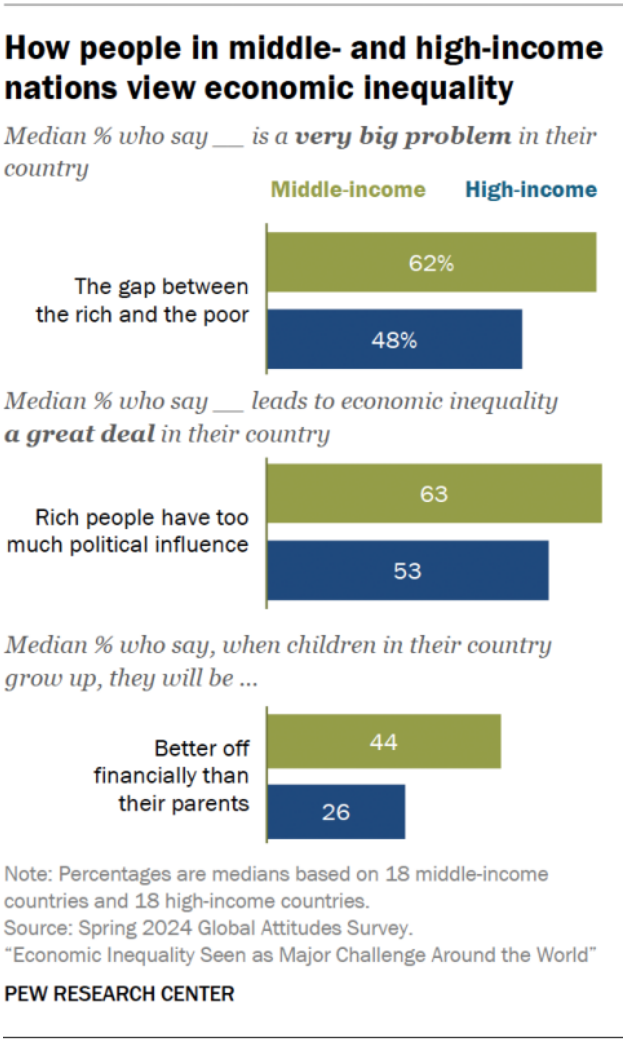
For instance, while concerns about inequality are common across the ideological spectrum, in many countries people who place themselves on the left are especially likely to say the gap between rich and poor is a very big problem.

Those on the left are also particularly likely to see racial and ethnic discrimination and gender inequality as very big problems.

And the same pattern appears when it comes to the perceived causes of inequality. People on the left are more likely than those on the right to cite the political influence of the rich, racial discrimination, and the fact that some are born with more opportunities than others.

Some of the largest ideological divisions in the survey are in the U.S. For example, 76% of U.S. liberals say economic inequality is a very big problem in their country, compared with just 30% of conservatives. This 46 percentage point gap is the largest left-right differences across the countries surveyed. *(The survey was conducted prior to the November 2024 U.S. presidential election.)*

Views of inequality in middle- and high-income nations



The survey finds important differences between middle- and high-income nations in attitudes about income inequality.

(We surveyed 18 middle-income countries and 18 high-income countries. Read Appendix A for a classification of these nations.)

While concerns about economic inequality are widespread in all the countries surveyed, people in middle-income nations are especially likely to describe it as a very big problem. They are also more likely to say that the rich having too much political influence is a major cause of inequality.

But when it comes to views about the economic future, people in middle-income nations are somewhat more positive. A median of 44% of adults in middle-income nations believe that when children in their country grow up, they will be financially better off than their parents. A median of just 26% in wealthier nations express this view.

Next: Global perceptions of inequality and discrimination

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Report PDF

Topline

French: Les inégalités économiques considérées comme un enjeu majeur partout dans le monde

Italian: Le diseguaglianze economiche sono considerate una delle maggiori sfide a livello globale

Spanish: En todo el mundo, la desigualdad económica se considera un desafío importante

American Trends Panel Wave 145

Spring 2024 Survey Data

REPORT | JANUARY 28, 2025

Comparing Levels of Religious Nationalism Around the World

By global standards, the U.S. has a relatively low level of religious nationalism, but it stands out from other high-income countries

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BY LAURA SILVER, JONATHAN EVANS, MARIA SMERKOVICH, SNEHA GUBBALA, MANOLO CORICHI AND WILLIAM MINER

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National and royal flags fly outside religious sites in Thailand, Turkey, the U.S. and Israel. (Clockwise from top left: Vera Tikhonova, Westend61, Samuel Corum and Paul Souders, all via Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this survey to examine the role of religion in public life in 36 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East-North Africa region, North America and sub-Saharan Africa. The countries have a variety of historically predominant religions, including Buddhism, Christianity, Hinduism, Islam and Judaism.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Comparing Levels of Religious Nationalism Around the World"

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

For non-U.S. data, this report draws on nationally representative surveys of 41,503 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode, probability-based online panel.

In the United States, we surveyed 12,693 adults from Feb. 13 to 25, 2024. Most of the respondents (10,642) are members of Pew Research Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel recruited through national random sampling of residential addresses, which gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection.

The remaining U.S. respondents (2,051) are members of three other panels: the Ipsos KnowledgePanel, the NORC Amerispeak Panel and the SSRS Opinion Panel. All three are national survey panels recruited through random sampling (not "opt-in" polls). We used these additional panels to

ensure that the survey would have enough Jewish and Muslim respondents to be able to report on their views.

Additional survey questions were asked on a follow-up survey conducted from April 1 to 7, 2024, among 3,600 ATP members who had previously participated in the February survey.

The U.S. data is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education, religious affiliation and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Throughout the report, we analyze respondents' attitudes based on where they place themselves on an ideological scale, their support for populist parties, their religious identification, their educational attainment, their income, and whether they live in high- or middle-income countries. For more on each of these measures, visit the methodology.

Religious nationalism index

In this report, we classify some people as "religious nationalists." Scholars do not fully agree on how to define religious nationalism, and the challenge is even more complicated when one tries to study the concept in multiple countries – and for multiple religious groups – concurrently. For example, scholars who measure Christian nationalism in the U.S. may consider whether the government should allow prayer in public schools, while those measuring Hindu nationalism in India may consider whether the government should regulate the protection of cows, which are sacred to many Hindus.

For the purpose of making cross-national comparisons, we focused on two concepts in our definition of religious nationalism:

- How important people think identifying with the country's historically predominant religion is for belonging – e.g., for being "truly" part of the country's nationality
- The role people want religion to play in their country's leader and laws

We measured these two concepts among followers of each country's historically predominant religion using four questions. For more information on how we designed our religious nationalism index and assessed its statistical reliability, go to the methodology.

This analysis was produced by Pew Research Center as part of the Pew-Templeton Global Religious Futures project, which analyzes religious change and its impact on societies around the world. Funding for the Global Religious Futures project comes from The Pew Charitable Trusts and

the John Templeton Foundation (grant 63095). This publication does not necessarily reflect the views of the John Templeton Foundation.

Here are the questions used for this report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

In many countries, religion and politics are deeply intertwined. The belief that a country's historically predominant religion should be a central part of its national identity and drive policymaking is sometimes described as "religious nationalism."

A wide range of movements have been described as religious nationalism, including in India, where Prime Minister Narendra Modi has campaigned and governed on the idea that Hindu faith and culture should shape government policies; and in Israel, where Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu is backed by a coalition that includes ultra-Orthodox and national religious parties.

But there is no universally accepted definition of religious nationalism, leaving lots of room for debate over who is, say, a Christian nationalist or a Hindu nationalist. This has made it difficult to assess how common such views are around the world.

To help fill this gap, Pew Research Center set out to measure – in an impartial, consistent way – what share of people in different countries view the dominant religious tradition as central to their national identity, want their leaders to share their religious beliefs, and want religious teachings to guide their laws.

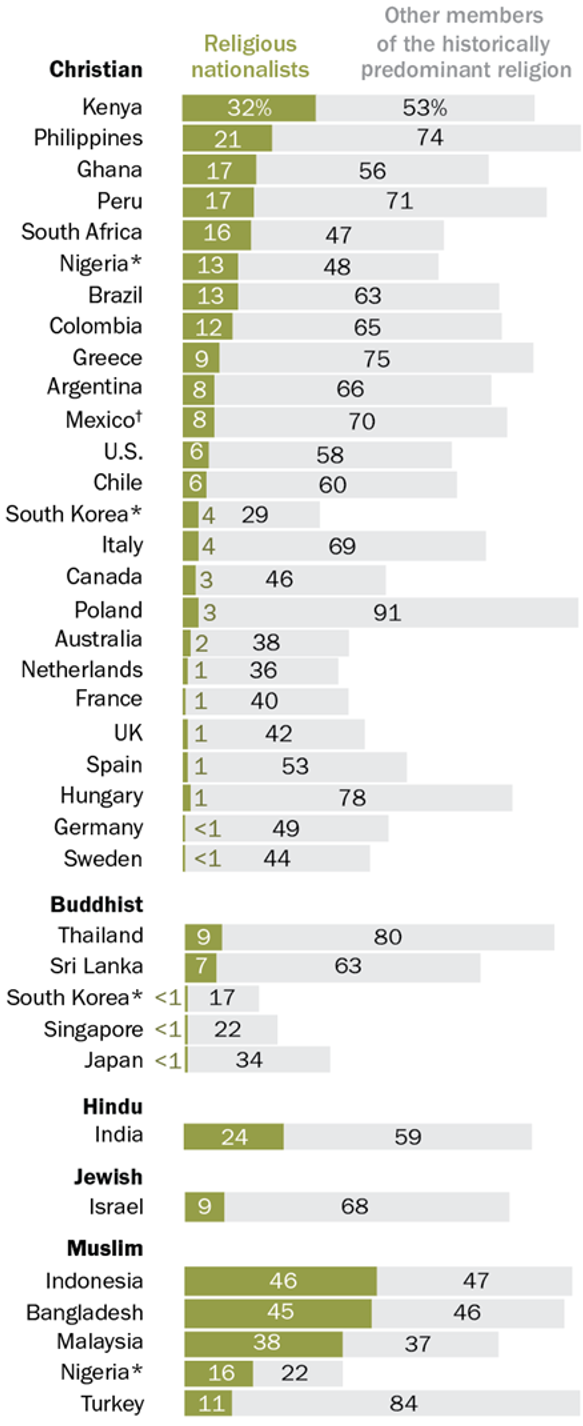
We asked four key questions in nationally representative surveys of nearly 55,000 people, conducted from January to May 2024 in three dozen countries[1]:

- **How important is belonging to the historically predominant religion to being *truly* part of your national identity?** (For example, how important is being a Muslim to being truly Indonesian, or being a Christian to being truly American?)

- **How important is it to you for your national leader to share your religious beliefs?**
- **How much influence do you think the historically predominant religion's sacred text should have on the laws of your country?** (For example, how much influence should the Quran have on the laws of Turkey, or should the Bible have on the laws of Italy?)
- **When the sacred text conflicts with the will of the people, which should have more influence on the laws of your country?** (This follow-up question was asked only of respondents who answered the previous question by saying that the sacred text should have a "fair amount" or "great deal" of influence on their country's laws.)

Share of religious nationalists varies widely across countries

% who are classified as ...



* In Nigeria and South Korea, people were asked separately about two historically predominant religions, and both are shown.
† In Mexico, respondents were asked about the importance of being Catholic to being truly part of the country.
Note: People are classified as "religious nationalists" if they identify with their country's historically predominant religion, say it is very important to be part of that religion to be truly part of the country, say it is very important to have a leader who shares their religious beliefs, say the sacred text of that religion should have a great deal or fair amount of influence on the laws of their country, and say that if the sacred text conflicts with the will of the people then the text should take precedence. People who are members of the

historically predominant religion but do not hold all these views are shown as "other members of the historically predominant religion." Adults who do not identify with a country's historically predominant religion are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Comparing Levels of Religious Nationalism Around the World"

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For this report, **we define "religious nationalists" as people who identify with the historically predominant religion (also often the majority religion) and take a strongly religious position on *all four* of these questions.**

In **Turkey,** for example, a religious nationalist would be a **Muslim** who says …

- Being a Muslim is very important to being truly Turkish;
- *And* it is very important that Turkey's president shares their religious beliefs;
- *And* the Quran should have at least a fair amount of influence over Turkey's laws;
- *And* when the Quran conflicts with the will of the people, the Quran should have more influence.

In **Israel,** a religious nationalist would be a **Jew** who says …

- Being a Jew is very important to being truly Israeli;
- *And* it is very important that Israel's prime minister shares their religious beliefs;
- *And* Jewish scripture should have at least a fair amount of influence over Israel's laws;
- *And* when Jewish scripture conflicts with the will of the people, Jewish scripture should have more influence.

In the **United States,** a religious nationalist would be a **Christian** who says …

- Being a Christian is very important to being truly American;
- *And* it is very important that the U.S. president shares their religious beliefs;
- *And* the Bible should have at least some influence over U.S. laws;

- *And* when the Bible conflicts with the will of the people, the Bible should have more influence.

Using this definition, the prevalence of religious nationalism varies widely across the 35 countries where we asked all four of these questions. **Fewer than 1% of adults surveyed meet the criteria in Germany and Sweden, compared with more than four-in-ten in Indonesia (46%) and Bangladesh (45%).**

In this global perspective, the U.S. does *not* stand out for especially high levels of religious nationalism.

Just 6% of U.S. adults are religious nationalists by the combination of these four measures, about the same level as several other countries surveyed in the Americas, such as Chile (6%), Mexico (8%) and Argentina (8%).Canada has a relatively low share of religious nationalists (3%), while Colombia (12%), Brazil (13%) and Peru (17%) have somewhat higher shares.

How we asked about different religions and religious texts

We asked people in 36 countries about the importance of being a member of a particular religion as well as the influence of specific religious texts on their national laws.

In each country, we selected the historically predominant religion(s) and corresponding sacred text(s). For example, in the United States, where Christianity has long been the majority religion, we asked about the importance of being a Christian to being truly American and about the influence of the Bible on U.S. laws. In Thailand, where the vast majority of the population is Buddhist, we asked about the importance of being a Buddhist to being truly Thai. And, because the concept of "religious texts" is somewhat more relevant in Western religious traditions, we asked about a comparable concept: the influence of Buddhist dharma on the country's laws.

In Japan, Nigeria and South Korea, we asked all respondents separately about two religions and the influence of their religious texts. In Japan, we asked about Buddhism and Buddhist dharma as well as Shinto and Shinto teachings. A significant portion of the population there identifies as Buddhist, but Shinto has long been tied to national identity, and a quarter

of Japanese adults say they feel a personal connection to the Shinto way of life.

In Nigeria, where large shares of the population identify as either Christian or Muslim, we asked about both of those religions, and about the influence of the Bible and the Quran. In South Korea, because sizable shares identify as either Christian or Buddhist, we asked about both religions, and about the Bible and Buddhist dharma.

The questions about the Quran were not asked in Tunisia, so that country is excluded from our analyses of religious nationalism and the influence of religious texts.

Here is a list of the religions and religious texts asked in each country:

Religion	Religious text	Country
Christianity	Bible	United States, Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Italy, Netherlands, Poland, Spain, Sweden, UK, Australia, Philippines, South Korea, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa, Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Peru
Catholicism	Bible	Mexico
Islam	Quran	Bangladesh, Indonesia, Malaysia, Nigeria, Turkey, Tunisia
Buddhism	Buddhist dharma	Japan, Singapore, South Korea, Sri Lanka, Thailand
Hinduism	Hindu teachings	India
Judaism	Jewish scripture	Israel
Shinto	Shinto teachings	Japan

CORRECTION (Feb. 6, 2026): Due to a translation error identified after publication, the question (Q34/Q36a) on the Mexico survey asked about the importance of being "Catholic" rather than being "Christian." Refer to the errata for more information. Care should be taken when directly comparing Mexico to other countries on this question.

How this survey's findings relate to other measures in the U.S.

There are many ways to define religious nationalism. In the U.S., previous Pew Research Center surveys have asked numerous questions about "Christian nationalism" and separation of church and state. A February 2024 survey, for example, found that 5% of U.S. adults have heard of Christian nationalism and view it favorably. And 13% said the federal government should declare Christianity the official religion of the United States.

Here's how religious nationalists in the U.S. – as defined in the global survey – answer some of these related questions:

- 53% of religious nationalists think the federal government should declare Christianity the official religion of the United States. Another 40% of religious nationalists think the federal government should promote Christian values but *not* declare Christianity the official religion. Only 4% of religious nationalists think the federal government should neither declare Christianity the official religion nor promote Christian values. By contrast, just 15% of U.S. Christians who are *not* religious nationalists want Christianity to be the official religion of the United States.
- 84% of religious nationalists in the U.S. think liberals who are not religious have gone too far in trying to keep religious values out of the government and public schools. About six-in-ten Christians who are not religious nationalists (61%) say the same.

Ultimately, more Americans may support individual policies sometimes associated with Christian nationalism than the 6% classified as religious nationalists in this report. This stems from the high bar of needing to take a specific position on all four measures included in our index to be classified as a religious nationalist.

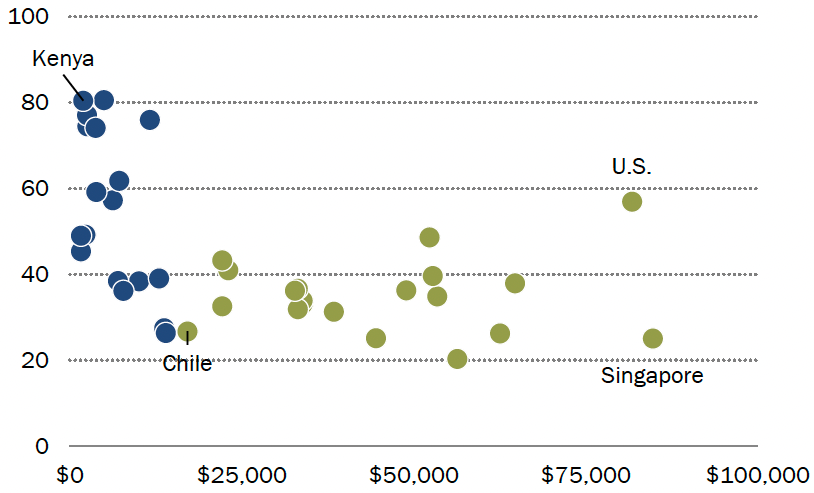
For more on religious nationalism in the U.S., read these Center publications:

- 45% of Americans Say U.S. Should be a 'Christian Nation'

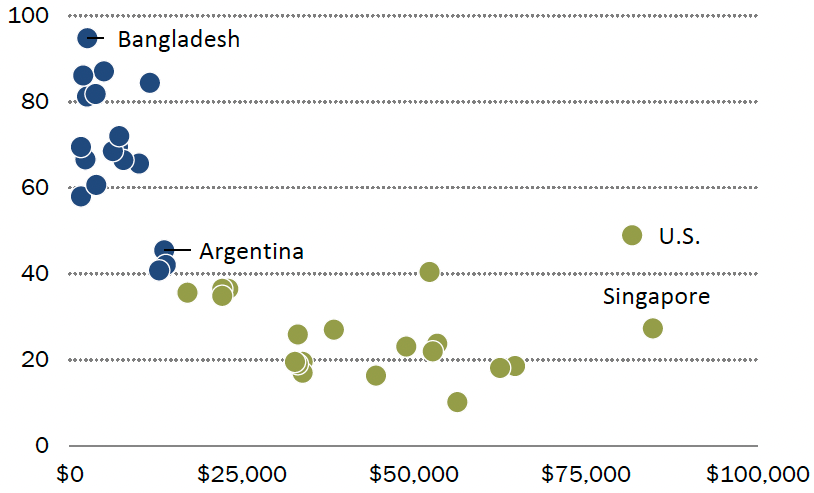
- A closer look at Americans who believe the U.S. should be a Christian nation
- 8 in 10 Americans Say Religion Is Losing Influence in Public Life

U.S. stands out from most high-income countries on views of how religious texts can and should influence their country's laws

*% who say [the Bible, Buddhist dharma, etc.] has a **great deal or fair amount of influence** on the country's laws today*



*% who say [the Bible, Buddhist dharma, etc.] should have a **great deal or fair amount of influence** on the country's laws*



Note: Blue and green dots represent middle- and high-income countries, respectively. Japan, Nigeria and South Korea appear twice in each scatterplot because two religious texts were asked about in each country. Refer to topline for full question wording.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Comparing Levels of Religious Nationalism Around the World"

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However, the U.S. *does* stand out when compared with other high-income countries, particularly on questions about religious

texts. **U.S. adults are more likely than people in any other high-income country surveyed to say the Bible *currently* has either a great deal or some influence over the laws of their country** (in other countries, people were asked about other texts).

And the U.S. public is also more inclined than people in other high-income countries to say that the Bible *should* have that kind of influence (again, relative to the sacred texts asked about in other places).

Americans are also among the most likely of any high-income public to:

- Describe a religious identity (in this case, being a Christian) as *very* important to truly sharing in the national identity (being American)
- Say it's very important for their country's political leader to have strong religious beliefs

Differences between wealthy and less wealthy countries

Why high- and middle-income countries?

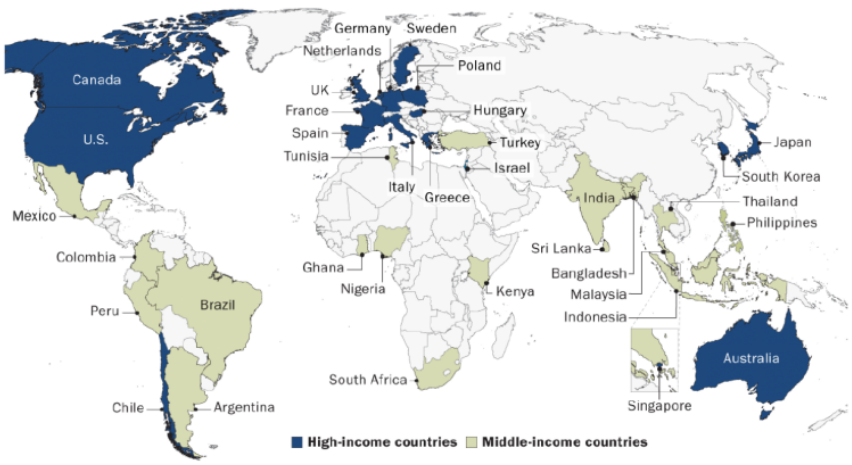
Decades of scholarship have explored the relationship between economic development and secularization. One influential notion argues that as societies get wealthier and people feel more secure, religion and religious values become less important in people's lives and they become more supportive of secular-rational values.

While secularization theory has many detractors and continues to be debated, the general pattern – that wealthier countries tend to see belief in God as less important for morality and that wealthier countries have lower rates of prayer – is one we have observed in our data for decades.

As a result, we analyze the data in this report in part according to each country's income status, using high- and middle-income categories from the World Bank. The high-income countries have larger percentages of people who are religiously unaffiliated (atheist, agnostic or "nothing in particular"). They are also more likely than middle-income countries to have:

- **Highly established democracies.** High-income countries are more likely to be classified as "full" democracies by the Economist Intelligence Unit (EIU), "high performing" by International IDEA, "free" by Freedom House, and "liberal" by Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem).
- **High rates of advanced education.** High-income countries, on average, have more than double the share of the total population who have attained a tertiary education (such as a postgraduate degree).

Countries included in this report, by income level



Source: Pew Research Center analysis of World Bank data.
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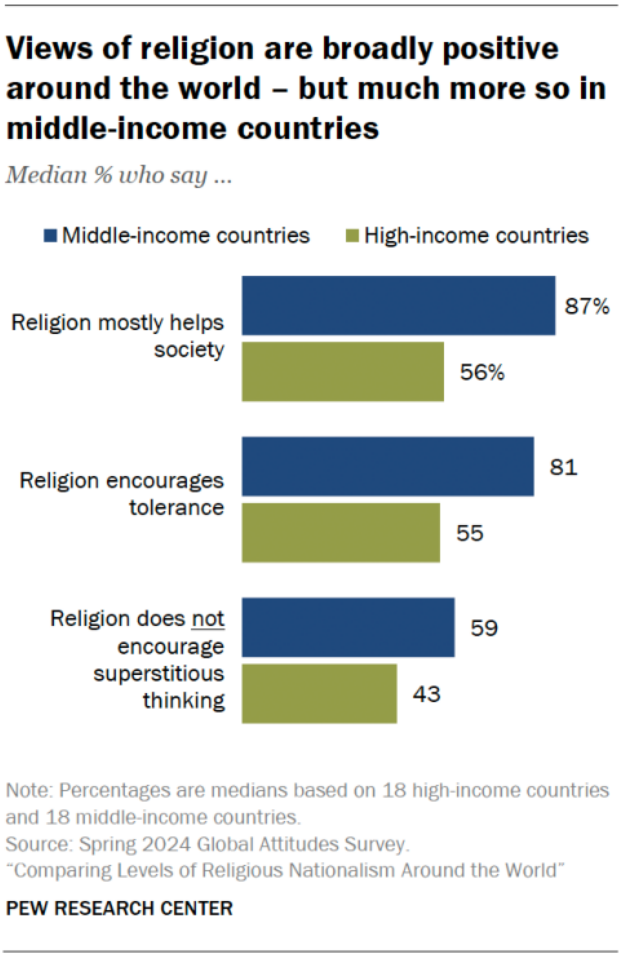


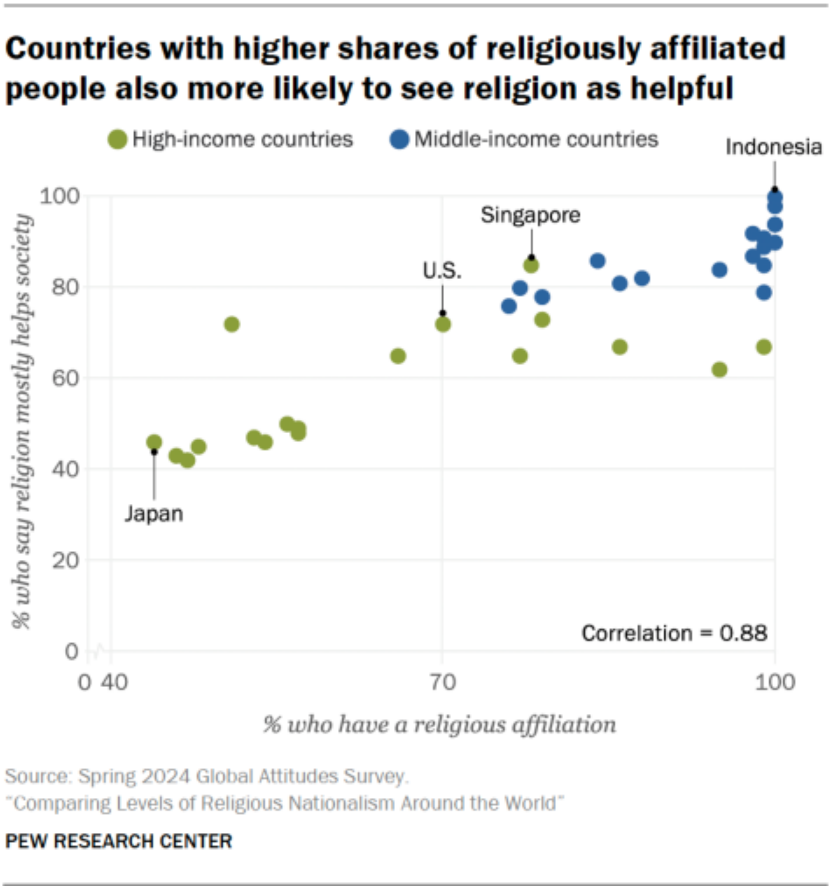
The survey shows that, in general, high-income countries differ sharply from middle-income countries (as defined by the World Bank) when it comes to public attitudes about religion.

People in middle-income countries are more likely than people in richer countries to say:

- Religion does more good than harm for society
- Religion encourages tolerance rather than intolerance
- Religion does *not* encourage superstitious thinking

Jump to Chapter 1 for more on how people around the world view religion's role in society.

These differences are related to levels of religiousness. **People who live in middle-income countries are more likely than people in high-income countries to have a religious affiliation, to pray regularly and to say religion is important in their lives.**



Religious people tend to favor a role for religion in public life. So it stands to reason that in countries where more people follow a religion, religion is more likely to be seen as a positive influence in society.

For example, in Bangladesh – where about nine-in-ten adults are Muslim – 94% say religion mostly helps society. But in Sweden – where fewer than half of adults surveyed (47%) have a religious affiliation – 42% say religion is helpful.

People in middle- and high-income countries also differ over the role they think religion should play in public life.

For example, **in many middle-income countries, majorities want religious texts like the Bible or the Quran to have either a great deal or a fair amount of influence on their country's laws.** By contrast, in most high-income countries surveyed, only a minority of adults want religious texts to play this role.

In some wealthier countries, people also tend to prioritize the will of the people over religious texts when the two conflict. In middle-income countries, the opposite is true.

Jump to Chapter 4 for more on views of the role religious texts can and should play.

People in middle-income countries are also more likely than those in high-income countries to say it's very important for the leader of their country to have religious beliefs that are the same as their own (and to have strong religious beliefs, period).

Jump to Chapter 2 for more on views of national leaders and their religious traits.

Religion plays more of a role in national identity in the middle-income countries than the high-income countries surveyed. While comparatively few people in most high-income countries say that sharing the country's historically predominant religion is very important for being "truly" part of that nation, half or more in most middle-income countries see religion as a key part of national belonging.

Jump to Chapter 3 for more on religion and national identity.

People in middle-income countries are also more likely to be religious nationalists. Religious nationalists do not make up a majority of the population in any country surveyed. But in 13 of the 17 middle-income countries surveyed (since Tunisia is not included in our analysis of religious nationalism), there are double-digit shares of religious nationalists. These shares reach around a third or more in Kenya (32%), Malaysia (38%), Bangladesh (45%) and Indonesia (46%).

In most high-income countries, there are fewer religious nationalists. Indeed, in nine of the 18 high-income countries surveyed, 1% or less of the public meets the criteria. While the shares are somewhat higher in a few countries – 9% in Greece and Israel, for example – in no high-income country do religious

nationalists make up a double-digit percentage of the overall public.

Demographics of religious nationalism

In many countries, **people who pray daily** are more likely than those who pray less frequently to be religious nationalists (under the definition used for this report). For example, in India, 27% of people who say they pray at least once a day are religious nationalists, compared with 17% of those who pray less frequently.

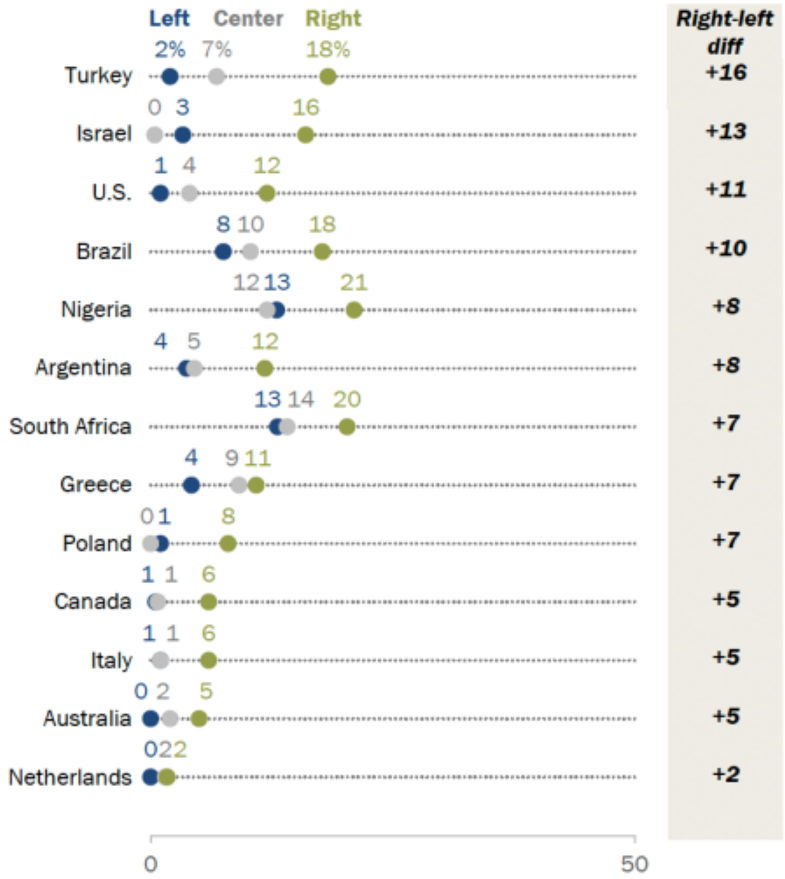
Older people in some countries are somewhat more likely than younger people to be religious nationalists. In Greece, 13% of people ages 50 and older are religious nationalists, compared with 8% of those ages 35 to 49 and only 1% of adults under 35.

In many countries, people with **lower levels of education** are also somewhat more likely to be religious nationalists than those with higher levels of education. In Kenya, 38% of people with less than a secondary degree are religious nationalists, compared with 22% of those with a secondary degree or more education.

In a few countries, people with **lower incomes** are more likely than those with higher incomes to be religious nationalists. This is the case in Brazil, where 17% of respondents with incomes at or below the median are religious nationalists, compared with 9% of those with higher incomes.

People on the ideological right are slightly more likely to be religious nationalists in many countries

% who are classified as religious nationalists, by ideology



Note: Only statistically significant differences are shown. Countries where ideology was not asked are not shown. People are classified as "religious nationalists" if they identify with their country's historically predominant religion, say it is very important to be part of that religion to be truly part of the country, say it is very important to have a leader who shares their religious beliefs, say the sacred text of that religion should have a great deal or fair amount of influence on the laws of their country, and say that if the sacred text conflicts with the will of the people then the text should take precedence. In the U.S., ideology is defined as conservative (right), moderate (center) and liberal (left). In Nigeria, only the shares classified as Muslim religious nationalists are shown (the shares classified as Christian religious nationalists do not have significant differences by ideology).
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
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In addition, people who place themselves on the **ideological right** are more likely to be religious nationalists than those in the center or on the left in many countries where the survey asked about political ideology. In Poland, for example, 8% of people on the right are religious nationalists, compared with 1% or fewer in the center and on the left.

In Europe, people with **favorable views of several right-wing populist parties** are also somewhat more likely than people with

unfavorable views of those parties to be religious nationalists. (For more on how these parties were defined, refer to the Appendix.) Returning to the example of Poland, 10% of adults who hold a favorable view of the Law and Justice party (PiS) are religious nationalists, compared with 1% of those who see PiS unfavorably.

(Of course, in the case of ideology and party favorability, the relationship could also be reversed. That is, people who hold certain beliefs about religious nationalism may be more likely to have favorable views of specific right-wing populist parties or to place themselves on the right of the ideological spectrum than those who do not hold those beliefs.)

In Israel, Haredi and Dati Jews (33%) are much more likely than Masorti Jews (5%) and Hiloni Jews (1%) to be religious nationalists. (Because of sample size considerations, we combine Haredim and Datiim for analysis in this report.)

Jewish religious groups in Israel: Haredim, Datiim, Masortim and Hilonim

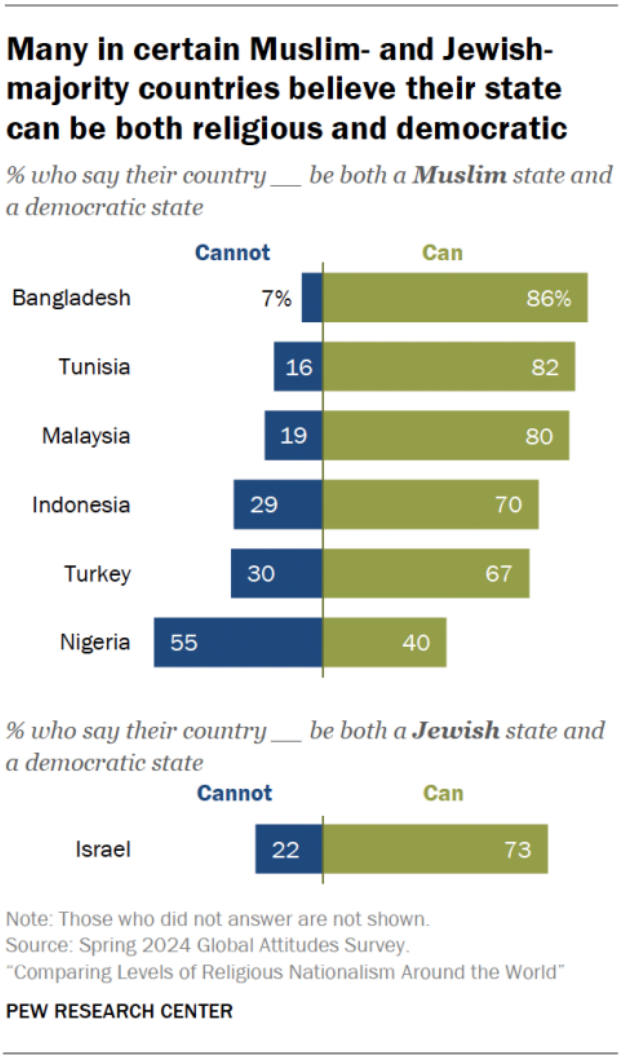
Nearly all Israeli Jews identify as either Haredi (commonly translated as "ultra-Orthodox"), Dati ("religious"), Masorti ("traditional") or Hiloni ("secular"). The spectrum of religious observance in Israel – on which Haredim are generally the most religious and Hilonim the least – does not always line up perfectly with Israel's political spectrum.

On some issues, including those pertaining to religion in public life, there is a clear overlap: Haredim are furthest to the right, and Hilonim are furthest to the left, with Datiim and Masortim in between. But on other political issues, including those related to the Israeli-Palestinian conflict and views of the United States, differences between religious groups do not always mirror those between people at different points on the ideological spectrum.

Because of sample size considerations, we combine Haredim and Datiim for analysis in this report.

For more information on the different views of these religious groups, read the Center's 2016 deep dive on the topic, "Israel's Religiously Divided Society."

Can states have a religious character and be democratic?



In a number of countries with sizable Muslim and Jewish populations, we also asked whether their country can be both democratic *and* a Muslim or Jewish country.

In countries with Muslim majorities, most do think the state can be both democratic and Muslim. The shares who believe this are particularly high in Bangladesh (86%), Tunisia (82%) and Malaysia (80%). (Islam is the official state religion in Bangladesh and Malaysia, and it was the official religion in Tunisia until 2022).

Slightly smaller majorities in Indonesia (70%) and Turkey (67%) agree that their country can be both Muslim and democratic at the same time. But in Nigeria – where Muslims are not the

overwhelming majority of the population – only 40% think Nigeria can be both a Muslim state and a democratic state.

Israel defines itself as "Jewish and democratic," and indeed, 73% of adults surveyed in Israel agree their country can be both. Only about a quarter say the country cannot be a Jewish state and a democratic state at the same time. Still, there are major differences by religion, as well as among Jewish religious groups.

Jump to Chapter 5 for more on the role religion should play in Muslim- and Jewish-majority countries.

These are among the key findings of a 36-country survey conducted by Pew Research Center in the first five months of 2024. This report includes chapters that explore the following questions:

- What impact do people around the world think religion has on their society? (Chapter 1)
- How important should religion be for a country's leader? (Chapter 2)
- How important is following a specific religion to national belonging? (Chapter 3)
- Should religious texts influence national laws? (Chapter 4)
- What role should religion play in Muslim- and Jewish-majority countries? (Chapter 5)

CORRECTION (June 5, 2025): The topline for this report has been updated. The changes do not substantively affect the findings of this report. Refer to the errata for more information.

CORRECTION (Feb. 6, 2026): Due to a translation error identified after publication, the question (Q34/Q36a) on the Mexico survey asked about the importance of being "Catholic" rather than being "Christian." Refer to the errata for more information. Care should be taken when directly comparing Mexico to other countries on this question.

Next: What impact do people around the world think religion has on their society?

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RECOMMENDED CITATION:

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1. Tunisia was surveyed but is excluded from some analyses in this report because certain questions – including those about leaders’ religious traits and the influence of the Quran on Tunisia’s laws – were not asked there. ↩

- Topline
- Report PDF
- Turkish: Dünya Çapında Dinî Milliyetçilik Düzeylerinin Karşılaştırılması
- Spanish: Comparando los niveles de nacionalismo religioso en el mundo
- Report errata
- American Trends Panel Wave 143
- American Trends Panel Wave 145
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SHORT READS | JANUARY 29, 2025

4 facts about Americans' views of the World Health Organization

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BY LAURA CLANCY

A World Health Organization sign is seen at the entrance to the organization's headquarters in Geneva. (Fabrice Coffrini/AFP via Getty Images)

On the first day of his second administration, President Donald Trump announced that the United States will withdraw from the World Health Organization (WHO), the United Nations health agency. He cited dissatisfaction with the organization's handling of the coronavirus pandemic and the United States' role as its largest funder.

But what do Americans think of the WHO? Here are some key findings about U.S. opinion of the organization, drawn from Pew

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From weight-loss drugs to raw milk, Americans

Research Center surveys conducted before Trump's announcement.

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to explore Americans' views of the World Health Organization in light of President Donald Trump's plans to withdraw the United States from the organization. We drew on a survey of 3,600 adults conducted from April 1-7, 2024, before Trump's announcement, as well as a survey of 2,596 adults conducted from Feb. 1-7, 2021, during the coronavirus pandemic.

Everyone who took part in these surveys is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), a group of people recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses who have agreed to take surveys regularly. This kind of recruitment gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection. Surveys were conducted either online or by telephone with a live interviewer.

The surveys are weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

Here are the questions used for this analysis and the survey methodology.

1 More than half of Americans believe the U.S. benefits from its membership in the WHO.

As of April 2024, 25% of U.S. adults say the country benefits a great deal from its membership, while about one-third say it benefits a fair amount.

hear more often about some health topics than others

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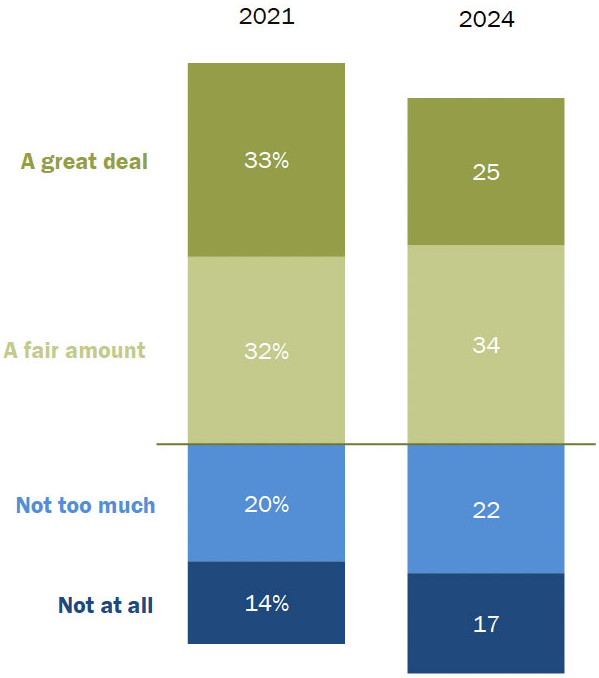
Most Americans see benefits to U.S. membership in the WHO

% who say the U.S. benefits ___ from being a member of the World Health Organization



Note: Those who did not answer are not shown.
Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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Conversely, 38% say the U.S. does not benefit much or at all from WHO membership.

2 The benefits of WHO membership are less evident to Americans now than during the coronavirus pandemic.

The share who say the U.S. benefits a great deal or a fair amount decreased significantly between 2021 and 2024. That includes a decrease of 8 percentage points in the share who say the U.S. benefits *a great deal*.

The 2021 survey was conducted in the weeks after then-President Joe Biden blocked Trump's first attempt at withdrawing the U.S. from the WHO.

3 Democrats are roughly twice as likely as Republicans to see benefits in WHO membership.

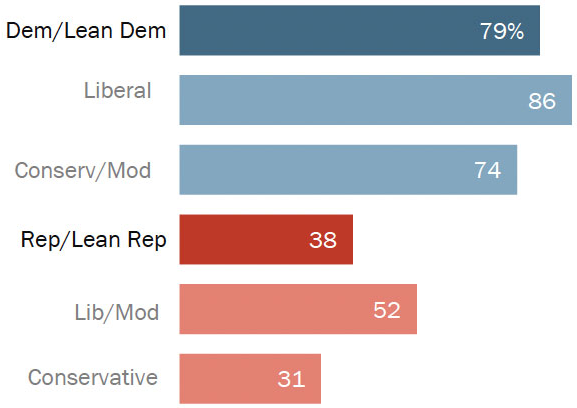
While about eight-in-ten Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents say the U.S. benefits from being part of the WHO, just 38% of Republicans and Republican leaners agree. That gap is 41 points, larger than the partisan divides seen when asking about the benefits of membership in the UN (36 points) or NATO (30 points).

Still, it's slightly narrower than in 2021, when Democrats were 50 points more likely than Republicans to see benefits to WHO membership.

The difference is even more stark between liberal Democrats and conservative Republicans. The former are 55 points more likely than the latter to see benefits to WHO membership.

Democrats more likely than Republicans to see benefits to WHO membership

*% who say the U.S. benefits **a great deal/fair amount** from being a member of the World Health Organization*



Source: Survey of U.S. adults conducted April 1-7, 2024.

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4 In 2021, Americans were mostly pleased with how the WHO was handling the coronavirus pandemic.

A 55% majority said the organization was doing a good job, and 42% said it was doing a bad job.

By comparison, just 42% said the U.S. was managing the outbreak well, and 43% said the same of China. Germany (72%) and the

European Union (61%) got higher ratings for their management of the outbreak.

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis and the survey methodology.

Topics

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REPORT | MARCH 19, 2025

What Age Do People Around the World Think Is Best to Reach Major Life Milestones?

Across mostly middle-income survey countries, people say it's ideal to be a spouse, parent and homeowner by 30, and to retire by 60

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BY JANELL FETTEROLF, CHRISTINE HUANG, JORDAN LIPPERT AND SOFIA HERNANDEZ RAMONES

Table of Contents

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis examines what people see as the best age to get married, have a first child, buy a home and retire. It draws on nationally representative surveys of 23,022 adults across 18 countries: Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, India, Indonesia, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. The surveys were conducted face-to-face from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024.

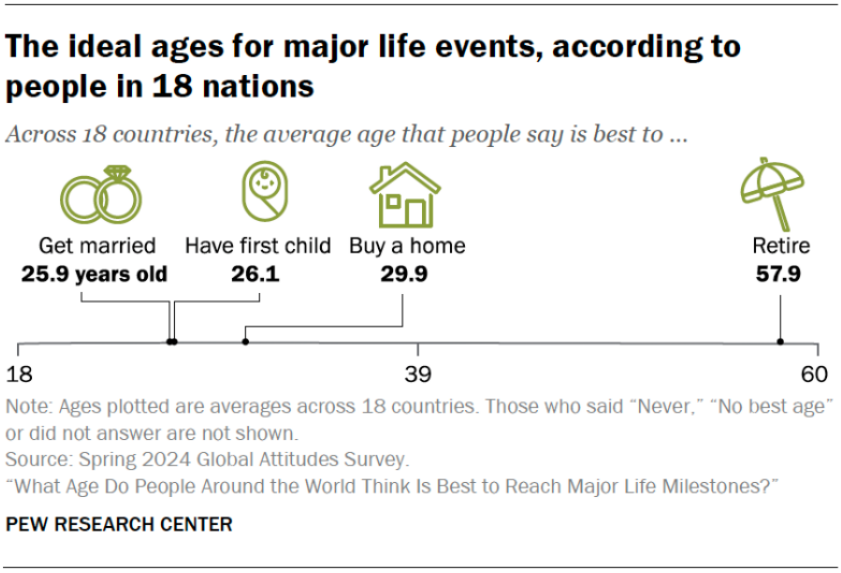
To analyze the ages respondents provided, we first removed any values that were more than three standard deviations from the mean. This is a common way to remove outliers, which, in survey work that requires an interviewer to log responses on a tablet in the field, can sometimes be

data entry errors. For each question, we averaged responses within each country (excluding outliers) and took an overall average based on these 18 values.

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardize education levels based on the United Nations' International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

Here are the questions used for the report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

When is the right time in life to get married or have a child? What is the best age to buy a home? Is there an ideal age for retirement? We asked adults in 18 mostly middle-income countries what they think is the best age to reach these life milestones. Overall, there is a lot of agreement around the world.



On average across the countries surveyed, people say it is best to get married and have a first child around 26 years old. They place the best age for buying a home at just under 30 and the ideal age for retirement at around 58.

And for each of these milestones, the average ages suggested by country are generally no more than a decade apart. For example, country averages for the ideal retirement age range from early 50s to early 60s – that is, 52.1 in Colombia to 62.7 in Nigeria. These averages give us a broad view of differences between countries,

but we're also able to take a closer look *within* each country at the much wider range of responses people provide.

Countries included in this analysis

We asked these questions about the ideal timing of life events in 18 countries where we conduct our surveys face-to-face: Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, India, Indonesia, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey.

In-person interviewing generally allows for greater rapport between the interviewer and respondent, and people are often more comfortable taking longer surveys in this setting.

The countries where we survey face-to-face are generally less wealthy than other nations. The World Bank classifies all countries included in this report (except Chile) as middle-income countries, while the United Nations classifies all 18 as developing economies. The middle-income nations we survey also tend to have younger populations than high-income nations, with a lower median age and life expectancy. Across the 18 countries in this analysis, the median age is 31.2 years, with a median life expectancy of 74.8 years.

Best age to get married

Generally, people across the 18 countries surveyed **think it's best to get married in one's mid-20s.** Average ideal ages range from 21.2 in Bangladesh to 28.9 in Argentina.

More than three-quarters of adults in Bangladesh say the best age for marriage is under 25. India is the only other country where a majority think the best age is under 25.

By contrast, in Argentina, Chile, Colombia, Peru, South Africa and Tunisia, roughly 10% of adults or more say the ideal age for marriage is 35 or older – the highest shares to say this among the countries surveyed. And 10% in Tunisia, 11% in Argentina and 16% in Chile say there is *no best age* for getting married.

People in the countries surveyed, on average, actually do get married in their 20s, according to data from the United Nations. But there is a gender gap, with women typically marrying at a younger age than men. Our survey finds a similar gender gap in views of the ideal age for marriage: In 14 of 18 countries, women say the best age to get married is slightly earlier in life, compared with men.

Read more in Chapter 1: What is the best age to get married?

And jump to Appendix A for the actual ages at which people around the world marry and become eligible for retirement benefits.

Best age to become a parent

People across the 18 countries surveyed **also largely agree that the best time to have a first child is in one's mid-20s.** Averages range from 23.5 years old in Bangladesh to 29.8 in Tunisia.

A third of adults or more in Bangladesh, India, Kenya and South Africa say it is ideal to have a first child before age 25. Similar shares in Argentina, Chile, Peru, Thailand and Tunisia say the best age to become a parent is 30 or older.

Read more in Chapter 2: What is the best age to have a first child?

Best age to buy a home

There is a little less agreement about what age is best to become a homeowner. **Average ideal ages for buying a home range from 24.9 in Brazil to 36.3 in Ghana.**

Roughly 20% of adults or more in South Africa, Sri Lanka and across Latin America say the best time to reach this milestone is before age 25. And in 11 countries, at least 10% say the ideal age to buy a home is 40 or older – including in Ghana, where 41% say this.

Read more in Chapter 3: What is the best age to buy a home?

Best age to retire

People across the countries surveyed **generally say the ideal age for retirement is in one's late 50s.** Still, views vary somewhat: Colombians say 52.1 is the best age to retire, while Nigerians say it is 62.7, on average.

There are also a wide range of responses within countries. Around 20% of adults in Turkey and Colombia think the best age to retire is under 50, while similar shares in Kenya and Nigeria think the best age is 70 or older.

In most countries, the average *ideal* age for retirement is younger than the age at which people can start receiving age-based retirement benefits. For example, many people in Mexico may qualify for a pension at age 65, according to data from the International Social Security Association. But Mexican adults say the ideal age to retire is 56.6.

Of course, retirement may not look the same or even be possible for everyone. Many older adults may work informally – such as in agriculture, child care or part-time employment – or may not retire for various reasons. And differences in the labor force across countries may also affect retirement ages and rates.

For instance, Nigerians can start receiving retirement benefits at age 50, which is earlier than most other countries included in this study – yet they give the highest ideal age for this milestone (62.7). This finding may reflect the fact that most employed Nigerians are self-employed (84% in the first quarter of 2024) and thus not eligible for pensions.

Read more in Chapter 4: What is the best age to retire?

What do Americans think is the best age for each milestone?

We asked the same set of questions in the United States, with one major difference. In the non-U.S. countries, where we surveyed face-to-face, people were able to "volunteer" (i.e., spontaneously provide a response that is not among the options given to them) that there is no best age for each milestone. But because people in the U.S. took the survey online, they saw "There is no best age" as a response option.

Large shares of Americans – from about a third to half – say there is no best age for getting married, having a first child, buying a home or retiring. But among those who provided an age, the averages generally look very similar to what we found across the 18 mostly middle-income countries surveyed for this report.

On average, Americans say the ideal age for each life milestone is:

- Getting married: 26.5
- Having a child: 27.3
- Buying a house: 28.8
- Retiring: 61.8

Democrats and adults under 30 say it is best to get married and have a child slightly later in life, and to retire earlier in life, compared with Republicans and people ages 65 and older.

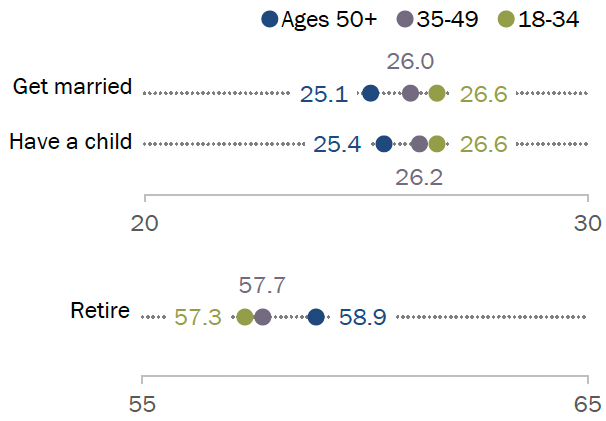
For more about how Americans answered these questions, read "Best age to get married, have a child, buy a home and retire? Here's what Americans say".

Age, gender and other factors affect views of the ideal timing for life events

The age people think is best for a certain milestone varies based on multiple demographic characteristics. A person's own age is one of the most common contributing factors across countries.

Age gaps in ideal timing of milestones

Across 18 countries, the average age that people say is best for each milestone, by age of respondents



Note: Ages plotted are averages across 18 countries for respondents within each age group. Those who said "Never," "No best age" or did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"What Age Do People Around the World Think Is Best to Reach Major Life Milestones?"

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Adults under 35 generally believe it is best to get married and have a child slightly later in life, compared with people ages 50 and older. On average across the 18 countries in this analysis, younger adults think 26.6 is the ideal age to get married *and* the best age to have a child. Older adults say 25.1 is the best age to get married and 25.4 is the best age to have a child.

However, younger adults generally suggest an earlier age for retirement than older adults. Looking across all 18 countries, adults under 35 say the best age for retirement is 57.3, while older adults say the best age is 58.9.

Views in Peru are a good example of this pattern:

- **Getting married:** Young adults in Peru say the ideal age for this milestone is 29.6, while older adults say 26.2.
- **Having a child:** 27.7 vs. 25.0
- **Retiring:** 57.9 vs. 60.4

Older and younger adults in many countries agree on the best age to buy a home. In eight countries, however, younger adults think

it is ideal to buy a home slightly earlier in life.

Views of ideal ages for life events also differ by:

- **Gender:** In most countries, men give an older ideal age for getting married and having a first child, compared with women.
- **Education:** People with more education tend to think it is best to get married and have a child later in life, compared with those who have less education.
- **Importance of religion:** People who say religion is very important in their life tend to suggest marriage and parenthood at a younger age, compared with people who say religion is only somewhat, not too or not at all important to them.

Around half of adults across 18 countries say it's ideal to get married, have a child and own a home by age 30

The average ages that people think are ideal for marriage, parenthood and homeownership generally fall around 30 or younger. But how large is the share of adults who say it is best to do *all three* by age 30? And do people generally agree on an ideal order for these life events?

What life milestones should people reach by 30, and in what order?

Average age that people say is best to ...

■ Youngest ideal age of the three events ■ Oldest ideal age of the three events

	Get married Average age	Have a first child Average age	Buy a home Average age	% who say it is ideal to marry, have a child and buy a home by 30 %
Sri Lanka	24.6	25.9	26.8	72
Indonesia	23.8	25.3	30.5	61
Kenya	25.3	25.4	31.1	56
Thailand	25.5	26.7	31.2	54
Turkey	25.1	27.3	31.1	47
Nigeria	24.9	26.4	31.9	46
India	22.7	25.3	32.7	44
Bangladesh	21.2	23.5	33.0	43
Tunisia	28.2	29.8	32.1	23
Mexico	25.6	25.5	26.9	74
Philippines	25.4	25.2	29.7	69
Colombia	28.2	25.9	28.4	53
Ghana	26.2	25.6	36.3	29
Peru	28.2	26.6	28.1	62
South Africa	28.6	24.4	28.5	52
Argentina	28.9	27.7	27.9	45
Chile	28.6	26.8	27.4	44
Brazil	25.6	25.7	24.9	65
18-country average	25.9	26.1	29.9	53*

* Median share across 18 countries.
Note: Those who said "Never," "No best age" or did not answer are not shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"What Age Do People Around the World Think Is Best to Reach Major Life Milestones?"

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Across the 18 countries surveyed, a median of 53% say the ideal age for reaching *all three* of these life events is 30 or younger. In Mexico and Sri Lanka, almost three-quarters of adults think it is best to get married, have a child and buy a home by age 30.

Fewer adults in Ghana and Tunisia hold this view; most think it's best to buy a home later in life.

In half the countries surveyed, the ideal order for these events – based on average ages suggested in the survey – is marriage, then parenthood, then homeownership.

The ideal order in Colombia, Ghana, Mexico and the Philippines is having a child, then getting married, then buying a home.

In Argentina, Chile, Peru and South Africa, the ideal age for having a child is youngest, followed by homeownership, then marriage.

People in Brazil say the best order is buying a home, then getting married, then having a child.

CORRECTION (April 15, 2025): An earlier version of this report included data on women's mean age at childbearing from the United Nations. We incorrectly reported it as the mean age that women have their first child. The data has been removed, but this change does not affect the overall findings of our survey data.

Next: What is the best age to get married?

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Best age to get married, have a child, buy a home and retire? Here's what Americans say

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BY JORDAN LIPPERT AND JANELL FETTEROLF

(Tempura/Getty Images)

Young adults in the United States are reaching family and financial milestones later in life than they were 40 years ago. That begs the question: *What are the best ages to reach these milestones?*

What do people in other countries think is the best age for these milestones?

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We also asked about these life events in 18 other, mostly middle-income countries where we survey people face-to-face. The responses look generally similar to the ones Americans give (among those who say there is a best age for each event). On average across the 18 non-U.S. countries, people say it is best to get married and have a child around age 26, buy a home around 30, and retire around 58. For more on views around the world, read "What Age Do People Around the World Think Is Best to Reach Major Life Milestones?"

We asked 3,600 U.S. adults what they think is the best age to get married, have their first child, buy a home and retire. Anywhere from about a third to half of Americans say there is *no best age* to achieve these milestones. Among those who say there *is* a best age, many say it's ideal to get married, have a child and buy a home between the ages of 25 and 34. And 45% of Americans say the best age to retire is in one's 60s.

The ideal timing that U.S. adults give for life events differs based on demographic factors such as age, income, political party and the importance of religion in their lives.

How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis examines what Americans think is the best age to reach certain life milestones: getting married, having a first child, buying a home and retiring. For this analysis, we interviewed 3,600 U.S. adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024.

Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey panel that is recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses. This way nearly all U.S. adults have a chance of selection. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other categories. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

To analyze the ages respondents provided, we removed any values that were more than three standard deviations from the mean. We then averaged the ages provided, excluding these outliers.

traditions and activities vary widely

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Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

What is the best age to get married?

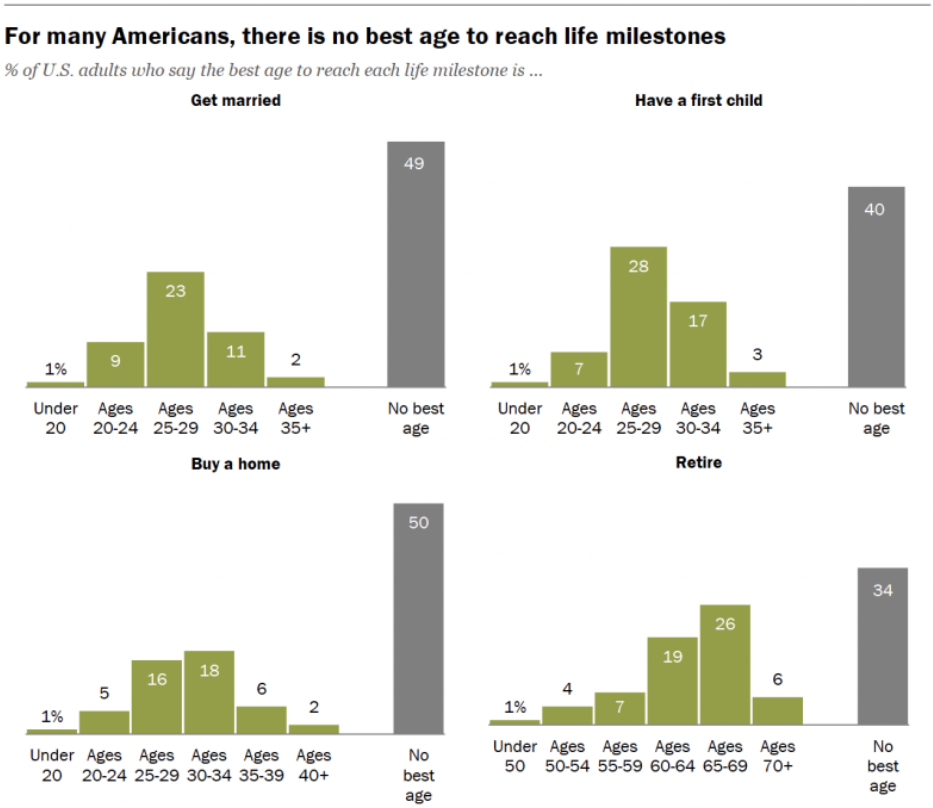
About half of Americans say there is no best age to get married, while roughly a quarter (23%) think the best age is between 25 and 29. Around one-in-ten say getting married between the ages of 20 and 24 is ideal, and a similar share say ages 30 to 34. **On average, Americans say the best age to get married is 26.5.**

The share of U.S. adults who are married has decreased over the past five decades, according to a 2023 Pew Research Center analysis of U.S. Census Bureau data. A record 25% of 40-year-olds in the U.S. had never been married as of 2021.

What is the best age to have a first child?

Four-in-ten U.S. adults say there is no best age to have a first child. The next-largest share (28%) say the best age is between 25 and 29. Very few say it is ideal to have a first child before age 20 or at 35 or older.

On average, Americans say the best age to become a parent is 27.3. And the typical U.S. woman actually does give birth for the first time around that age: 27.4, according to federal data. Parents say it's best to have a first child at a slightly younger age (26.9) than do those without kids (27.9).



However, many adults in the U.S. do not have children, and a 2024 Center survey found that almost half of adults under 50 who do not already have kids think it is unlikely they ever will.

What is the best age to buy a home?

Half of Americans say there is no best age for purchasing a home. Around a third believe the best age for this is between 25 and 34. Fewer than 10% say the ideal age is 35 or older.

On average, U.S. adults say the best age to purchase a home is 28.8. Those who are homeowners themselves recommend a slightly younger age (28.4) compared with renters (30.0).

For many Americans, though, buying a home comes later in adulthood than the age our survey respondents say is ideal. The median age of first-time homeowners is 38, according to data from the National Association of Realtors. And a Center analysis

of recent Census Bureau data finds that 62% of Americans ages 18 to 34 are renters.

What is the best age to retire?

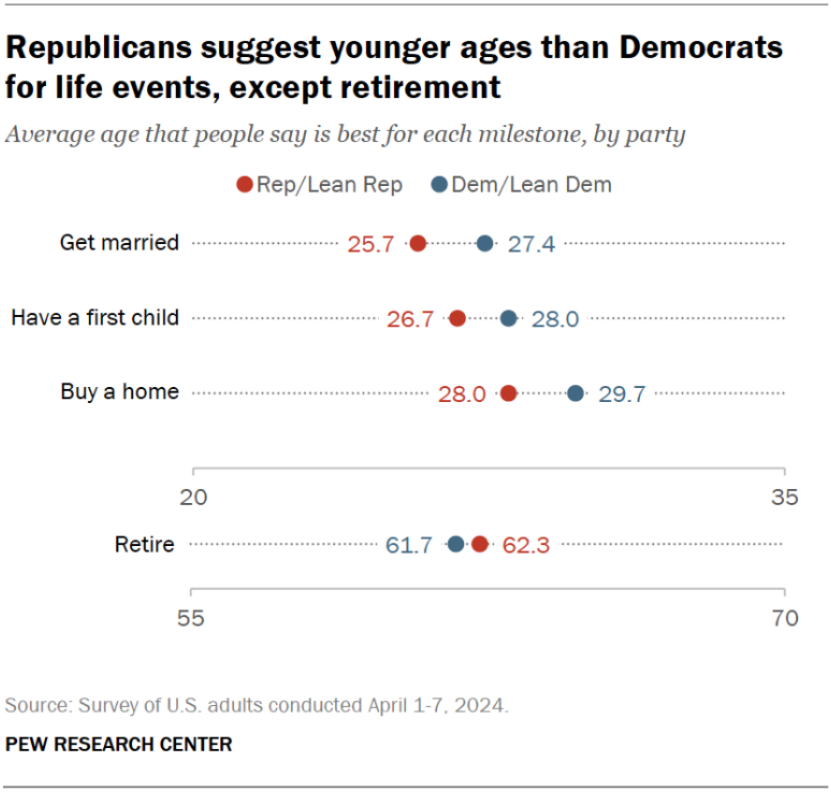
While around a third of Americans believe there is no best age to retire, 26% say the best age is between 65 and 69. About two-in-ten say the best age falls between 60 and 64, and 6% say it's 70 or older. **On average, U.S. adults say the best age to retire is 61.8.**

The age seen as ideal is younger than the age Americans can generally start receiving full government retirement benefits – between 65 and 67, depending on birth year. Over the years, more Americans have been working past age 65, and 19% of Americans ages 65 and older were employed in 2023.

Related: *What Age Do People Around the World Think Is Best to Reach Major Life Milestones?*

Demographic differences in ideal ages

The age U.S. adults think is best for each milestone differs based on factors like political party, age, income and the importance they place on religion.



Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents generally provide ideal ages that are later in life, compared with Republicans and Republican leaners. The exception is that Democrats think the best age for retirement is slightly younger than the age Republicans suggest (61.7 vs. 62.3).

Adults under 30 also recommend getting married and having a child later in life than those ages 65 and older do. But the ideal age for retirement is much lower for younger adults. On average, adults under 30 say the ideal age to retire is just before 60, while older adults say the ideal age is 65.0.

Although U.S. women tend to get married at a younger age than men, there is no difference in the ideal ages women and men give for this milestone. They also suggest similar ideal ages for buying a home and retiring. But women think it is best to have a child at a slightly younger age (27.0) compared with men (27.6).

Americans in upper-income households tend to say it's best to achieve several milestones later in life than those in lower-income households do.

- **Get married:** Americans in upper-income households say 27.0 is the ideal age for this, compared with 26.2 for those in lower-income households.
- **Have a child:** 28.7 vs. 26.2
- **Retire:** 62.6 vs. 61.2

Meanwhile, U.S. adults who say religion is very important in their lives say it is best to marry and have a child at slightly younger ages, compared with those who say religion is somewhat, not too or not at all important.

- **Get married:** Americans for whom religion is *very important* say 25.7 is the ideal age for this, whereas those who place less importance on religion say it's 27.1.
- **Have a child:** 26.4 vs. 28.0

Note: Here are the questions used for this analysis, along with responses, and its methodology.

Topics

Family & Relationships, Homeownership & Renting, Marriage & Divorce, Parenthood, Retirement

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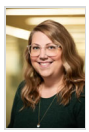

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REPORT | MARCH 26, 2025

Around the World, Many People Are Leaving Their Childhood Religions

Surveys in 36 countries find that Christianity and Buddhism have the biggest losses from 'religious switching'

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BY KIRSTEN LESAGE, KELSEY JO STARR AND WILLIAM MINER

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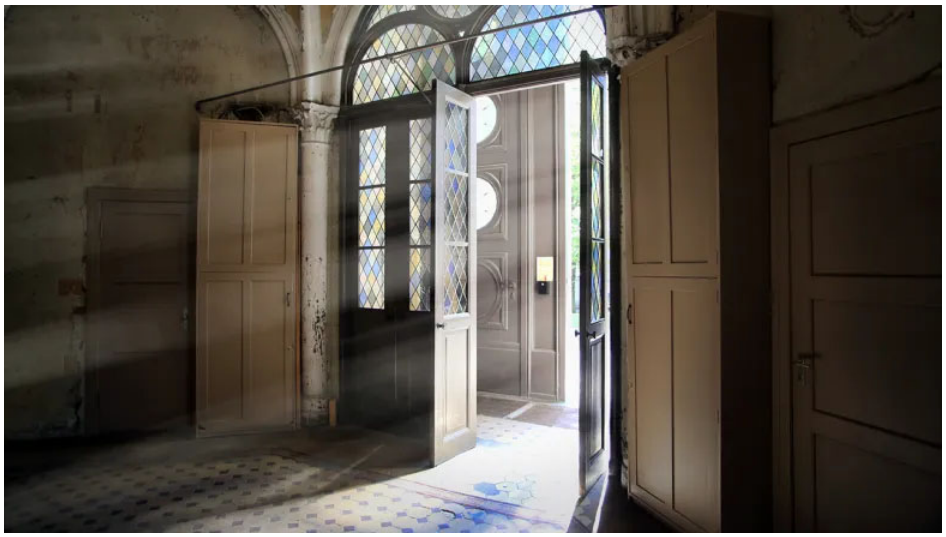


Light shines through the doors of Zionskirche, a Protestant church in Berlin. (Busà Photography/Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this analysis to examine rates of religious switching in 36 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East-North Africa region, North America and sub-Saharan Africa. The countries have a variety of historically predominant religions, including Buddhism, Christianity, Hinduism, Islam and Judaism.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Religious Landscape Study of U.S. adults conducted July 17, 2023-March 4, 2024.
"Around the World, Many People Are Leaving Their Childhood Religions"

PEW RESEARCH CENTER

For non-U.S. data, this analysis draws on nationally representative surveys of 41,503 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024. All interviews were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Interviews were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

For the United States, data comes from the 2023-2024 Religious Landscape Study (RLS). The new RLS was conducted in English and Spanish from July 17, 2023, to March 4, 2024, among a nationally representative sample of 36,908 U.S. adults. Respondents had the option of completing the survey online, on paper, or by calling a toll-free number and completing the survey by telephone with an interviewer. The RLS was made possible by The Pew Charitable Trusts, which received support from the Lilly Endowment Inc., Templeton Religion Trust, The Arthur Vining Davis Foundations and the M.J. Murdock Charitable Trust.

Here are the questions and responses used for this report, along with the survey methodology.

This analysis was produced by Pew Research Center as part of the Pew-Templeton Global Religious Futures project, which analyzes religious change and its impact on societies around the world. Funding for the Global Religious Futures project comes from The Pew Charitable Trusts and the John Templeton Foundation (grant 63095). This publication does not necessarily reflect the views of the John Templeton Foundation.

Terminology

Throughout this report, **religious switching** refers to a change between the religious group in which a person says they were raised (during their childhood) and their religious identity now (in adulthood). The rates of religious switching are based on responses to two survey questions we asked of adults ages 18 and older:

- "What is your current religion, if any?"
- "Thinking about when you were a child, in what religion were you raised, if any?"

The responses to these two questions allow us to calculate what percentage of the public has left a religious group (or "switched out") and what percentage has entered (or "switched in"). This kind of switching can take place without any formal rite or ceremony.

We have analyzed switching into and out of five widely recognized, worldwide religions to allow for consistent comparisons around the globe. Specifically, this report analyzes change between the following groups: Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Buddhism, Hinduism, other religions, religiously unaffiliated adults, and those who did not answer the question.

For example, someone who was raised Buddhist but now identifies as Christian would be considered as having switched religions – as would someone who was raised Christian but is now unaffiliated.

However, switching *within* a religious tradition, such as between Catholicism and Protestantism, is not captured in this report. (Refer to Pew Research Center's 2023-24 Religious Landscape Study for an analysis of switching in the United States that *does* count some switching within Christianity. Read "4 facts about religious switching within Judaism in Israel" for an analysis of switching within Judaism.)

Religiously unaffiliated refers to people who answer a question about their current religion (or their upbringing) by saying they are (or were raised

as) atheist, agnostic or "nothing in particular." This category is sometimes called "no religion" or "nones."

Other religions is an umbrella category. It contains a wide variety of religions that are not in the other categories and that have survey sample sizes too small to analyze separately in most countries. This includes Sikhism, Jainism, the Baha'i faith, African traditional religions, Native American religious traditions, and others.

Disaffiliation rates refer to the percentage of adults who say they were raised in a religion but are now religiously unaffiliated (or have no religion).

Net gains/losses are the differences between the percentage of survey respondents who say they were raised in a particular religious category (as children) and the percentage who identify with that same category at the time of the survey (as adults). The "net" gain or loss takes into account both sides of the equation – those who have left *and* those who have entered the group.

Retention rates show, among all the people who say they were raised in a particular religious group, the percentage who still describe themselves as belonging to that group today.

Accession rates (also called entrance rates) show, among all the people who describe themselves as belonging to a particular religious group today, the percentage who were raised in some other group.

In many countries around the world, a fifth or more of all adults have left the religious group in which they were raised. Christianity and Buddhism have experienced especially large losses from this "religious switching," while rising numbers of adults have no religious affiliation, according to Pew Research Center surveys of nearly 80,000 people in 36 countries.

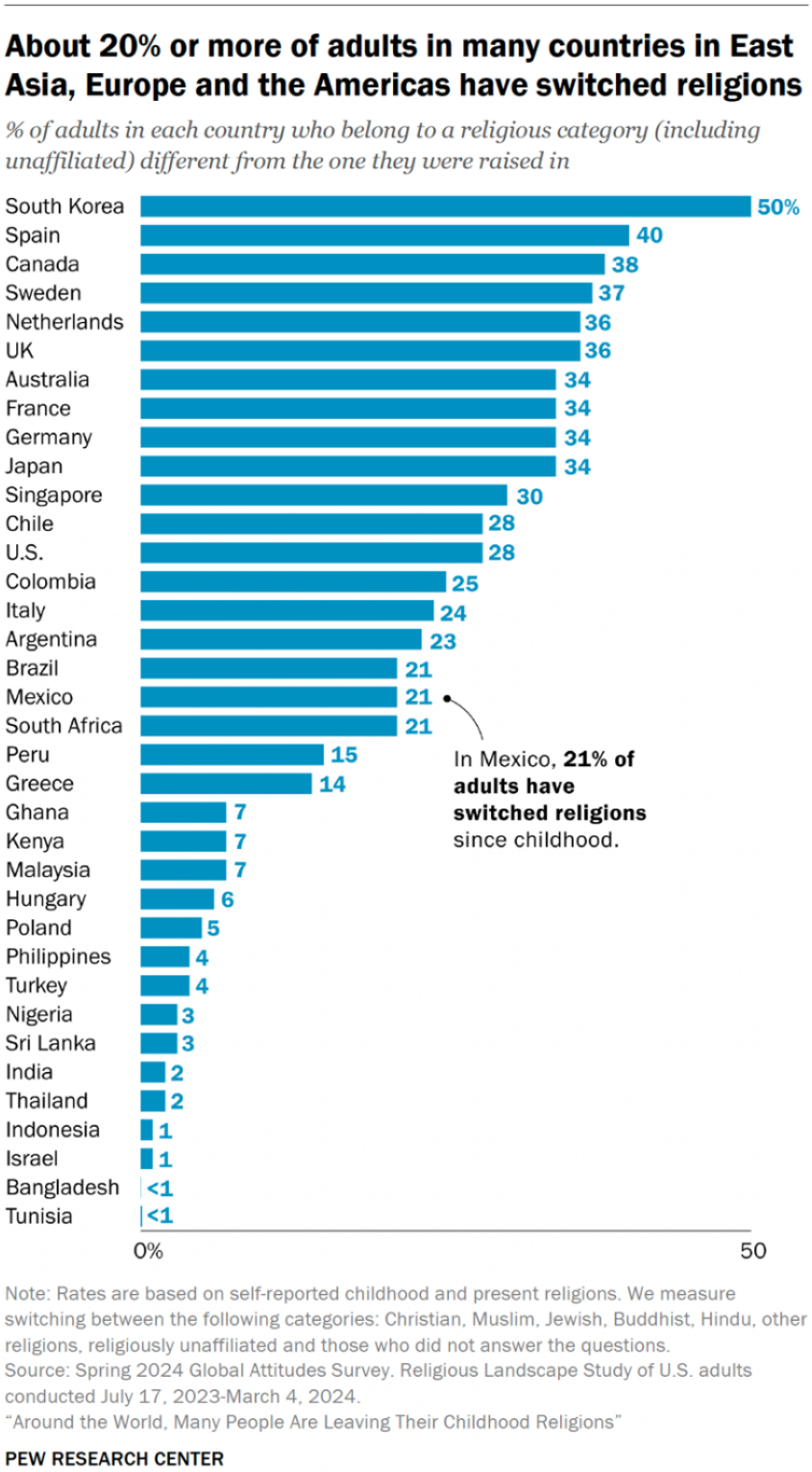
Rates of religious switching vary widely around the globe, the surveys show.

What is religious switching?

Throughout this report, **religious switching** refers to a change between the religious group in which a person says they were raised (during their childhood) and their religious identity now (in adulthood).

We use the term religious switching instead of “conversion” because the changes can take place in many directions – including from having been raised in a religion to being unaffiliated.

We count changes *between* large religious categories (such as from Buddhist to Christian, or from Hindu to unaffiliated) but not switching *within* a world religion (such as from one Christian denomination to another). Refer to the Terminology section for details.



In some countries, changing religions is very rare. In India, Israel, Nigeria and Thailand, 95% or more of adults say they still belong to the religious group in which they were raised.

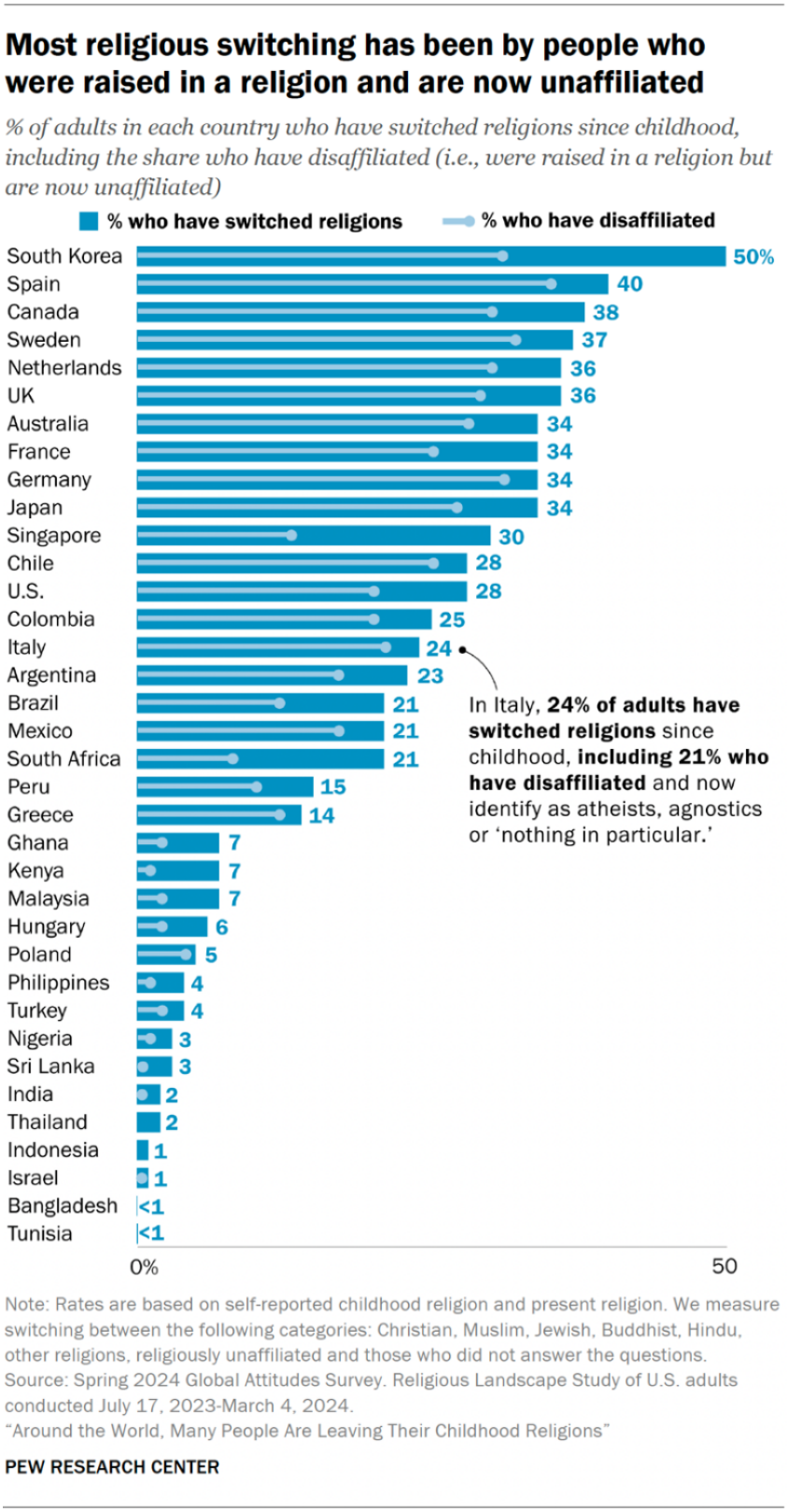
But across East Asia, Western Europe, North America and South America, switching is fairly common. For example, 50% of adults in South Korea, 36% in the Netherlands,

28% in the United States and 21% in Brazil no longer identify with their childhood religion.

Which religions are people switching to?

Most of the movement has been into the category we call religiously unaffiliated, which consists of people who answer a question about their religion by saying they are atheists, agnostics or "nothing in particular."

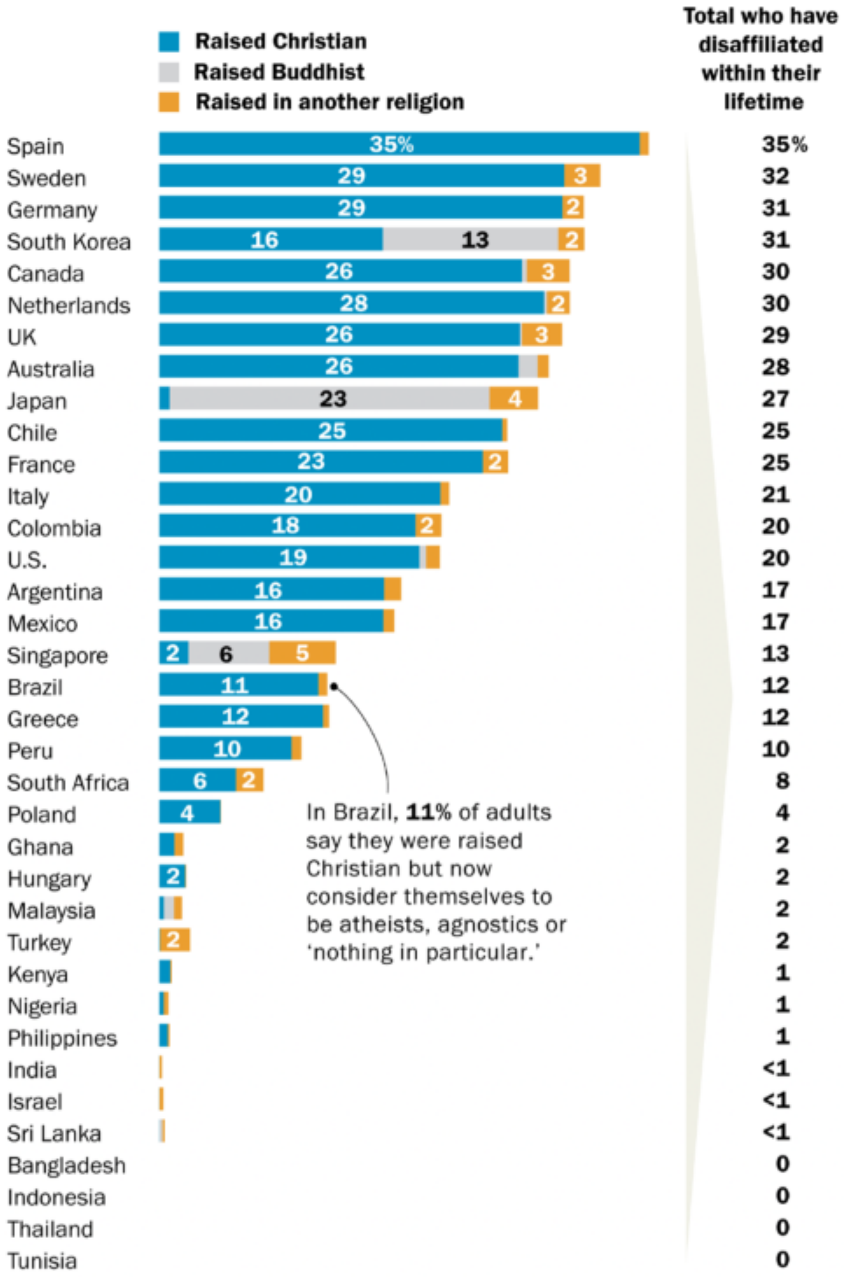
In other words, **most of the switching is *disaffiliation* – people leaving the religion of their childhood and no longer identifying with *any* religion.**



Many of these people were raised as Christians. For example, 29% of adults in Sweden say they were raised Christian but now describe themselves religiously as atheists, agnostics or "nothing in particular."

Most religious disaffiliation is from Christianity

% of adults in each country who say they were ___ but now identify as religiously unaffiliated (atheist, agnostic or "nothing in particular")



Note: "Raised in another religion" in this chart includes respondents who say they were raised Muslim, Jewish, Hindu, some other religion, or did not state their childhood religion. Figures may not add to subtotals indicated due to rounding.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Religious Landscape Study of U.S. adults conducted July 17, 2023-March 4, 2024.
"Around the World, Many People Are Leaving Their Childhood Religions"

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Buddhism also is losing adherents through disaffiliation in some countries. For example, 23% of adults surveyed in Japan and 13% in South Korea say they were raised as Buddhists but don't identify with any religion today.

However, not all switching is away from religion. Some people move in the opposite direction. Of the 36 countries surveyed, **South Korea has the highest share of people who say they were raised with no affiliation but have a religion today (9%).** Most of them (6% of all South Korean adults) say they had no religious upbringing and are now Christian.

Additionally, about one-in-ten or more adults in Singapore (13%), South Africa (12%) and South Korea (11%) have switched between two religions.

While these figures reflect religious trends in the 36 countries included in the survey, they are not necessarily representative of the entire world's population. Christianity – the world's largest and most geographically widespread religion, by Pew Research Center's estimates – is either the current majority faith or historically has been a predominant religion in 25 of the countries surveyed.

Islam, the world's second-largest religion, is a historically predominant religion in six of the 36 countries surveyed: Bangladesh, Indonesia, Malaysia, Nigeria, Tunisia and Turkey. (We consider *both* Christianity and Islam to predominate in Nigeria, which is closely divided religiously.)

Buddhism has been predominant in five other countries surveyed: Japan, Singapore, Sri Lanka, South Korea and Thailand. (We also count South Korea as having *two* predominant religions, Buddhism and Christianity.)

Hinduism and Judaism are each the predominant religion in just one country surveyed (India and Israel, respectively).

Other questions answered in this Overview:

- Which religious groups have experienced the largest losses from religious switching?
- Which religious group has gained the most from religious switching?

- Are there differences in religious switching rates by age, education or gender?

Jump ahead to:

- Switching into and out of Christianity
- Switching into and out of the religiously unaffiliated group
- Switching into and out of Buddhism
- Switching into and out of Islam
- Switching into and out of Hinduism
- Switching into and out of Judaism

Other factors driving religious change ⊖

This report focuses on religious switching. But switching is far from the only factor driving changes in the size of religious groups around the world. Other factors include migration rates (how many people in each religious group are moving into and out of a particular place); age structure (variations in the demographic makeup of religious groups by age and sex); fertility rates (the number of children born to women in different religious groups); and mortality rates (whether people in some religious groups live longer than others).

For example, across sub-Saharan Africa, the numbers of both Christians and Muslims are rising, largely because of high birth rates rather than switching. In the United States, the size of Muslim, Buddhist and Hindu populations are growing, due in large part to migration. And in some Western European countries, more Christians are now dying than being born each year, reflecting the continent's low fertility rates.

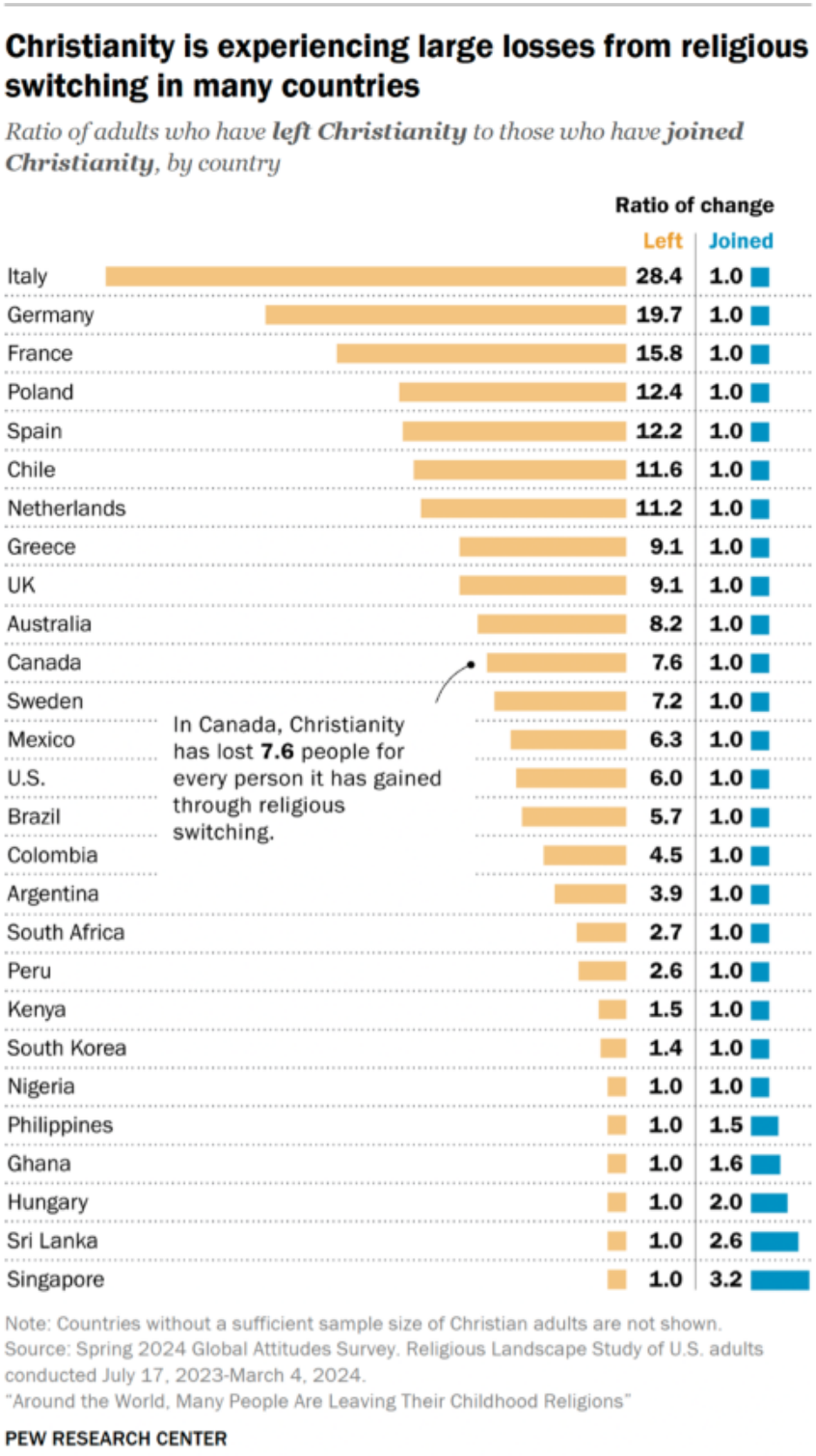
Pew Research Center has published several global demographic studies looking at the interplay between all these factors and projecting the future growth rates of major world religions under various scenarios, including:

- "The Religious Composition of the World's Migrants"
- "Modeling the Future of Religion in America"
- "Europe's Growing Muslim Population"
- "The Changing Global Religious Landscape"
- "The Future of World Religions: Population Growth Projections, 2010-2050"

Which religious groups have experienced the largest losses from religious switching?

Another way of analyzing religious switching is to examine *net* gains and losses – how many people have entered and how many have left each religious group.

Net gains and losses can be expressed as a ratio: For every person who has left, how many people have joined a particular religion?



In most of the countries surveyed, Christianity has the highest ratios of people leaving to people joining – the largest net losses.

In Germany, for example, this ratio among Christians is 19.7 to 1.0, meaning *there are nearly 20 Germans* who say they were raised as Christians in childhood but don't consider themselves

Christian today *for every one German* who has become a Christian after being raised in another world religion or in no religion.

In a handful of countries, though, Christianity is making small gains from religious switching. In Singapore, for instance, the ratio among Christians is 1.0 to 3.2. For every Singaporean who has left Christianity, about three others have become Christians.

And in a few other places, roughly equal numbers of people are leaving and joining Christianity. For example, the ratio in Nigeria is 1.0 to 1.0.

(Read more about switching into and out of Christianity in Chapter 1.)

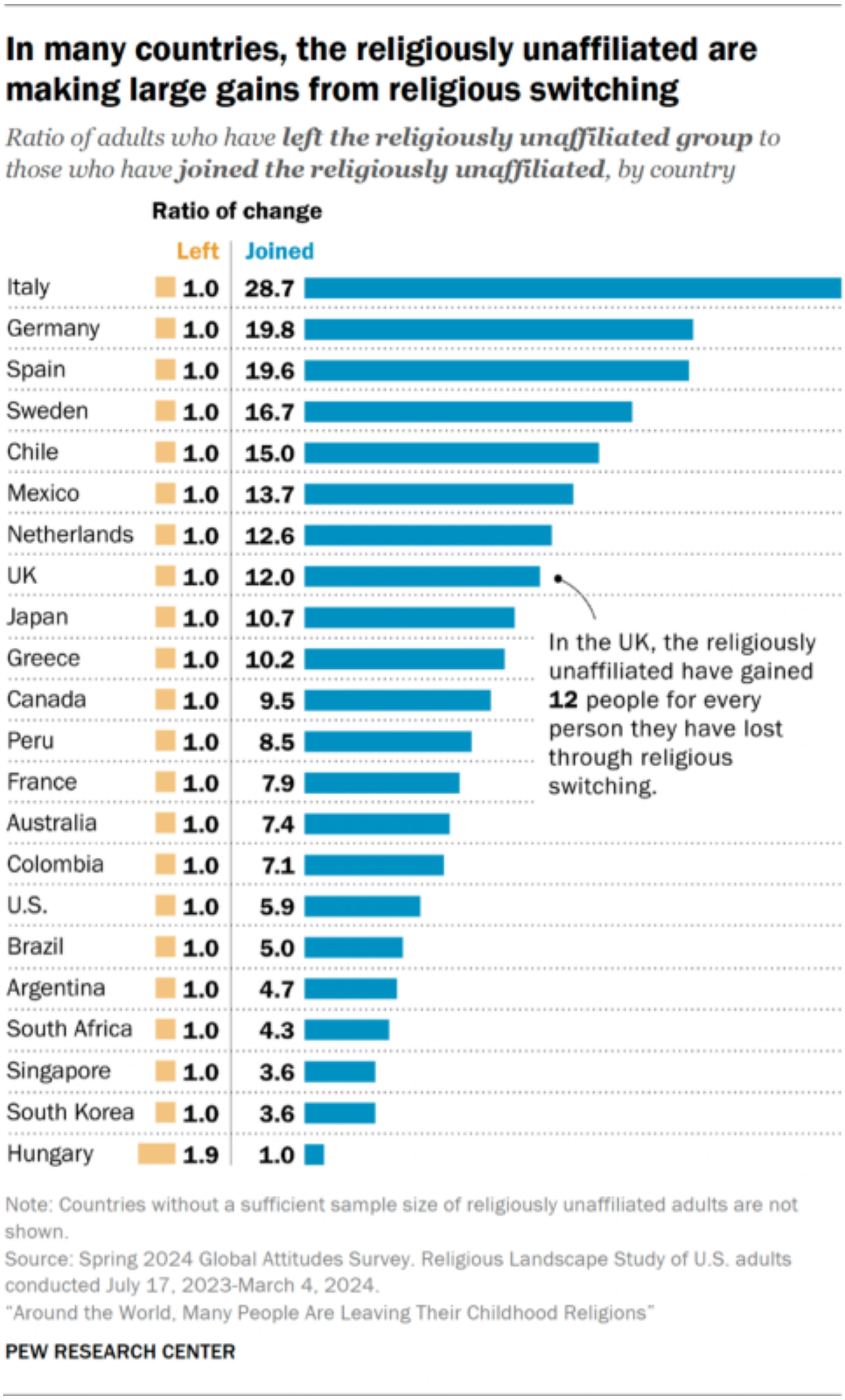
The survey also shows that **Buddhism is experiencing large losses from religious switching – mostly disaffiliation – in a few countries, such as Japan, Singapore and South Korea.**

However, the leaving-to-joining ratios are not as high as those for Christianity. For instance, in Japan – the country with the largest percentage of people who say they were raised Buddhist but are no longer Buddhists – the leaving-to-joining ratio among Buddhists is 11.7 to 1.0.

(Read more about switching into and out of Buddhism in Chapter 3.)

Which religious group has gained the most from religious switching?

The category that has experienced the largest net gains from switching is the religiously unaffiliated.



In countries with substantial numbers of people who describe themselves as having no religion – sometimes called "nones" – many more survey respondents have become unaffiliated than have joined a religion after being raised without one.

In Italy, for example, the ratio of leaving to joining among the unaffiliated is 1.0 to 28.7. For every person who was raised without a religious affiliation but who now has a religion, more than 28 people say they were raised in a religion but no longer have one.

However, in Hungary, this is not the case. For every Hungarian who has become religiously unaffiliated, nearly two others say they were raised without a religion but now identify with one (a leaving-to-joining ratio of 1.9 to 1.0). Most of the Hungarians who have taken on a religion after being raised without one are now Christians.

(Read more about switching out of the religiously unaffiliated category in Chapter 2.)

Are there differences in religious switching rates by age, education or gender?

Age

In most countries surveyed, roughly equal percentages of younger and older adults have switched religions. For example, in Singapore, 29% of adults between the ages of 18 and 34 say they belong to a religious group that is different from the one in which they were raised, as do 29% of adults older than 50.

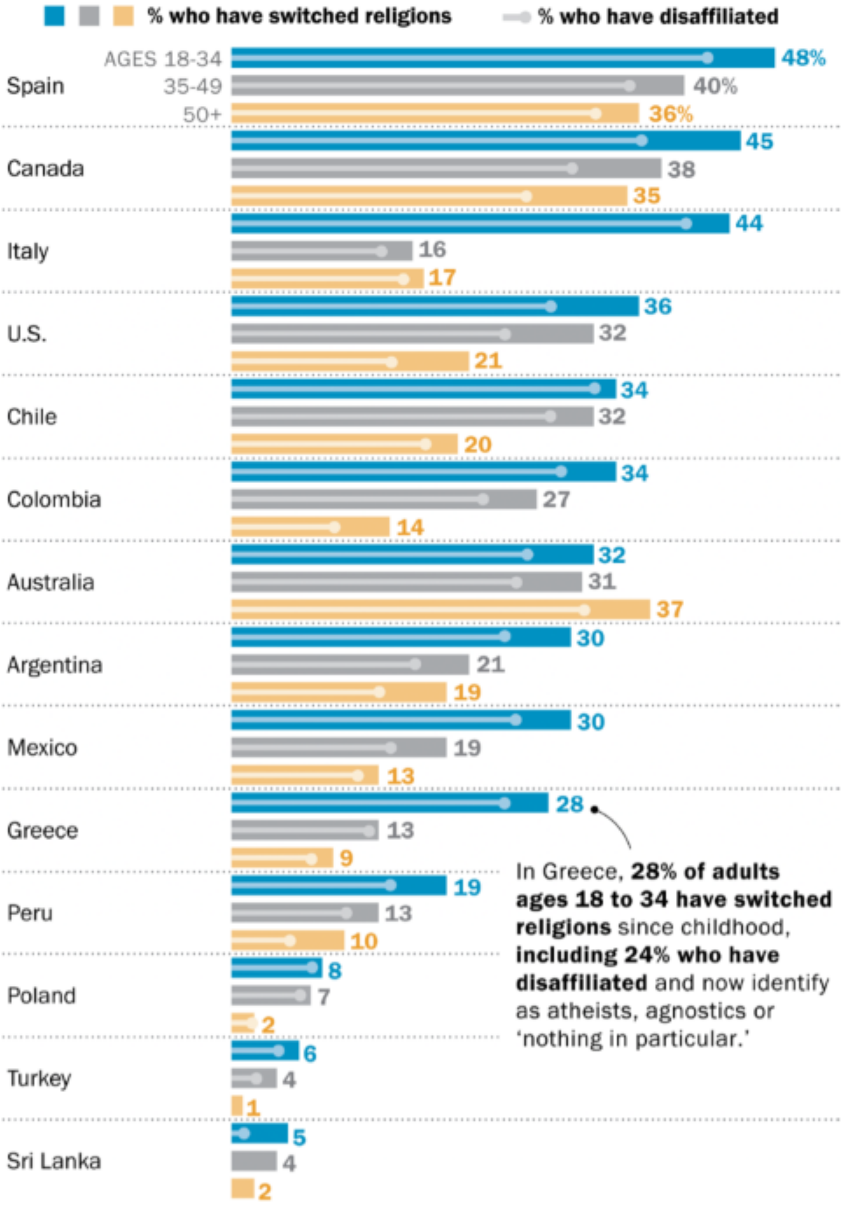
However, **in 13 countries – including nearly all Latin American nations surveyed, as well as several countries in Europe and North America – adults under 35 are more likely than adults ages 50 and older to have switched religions.**

In Spain, for instance, 48% of 18- to 34-year-olds have switched religions since childhood, compared with 36% of adults ages 50 and older. And in Colombia, 34% of the youngest adults have switched religions, compared with 14% of the oldest adults.

In Australia, however, younger adults are slightly *less* likely than older adults to have switched religions (32% vs. 37%).

Younger adults are more likely than older adults in some places to change religions and to disaffiliate

% of adults, grouped by age and place, who have switched religions since childhood, including the share who have disaffiliated (i.e., were raised in a religion but are now unaffiliated)



Note: Rates are based on self-reported childhood religion and present religion. We measure switching between the following categories: Christian, Muslim, Jewish, Buddhist, Hindu, other religions, religiously unaffiliated, and those who did not answer the questions. Only places with significant differences (in religious switching) between the youngest and oldest age groups are shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Religious Landscape Study of U.S. adults conducted July 17, 2023-March 4, 2024.
"Around the World, Many People Are Leaving Their Childhood Religions"

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In most cases, the bulk of the switching in all age groups is *disaffiliation* – much of which is people leaving Christianity. But the rates of disaffiliation are often higher among young adults.

In Colombia, for example, 26% of 18- to 34-year-olds say they were raised as Christians but no longer identify with any religion, compared with 9% of Colombians ages 50 and older.

Because the survey questions pick up changes that have happened *at any time* since childhood, it is not possible to know whether the adults older than 50 who have disaffiliated did so recently or long ago, perhaps when they were in their teens or early 20s. Some older adults may have disaffiliated when they were young and then came back to a religion as they aged.

In short, these age patterns *might* be signs of secularization, indicating that countries like Spain, Canada, Italy and the U.S. are gradually becoming less religious. However, it's also possible that some of the age differences in religious affiliation revealed in a single survey (or multiple surveys conducted at the same point in time) could result from people becoming more religious as they grow older.[1]

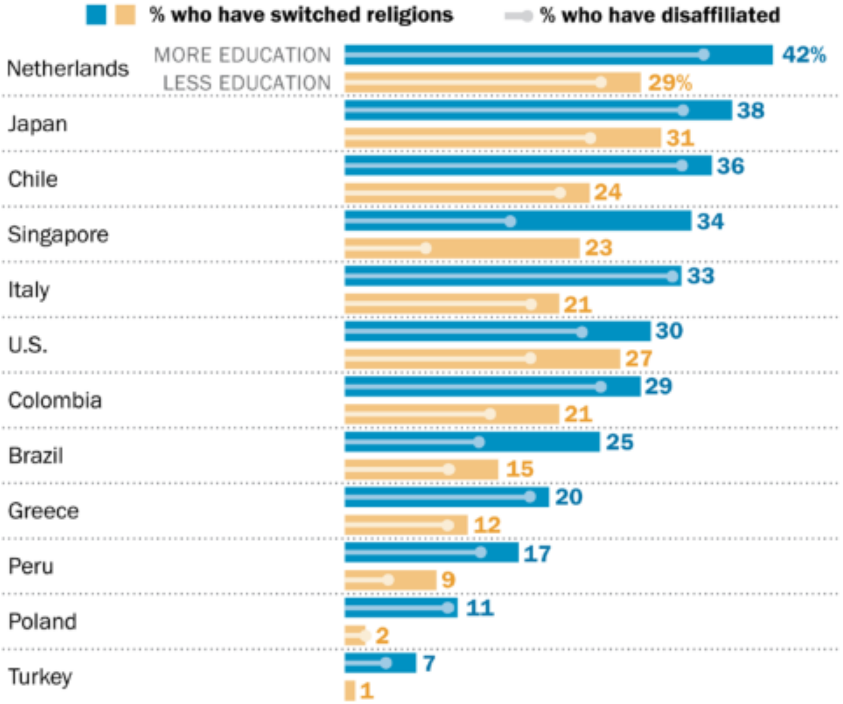
Education

In most countries, rates of religious switching don't vary a great deal between people with different levels of education.

However, in 12 of the 36 countries surveyed, people with more education tend to have higher rates of religious switching.

In some countries, people with more education are more likely to have changed religions and to have disaffiliated

% of adults, grouped by education and place, who have switched religions since childhood, including the share who have disaffiliated (i.e., were raised in a religion but are now unaffiliated)



Note: Rates are based on self-reported childhood religion and present religion. We measure switching between the following categories: Christian, Muslim, Jewish, Buddhist, Hindu, other religions, religiously unaffiliated, and those who did not answer the questions. Only places with significant differences (in religious switching) between people with differing levels of education are shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Religious Landscape Study of U.S. adults conducted July 17, 2023-March 4, 2024.
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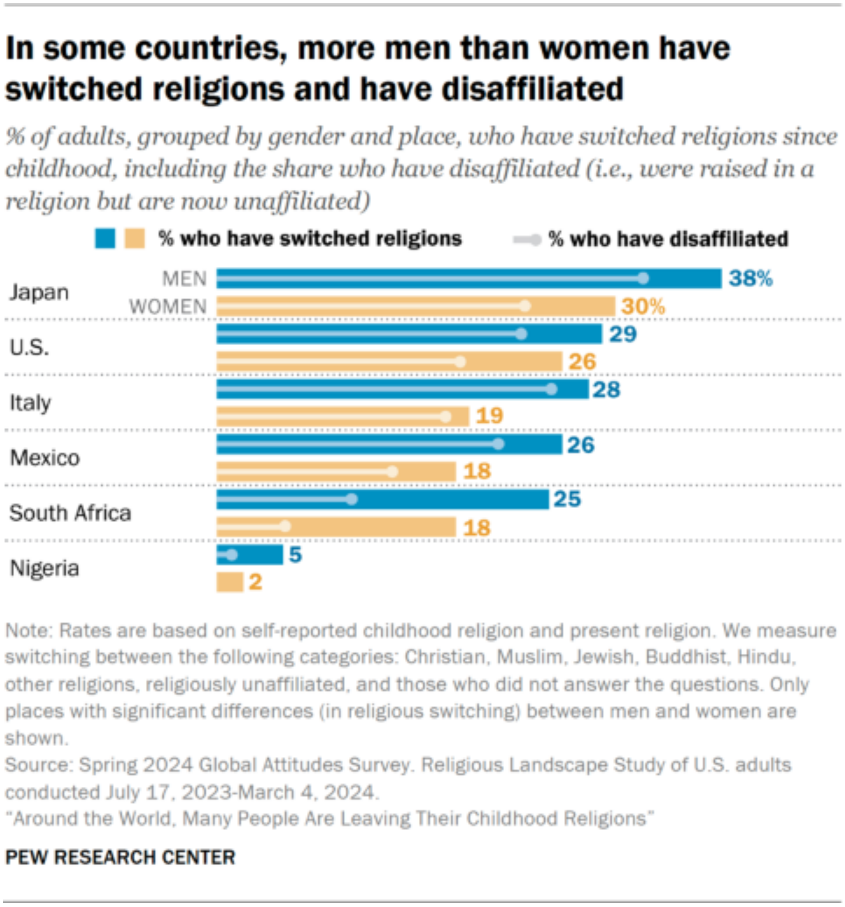
Once again, **most of the switching by people at each level of education is *disaffiliation*** – in particular, people who say they were raised in a religious tradition (often as Christians or Buddhists) but no longer identify with any religion.

The Netherlands displays the largest differences in switching rates by education: 42% of Dutch adults with higher levels of education (a postsecondary degree or higher) have changed religions since childhood, compared with 29% of Dutch adults with lower levels of education.[2]

Gender

Likewise, in most countries surveyed, roughly equal percentages of women and men have changed religions. For instance, in South Korea – the country with the largest share of adults who have switched religions – 51% of women and 50% of men have changed religions over the course of their lives.

But in six countries, there are statistically significant differences in switching rates by gender, with men more likely than women to have switched religions.



And, as with the differences by age and education, much of the switching among both men and women is disaffiliation – especially from Christianity or, in Japan, from Buddhism.[3]

Other key findings in this report

- Across the countries surveyed, most people who currently identify as **Christian** were raised as Christians. Among the smaller numbers who have *become* Christian after being brought up in a different way, most say they were raised as

Buddhists or religiously unaffiliated. (Chapter 1 discusses switching into and out of Christianity.)

- Most adults who are now **religiously unaffiliated** say they were raised in some religion – in many cases, Christianity or Buddhism. (Chapter 2 covers switching into and out of the unaffiliated category.)
- In some countries, **Buddhism** has declined due to religious switching, while in other countries, it has remained relatively stable. (Chapter 3 examines switching into and out of Buddhism.)
- Very small percentages of the overall adult population have left or joined **Islam** in most of the countries surveyed. (Chapter 4 discusses switching into and out of Islam.)
- Most people who were raised **Jewish** in Israel and the U.S. still identify this way today, resulting in high Jewish retention rates in both countries. (Chapter 6 discusses switching into and out of Judaism.)
- Nearly all people who were raised **Hindu** in India and Bangladesh still identify as Hindu today. (Chapter 5 covers switching into and out of Hinduism.)

Next: Religious switching into and out of Christianity

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RECOMMENDED CITATION:

Lesage, Kirsten, Kelsey Starr and William Miner. 2025. “Around the World, Many People Are Leaving Their Childhood Religions.” Pew Research Center. doi: 10.58094/xt5h-b241.

1. For more discussion of age patterns in religious beliefs, behaviors and identities, read Pew Research Center’s report “The Age Gap in Religion Around the World.” ↩

2. For more on the relationship between educational attainment levels and religion, read Pew Research Center's report "Religion and Education Around the World." ↩

3. For more discussion of gender differences in religious affiliation, beliefs and practices, read Pew Research Center's report "The Gender Gap in Religion Around the World." ↩

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Free Expression Seen as Important Globally, but Not Everyone Thinks Their Country Has Press, Speech and Internet Freedoms

Made-up news and information seen as pervasive across the globe

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BY JACOB POUSHTER, MARIA SMERKOVICH, MOIRA FAGAN AND ANDREW PROZOROVSKY

Table of Contents

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How we did this

This Pew Research Center analysis focuses on public opinion of free speech, freedom of the press and freedom on the internet in 35 countries across the Asia-Pacific region, Europe, Latin America, the Middle East-North Africa region, North America and sub-Saharan Africa.

Views of the importance of these various freedoms are examined in the context of long-term trend data. The report also explores people's perceptions of how free they are to express themselves and use the internet without restrictions and how free the media are to report the news, as well as people's concerns about the spread of misinformation in their country.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey; surveys of U.S. adults conducted Feb. 24-March 2, 2025, and March 24-30, 2025.
"Free Expression Seen as Important Globally, but Not Everyone Thinks Their Country Has Press, Speech and Internet Freedoms"

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For non-U.S. data, this report draws on nationally representative surveys of 40,494 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode probability-based online panel.

In the United States, we surveyed 3,600 adults from April 1 to April 7, 2024; 5,123 adults from Feb. 24 to March 2, 2025; and 3,605 adults from March 24 to March 30, 2025. Everyone who took part in this survey is a member of the Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), a group of people

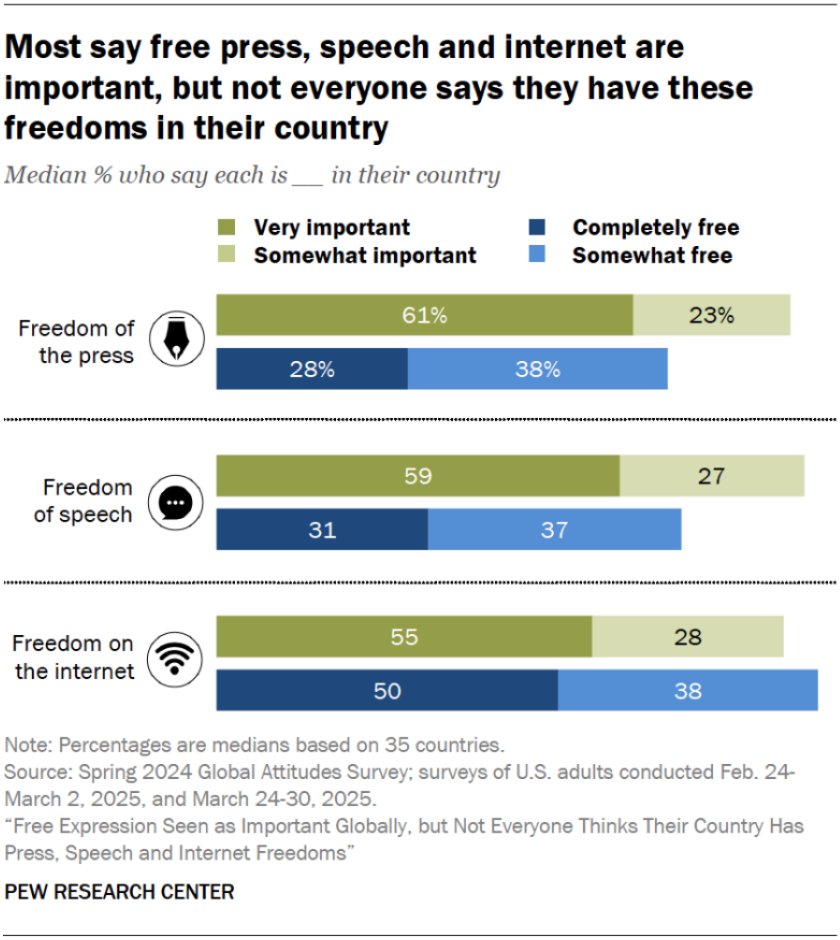
recruited through national, random sampling of residential addresses who have agreed to take surveys regularly. This kind of recruitment gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection. Surveys were conducted either online or by telephone with a live interviewer. The survey is weighted to be representative of the U.S. adult population by gender, race, ethnicity, partisan affiliation, education and other factors. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

To compare educational groups across countries, we standardize education levels based on the UN's International Standard Classification of Education (ISCED).

Prior to 2024, combined totals were based on rounded topline figures. For all reports beginning in 2024, totals are based on unrounded topline figures, so combined totals might be different than in previous years. Refer to the 2024 topline to see our new rounding procedures applied to past years' data.

Here are the questions used for the report, along with responses, and the survey methodology.

Amid global debates about press freedom, free speech and freedom on the internet, new surveys of 35 countries show there is a disconnect between how people rate the importance of these freedoms and how free they actually feel to express themselves.



Overall, a median of 61% of adults across 35 countries say having **freedom of the press** in their country is very important, with another 23% saying it is somewhat important. But only 28% say the media are *completely free* to report the news in their country, with an additional 38% saying the media are somewhat free.

What is a freedom gap?

We use the term "press freedom gap" to describe the difference between the share of people who say free media without censorship are important to have in their country, and the share who say media in their country are actually free to report the news. Similarly, we use "speech freedom gap" and "internet freedom gap" in reference to questions on those topics.

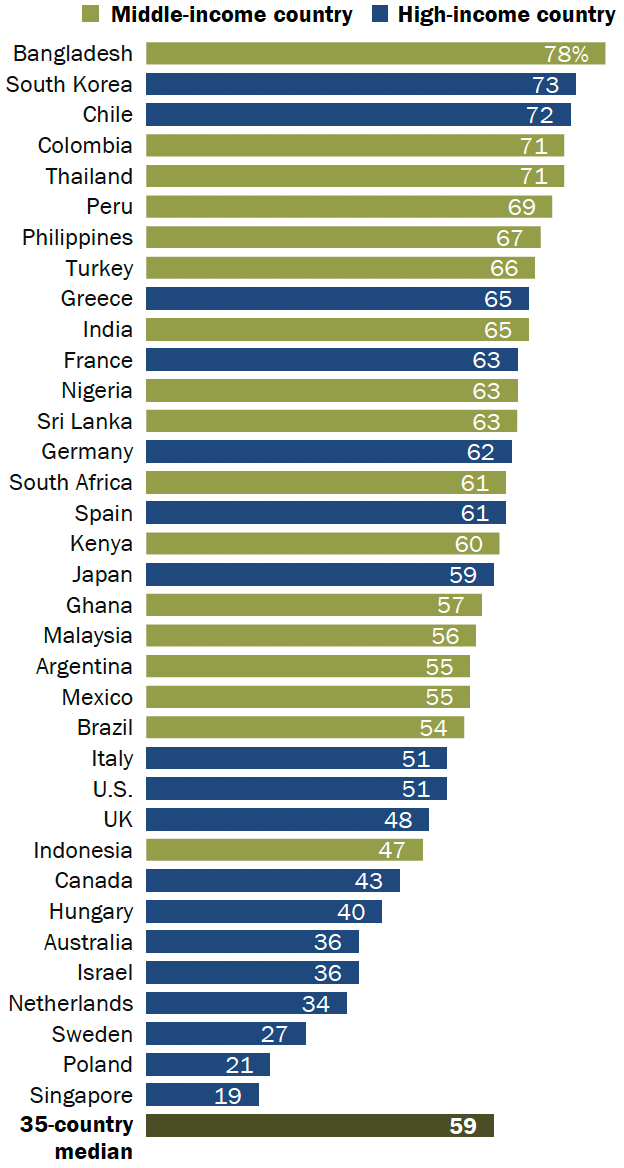
Similarly, a median of 59% globally say having **freedom of speech** in their country is very important, while 31% say speech is completely free where they live. This so-called "freedom gap" – where the share of people who value free speech is larger than the

share who believe they have it – appears in 31 of the 35 countries surveyed.

On the subject of **freedom on the internet,** a median of 55% say the ability to use the internet freely is very important, while 50% say they are completely free to use the internet in their country.

Majorities in many countries see made-up news as a very big problem

*% who say made-up news and information is a **very big problem** in their country*



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Majorities in over half the nations surveyed also say **made-up news and information is a very big problem** in their country.

Concerns about fabricated or manipulated news are pervasive across all regions but generally more intense in countries

classified as middle-income. Still, majorities see made-up news and information as a very big problem in the high-income countries of South Korea (73%), Chile (72%), Greece (65%), France (63%), Germany (62%), Spain (61%) and Japan (59%).

(We surveyed 17 middle-income countries and 18 high-income countries. Refer to the Appendix for a classification of these nations.)

Furthermore, in every country surveyed except Singapore, a majority of adults say that made-up news and information is *at least a moderately big problem*.

These perceptions are tied to people's overall satisfaction with democracy. In many of the countries surveyed, those who express the most concern over made-up news and information are less likely to say they are satisfied with the state of their nation's democracy.

We mostly observe this pattern in high-income countries like Canada, Greece, Hungary, Israel, Sweden and the United Kingdom – several of which have seen an overall decline in satisfaction with democracy in recent years.

Dissatisfaction with democracy during the 2024 year of global elections

Voters in more than 60 countries went to the polls in 2024. In many of these countries, incumbents lost or suffered major electoral setbacks. Frustration with the way representative democracy is working played a key role in these elections. For more, read our data essay "Global Elections in 2024: What We Learned in a Year of Political Disruption."

Views of the importance of free speech, free press and internet freedom are also linked with concerns about fabricated news. In many countries, people who say these freedoms are very important are more likely to consider made-up news and information a very big problem where they live. For more, read Chapter 1 of this report.

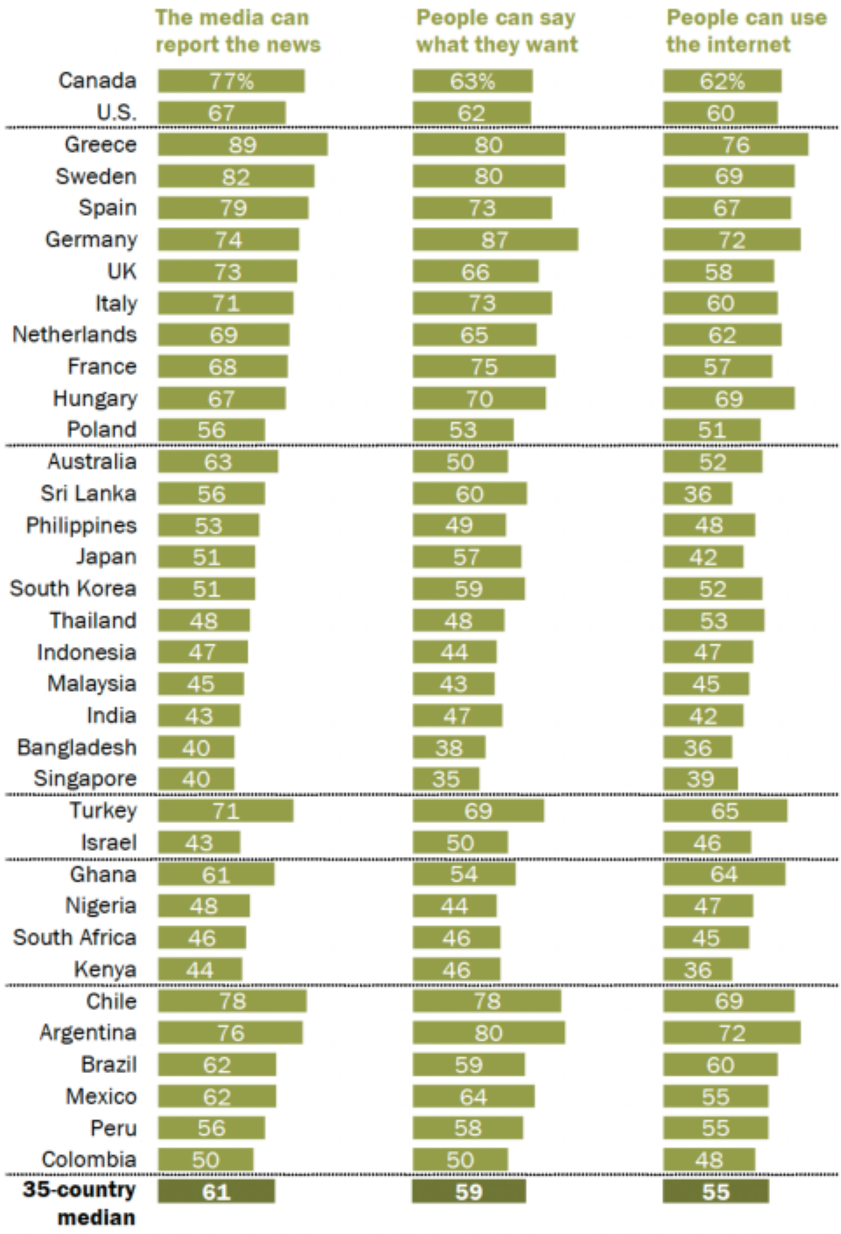
The rest of this overview explores:

- Views on the importance of free press, free speech and freedom on the internet
- Factors that influence concerns about censorship
- How free people feel they are
- Attitudes on freedom of expression in Latin America and the U.S.

How important are free press, free speech and freedom on the internet?

Majorities in many countries see freedom of the media, speech and internet as very important

*% who say it is **very important** that ___ without state/government censorship in their country*



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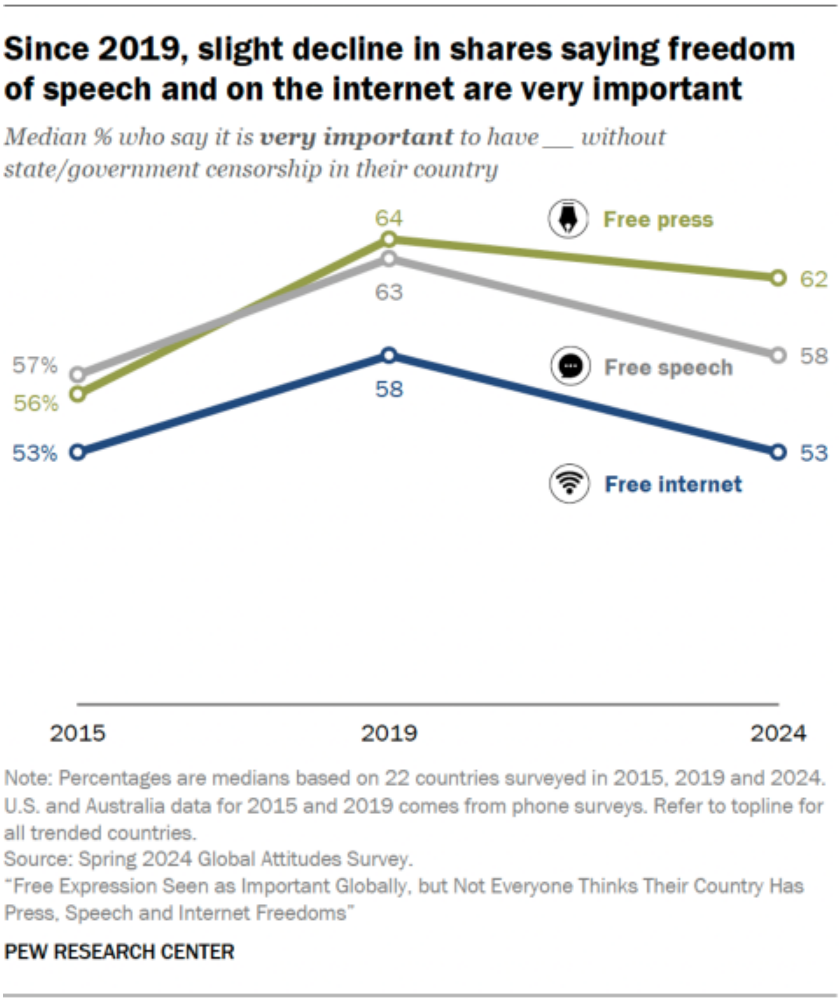
Generally, people around the world believe it's at least somewhat important that the media can report the news, that people can say what they want, and that people can use the internet without state or government censorship. But there is more regional variation among the shares who see these freedoms as *very* important.

People in many European and Latin American countries tend to place more importance on these freedoms, while people throughout Asia and sub-Saharan Africa consider them somewhat less important. Of the Middle East-North African populations surveyed, Turks are more likely than Israelis to see these freedoms as very important.

Trends over time



Across 22 countries surveyed in 2015, 2019 and 2024, the median percentage who see freedom of the press as very important is 62% in 2024. This is similar to the 64% median measured in 2019, but up from 56% in 2015. (The 2024 medians were calculated with U.S. data collected in April 2024, though our most recent U.S. data is from March 2025.)

The median percentage who see free speech as very important is 58% in the 2024 survey, down from 63% in 2019.

Similarly, the median share saying freedom on the internet is very important is 53% in 2024, compared with 58% in 2019.

Global attitudes toward both of these freedoms in 2024 are similar to what they were in 2015.

By country

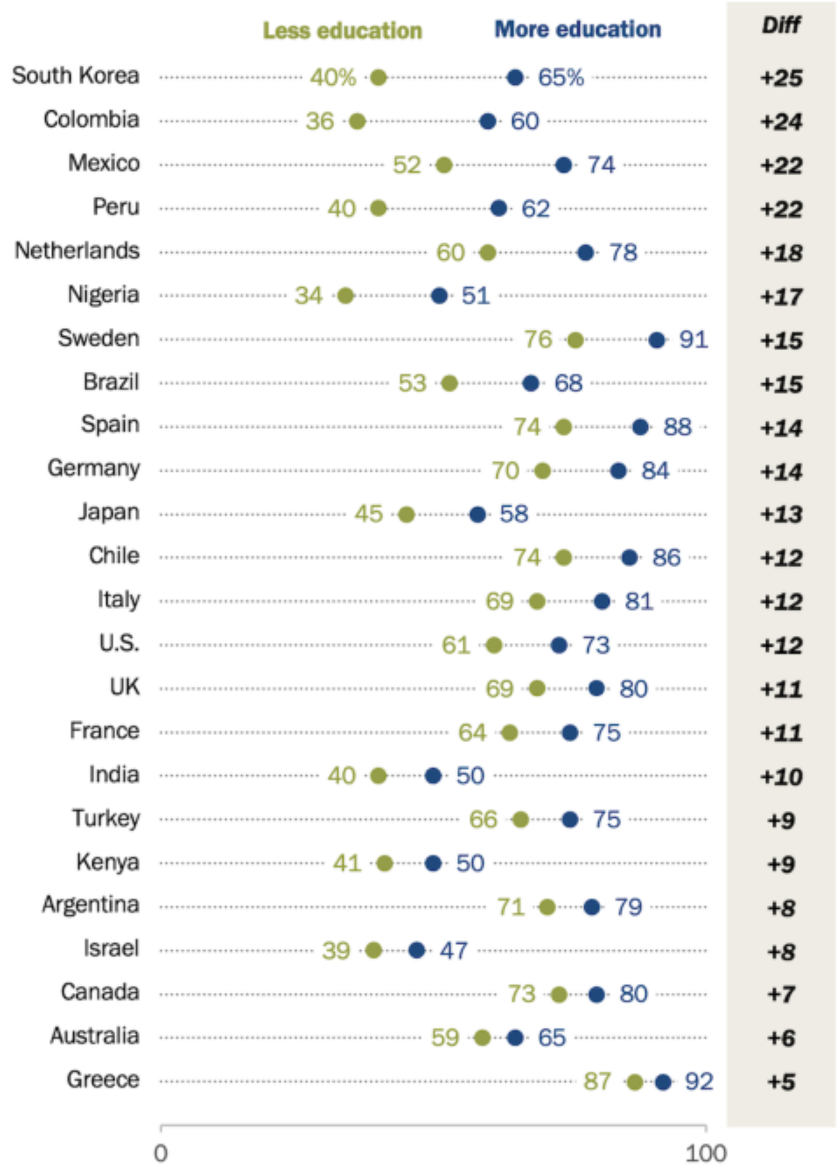
Since 2015, the share of adults saying a free press is very important has increased in Australia, Canada, France, Indonesia, Japan, Italy, Turkey and the UK. The jump in Turkey is especially notable, from 45% in 2015 to 71% in 2024. But in Brazil, Kenya, Nigeria, Peru and South Africa, the share who see freedom of the press as very important has declined since 2015.

In some countries, there have also been changes in views on the importance of free speech and freedom on the internet. For more, read Chapter 2 of this report.

Factors related to concerns about censorship

Views of press freedom's value vary by education

*% who say it is **very important** that the media can report the news without state/government censorship in their country, by education*



Note: Only statistically significant differences are shown. In Argentina, Brazil, India, Israel, Mexico and South Korea, those with less education were less likely to provide a response.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey; survey of U.S. adults conducted March 24-30, 2025.
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In 24 of the 35 countries surveyed, **adults with more education** are especially likely to say having media that can report the news without state interference is very important.

Educational differences in views of press freedom are present across various regions, but they are especially large in South

Korea, Colombia, Mexico and Peru.

Additionally, attitudes toward freedom on the internet are connected to social media usage, which we measured in 20 primarily middle-income countries. In several of them, **social media users** are more likely than non-users to believe that the ability to use the internet without censorship is very important.

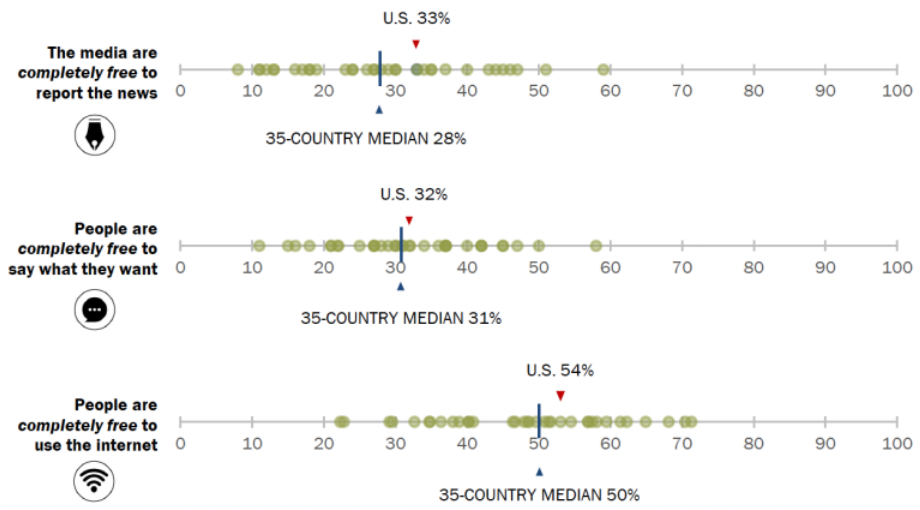
How free do people feel?

The share of people who say the media are completely free to report the news, that people are completely free to say what they want, or that people are completely free to use the internet varies across the countries surveyed.

But globally, a median of 28% say that the media are completely free where they live, while a median of 31% say that people have complete freedom of speech in their country. Larger shares (50% median) say that people are completely free to use the internet.

People are more likely to say they have complete freedom on the internet in their country than total freedom of speech or press

% who say that ___ without state/government censorship in their country



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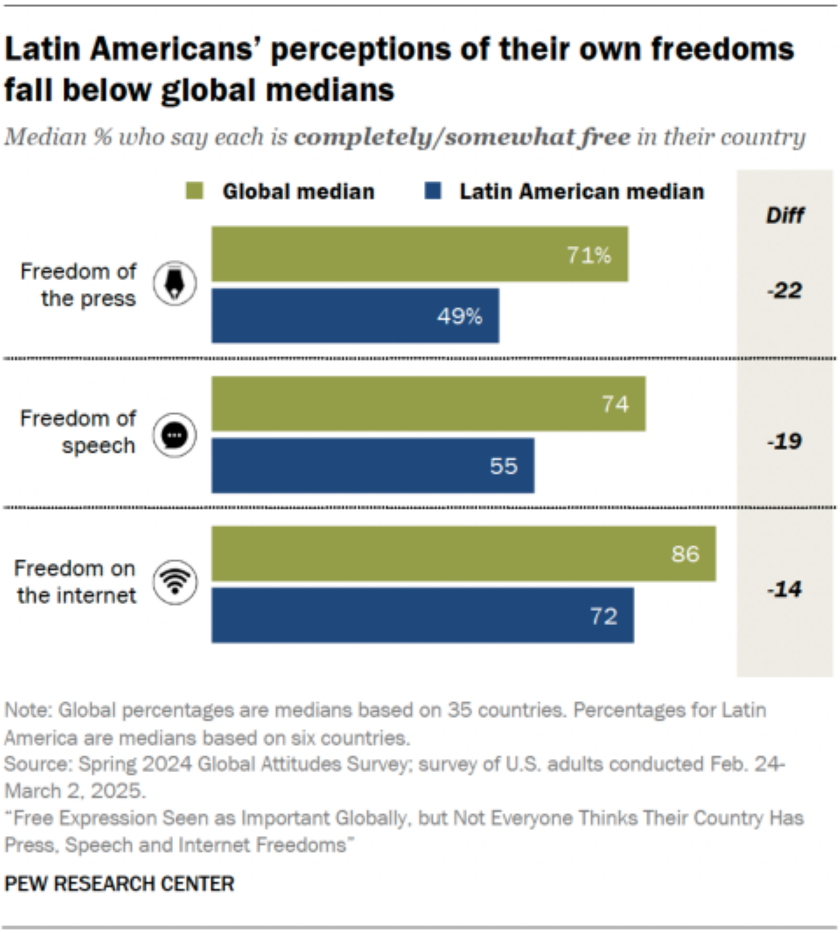
In many countries, perceptions of freedom are tied to satisfaction with democracy. Those who think the media in their country are completely free to report the news are more likely than those who

say otherwise to approve of the way their democracy is working. The same is true for those who believe that people in their country are completely free to say what they want or to use the internet without government censorship – they rate their democracy more positively than people who say these activities are less free.

Related: *What Can Improve Democracy?*

Finally, social media users are more likely than non-users to say they have complete freedom on the internet in 12 countries. (We ask about social media use in a total of 20 countries, most of which are middle-income.) For more, read Chapter 3 of this report.

Attitudes on freedom of expression in Latin America and the U.S.

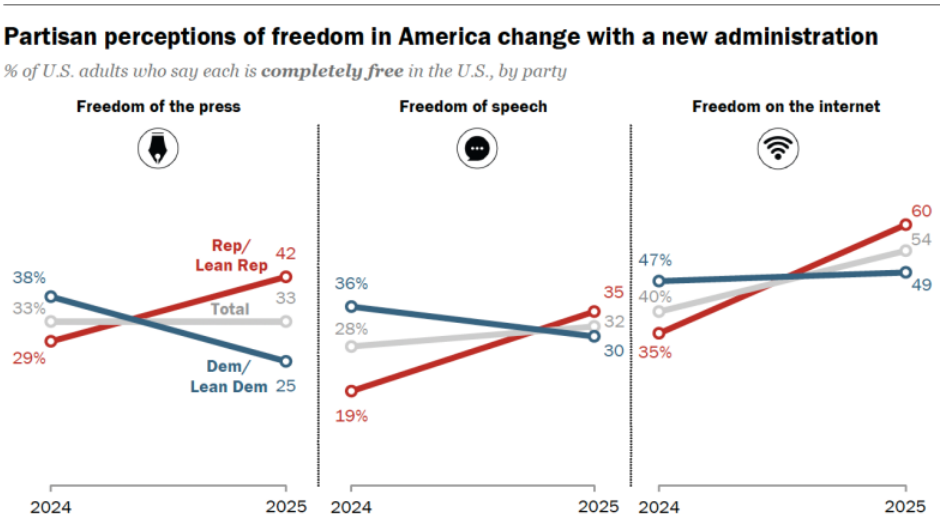


Compared with global medians, **Latin American countries** have relatively small shares saying their press, speech and use of the internet are completely or somewhat free from censorship.

The difference is especially large on perceptions of press freedom. A median of 49% of adults across the six Latin American countries surveyed (Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Mexico and Peru) say that the press are completely or somewhat free to report the news without censorship in their country. By comparison, a median of 71% say this across all 35 countries surveyed.

In the **United States**, we asked about freedom of the press, freedom of speech and freedom on the internet as part of our 35-country survey in spring 2024 (fielded in the U.S. in early April). But we asked these same questions again in February and March 2025 to see how Americans' opinions may have shifted during the second administration of President Donald Trump:

- There has been very little change in Americans' views of the importance of press freedom. But there has been a slight uptick in the share who say free speech is very important (from 56% in 2024 to 62% this year) and the share who say this about internet freedom (from 54% to 60%).
- When it comes to how free Americans feel they actually are on these measures, more than half (54%) now say people in the U.S. are completely free to use the internet – up from 40% in 2024. Similarly, 32% now say people in the U.S. are completely free to say what they want, up from 28% in 2024. Attitudes on freedom of the press have not changed much overall.
- On all three freedoms – press, speech and internet – there have been considerable partisan shifts since 2024. Republicans have become *more* likely to see that each is completely free in the U.S., while Democrats have become *less* likely to say this.



- Overall, Americans' concerns about made-up news and information are virtually unchanged from 2024. About half (51%) now say made-up news is a very big problem in the U.S. – similar to the share who said this last year.

Related: *Americans remain concerned about press freedoms, but partisan views have flipped since 2024*

Jump to the following chapters:

Chapter 1: Widespread global public concern about made-up news
Chapter 2: Importance of press freedom, free speech and freedom on the internet
Chapter 3: How people rate press, speech and internet freedoms in their country
Chapter 4: Freedom gaps

Next: Widespread global public concern about made-up news

Questionnaire

American Trends Panel Wave 145

American Trends Panel Wave 166

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Believing in Spirits and Life After Death Is Common Around the World

Younger people are just as likely as older people to hold some spiritual beliefs

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BY JONATHAN EVANS, KIRSTEN LESAGE, WILLIAM MINER, KELSEY JO STARR AND MANOLO CORICHI

Table of Contents

(Handini Atmodiwiryo/Getty Images)

How we did this

Pew Research Center conducted this survey to measure the prevalence of a variety of religious and spiritual beliefs and practices around the world. The survey included some questions grounded in the Christian, Jewish and Muslim traditions, as well as some questions with roots in Buddhism, Hinduism and other Asian faiths. We wanted to see how widely such beliefs and practices are shared by people in different regions and different religious groups, including those who don't affiliate with any religion.

Countries included in this report

Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
"Believing in Spirits and Life After Death Is Common Around the World"

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This report is based on surveys conducted in 36 countries on six continents. The countries have a wide array of religious traditions. Some have Christian, Muslim or Jewish majorities, while others have Hindu or Buddhist majorities. A few are quite religiously mixed, and some have large shares of people who are religiously unaffiliated.

Outside the United States, this report draws on nationally representative surveys of 41,503 adults conducted from Jan. 5 to May 22, 2024. All surveys were conducted over the phone with adults in Canada, France, Germany, Greece, Italy, Japan, Malaysia, the Netherlands, Singapore, South Korea, Spain, Sweden and the United Kingdom. Surveys were conducted face-to-face in Argentina, Bangladesh, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Ghana, Hungary, India, Indonesia, Israel, Kenya, Mexico, Nigeria, Peru, the Philippines, Poland, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Tunisia and Turkey. In Australia, we used a mixed-mode, probability-based online panel.

For the U.S., data comes from respondents contacted in three separate survey waves in 2023 or 2024:

1. 11,201 respondents were surveyed from July 31 to Aug. 6, 2023**,** via Pew Research Center's American Trends Panel (ATP), an online survey

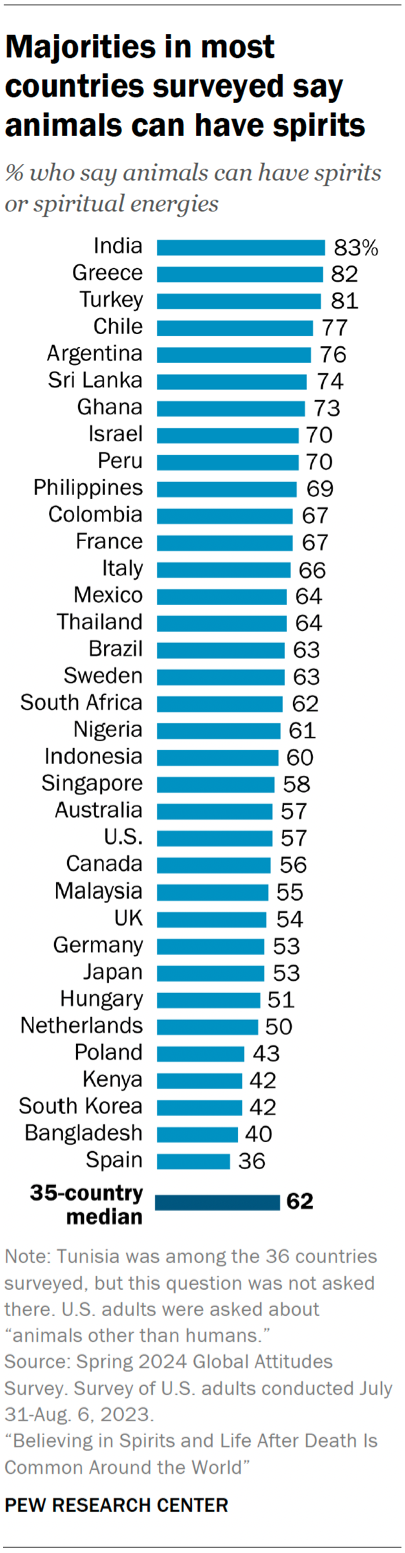
panel recruited through national random sampling of residential addresses, which gives nearly all U.S. adults a chance of selection. Read more about the ATP's methodology.

2. 12,693 respondents were surveyed from Feb. 13 to 25, 2024. Most of the respondents (10,642) in this survey are members of the ATP, and nearly all these panelists also participated in the ATP survey that concluded in Aug. 2023. The remaining U.S. respondents (2,051) in this wave are members of three other panels: the Ipsos KnowledgePanel, the NORC Amerispeak Panel and the SSRS Opinion Panel. All three are national survey panels recruited through random sampling (not "opt-in" polls). We used these additional panels to ensure that the survey would have enough Jewish and Muslim respondents to be able to report on their views.
3. In addition, U.S. data for a few questions comes from 36,908 respondents surveyed from July 17, 2023, to March 4, 2024, as part of the Center's latest Religious Landscape Study (RLS). This survey was conducted mainly online and on paper, while 3% opted to complete the interview on the telephone. The RLS was made possible by The Pew Charitable Trusts, which received support from the Lilly Endowment Inc., Templeton Religion Trust, The Arthur Vining Davis Foundations and the M.J. Murdock Charitable Trust.

This report was produced by Pew Research Center as part of the Pew-Templeton Global Religious Futures project, which analyzes religious change and its impact on societies around the world. Funding for the Global Religious Futures project comes from The Pew Charitable Trusts and the John Templeton Foundation (grant 63095). This publication does not necessarily reflect the views of the John Templeton Foundation.

Here are the questions and responses used for this report (including information about the U.S. source used for each question), along with the survey methodology.

Belief in life after death is widespread around the globe, as is the belief that spirits can reside in animals and in parts of nature such as mountains, rivers or trees, according to a Pew Research Center survey of three dozen countries with a wide range of religious traditions.



Moreover, the new survey shows that younger adults are at least as likely as older adults to hold these spiritual beliefs – *unlike* belief in God, which tends to be more common among older people, globally.

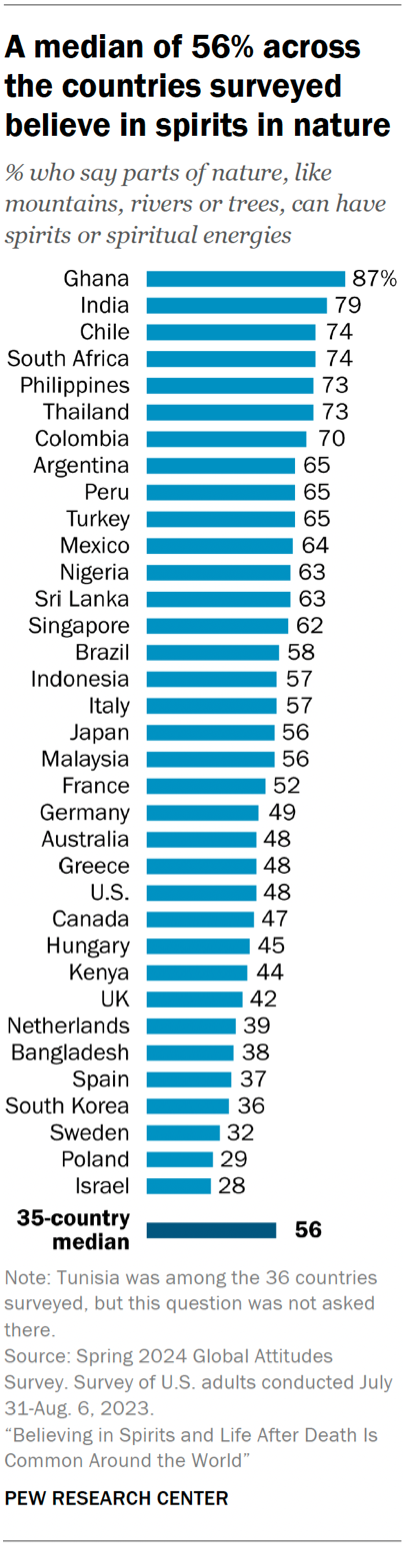
Over the last two decades, we've conducted surveys about religion and spirituality in more than 100 countries and territories. But in

this survey, for the first time, we asked more than 50,000 people across six continents about some beliefs and practices that we previously had explored only in Asia or the United States.

This allows us to draw a fuller picture of spirituality around the world. Some of the concepts we asked about have roots in specific religious traditions – such as Judaism, Christianity and Islam, Hinduism and Buddhism, or Asian folk religions. Others are associated with less formal religious traditions that some people might label "New Age."

We find that adults around the world – often across religious and geographic boundaries – share many of the beliefs and practices we asked about.

For example, majorities of adults in most countries surveyed say that **animals can have spirits or spiritual energies.** This includes 83% of adults in India, which has a Hindu majority. It also includes 81% in Muslim-majority Turkey, 76% in Christian-majority Argentina and 70% in Israel, the world's only country with a Jewish majority.



Many people around the world also believe that **parts of nature (such as mountains, rivers or trees) can have spirits or spiritual energies.** This belief is voiced by nearly three-quarters of adults in Christian-majority Chile (74%) and Buddhist-majority Thailand (73%), and by 57% in Muslim-majority Indonesia.

The U.S. falls somewhere in the middle of the countries surveyed on these questions: 57% of U.S. adults believe that animals can have spirits, while 48% say the same about mountains, rivers or trees. (Around six-in-ten U.S. adults identify as Christian, and about three-in-ten are religiously unaffiliated.)

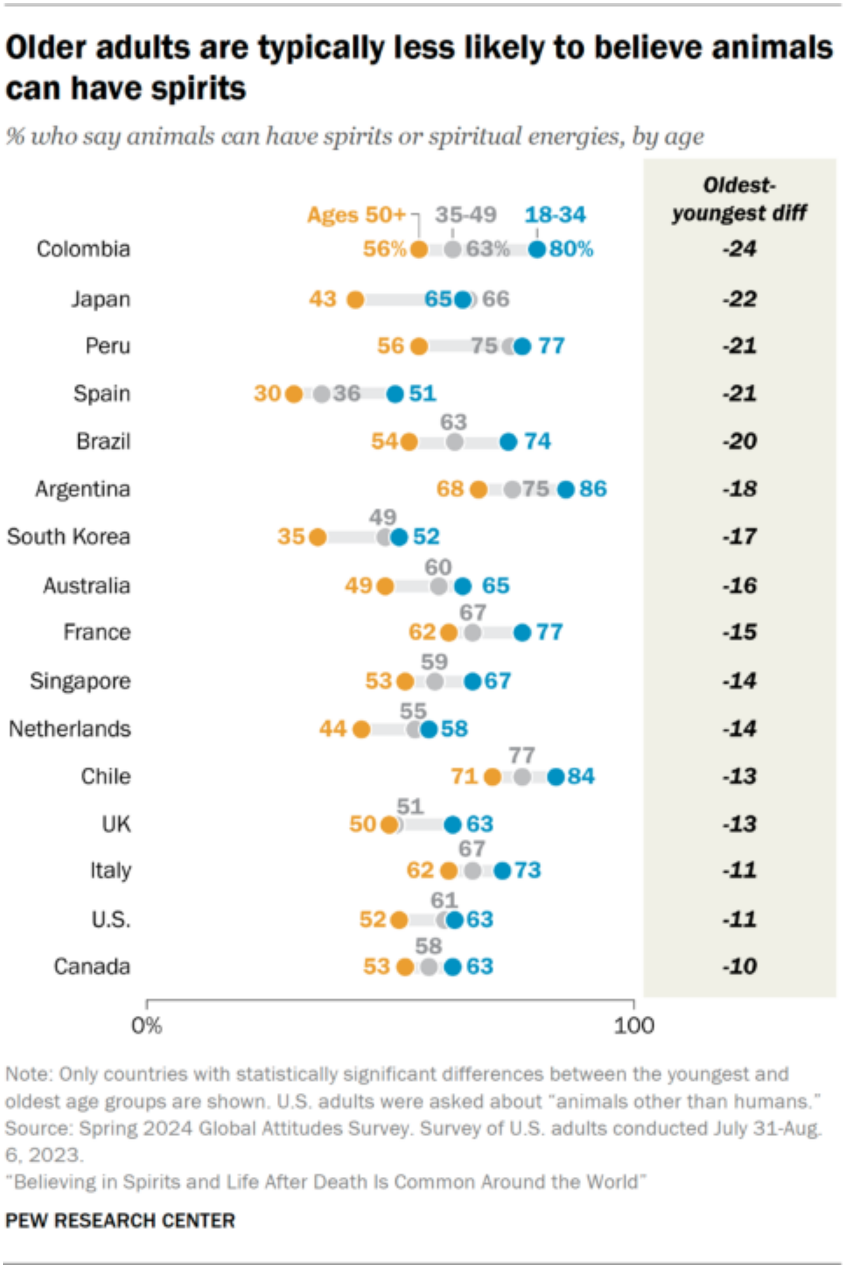
In general, people around the world are much less likely to say that **certain objects (such as crystals, jewels or stones) can have spiritual energies.**

In some countries where large segments of the population do not identify with *any* religion, belief in spiritual forces nevertheless is fairly common. In Japan, for example, 53% of adults say that animals can have spirits, and 56% say that parts of nature can have spiritual energies – even though more than half of Japanese adults are religiously unaffiliated.

Related: *Spirituality and Religion: How Does the U.S. Compare With Other Countries?*

Age differences

Previous Pew Research Center studies have shown that in many countries, older adults tend to be more religious than younger adults. This pattern has been observed around the world in traditional measures of religious identity and commitment, such as how many adults identify with a religion, attend religious services, consider religion to be very important in their lives and pray frequently.



But in addition to those standard questions, this survey includes a wider set of questions about spiritual topics, including beliefs about spirits and spiritual energies, life after death and the power of ancestral spirits. On some of these newer questions, we find much smaller differences between younger and older respondents.

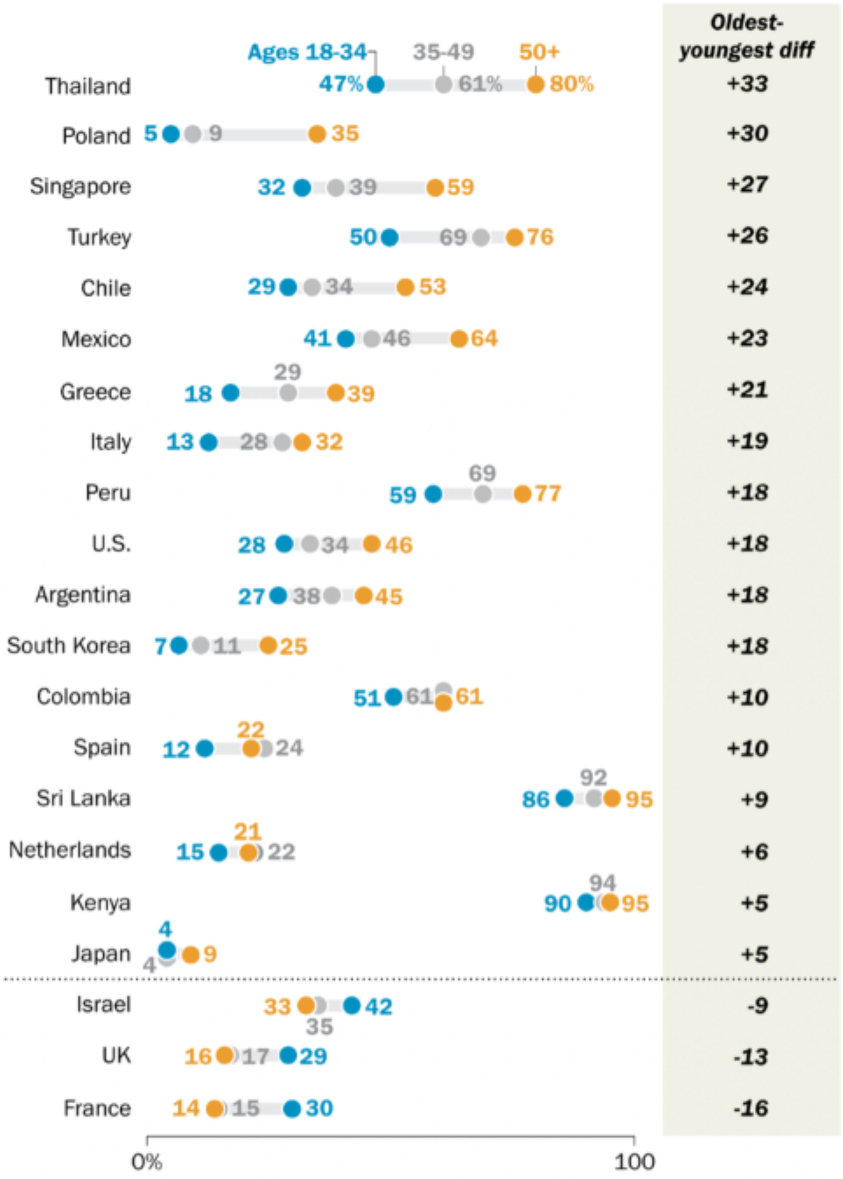
Indeed, on a couple of questions, the youngest adults (ages 18 to 34) seem to be *more* likely than the oldest adults (ages 50 and older) to believe in spiritual ideas.

For example, in about half of the countries surveyed, the belief that animals can have spirits is more common among the youngest adults than among the oldest age group. And in *no*

countries are the oldest adults significantly *more* likely than the youngest adults to hold this belief.

Older adults often are more likely to say religion is personally very important

*% who say religion is **very important** in their life, by age*



Note: Only countries with statistically significant differences between the youngest and oldest age groups are shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Religious Landscape Study of U.S. adults conducted July 17, 2023-March 4, 2024.
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Likewise, in 10 countries, the youngest adults are more likely than the oldest to say they **believe in reincarnation,** defined for survey respondents as the belief that "people will be reborn in this world again and again." In most other countries, there are no

significant age differences. Nigeria is the only place surveyed where the oldest adults are more likely than the youngest adults to believe in reincarnation (63% vs. 47%).

As in past surveys, we still find that older adults generally are more religious than younger adults when asked about topics like belief in God, attending religious services and the personal importance of religion.

For example, while eight-in-ten people ages 50 and older in Thailand say religion is very important in their lives, only about half of Thai adults under 35 say the same.

Older versus newer questions ⊖

We have asked some of the questions in this survey many times, in many places, over the past two decades. These questions are well-suited for measuring formal, organized religions – particularly Abrahamic faiths (i.e., Judaism, Christianity and Islam).

- What is your current religion?
- How important is religion in your life?
- How often do you pray?
- How often do you attend religious services?
- Do you believe in God?
- Do you fast for certain periods during holy times?

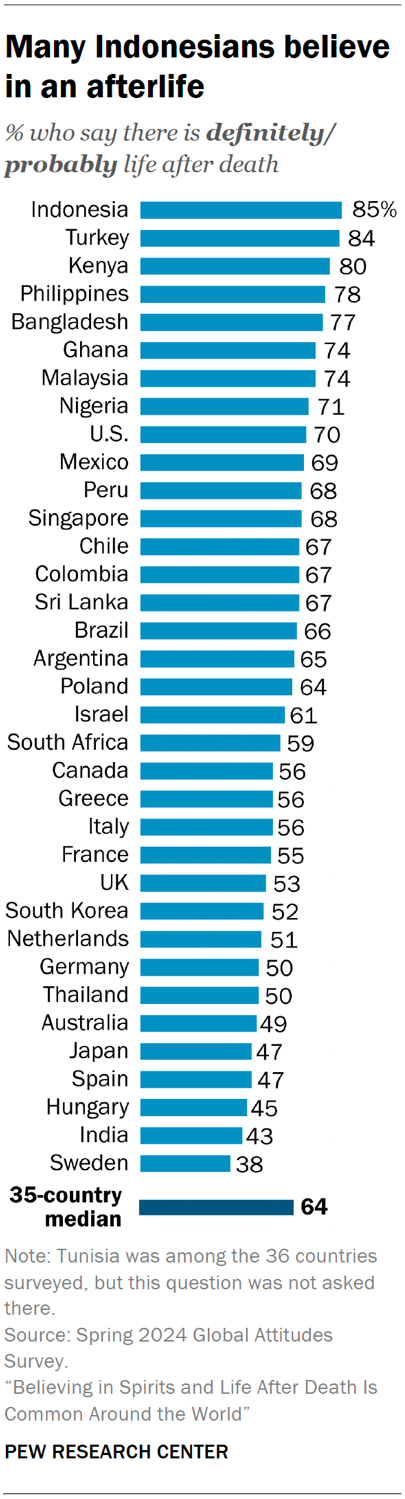
The somewhat newer questions in this survey are part of our efforts to explore a wider range of beliefs and practices. These questions largely arise from recent research we've conducted on spiritual beliefs, experiences and activities in the United States, as well as from studies we've published on religion and spirituality in India, China, South and Southeast Asia and East Asia.

- Do you think there is life after death?
- Do you believe that each of the following – parts of nature, such as mountains, rivers or trees; certain objects, such as crystals, jewels or stones; and animals – can have spirits or spiritual energies?
- Do you believe that spells, curses or other magic can influence people's lives?
- Do you believe that the spirits of ancestors can help or harm you?

- Do you believe in reincarnation – that people will be reborn in this world again and again?
- Do you wear religious items or symbols, or carry them with you?
- Do you consult a fortune teller, horoscope or other way to see the future?
- Do you light incense or candles for spiritual or religious reasons?
- Do you think there is something spiritual beyond the natural world, even if we cannot see it, or is the natural world all there is?

(For the exact wording of questions in this survey, refer to the report's Topline.

Life after death



In many previous surveys in the U.S. and some other parts of the world, we have posed questions about a specific vision of the afterlife, asking people whether they believe in heaven and, separately, whether they believe in hell. In this survey, to better allow comparisons across regions and religious traditions, we asked simply about "life after death."

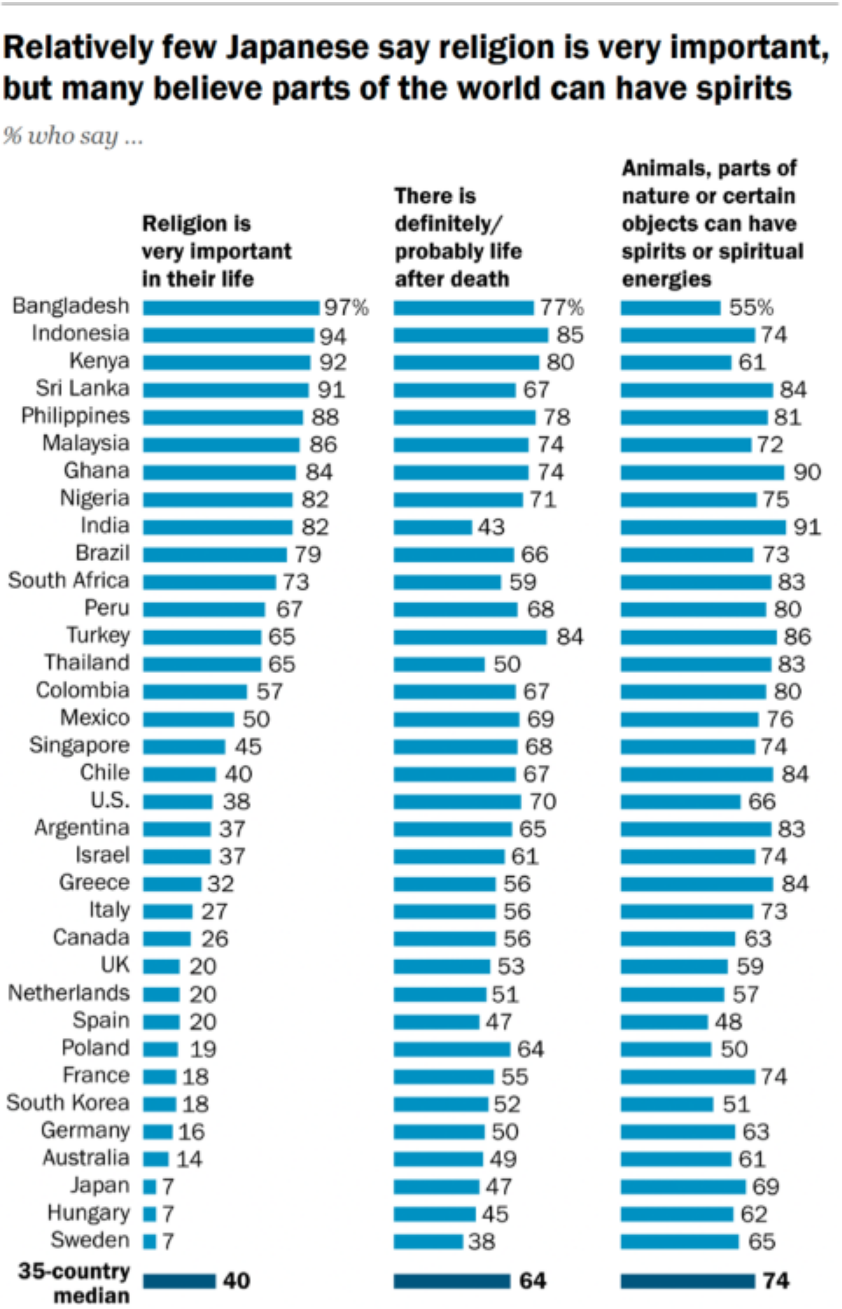
In most of the countries surveyed, a majority of adults say there is definitely or probably life after death. For example, 85% of adults in Muslim-majority Indonesia say this, as do 80% of adults in Christian-majority Kenya. And across the six Latin American countries surveyed, about two-thirds of adults believe there is an afterlife.

In a few countries, adults ages 18 to 34 are *more* likely than adults ages 50 and older to say there is an afterlife. But in the U.S. and Canada, the oldest adults are slightly more likely than the youngest adults to believe in life after death.

In the U.S., 70% of adults say there is definitely or probably life after death. (By comparison, 67% of Americans report believing in heaven, and 55% say they believe in hell, our 2023-24 U.S. Religious Landscape Study found.)

Comparing results across a spectrum of measures

In many of the countries surveyed, substantial shares of adults say religion is *very* important in their lives. This is especially true for countries in South and Southeast Asia, sub-Saharan Africa and Latin America, and less so for Western Europe. The U.S. is roughly in the middle of the pack, with 38% of Americans saying religion is very important in their lives.



Large percentages of people in most of the countries surveyed also express belief in life after death and say that animals, parts of nature (such as mountains, rivers or trees) or physical objects (such as crystals, jewels or stones) can have spirits.

While **there is no clear and widely accepted dividing line between religion and spirituality,** these questions show that even in countries where comparatively few people view religion as very important, many do hold beliefs in spirits and/or life after death.[1]

For example, relatively few Swedish adults (7%) say religion is very important to them. But more Swedes (38%) believe there is definitely or probably life after death, and nearly two-thirds believe in spirits in animals, parts of nature or objects.

On the other hand, India is among the countries where a high proportion of adults (82%) describe religion as very important in their lives. The vast majority (91%) also say that animals, parts of nature or objects can have spirits or spiritual energies. Indians (43%) are less likely than people in many of the other countries surveyed to believe in an afterlife, but about half of Indian adults (48%) believe in reincarnation.

Overall, the survey shows that some measures of religion and spirituality are strongly related to each other around the world. For example, people who say religion is very important in their lives often are more likely than others to fast during holy times, to pray daily, and to believe that spells, curses or other magic can influence people's lives.

But the importance of religion is not strongly associated with some other measures, such as the belief that animals can have spiritual energies and the belief in reincarnation.

For more on how different measures of spirituality and religiousness relate to each other, read "How newer measures compare with long-standing measures of religiousness" later in this Overview.

These are among the key findings from surveys of more than 50,000 adults conducted by Pew Research Center in 36 countries. Surveys outside the U.S. were conducted from January through May 2024. Survey data for the U.S. comes from two waves of the

Center's American Trends Panel conducted in summer 2023 and February 2024, as well as from the most recent U.S. Religious Landscape Study (conducted July 2023 through March 2024). Globally, interviews were conducted in several dozen languages. For more information on how the data was collected in each country, read the Methodology.

The rest of this Overview covers:

- Economic connections to beliefs and practices
- Differences by religious group
- How newer measures compare with long-standing measures of religiousness

This report also includes:

- Chapter 1: God, spirits and the natural world
- Chapter 2: Beliefs about the afterlife
- Chapter 3: Spells, curses and ways to see the future
- Chapter 4: Spiritual and religious practices
- Chapter 5: Religious importance and religious affiliation

Economic connections to beliefs and practices

Scholars have long studied the relationship between economic development and religion, with "secularization theory" broadly positing that as societies become more economically and technologically advanced, religion and religious values become less important in people's lives.

This theory continues to be debated, but international survey data has demonstrated a general pattern in which people in wealthier countries tend to pray less often and view belief in God as less important for morality, while people in less economically advanced countries tend to describe religion as more important in their lives.

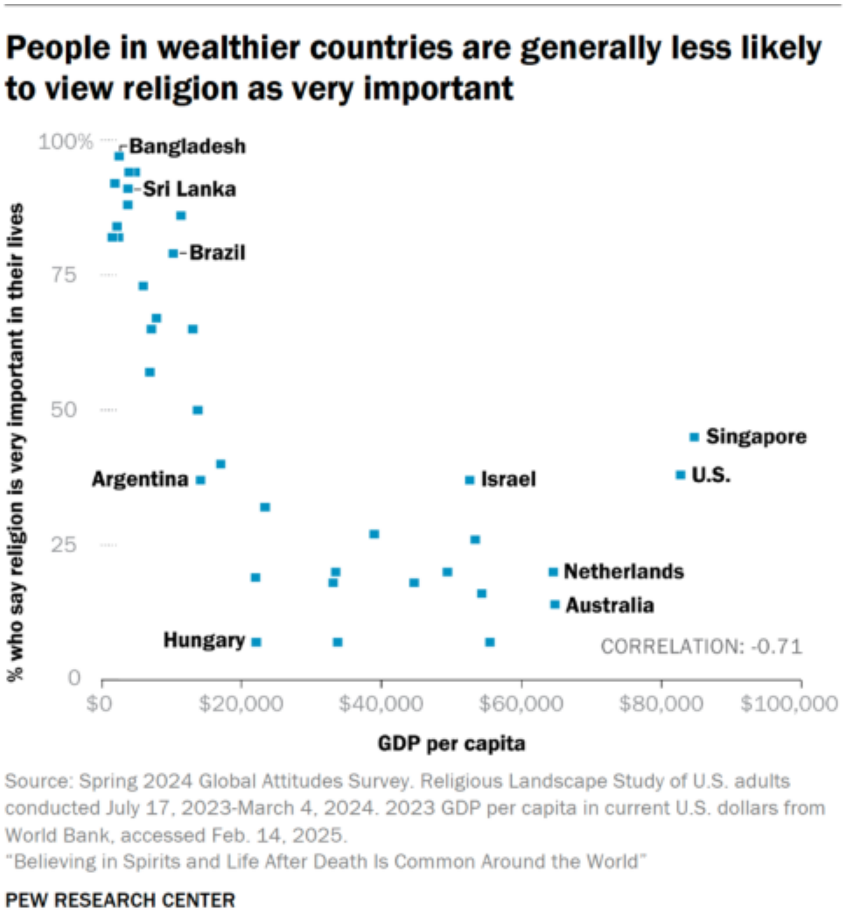
This economic pattern continues to hold for traditional measures of religiousness (such as importance of religion,

daily prayer and belief in God) in the three dozen countries analyzed in this report.

However, levels of national income are much less clearly correlated with some of the newer questions in the survey about religious and spiritual beliefs – such as belief in the power of ancestral spirits and the existence of "something spiritual beyond the natural world."

Importance of religion

The share of people in each country who say religion is very important in their lives broadly follows what secularization theory would predict. Wealthier countries – those with higher per capita gross domestic product (GDP) – tend to have lower shares of adults who say religion is very important in their lives, with a fairly strong correlation.



In 11 countries, around eight-in-ten or more adults say religion is very important to them, and all these countries have relatively low

GDPs per capita. They include Buddhist-, Christian-, Hindu- and Muslim-majority societies.

Conversely, in 11 countries, only two-in-ten adults or fewer say religion is very important in their lives, and all 11 are relatively wealthy countries (measured by GDP per capita). They include places with strong ties to Buddhism and Christianity, though most currently have large percentages of religiously unaffiliated adults.

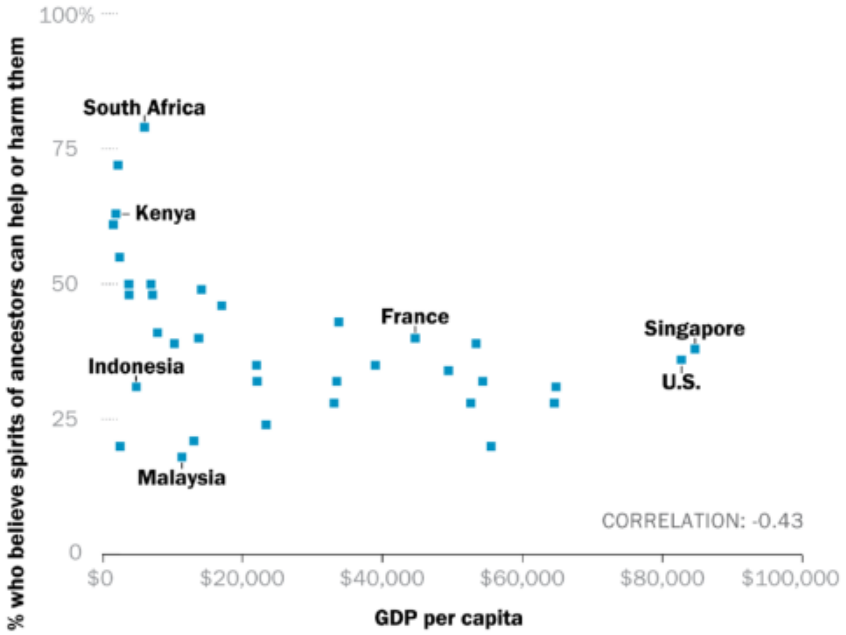
Two high-income countries stand out on this measure. Singapore and the U.S. have the highest per capita GDPs of the countries surveyed, yet they fall in the middle on the question about religion's personal importance, with 45% of Singaporeans and 38% of Americans saying religion is very important in their lives.

The correlation between economic advancement and religiousness also holds for several other measures, including religious service attendance; belief in God; and the belief that spells, curses or other magic can influence people's lives. On these questions, wealthier countries tend to be the least religious, while less advanced economies are generally the most religious.

Belief that ancestors can affect the living

But the connection between economics and spirituality is not always so strong. For example, the correlation is much weaker on a question about whether ancestral spirits can help or harm the living.

Countries' economic status is only modestly related to the belief that ancestral spirits can affect the living



Note: Tunisia was among the 36 countries surveyed, but this question was not asked there.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. 2023 GDP per capita in current U.S. dollars from World Bank, accessed Feb. 14, 2025.
"Believing in Spirits and Life After Death Is Common Around the World"

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Some of the less economically developed countries we surveyed have the highest shares of people who believe that the spirits of ancestors can intervene in our lives. Kenya (63%) and South Africa (79%) fall in that category.

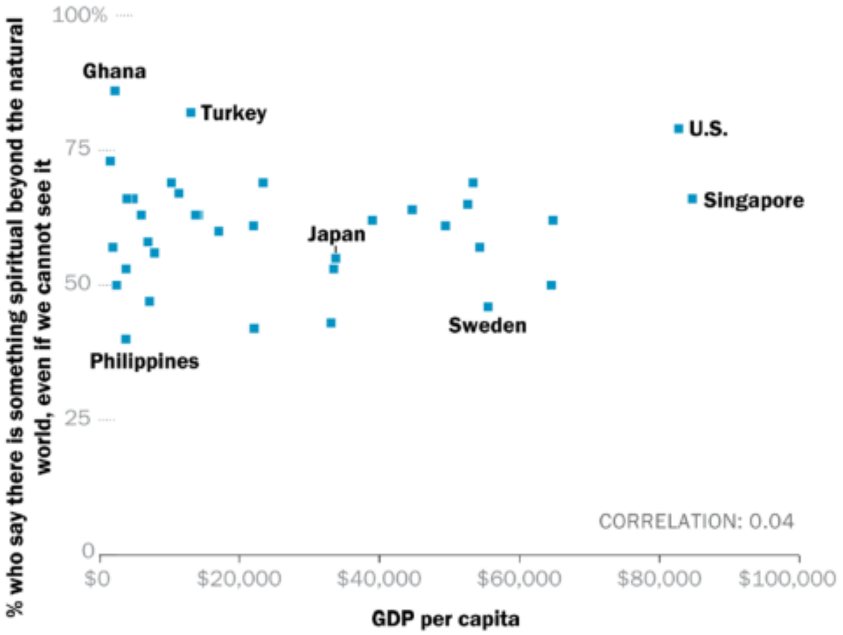
Economics is not the only factor at play – the religious makeup of a country also has a role. For instance, the Muslim-majority countries of Bangladesh, Indonesia, Malaysia and Turkey also are among the less wealthy countries in our survey, yet people in those countries are among the *least* likely to say ancestors can interact with the living in these ways.

Something spiritual beyond the natural world

One measure of spirituality has basically no relationship with a country's level of economic development: Living in a wealthier country is generally *not* correlated with either higher or lower shares of adults who say "there is something spiritual beyond the

natural world, even if we cannot see it" rather than selecting the alternative response that "the natural world is all there is."

No correlation between a country's wealth and whether people say there is something spiritual beyond the natural world



Note: Results for Bangladesh are excluded due to a translation error.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Religious Landscape Study of U.S. adults conducted July 17, 2023-March 4, 2024. 2023 GDP per capita in current U.S. dollars from World Bank, accessed Feb. 14, 2025.
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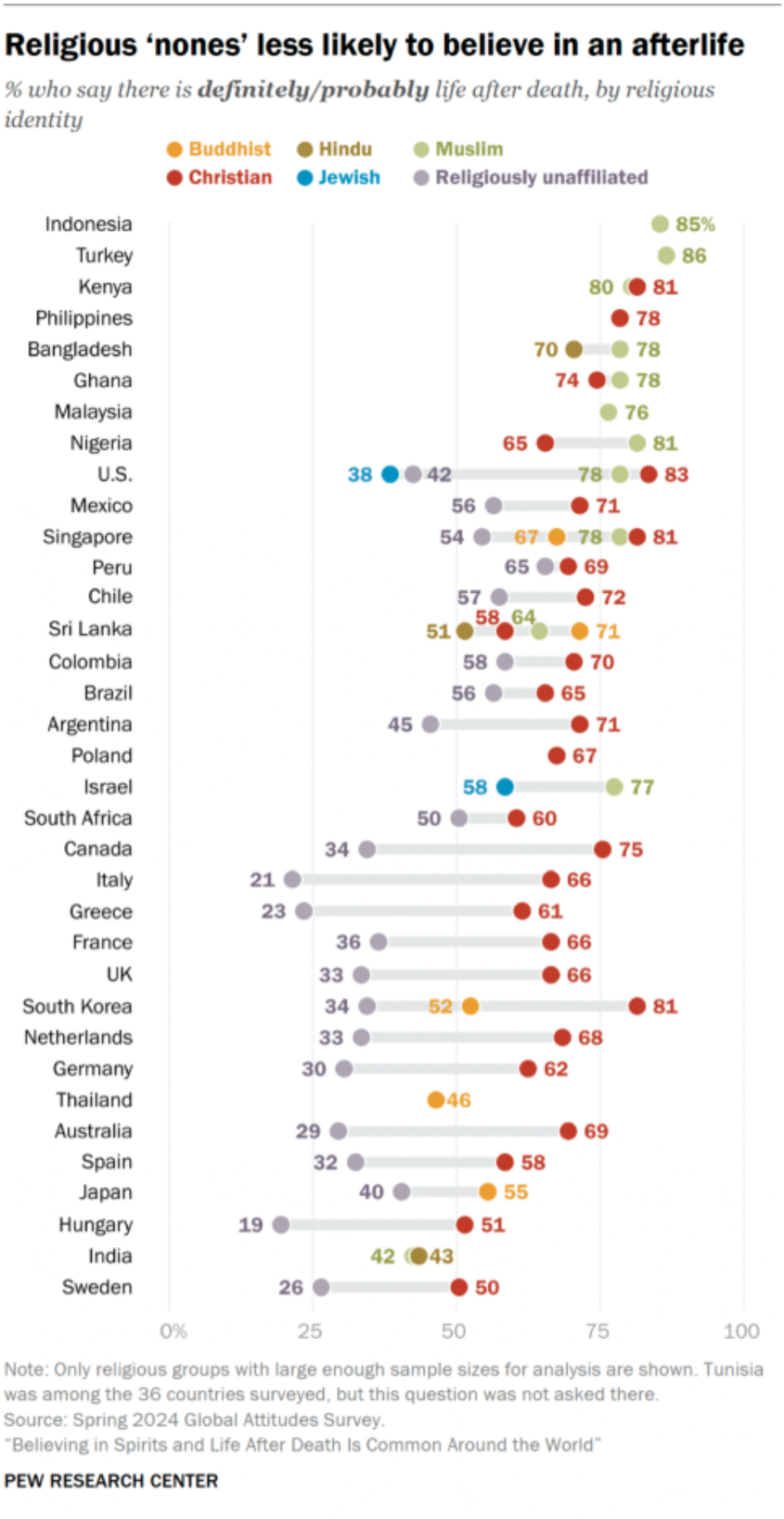
The U.S. and Sweden, for instance, each have among the highest per capita GDPs in this survey. Yet a majority of U.S. adults (79%) say there is something spiritual beyond the natural world, while Swedish adults (46%) are among the *least* likely to say this.

Likewise, the countries with the lowest per capita GDPs represent a wide range of views on whether there is something spiritual beyond the natural world – from 86% in Ghana to 40% in the Philippines.

Differences by religious group

While levels of economic development seem to be connected to some aspects of spirituality and religion, we also see significant patterns based on religious identity. The nuances of these patterns

vary depending on the specific measure. But in general, people who are religiously *unaffiliated* – i.e., those who describe themselves as atheist, agnostic or "nothing in particular" and are sometimes referred to as religious "nones" – tend to be less religious than people who affiliate with a religion within each country.



For example, in Germany, Christians are twice as likely as adults with no religion to say there is definitely or probably life after death (62% vs. 30%). And in nearly every country with enough Muslims to analyze separately, a majority of Muslims says there is

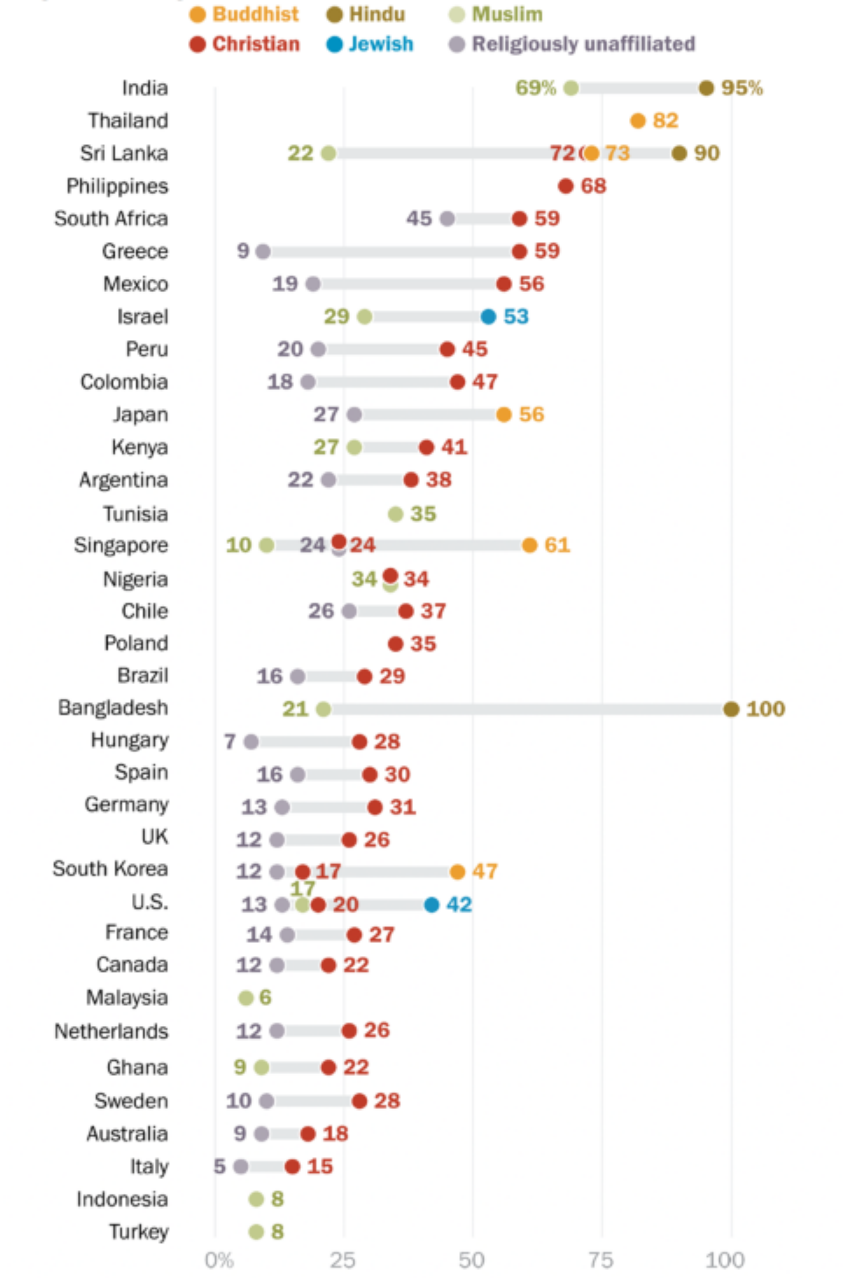
life after death. Only in India do fewer than half of Muslims (42%) believe in an afterlife.

Meanwhile, Jewish adults in the U.S. and Israel (the only countries in the survey with sufficient samples of Jews to analyze) are much less likely than Muslims in the same two countries to believe in an afterlife.

A different pattern emerges when comparing the shares of people who say they light incense or candles for spiritual or religious reasons. In Israel and the U.S., Jews are the *most* likely religious group to follow this practice. Muslims in both countries are much less likely to say they light candles or incense for religious or spiritual reasons.

Overwhelming shares of Hindus say they use candles or incense for spiritual or religious reasons

% who say they light incense or candles for spiritual or religious reasons, by religious identity



Note: Only religious groups with large enough sample sizes for analysis are shown.
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey.
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Across the other 34 countries surveyed, though, Hindus and Buddhists tend to be the most likely to light incense or candles for spiritual or religious reasons. In India, for instance, nearly all Hindus follow this practice, while about two-thirds of Muslims do so.

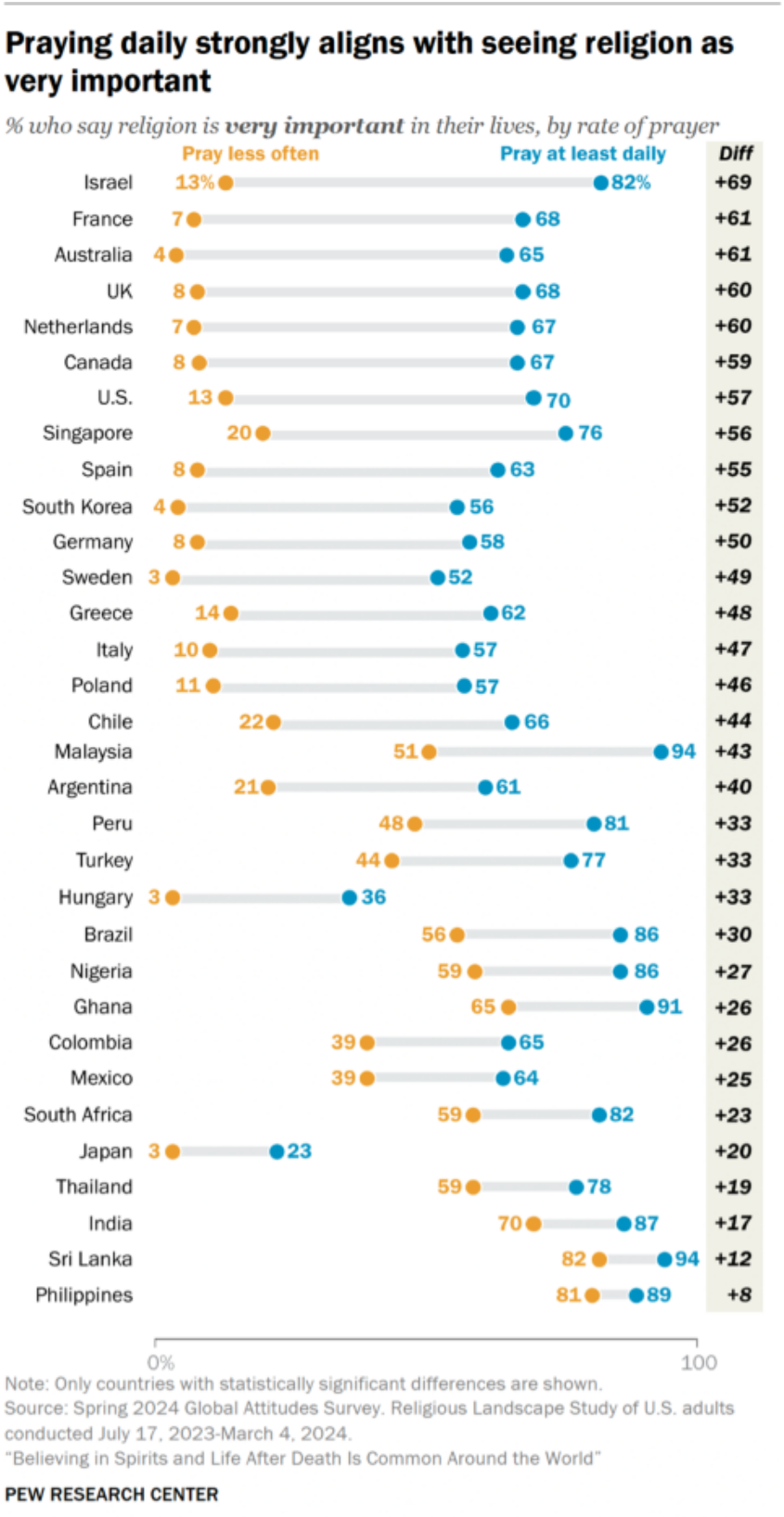
And in countries with sufficient sample sizes to analyze Hindus and Buddhists separately, those two groups are consistently the most likely to say they believe in reincarnation – a mainstream teaching in both religions.

To read how people in different religious groups answered specific survey questions, go to the chapters on God and spirits, the afterlife, spells and ways to see the future, spiritual and religious practices, and the importance of religion in one's life.

How newer measures compare with long-standing measures of religiousness

For decades, researchers have relied on some core measures of religious identity, beliefs and practices to assess the religiousness of individuals and societies, by asking questions such as:

- What is your current religion?
- How important is religion in your life?
- How often do you pray?
- How often do you attend religious services?
- Do you believe in God?



These measures are strongly associated with each other. In other words, if a person prays daily, that individual is significantly more likely than adults who pray less often to consider religion to be very important.

In Argentina, for example, 61% of adults who pray daily say that religion is very important in their lives, compared with 21% of Argentines who pray less often. Meanwhile, in Japan, 23% of those who pray daily say that religion is very important, while just 3% of Japanese adults who pray less often say religion is very important in their lives.

But what happens when we compare these long-standing measures of religiousness with the *newer* questions included in this survey?

The results depend on the measures used.

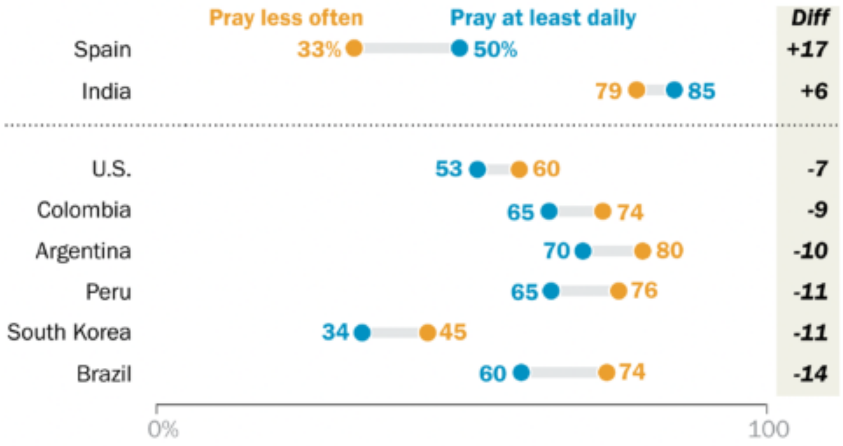
In general, there is a strong association between standard measures of religious commitment and whether people believe in life after death.

In Israel, for example, adults who pray daily are twice as likely as those who pray less often to believe there is life after death (92% vs. 45%).

But on some other measures, there is only a weak alignment – or even none at all.

Praying daily does not consistently align with beliefs about animals having spirits

% who say animals can have spirits or spiritual energies, by rate of prayer



Note: Only countries with statistically significant differences are shown. U.S. adults were asked about "animals other than humans."
Source: Spring 2024 Global Attitudes Survey. Survey of U.S. adults conducted July 31-Aug. 6, 2023.
"Believing in Spirits and Life After Death Is Common Around the World"

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For instance, in most countries, adults who pray daily do *not* significantly differ from those who pray less often in their inclination to believe that animals have spirits, or in the likelihood that they consult a fortune teller or use other ways to see the future. This may reflect the fact that these beliefs and practices are less orthodox or central to the dominant faith traditions in many countries.

CORRECTION (May 14, 2025): A previous version of the chart "Praying daily does not consistently align with beliefs about animals having spirits" misstated the difference in responses to the question by rate of prayer in India. The chart has been replaced. This change does not substantively affect the findings of this report.

Next: God, spirits and the natural world

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1. There is an active debate among scholars over how to define religion and spirituality. Some survey questions that traditionally have been used to measure religiousness (such as rates of daily prayer and attendance at religious services) are more appropriate for Abrahamic religions (Judaism, Christianity and Islam) than they are for other faith traditions. Consequently, this survey also includes questions based on Pew Research Center's previous regional surveys in parts of Asia – asking, for example, about the power of ancestral spirits and whether parts of nature (such as mountains, rivers or trees) can have spirits or spiritual energies. In this report, we use "spirituality" loosely to refer to beliefs or practices that don't necessarily imply participation in, or identification with, any organized religion. At the same time, we do not wish to suggest that there is a clear dividing line between religion and spirituality. We often use the two terms together or interchangeably. ↩

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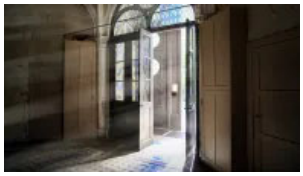

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